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I.I Prolegomena to any Future Tradition

As a thought experiment, we shall attempt, in several posts, to specify the characteristics of what Tradition in the West will have to look like, based on the 400+ preceding posts. In particular, we will look at the following elements:

1. Foundation
2. External structure
3. Internal Structure
4. Practical Dualism

These characteristics will be looked at from the point of view of a spiritual race. Features based on biological or psychic race are not part of this consideration, since they are contingent and arbitrary. Specifically, the originary races no longer exist as such, due first of all to migrations and secondly because the race of the soul alters over time.

Foundation A tradition always has a divine or supernatural founder who is its lawgiver and formative spirit. Thus any and all attempts to build on merely human thought forms are destined to fall short. This divine person reveals the cosmic law and is the unifying factor among the various segments of the members of the tradition.

External Structure The external structure follows the divine plan. There must be a spiritual authority that understands, interprets, and teaches the revealed law. Beneath that is the temporal power that implements the law for the benefit of all, justly, according to the merits and needs of the members. A producing segment provides for the economic well-being of the group. This requires a caste based system of the regal-spiritual caste, a warrior caste, and a productive caste. An Internet comment brought to our attention claims that “Gornahoor loves castes”. It is not a question of “loving” castes for their own sake, but rather a love for the revelation of cosmic law. A caste system is the simple recognition that people have different talents and interests and thus need a place in society where they fit in. The opposite of this is so-called egalitarianism, which is never such in practice since some will attempt to gain power by unprincipled means based on money or mere physical prowess.

Internal Structure Men will understand and experience themselves as threefold beings: spirit, soul, and body. The soul and body are natural elements, irreducible to each other, while the spirit is transcendent. The spirit, or rational soul, understands the external and internal structures directly and intuitively, without the intermediary of discursive thought.

Practical Dualism Men learn to fight the greater and lesser battles, the former for their individual souls, the latter for each other. Every man capable engages in this battle in his own consciousness, siding with the forces of the cosmos against those of chaos. He must learn to assert the

primacy of the spirit over the soul, and the soul over the body. His tools are meditation, prayer, rites, sacraments, clairvoyant vision, hence this can never be reduced to a mere system of thought. We call this practical dualism, since it is part of this experience, although it is not a real dualism. Chaos had no independent existence, but as long as we experience it as resistance, it is a privation, not a thing in itself.

To be victorious, a man must know how to think, how to fast, and how to wait. While instrumental and logical thought have their place, man must, however, learn again how to think. Discursive thought, with each thought connected to another, creates a tight web, like chain-mail, that obscures the light of Being. Thoughts need to come in isolation and understood more as acts of perception rather than as a secondary experience of being.

While caloric fasting leads to loner physical life, mind fasting is the path to eternal life. Thus, the first trial is to purge the mind of opinions, beliefs, theories, unexamined assumptions that are connected together in the flow of consciousness. When freed of this lower mind, then the mind of spirit can gain gnosis, a direct intuition of the world of ideas. Man must also fast from the stories he uses to organize his life. Habitual ways of looking at the world, repeated tales of wrong doings, injustices, excuses, and justifications are dropped in the mind fast.

Then there is the waiting. When the mind is freed of false ideas and emotional perturbations, it can act as a perfect reflector of the Spirit, allowing it to come into consciousness. There is no technology for this, no technique, no drug, no practice, no gene, no new theory, no weekend seminar, no new age “mind treatment”.

Posted on 2011-09-26 by Cologero

Traditional psychology

2.1 Stages of Initiation

Louis Claude de Saint-Martin separated men into four categories.

Man of Torrent The Man of Torrent is caught up in the world process. He accepts things as they appear. He identifies with his thoughts, feelings, likes, dislikes, and desires. However, since they are so variable, he lacks a stable identity, thinking one thing today, another thing tomorrow, willing one thing today, another tomorrow.

Man of Desire The Man of Desire is no longer satisfied with ordinary life and the desire for something else begins to burn in him. He is a seeker, he reads and studies metaphysical ideas, he questions consensus opinions about religion and political systems. He learns to meditate. He challenges and tests himself, physically, emotionally, intellectually. He seeks to overcome the prison that fear, lust, greed, and guilt keep him in. Still tied to the physical, he is still tempted to enter debates with the men of torrent,

believing that his rationality will persuade them. In many areas, he is still attached to the tastes and values of the men of torrent.

The New Man The New Man is more developed and avoids the errors of the men of desire. He has calmed many of the distractions that perturb consciousness. Through introspection, he gains self-knowledge. This allows him to understand human nature and how man is moved by the random thoughts and feelings that pass through his mind.

Spirit Man Or Guenon's True Man¹. This man has realized all his possibilities as a man. He has mastered the personal element: the arbitrary thoughts, feelings, likes, dislikes, and desires no longer perturb his consciousness. He is in the Primordial State and his consciousness is a clear reflector of transcendent ideas. No longer tormented by doubt and inconsistent thoughts, he has true Will. Since he wills one thing, he is pure of heart. He avoids inter-religious debates, since he follows the primordial tradition. He is unconcerned about solar or lunar initiations, since he has undergone both.

Posted on 2010-11-10 by Cologero

2.2 Metaphysics and Philosophy

Because we write about topics such as being, religion, knowledge, history and the like — topics philosophers like to deal with — some readers of Gornahoor have the mistaken impression that we are also philosophers. Hence, they presume we are defending a particular philosophico-religious system, or trying to promote one; then they desire to engage in debate, for their own unfathomable purposes. Philosophy in our time

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1039>

involves speculative theories about the nature of the world and mind or else a tedious logical analysis of words. This is far from our task. Readers wishing to discuss topics are obliged to read the entire blog, or at least related material, prior to drawing any conclusions.

As we pointed out in *Metaphysical Positivism*², we regard metaphysics as an exact science analogous to physics.

Physics The science of the natural, or external, world

Metaphysics the science of the states of the inner world

When someone denies the possibility of such metaphysical knowledge, they are like the bishops who denied the existence of Jupiter's moons discovered by Galileo. In the latter case, the solution is simple: look through the telescope. Analogously, in the former case, the solution lies in meditation or other spiritual exercises that will unveil the inner world. The obstacle is, however, that in metaphysics, "to know is to be". That means that, in order to know a particular inner state, one's very being much change to be in that state. Few are willing to go through the trouble; perhaps it is not even an option for many.

Such a change in being is not required in order to look through the telescope, a task that is readily accomplished by anyone. Therefore, physics is universal, democratic and egalitarian. Metaphysics is necessarily just the opposite.

We relate this to the trichotomous structure of man³ in Table 2.1.

The body is part of gross manifestation, or nature. It is subject to the laws of physics. We may not be accustomed to regarding our soul life as part of manifestation, but it consists of our thought, desires, moods, feelings, daydreams, fantasies, likes, dislikes and so on. It is part of our human state. Physics is the science of gross manifestation, metaphysics

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1189>

³<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1029>

Spirit	Non-formal manifestation
Soul	Subtle manifestation
Body	Gross manifestation

Table 2.1: The trichotomous structure of man

of subtle manifestation or higher states. Hence, just as the physicist is detached when he studies the movements of the planets, so also must the metaphysician be when he observes the movement of thoughts, fantasies, and so on in his consciousness.

In the Kali Yuga, man's identity is centered in his soul life⁴, so it is very unnatural to have that sense of detachment in regards to the events in one's own consciousness. The "analog I" is being asked to detach from the very objects of consciousness he is creating. That is why so many spiritual practices are aimed at destroying that identity of one's being with the analog I.

The Spirit refers to non-formal manifestation. Whereas the soul and body are part of the phenomenal world, that is, part of our experience, the spirit cannot be an object of consciousness. In other words, it is noumenal; we can't know it as an object, but rather as subject, a direct intuitive knowledge of oneself as subject. In most men, this awareness will be vague or even non-existent, that is, it is virtual. In the True Man, it is actualized as one's true will.

Posted on 2011-01-23 by Cologero

* * *

Ted on 2011-01-23 at 17:52 said:

Good article. However, the positions of Soul and Spirit should be reversed As Evola shows in his book "The Hermetic Tradition", the attainment of the Soul is a stage in Alchemy which

⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1374>

occurs after the attainment of the Spirit. The Spirit is feminine and represents the Moon and subtle while the Soul is masculine and represents the Sun and higher states of being above that of the subtle realm. This seems to be a common error in much esoteric writing.

Other than that, this article was excellent.

Cologero on 2011-01-23 at 22:51 said:

Unfortunately, Ted, there is merely a confusion of terminology. In the beginning of the chapter "Soul, Spirit, and Body" in *Hermetic Tradition*, Evola makes this clear: "It should be noted henceforth that soul and spirit do not possess the same meaning here that they do in our time."

To make it more confusing, in other parts of the book, Evola seems to reverse the meanings of soul and spirit again. That is why it is more important to understand principles, not vocabulary. English is not a very precise language when it comes to metaphysical topics.

It gets even worse. In the chapter "Sulfur, Mercury, and Salt" in Guenon's "The Great Triad", Guenon uses the word soul and spirit in our sense. So both Guenon and Evola make the equivalence between mercury and passivity. But Evola writes "Spirit is Mercury" (ch 13) and Guenon claims that Mercury corresponds to the soul. Nevertheless, they are not disagreeing with each other on this point, despite the seeming verbal contradiction.

Ismo Meinander on 2011-01-24 at 03:58 said:

I think the terminology should many times be looked from different angles depending on where one stands currently, something like the planetary archetypes in astrology, in which different archetypes reside in each other and affect each other while one remains the primary dominating one. For example, "mercury as spirit" would mean the spirit as a dissolving force that draws everything back into the "one life", back into the liquid state without distinction, and "mercury as soul" would mean the higher intellect so. buddhi; and "sulphur as spirit" means the fiery, dry force of will that asserts itself and "sulphur as soul" would mean the fiery, passionate and timid forces of the individual. Salt seems to be the most stable symbol of the body, but we can also remember the gospel saying about "the salt of the earth", in which it means people who can bring light of reason and meaning into peoples lives, and salt can be related also to the reasonal, logical faculties via its symbolical structure. And so on.

It can be confusing, that's for certain. The alchemists and hermeticists didn't hide their art behind apparently meaningless mumbo-jumbo without sufficient reason. Just as Cologero said: it is more important to understand principles, not vocabulary.

Cologero on 2011-01-24 at 20:08 said:

Thumos is not identical to the soul, it is one tendency. Eros is another. Get out of theory and observe your own consciousness.

You can experience a desire (eros) independent of thumos. The intelligence will decide whether or not to act on it, or how best to satisfy it. The desire may be strong, so some “will-power” (thumos) may have to be called up. In this case, thumos may be active in relation to eros, yet passive in relation to nous; so it is not absolutely masculine, just relatively.

Observe a moment of anger arising. Perhaps someone slighted you, a friend irritated you, a car cut you off on the highway. In this case, do you summon that anger or does it arise spontaneously in reaction to the event? I’m certain it is the latter. That is what makes it passive, or feminine. If the nous is not strong enough to channel it, you will act on that anger, probably in an ineffective way.

Say you are preparing for a sporting contest or some other competitive activity. In this case, you will “pump yourself up”, that is, use the energy of thumos to improve performance.

The point is that this is not really a matter for opinions or thoughts. One must learn to observe oneself over time in many different situations. Then one comes to understand himself, one’s nous is strengthened. One then sees the folly and futility of all the debates he used to participate in.

That is why we are taking Gornahoor “private”. There is only so much that can be shared via theoretical discussions. These need to be replaced with self-observation and spiritual exercises, at least for those able and willing to make the efforts.

Graham on 2011-01-24 at 21:47 said:

Ah, thumos is passion. I was mistranslating thumos as will.

2.3 Phenomenology of the Medieval Mind

The man who knows the future is the man who wills the future.

In *The Discarded Image*, **C. S. Lewis** offers this somewhat strange suggestion:

[Facts] become valuable only in so far as they enable us to enter more fully into the consciousness of our ancestors by realising how such a universe must have affected those who believed in it. The recipe for such realisation is not the study of books. You must go out on a starry night and walk about for half an hour trying to see the sky in terms of the old cosmology.

If that old cosmology is false, as Lewis believes and as it seems to be from the purely quantitative aspect, what would be the point of that exercise? Lewis thinks like a modern. There is a world “out there, right now”. It is experienced by a self-enclosed mind, which then devises various theories of models to explicate that world. This is hardly the “consciousness of our ancestors”.

The Medieval mind experienced things quite differently. For him, man, situated between the worlds of spirit and matter, was thus a Microcosm of the enclosing Macrocosm. The physical world is a reflection of the spiritual world. In knowing the physical world, man simultaneously knew the spiritual world, participating in the realm of Ideas. Modern man, whose consciousness is formed by the thoughts of a Francis Bacon⁵, ignores the realm of ideas. Instead, he experiences phenomena and investigates the causes of their motions.

The Medieval man is ruled by the Logos, that is, Logic, for which cause and effect are meaningless. He is interested in Form, the “what”, the “why”, the “purpose”. For him, there is a correspondence between the spiritual and the material, the inner world and the outer. It is wildly wide of the mark, for example, to believe that the Medieval mind thinks that the planets affected his consciousness like some strange sort of physical force. Rather, he sees a correspondence between the starry night and his inner states, not an abstract cause. So, a better meditation would be, while looking out at the heavens, to also look within and recognize the correspondence. Below, we give some examples from *The Discarded Image*.

Wits and Senses Corresponding to the five outer senses of touch, smell, taste, sight, and hearing, there are the five inner wits.

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3468>

Memory	The ability to recall past experiences
Estimation	Subconscious awareness, knowing “in the gut”
Imagination	The formation of images of external things
Fantasy	The ability to consider in one’s mind things that have not been experienced
Common sense	The ability to recognize a unity from the many impressions coming from the external senses.

Humours As in all Traditional and esoteric teachings, the Medievals were concerned with identifying personality types. They recognized four main types corresponding to (not caused by) the qualitative elements and bodily processes, as well as the combinations thereof. An active meditation is to recognize these qualities in those you meet during the day.

Element	Fluid	Humour
Air	Blood	Sanguine
Fire	Yellow Bile	Choleric
Earth	Black Bile	Melancholic
Water	Phlegm	Phlegmatic

Planets The planets, too, correspond to various moods, few of which are even recognizable to contemporary men. Note how few of these you use in your quotidian life. Again, we note the triple division: from the spirit, we have the spiritual hierarchy⁶; from matter, the element; finally, the correspondence to an inner state.

As Lewis rightly points out, it is insufficient to know about these moods, but rather to know them intuitively, in one’s own consciousness. Of course, the motions of the planets, or the variations of our moods,

⁶<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1941>

Planet	Metal	Mood
Saturn	Lead	Saturnine
Jupiter	Tin	Jovial
Mars	Iron	Martial
Sol	Gold	Solar
Venus	Copper	Amorous
Mercury	Quicksilver	Mercurial
Moon	Silver	Lunar

appear in various constellations or patterns⁷. These we must learn to recognize in ourselves, lest we be controlled by them. In thus knowing ourselves, we become master of our own destinies. The man who knows the future is the man who wills the future.

Posted on 2011-12-18 by Cologero

* * *

logres on 2011-12-20 at 21:11 said:

Taste goes with common sense, estimation with smell, fantasy with hearing, memory with touch, & imagination with sight? Need to look this one up...

2.4 View from the Primordial State

What heaven wishes
Fortune ordains
Reason demands
and, above all, what my will desires.

DON QUIXOTE

⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2377>

In general, grace does two things. First, it remedies the defects in the natural order that have resulted from original sin, at least partially restoring what would have existed had the Fall not occurred. Second, it directs nature to an even higher, supernatural end — the beatific vision.

EDWARD FESER

Human Stratification The esoteric understanding of human differences is not horizontal, in the sense that people differ by races or nationality. Rather, the more important differences are in the vertical direction. Thus the notion of castes is used to explain it. However, caste has the connotation of being hereditary, so it is misleading. Castes can also be defined by function, as in the trifunctional classification of Georges Dumézil. But even that distinction does not take into account that people may functionally be in a caste that is inappropriate to them. That is noticeably true in decadent epochs like the Kali Yuga. So “class” as used here has no other connotations. Hence, it is incumbent to understand the inner state appropriate to each caste. These are defined by how they relate to the three primary influences in the world: Providence, Will, Destiny.

- **First class:** they are guided by “what Heaven wishes”, or Providence. They are the spiritual leaders. Those in this class have realized a permanent sense of the transcendent Self. They live only for humanity and have come to help. These are in direct contact with the 1st angelic hierarchy. They have chosen their incarnation to accomplish a specific task.
- **Second class:** they are guided by their Will, which is aligned with the Will of God. They include the political leaders and warriors. People in this class consciously take part in the conflict between good and evil. They have developed, to an extent, a strong sense of

Self-awareness and are led by the 2nd angelic hierarchy. They fight for causes that are larger than their own individuality, which they learn to recognize over time.

- **Third class:** they are subject to Destiny which they have been given by God. They have not yet developed a real sense of I and are victims of the curses resulting from the Fall. The people of the third class are all still experiencing their own karma and looking for their real purpose in life. They are under the leadership of the 3rd angelic hierarchy.

Since they don't have a true sense of Self, their psychic center is dominated by one of the three soul functions:

- **Thinking:** Those dominated by the Thinking function seek out rational knowledge and love to dispute and debate. They believe that the road to knowledge is paved by a selection of books.
 - **Emotions:** Those dominated by the Feeling function are moved by strong emotions. Since emotions are so fickle, it is difficult to establish a stable sense of Self.
 - **Sensations:** They seek out "experiences", and are guided by what they like or dislike. They are dominated by the Will, but a will untrammelled by intellect or sound emotions.
- **Fourth class:** Those in this group do not have any type of center and rely on outside influences for stability. The Church has always held a preference for these people, protects them from arbitrary political and economic powers, and leads them to salvation.

The ideal distribution of power is from the first class downward, but deformations occur in history. The understanding of historical events

needs to include the roles of the four classes at that time. This arrangement is not oppressive. Those of the First Class are called to serve the others, not to exploit them for their own benefit. Those of the Second Class take responsibility for administering the state, distributing justice, and protecting against enemies. The remaining classes are not conscious enough to take on those burdens.

Human State A human birth is rare and privileged. The principle of the human being is the Self, his center; a person is human to the extent that he participates in that center. Only then can he progress vertically. To sum up: our task as human beings, in order to actualize our possibilities, i.e., achieve Salvation, is to move horizontally toward the center and then vertically to reach even higher states.

In the essay *Deliverance and Salvation*, Rene Guenon points out that there is a danger in failing to at least reach the center. His explanation needs to be quoted exactly:

When a being must pass to another individual state, nothing guarantees that there he will again occupy a central position relative to the possibilities of that state as he does in its present state.

On the contrary, there is even an incomparably greater probability that he will encounter one of the innumerable peripheral conditions comparable in our world to those of animals or even vegetables.

One can immediately understand how serious a disadvantage this would be, especially from the point of view of the possibilities for spiritual development.

Referring to the first part, those in the third class have not achieved the primordial state. Since the intellectual soul distinguishes the human from animals and vegetables, those dominated by the Thinking function still have the possibility of developing their possibilities. On the other hand,

those dominated by Emotions and Sensations are in danger of remaining in a state of being comparable to animals or plant life.

Diseased Souls A fundamental metaphysical principle is that Knowing is Being. For example, in order to Know the Primordial State, one must be in, i.e., experience, the Primordial State. It is insufficient to just read and speculate about it.

Hence, the state of the soul determines what the being understands to be real and true. A disordered soul will not see reality, but only the projection of its disorder. 20% of adult Americans, or about 50 million people, suffer from some degree of mental illness, including 10 million with a serious mental illness. One of the symptoms is a distorted understanding of reality.

For example, you wouldn't ask Sylvia Plath if life is worth living. Nor would you put a paranoid schizophrenic on the security council to identify the most serious threats facing a nation. Those with serious illnesses like personality disorders or psychopathy are similarly unable to relate to the world accurately. For example, the Mayo Clinic says:

you may not realize that you have a personality disorder because your way of thinking and behaving seems natural to you. And you may blame others for the challenges you face.

That describes a great deal of comments on social media and explains why communication can be so frustrating. This is not to belittle those who are in therapy, especially for conditions that may be situational or temporary. Nevertheless, such widespread mental illness reveals a deep flaw in the collective psyche of a nation.

Moreover, one's level of development also shapes a worldview and opens oneself up to various distortions.

- Those dominated by the Thinking function may fall victim to various ideologies or conspiracy theories.

- Others will react emotionally, rather than rationally, to events.
- At the lowest level, all that matters is pleasure vs pain, like vs dislike, attraction vs repulsion.

Anyone not making the horizontal journey to the center will be inconsistent. He or she will have little self-awareness.

Lost in the Wilderness So living in the fallen world is just as described in Genesis. You will encounter a jungle of vegetation of various types. You will always be on the lookout for animals, some of which are harmless, others dangerous. Some are cute and cuddly, others are repulsive.

You will encounter pockets of proto-humans, able to lead and organize the animals or cultivate the vegetation. The blather of competing opinions sound like the random sounds heard at a watering hole in an African savannah.

On the positive side, fully functional humans are working for things that transcend their own self-interest. They may be organizing for humanity, such as, building nations, administering justice, creating hospitals, churches, etc.

Further off in the distance, you may catch a glimpse of saints and initiates. They are in higher states, but from time to time you may reach that state and recognize them. There are even higher beings. For us, the influences of angels and demons are experienced directly.

Note *The State of Mental Health in America:*

<https://www.mhanational.org/issues/state-mental-health-america>

National Institute of Mental Health:

<https://www.nimh.nih.gov/health/statistics/mental-illness.shtml>

Personality Disorders:

<https://www.mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/personality-disorders/symptoms-causes/syc-20354463>

Posted on 2021-01-10 by Cologero

* * *

Solphomeron on 2021-01-10 at 17:10 said:

Hi I'm a mentally ill man, have been diagnosed with Borderline personality disorder, Narcissism and most recently Dissociative identity disorder (this last one is self diagnosed).

Finding Gornahoor and esoteric knowledge has been a double-edged sword. On the one hand It gives me tools to deal with my diseased soul, for example: Living a chaste life, in obedience to the Catholic faith have helped me to develop self respect and boundaries between me and other people, being vigilant helps me to not identify myself with my intense emotions, praying the rosary constantly have made me grow a more healthy internal dialogue, instead of violent and lustful daydreaming I find myself repeating the Our Father or the Ave Maria.

but on the other hand, My delusion feeds itself with the information found here, and creates more intricate, labyrinthine alternate realities..

So it has become difficult to distinguish between a synchronicity and a delusion of grandeur. My mind is always looking for associations, deeper meanings, symbolism. I often feel many layers of meaning in a conversation or interaction, and the deeper it always have some archetypal/mythic feeling.

Can I trust myself? I find the only way out is to surrender completely To Christ. I'm a cup brimming with demonic goo and a few angelic sprinkles. But they are not me. Who am I? . I'm an interface. I'm a battleground.

Auld Wat on 2021-01-11 at 07:44 said:

A personal reflection:

I believe I was in the fourth class until I was about 22 years of age. I then entered into the Third Class, on the lowest rung, when I became aware of what I liked and disliked. I cannot remember being overly emotional but I do remember enjoying debates and discussions. The changes in my awareness were brought about by external factors, women, political events, recommendations.

I believe I moved from the Third to the Second Class only recently, despite being a practicing Catholic for the last 5 years, as it was only last week that I came to the realisation of what my

purpose in life is. I had known what it was to some extent for over 2 years but I didn't recognise it fully until now.

Thank you for writing.

2.5 The Intellectual Soul

The Western Tradition teaches the four Kingdoms and that Man participates in all of them through body and soul. In common with other traditions, there are different layers to the soul, as shown in diagram 2.2 adapted from **St Thomas Aquinas**.

	Kingdom	Hermetic	Source
Body	Mineral	Body	Natural
Nutritive Soul	Vegetable	Etheric Body	Natural
Sensitive Soul	Animal	Astral Body	Natural
Intellectual Soul	Man	Causal Body	Supernatural

Table 2.2: Layers of the Soul

In man, these form a unity, unlike some gnostic and theosophical systems which try to separate them. As Aquinas puts it, “the sensitive soul, the intellectual, and the nutritive soul are in a man, and are numerically one and the same soul.” But the body, also, is a part of man. Unlike dualist systems which view the soul and body as separate substances, or monist systems such as materialism or spiritualism which deny the existence of the soul or body, respectively, this system is nondual. That is, the soul as spirit is the form of the body as matter.

This is the traditional teaching, which regards the material world as the reflection of the spiritual. Theologians have not really drawn out fully the consequences of this teaching. In particular, it means that all aspects of the sensitive soul, nutritive soul, and body take on the form of the

intellectual soul. This has to include our racial and physical characteristics as well as our mental characteristics.

Aquinas makes this clear in his doctrine of subordination, which is accepted by both Evola and Guenon. He writes:

the sensitive is subordinate to the intellective and the nutritive to the sensitive, as potency is subordinate to act, since in the order of generations the intellective comes after the sensitive and the sensitive after the nutritive.

Yet things are not so simple. Aquinas continues:

man's intellectual soul contains virtually whatever belongs to the sensitive soul of brute animals, and to the nutritive soul of plants.

So although the lower parts of the soul and the body are passive in relation to the intellectual soul, this is only virtual, not actual. That is why we see man as fragmented. Instead of being guided by his intelligence, his acts are motivated by physical desires, conflicted emotions, and personal whims. Man comes to see this as his "normal" and "natural" condition. If he hears otherwise, he will dismiss it as being "life denying", prudish, authoritarian, uptight, and so on. Such a person, similarly to Nietzsche, will regard intelligence as merely instrumental; that is, it will help him devise the means to satisfy his desires. However, he does not use his intelligence to determine the ends themselves.

Even when a man is drawn to such a teaching by virtue of his spiritual condition or destiny, in today's world there is nowhere he can turn. The philosophy books explain all this in the abstract, while what he really needs is a direct intuitive understanding or gnosis. In the Hermetic schools, he would learn to observe the various movements of his soul just as the physicist observes the movements of physical bodies. In this way he learns to distinguish between the processes of the various parts of the

soul. He can catalog them and, through various exercises, develop the skills to actualize the proper relationships among those parts.

As he learns to see things in the clear light of the intellect, he will develop a sense of detachment and will no longer be driven by the irrational desires of the body nor be perturbed by emotional swings. This is not to say that he will not experience higher emotions such as equanimity and peacefulness, just that they are not the motivating factor. Only when a man acts from the intellectual soul is he free. Then he will possess the virtues: **temperance, courage, prudence, and justice.**

Posted on 2011-11-14 by Cologero

* * *

Gabe Ruth on 2011-11-16 at 10:06 said:

I've been lurking for a few weeks, trying to figure out what's going on here. Some things have troubled me, but this take on Nietzsche convinces me that you are very right about many things, and quiets my fears about your purpose.

I think the apostasy of a man like Nietzsche is one of the strongest pieces of evidence in the indictment of the exoteric church. Though I think the zeitgeist bears most of the responsibility, surely a more vigorous, confident church would have been able to reach a man with such great incite into the human condition. When I read accounts of his decline, I was reminded of Weston's ravings to Ransom in *Perelandra*, when he regains control temporarily.

Given your view of the modern church, I wonder what you think of the Theology of the Body. While I doubt you think very well of JP2, those ideas seem to be a fleshing out of some of what you get into here, and not without value.

charlotte on 2011-11-16 at 16:33 said:

JP11 actually restored the Latin Mass in some places, but was unable to get the method of priestly ordination changed. Recently I've been thinking a lot about the assassination of JP1, the prophecies of Fatima and so on. Benedict is making me wonder, as well, with all this stuff about a global banking system, in which the Vatican would no doubt play a significant role... All in all I'm very inclined to go seek out one of those traditional churches. there are a few places in England that still offer a traditional high mass and I feel a great need to go find one as soon as possible.

Cologero on 2011-11-17 at 12:20 said:

I am not in a position to comment on the Theology of the Body. Karol Wojtyła was part of a movement that combined Thomism with Phenomenology. In principle, that sounds fruitful since it seems to make the metaphysical experiential. I don't know where that led to or what part it plays. But it is the necessary approach.

This is not something we can do on a blog, just to make people aware of that option. For example, as for the Traditional teaching on the various souls ... is that something theoretical or experiential? Was Aquinas just weaving words or was he describing an inner experience? Disputing and debating positions goes on forever with no result.

So, as far as a theology of the body ... we know the proper relationship is spirit → soul → body. However, we find that the body does not simply respond to the will. Why is that? How can that change? And so on. So the approach is not a mental exercise, but rather a spiritual exercise.

Graham on 2011-11-18 at 10:37 said:

"In particular, it means that all aspects of the sensitive soul, nutritive soul, and body take on the form of the intellectual soul. This has to include our racial and physical characteristics as well as our mental characteristics."

The Greeks held that an attractive body is a sign of interior worth; this is particularly revealed by the word 'kallis' which could mean both physical beauty and goodness. One finds, curiously, that Plato believed looks should be considered (to a small degree) in the selection of the golden-souled guardians in his perfect republic.

It is an instinctively attractive proposition – and self-examination as well as scientific studies bear out that we think like that to this day – but we also know from experience that it often doesn't hold true. How does Gornahoor's 'theology of the body' navigate this issue? Does the good-looking person have a greater potential for goodness?

Gabe Ruth on 2011-11-18 at 11:55 said:

From Cologero's comment: "the body does not respond to the will". This is referring to the body's urges, but I think physical appearance would be even less connected to the will of the spirit.

The spirit takes precedence, as the immortal component. The fact of aging also indicates that physical appearance is not an exact indication of spiritual condition.

On the other hand, who can say how completely the modern conception of who is good-looking has been distorted?

Regarding the Theology of the Body, I am far from an authority and have never even read the primary text. But making the metaphysical experiential is very much the goal. It is an exoteric teaching, but a metaphysically ambitious one that contemplates what human nature as male

and female says about the nature of God. It also seeks to ground Catholic sexual ethics in metaphysics as well.

Charlotte, what was he trying to change about the method of priestly ordination?

I just read an older post on the Aztecs, and it brought the movie "The Mission" to mind. What are your thoughts on the Jesuit Reducciones?

Graham on 2011-11-18 at 13:15 said:

Gabe,

If the doctrine of correspondences is to have any validity, the physical body must be a reflection of the spirit. The post spells it out clearly, saying that the soul as spirit is the form of the body as man, and that this applies to physical characteristics as well as mental. So the problem remains.

In this view, growth and aging would have to do with the 'phasing' of the intellectual soul into and out of the material world. The prime of life would be the fullest physical and mental expression of the spiritual form, and it's for this reason that Aquinas asserts that the resurrected body will appear as that of a 28 year old. So aging does not alter the problem.

As for your final question, I agree that the modern American taste is different from that of the ancient Greek, and I go further in asserting that the taste of the dispassionate Plato differed again from that of his average carnal contemporary. His sense of human beauty would have been subtle and spiritualized. However, since number is eternal, and beauty has its basis in proportion (or vice versa), there are also unchanging givens at play. A proportionate face is a proportionate face: there would be significant overlap between all these differing tastes. More concretely, we know from Greek sculpture that their idea of human beauty was much like ours, if more sublime.

It is odd though that Plato would put ideas like this in the mouth of the notoriously ugly Socrates. It seems like one of those contradictions that Strauss (speaking of him) would want to explore further.

charlotte on 2011-11-19 at 05:20 said:

Jesus Christ was/is extremely beautiful...

Grail Queens tend to be also, but these are ultimate examples.

More generally, if somebody is physically very attractive (as opposed to just very pretty) it indicates a certain charismatic power of radiation, and love energy radiates outwards. In contrast with someone who is simply good looking but 'fake' or very vain, for instance, which is a contracting force. Those people are often appealing at first sight but soon lose magic and mystery unless the eye of the beholder is similarly vain. You often find that enormous sexual power equates to spiritual power in some degree, because it's a measure of that person's overall energy (as with the 'man of action') – we have 7 centres and the same force flows through them

all. However, if it 'gets stuck' in the sex centre then that's not 'good', although the potential is there. Throughout one's life I would imagine that part of the developmental task is to keep the energy flowing smoothly and constantly.

Understanding how to keep this energy at peak condition, to master it rather than allowing it to master us, is very important and involves a lot of polarity working (which is why the sexual and soul-mate relationships are so important during our lives). Highly spiritualised people will have their energy primarily emanating from the heart centre, while the crown will be open, shining and receiving force from the vertical hierarchy. Other people will be naturally inclined to love them – to love the angelic, Christed spirit flowing through the individual. Buddhist training helps us to master the energy flow and strengthen the centres.

Regarding the priestly ordination, I understand that during Vatican II one of the changes made to the church was with respect to this. JPII was unable to revert back to the original form but did win some victories with respect to the traditional mass. perhaps this is part of the mysterious spiritualisation process of the church, because it is still possible to be part of a catholic community, even if it is not necessarily visible...

Cologero on 2011-11-19 at 16:35 said:

Regarding physical attractiveness and related issues, it would be better to avoid speculation in favour of what we can directly know.

First of all, the body is a means of self-expression. We smile, frown, show anger, excitement, and so on. The body then reveals our inner states. Then, it is a means of our self-determination. We have projects, aims, goals and we execute them through our bodies. Thus, it is a means of our creative self-expression.

We then note our privations. We may spontaneously express anger, seemingly against our will. We may stammer in an embarrassing situation. We want to exercise but our body resists. These are all things to observe in developing the will.

Keep in mind that we are born into a particular stream of soul-life and material conditions, so it can't be said the soul and body are a perfect expression of the spirit *ab initio*. This is also a task, not just a given.

charlotte on 2011-11-20 at 03:33 said:

well I think whichever way one looks at it beauty is a form of power, and like any form of power can be used for good or ill. Of course beauty of spirit radiates outwards and makes a person attractive in its own right, certainly lovable, regardless of whether they have perfect bodies and flawless skins.

2.6 Psychic Distortion

Living in the consciousness soul, man experiences isolation, loneliness, materialism, loss of faith in the spiritual world, above all, uncertainty. The soul has to make up its mind and to act in a positive way on its own unsupported initiative. And it finds great difficulty in doing so. For it is too much in the dark to be able to see any clear reason why it should, and it no longer feels the old (instinctive) promptings of the spirit within.

OWEN BARFIELD, *Romanticism Comes of Age*

We are now the sons of God; and it hath not yet appeared what we shall be. We know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like to him: because we shall see him as he is.

1 JOHN 3:2

Types of People Plato identified three forces in the soul: eros, thumos, and nous. These correspond to the willing, feeling, and thinking functions of the soul, each of which has its own relatively independent centre. The once-born will be centred in one of the three centres:

1. Centre of gravity is sensations and movement
2. Centre of gravity is the feeling function
3. Centre of gravity is the thinking function

The Psyche Psyche, for our purposes, refers to the soul life and all its functions: thinking, feeling, willing. The Real I, or Self, transcends the psyche. A result of the Fall is that one's self-identification fell from the Self to the I of the Personality, or Ego. The Ego is the conscious part of

the psyche, but it accounts for just a small part of the psyche, most of which is unconscious.

Self-observation reveals that the Ego is not unified, since there are multiple, potentially hundreds of I's, each claiming to be the Ego. Some of them may work together, creating a psychological "complex" which takes on a life of its own.

The Ego falsely believes it is one, because of

- the unity of the body and
- a common name.

In extreme cases, like multiple personality disorder, the different complexes even take on their own names. The task is to integrate the various parts of the personality and move the centre of gravity up from the Ego to the Self. Integration means to make whole, which means to make holy. Thus, it is a spiritual task, not merely a psychological process. That is probably why **Carl Jung** could claim that most of his patients were non-religious.

Resistance of the Ego The Ego resists this process, which it regards as death. In a way it is, since the Real I then takes its rightful place, replacing the Ego. You often hear people say something like, "I need to contact my higher Self." Of course, the Self is never an object, but always a subject. A claim like that shows the Ego's resistance to the Self. In the Parable of the Coach, the Ego is like the coachman who refuses to take the orders of the Master in the cabin.

Image and Likeness We are born in the image of God, although the likeness has been lost or severely distorted. The image is beyond words and thoughts, so that our awareness of it is a mystical experience.

The likeness is the image as reflected in the soul or psyche. There are three stages:

- **Gnosis:** Gives form to the mystical experience
- **Magic:** Leads to action
- **Philosophy:** Makes the ideas communicable

The psyche is perturbed by negative emotions, obsessive thoughts, and insistent desires. Moreover, much of it is subconscious and not readily available to the conscious mind. That is why the likeness of God gets distorted in the psyche. Hence, it is necessary to purify the psyche so that it reflects God's likeness perfectly. We will briefly examine the distortions in the feeling and willing functions here; the intellectual function will be discussed later.

Existence of Demons As was mentioned in the previous post on Demonic Possession⁸, the feeling and willing functions are under the influence of demons. We are not referring to any Hollywood-style depictions. Rather, the demons are known by their effects, which can be described. This is actually an important teaching. That is because it shows that our psychic functions are not intrinsically evil, but are under the heavy influence of outside forces. This was recognized in the baptismal rite prior to 1968, which used to include an exorcism. In particular:

In the traditional Roman baptismal liturgy, we find a sequence of exorcisms that directly represent baptism's role as releasing us from the devil's possession.

See *The Significance of the Exorcisms before Baptism*⁹ for more details. Unfortunately, the exorcism was subsequently removed, so anyone baptized after that year may experience more problems.

⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=10454>

⁹<https://rorate-caeli.blogspot.com/2018/11/thomas-pink-on-significance-of.html>

So this is hardly a novel teaching and is verified by experienced exorcists.

There is a purpose to demonic possession: to provide the friction required to become more virtuous or conscious. Although they are part of God's plan, that does not make them somehow "good", as some false teachings assert.

I will use the terms *Luciferic* and *Ahrimanic* to refer to the demons affecting the emotional centre (astral body) and willing function (etheric body) respectively. Keep in mind **Valentin Tomberg's** reservations about the cavalier use of those terms in certain anthro circles to account for all sorts of unrelated phenomena. Nevertheless, they are useful.

Disordered Emotions In sound functioning, the Intellect will determine what is good, just, noble, moral, rational, prudent, or loving. The Emotions and the Will then follows the intellect. This is not the case with psychic distortions. A person finds himself subject to the capriciousness of passions, particularly of negative emotions.

Work must be done on three levels:

- willpower,
- emotional life
- thought control

These must be ordered, educated, and shaped. By self-observation, the contradictions in one's psychic life become visible; in particular, one must learn to resist the outward expression of negative emotions.

Disordered Will The will is a force that manifests differently in the different levels:

- **Mineral:** electromagnetic forces

- **Vegetable:** Tropism ¹⁰
- **Animal:** Desire
- **Human:** Will

In a disordered will, a being is motivated by desires, which then distort the thinking function to justify the desire and then to determine a way to act on it. On a more primal level, one simply follows impulses such as like/dislike, attraction/aversion, and so on, quite apart from any intelligence.

The human will is still a gnostic will, that is, it depends on deliberation. This leaves the will open to doubt, viz., it becomes double-minded, hearing the second voice. This often leads to confusion and distress rather than to liberation. This is the fate of the man who is awakening to his Real I. He then finds himself alone spiritually, without traditional support. Refer to the Barfield quote on the consciousness soul in the epigraph.

The True Will, on the other hand, means that a person is acting according to his real, unfallen nature. This is the purified will, because it will only one thing. In this case, what one believed through custom, habit, conditioning, and so on, no longer suffices. Such a person chooses his beliefs because he wills them.

Imagery The demon acts on the Will through imagery. However, it cannot manufacture images, but has to rely on pre-existing images. That is why it is so important to monitor the images the one pays heed to. Our contemporary world is full of manufactured images, designed to manipulate and control people. That is why the use of TV, movies, and related media should be reduced if not eliminated.

Although some may think this topic is off-colour, I am convinced that in this day and age, specific examples are necessary. Therefore, we

¹⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8349>

can provide a study of how the use of imagery works in distorting the Will.

Men and women are typically dominated by one main feature. A very common feature is Lust, since it is so tightly tied to pleasure. Take the case of Jim, for example, who is civilly divorced, although still married, morally. Having succumbed to temptation, he goes to the confessional. He starts by confessing erotic thoughts. The priest asks him if he willingly entertained them. That is because the spontaneous arising of such thoughts is not ipso facto sinful. This is completely unlike secular psychology which presumes that such thoughts are indicative of one's deepest nature. Not at all: our deeper nature is to be in the image and likeness of God, i.e., centred in our Real I or Self.

Therefore, we attribute the initial image to the Ahrimanic demon, not to some repressed desire within. The priest then asks Jim if he looks at pornography. That is because the demon cannot create the imagery, but only rearrange what is already there in one's mind. Hence, the priest is looking for the real source in external causes. Jim denies watching pornography, but explains that he has had many girlfriends, so that the memory of sexual activity with them provides ample imagery. Thus, the demon can use Jim's own life experience against him.

This is actually good news, since our faults can be forgiven. By understanding how these outer forces act on our inner psychic life, we can learn to be liberated from such forces.

Postmortem Purification This should make it clear why postmortem purification is usually necessary. Death does not by itself remove the psychic distortions, making the divine likeness impossible without further work. Then, in the Beatific Vision, one knows God as he is, in his essence, not just in his energies.

Posted on 2018-11-25 by Cologero

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jonh oliver on 2018-11-26 at 15:07 said:

I have a doubt regarding the nature of the true self, according to the conception given by Tomberg, and more specifically to the distinction that he makes of it from the vedic conception. The eastern conception affirms that atman=brahman, and thus, that by knowing our true self, we know god or the absolute. Tomberg goes against this, by stating that there are other transcendental immortal selves, that are higher than our own, that of the celestial hierarchies and the holy trinity, and that knowing them constitutes a higher level of spiritual experience.

My question is about the status of all of these different immortal selves, and whether are they really distinct, or are they just like the different qualities of god, that only have an analogical difference between them, but in the end being fundamentally the same. Everything at the highest level is indistinct in god, on what tomberg would call the world of emanation, but from a logical standpoint, i can't grasp how can there be more than one transcendental immortal and fully free self in existence, so as to allow an distinction between them. Because Tomberg affirms that in knowing our true self, we are only knowing the spiritual microcosm and not the macrocosm, which implies that these beings are separated from the human individuality. If i'm not misrepresenting what he's saying in some way, could you explain how this distinction is possible.

I know that this goes off on a bit of a tangent from the post, but i still think it's somewhat related.

Jack on 2018-11-26 at 21:53 said:

Thank you for this excellent post. The last line seems to reference, and contradict, the Eastern Orthodox doctrine of the distinction between the essence and energies of God; that we can know and participate in the latter, but not the former. Could you refer me to a good Catholic critique of this doctrine?

Xavier Galindo on 2018-11-27 at 09:34 said:

Jack: There is a disagreement between the EO's and the RC on whether God's "essence can be known" –more specifically between essence-energies and Augustinian-Thomistic divine simplicity. Good sources to read about this are 'Ground of Union' by Williams (very irenic), Aristotle East & West by Bradshaw (informative but polemic, blames Augustine a lot), and (Byzantine Catholic) Fr. Klappes works (available on Academia.edu). There's a part of the Summa (in the treatise on the Holy Trinity) where St. Thomas explicitly (but respectfully) says St. John Damascene was wrong about *energeia*, and the EO naturally don't concede this.

Truthfully there could be a whole new Council of Florence devoted to this issue alone.

John Oliver: I wonder how your question relates to the metaphysical principle that identifies knowledge with being?

Cologero on 2018-12-08 at 08:28 said:

In the future, Jonh, should you post another comment, please quote Tomberg (or whomever) directly; in other words, it is not helpful to tell me what you think that Tomberg said.

First of all, the vedas make reference to a multitude of Devas or immortal selves, so your first point is unclear.

Perhaps from a logical point of view, separate selves may not make sense. For example, F H Bradley in *Appearance and Reality* logically reaches the Absolute, which alone is "real". Other selves, therefore, cannot "really" exist.

However, the Hermetic teaching is that God made a sacrifice, or withdrawal, thereby creating a void into which created things, including other selves, could reside.

Tomberg writes about two substances and one essence ... ultimately only God is "essence" or Being, and substances are part of the world of becoming. Nevertheless, when we know our True Self most deeply, we discover that we also know God. This is not a matter of logic, but rather of gnosis or direct experience.

Cologero on 2018-12-14 at 22:47 said:

@Jack, there is no intent to be polemical.

The "energies" is rendered as "acts" in the west, since *energeia* in Greek is translated as *actus* in Latin. So we do know God, in ordinary circumstances, through his acts (e.g., actual grace). However, there can be no real distinction between God's essence and existence (or acts).

A critique is not a valid starting point, but rather direct knowledge or gnosis is the only guide. For starters, I would recommend *Christian Gnosis* by **Wolfgang Smith**, in which he writes:

Gnosis in the ultimate sense, if attainable in this life at all, will be the lot, here below, of exceedingly few.

The possibility of gnosis in this life (understood as knowing "*the essence of God*") has indeed been recognized by the Church. St. Thomas Aquinas, for example, has this to say:

"As God works miracles in corporeal things, so also he does supernatural wonders above the natural order, raising the minds of some living in the flesh beyond the use of sens, even up to the vision of his own essence; as Augustine says of Moses, the teacher of the Jews, and of St. Paul, the teacher of the gentiles."

And again, referring to the same exalted state of gnosis: "It is not incredible that this sublime revelation is vouchsafed certain saints without their departing this life so completely as to leave nothing but a corpse for burial."

We remind you of the epigraph:

We are now the sons of God; and it hath not yet appeared what we shall be. We know that, when he shall appear, we shall be like to him: because we shall see him as he is.

1 John 3:2

Vimana on 2019-06-05 at 12:17 said:

"In sound functioning, the Intellect will determine what is good, just, noble, moral, rational, prudent, or loving. The Emotions and the Will then follows the intellect. This is not the case with psychic distortions. A person finds himself subject to the capriciousness of passions, particularly of negative emotions."

It seems, then, that Schopenhauer was right that the vast majority of people have a blind and impulsive Will, but he was mistaken in his promotion of complete rejection of the Will rather than aligning it with the Intellect?

2.7 The Creative Process

Training in esoteric psychology not only enables us to understand our own inner natures, but also provides a key to understanding much about how the world works. In the books on *Gnosis*, **Boris Mouravieff** expresses traditional psychology in terms suitable for our contemporaries. So instead of speaking of the soul elements – viz., the vegetative, animal, and intellectual souls – he refers to various centers.

Animal life, in this scheme, has sexual, motor, and emotional (at least in higher animals) centers. Man has an intellectual center, actually two of them, a lower center for rational thinking and a higher center for intuitive thinking. In the Primordial State, represented by Eden, Adam had the lower centers, but his consciousness was dominated by the higher intellectual center, i.e., direct intuition of the spiritual realm. Nevertheless,

as part of his creative activity in the world, the lower intellectual center, or critical spirit, was necessary to formulate aims and to determine the means to achieve them. This formation of the critical mind is, according to Mouravieff, the *Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil*. As the critical spirit becomes dominant, the intuitive center or divine spark recedes and is generally forgotten.

Now animal and plant life lacks the intellectual centers, hence they do not have any inner conflicts that arise from the over-development of the critical spirit. This is the attraction many people feel toward animals. Moreover, there are systems of thought, most famously that of Rousseau, that seek that animal state in some primeval "state of nature". Of course, that is not possible, nor is it really a return to the Primordial State. That path is not a rejection of the critical spirit from below as a return to animal nature, but rather the transcendence of that spirit from above. The esoteric path seeks the regeneration of man through conscious efforts to become aware of the divine spark.

To illustrate esoteric psychology, I will use Mouravieff's description of how the creative process functions. There are three stages from the idea, the thought, and the will.

The joint action of the creative energy of the sexual centre and the faculties of intuition and discernment of the lower intellectual centre caused imagination to arise in man. After this, his development, the fruit of his conscious efforts, takes on an epicyclic form:

1. Man explores the unknown: this operation, fruit of this creative imagination, is characteristic of every project;
2. Then, by the return path his ideas become concrete, he accumulates the necessary data to establish a plan of action and assembles the elements needed to put it into execution;

3. Lastly, thus enriched, he acts on this plan.

This is the scheme of every human enterprise which puts into play all the factors in this activity.

The first phase involves the action of sexual energy, or eros. It causes phantasms, or images unrelated to the external world, to spontaneously arise in consciousness. When it is sublimated by means of its interaction with the higher centers, there will be creative activity. Otherwise, left on its own, the eros will simply produce sexual phantasies of the type that **John of Ruysbroeck** warned us against. This is not the place to discuss the practice of "concentration" in which the formation of thoughts and images are consciously directed rather than spontaneously arisen.

If the higher powers are weak, then the power of the eros will be dissipated in sexual imagery. Moreover, *pace* the Rousseauists, the state of nature is not necessarily pure and healthy. For example, **Sigmund Freud** last century made a career out of documenting the unhealthiness of the unchecked libido. Although Freud distorted traditional psychology and was completely unaware of the higher centers, he recognized the decadence of modern man. Keep in mind that the "id" represents the lower centers, and the lower intellectual center he called the "reality principle". Unfortunately, his system was unable to point the way to a cure.

Step (2) is not always so straight-forward. Of course, ideally the critical spirit should be able to judge rationally the ideas of the mental imagery. The spirit would determine if the plan is just and reasonable. It would then formulate the means to realize the plan. But at this point it is helpful to recall some of **Julius Evola**'s ideas. Of course, he agrees about new representations of the world spontaneously arising in consciousness.

Beyond that, Evola recognizes three stages:

1. **Spontaneity**. The self is not fully developed. Evola describes it as "immersed in an immediate, indistinct coalescence with nature and

the world, we can say that it is not so much he who thinks, speaks, and asserts himself, but rather that various forces and impulses think, speak and assert themselves in him."

2. **Autonomy.** The self begins to separate from the world. Evola's description is much like Mouravieff's description of the lower intellect: "Consequently, what used to be familiar to the individual is made alien and impenetrable, what intuitive certainty used to reveal to him as indisputable fact is made dubious and problematic."

In the attempt to discover some unity in the random fluctuations of phenomena, the self looks for solutions in adhering to some ideology, typically in the form of science or religious doctrines.

3. **Mastery.** By transcending phenomena and ideologies, the self gains the power of mastery and becomes a "deep centre of will and power".

Primal Traditions As an example of the first stage, we can rely on **Julian Jaynes's** study on the *Origin of Consciousness in the Breakdown of the Bicameral Mind*. In those early civilizations, there was a priesthood that still had an active and direct connection to transcendent reality. There was also a caste of aristocrats who knew how to wield political power, while maintaining the societal order determined by the spiritual authorities. The workers were still at stage one, living spontaneously. They were sub-rational, with a poorly developed lower intellectual center, and responded spontaneously to the images arising in consciousness. They were not plagued with the doubts that arise from the uncertainty of critical thinking. Hence, their primary mode of control and communication required the use of commands, poetry, songs, or other art. That is obvious from the perusal of ancient spiritual texts. Now Jaynes claims that those people were content in those roles, and that is probably true. Such civilizations were able to persist for extended periods.

Ideologies Step (2) of the creative process can be distorted or even thwarted by the adherence to ideologies that are at best partially true, if not completely false. That is Evola's second stage. When attempting to solve a difficult societal problem, ideologues will be blinded by their own worldviews. Since a worldview forms the foundation for their being in the world, there is a strong psychological need to adhere to it; the alternative is to fall back into the uncertainty of critical thinking and fluctuating phenomena.

Hence, the human race is prevented from achieving its creative potential. People get stuck at step (2) by debating worldviews without any possible resolutions. They become convinced that their own worldview is correct, so that it would be necessary to convince everyone else to adopt it. That is simply not possible because men have different capabilities and are of various spiritual races which prevent a common way of relating to the world.

The Degeneration of Castes Since the question of pseudo-traditions came up in the comments recently, this is a good moment to look at the question from the eternal perspective of Tradition. There is still this idea in certain circles that claim to be "traditional" that the goal is to formulate the perfect ideology. Hence, they usually blame "Christianity" for replacing the pure spontaneity of animal life with a critical attitude, especially its moral judgments. Since the identity of the self still resides in the lower centers or chakras, they come to experience the Christian teachings as "alien" and therefore resent its intrusion onto the spontaneity of the self-expression of the lower instincts or desires.

As we see, however, even Evola, who was no Christian, recognized that stage (2) is a necessary element in spiritual maturity. However, since the spirit is free, there is no compulsion or mechanical process to traverse the three stages. The Christian teaching therefore is the "way" to promote the movement into stage (3) or theosis. At that stage, there is a second

spontaneity as one lives in the intuitive awareness of the presence of God. Now, someone can try to make the case that Christendom has lost its power for that. Their burden, in that case, is to come up with a living and viable alternative, not to reject the teaching in toto.

Back to the point. According to **Rene Guenon** and Evola, the decline in the world process results from the degeneration of castes, not from the adoption of specific ideologies. In that decline, the spiritual authority and political power proper to the higher castes are transferred to lower castes who are incapable of maintaining the traditional structures. It would be impossible to convince them to adopt a different ideology that would deprive them of power; that is why logical arguments are beside the point in political discourse. It is a democratic illusion to believe that a single ideology can be grasped and adopted by the entire population. If a spiritual elite arises with demonstrable powers, then circumstances may change, otherwise people are satisfied with what they have.

Posted on 2016-01-21 by Cologero

2.8 Doctrine of the Soul

In the Medieval period, the doctrine of the soul reached its deepest understanding in the thought of **Thomas Aquinas**. This doctrine was adopted, virtually *in toto*, from Aristotle. Now, **Aristotle** was the heir to the totality of Greek philosophy and its mysteries. Even if much of that earlier work has now been lost except in fragments, it was familiar to Aristotle, who absorbed and organized it. Furthermore, as Guenon takes pains to demonstrate on numerous occasions, Aristotle is in deep agreement with the metaphysicians of India. As we have recently pointed out, this may be the result of a direct historical influence.

Bear in mind that the ultimate and primary goal of the Medieval Christian is to save his soul. But we see that the understanding of that

soul is purely pagan in its origins. And this understanding insinuates itself at the heart of Medieval doctrine.

There is no point to repeat what was written in *The Intellectual Soul*¹¹. There are a few important implications of this doctrine.

- The soul forms the body, not the other way around as most contemporary Westerners seem to believe (if they even consider the question).
- The body and the components of the soul form a unity.
- The natural order is for the body to be subservient to the soul, and each layer of the soul to be subservient to the one above.
- Unlike the view of some gnostic doctrines, and even Plato, the soul is not “imprisoned” in the body. There is a struggle between the body and soul to enforce the natural order between them. However, this cannot be understood as being “anti-life”.
- The intellectual soul reveals “man as the one who possesses the power of knowing with respect to the visible world.” (TB 5:6) This knowing is transcendental to the world. Guenon writes, in reference to Aristotle: “Pure intellect is of a transcendent order, knowledge of universal principles is its proper object.”
- The body is the object of the Will. Man is a subject not just in knowing, but also in acting. “The structure of this body is such that it permits him to be the author of all human activity.” (TB 7:2)
- The human person is never experienced as a phenomenon, but is revealed indirectly through his activity. Hence, the person is transcendent. Again, Guenon relies on Aristotle when he asserts, “The

¹¹See Section 2.5 in this book.

personality (*Atma*) is not manifested", since it is the principle of manifestation.

- For Aristotle, the principle of all action must be actionless. That is, the unmoved mover is not an object in the action he initiates. The person, then, is that unmoved mover, the microcosmic version of the macrocosm.

One step to fully recover Tradition, then, is to use Guenon's Man and his Becoming to supplement and augment the Western understanding. However, it is clear that for the Westerner, this explanation is preferable to slogging through such a dense work, replete with Sanskrit words. Unfortunately, and perhaps necessarily, there are many Westerners who look to the East, not realizing what lies closer to home. The real benefit would come from those who understand the Eastern teachings and then re-express them in a Western context. Have we mentioned Aristotle and Aquinas as examples of how this can be done?

For example, one could take what Guenon writes about the envelopes of the Self and apply it to the Western understanding of the soul. Obviously, I am assuming a familiarity with the Western tradition, which is far from common knowledge. The teachings of Purusha and Prakriti from the Sankhya school of Vedanta have direct analogs with the hylo-morphism of Aristotle and Aquinas. Purusha is the form or idea that acts on Prakriti, or prime matter.

Matter for the Medievals meant something quite different from what is meant today. Prime matter, or Prakriti, has no existence on its own, but is pure potentiality. Hence, things are not "made" out of matter. Just the opposite, a thing is manifested when its idea informs the potential of prime matter, making it actual. Some may object that this is unscientific. Perhaps for the outmoded mechanistic view of matter, but it is compatible with quantum theory. This theory, following Schrodinger, holds that matter is really energy waves in an indeterminate state. Only a conscious

observer, or as we prefer, a conscious actor, collapses the wave, making a determinate thing.

Since the soul is not exhausted in its bodily functions, it has two modes of existence, a corporeal one and a purely spiritual one. Hence, we can speak of an *anima spiritualis*, or spirit-soul. But this is a topic for another time.

The homework is to make the interior shift in worldview to understand oneself and the world in this way. Through self-knowledge and self-observation, learn to distinguish in consciousness the various sheaths of the soul. Where is an urge arising from, what creates a certain emotion, what is the source of a thought? Discover the "person", the unmoved mover, that is not directly experienced, yet is part of every experience. Change your attitude about matter, which has no real existence. Experience everything as the result of the ideas that inform things and events. Matter itself is empty. What we experience as resistance from matter is really a Privation¹², something that our Will is not yet strong enough to overcome. The spirit-soul has great power, or siddhis, *in potentia*; that can be harnessed.

References:

Rene Guenon, *Man and his Becoming*

Pope JP II, *Theology of the Body (TB)*

Alois Wiesinger, OCSO, *Occult Phenomena*

Posted on 2012-01-20 by Cologero

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-20 at 15:25 said:
when do you think the 'way of Fool' came into play, and with whom?

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-22 at 15:47 said:

¹²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1815>

While I remember – seeing as a defence of scholasticism is in order and also that I kept thinking over the past few weeks I must somehow get us onto Lazarus – here is an extract from VT's wonderful book, *Lazarus, come forth!*, that I thought was very pertinent:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/lazurus-come-forth>

Logres on 2012-01-22 at 20:53 said:

Sir, was the blank spot at the end meant to be a spur to personal meditation? Or could you supply the ending, if there is one? Helpful article – I find it like pulling teeth to try to discern the parts of the soul – very confusing at first. Like unsnarling a knot.

Cologero on 2020-01-20 at 10:55 said:

Theosophical inspired and other New Age systems usually have the false, if not absurd, goal of “contacting the Higher Self”. The Higher Self can never be an “object” in the world; hence it makes no sense to try to “contact” it.

2.9 The Spirit Soul

Everything belonging to the subtle state is very closely connected with the nature of life itself, which is inseparable from heat; and it may be recalled that on this point, as on many others, the conceptions of Aristotle are in complete agreement with those of the East.

RENE GUENON, *Man and his Becoming*

Rene Guenon often used **Aristotle** as the exemplar in the West of Indian metaphysics. Whether this is the result of a direct influence or from plumbing the same depths is open to debate. More likely, both the East and pagan Antiquity were drawing on a common source, viz., the primordial tradition of the original Indo-European peoples.

We recently outlined the Western tradition on the corporeal soul¹³. Although the soul is the form of the body, it also transcends that func-

¹³See Section 2.8 in this book.

tion. Guenon mentions that the corporeal state belongs to the human individual. Moreover, there is the subtle state of the individual. Guenon makes clear that the subtle state is not totally coincident with the corporeal state:

The corporeal state [and the subtle state] are strictly and essentially states of the living man. This does not necessarily involve admitting that the subtle state comes to an end at the precise moment of bodily death and simply as a result thereof.

The Western Tradition has an analogous teaching. In his book, *Occult Phenomena*¹⁴, **Alois Wiesinger** describes this subtle state in some detail to explain the experience of preternatural and mystical phenomena. He gives the name spirit-soul to the subtle state to distinguish it from the corporeal soul; this corresponds to the Hermetic distinction between spirit, or *pneuma*, and soul, or *psyche*.

As interesting as Fr. Wiesinger's analysis of occult phenomena is, for our purposes we now restrict ourselves to his description of spirit. Here are some salient points, without further explanation.

- The existence of spirit is not a philosophical hypothesis. The knowledge of it comes from experience beyond the material.
- He points out that this doctrine was taught by the greatest philosophers of mankind, for thousands of years, hence predating Christianity. He points out that this doctrine is either unknown or ignored; the reader is free to offer his own explanation for this curious neglect.
- The activity of spirit proceeds by means of thought and will. The two basic faculties of the spirit are, then, the acts of understanding and the will.

¹⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/occultPhenomena.pdf>

- Unlike the corporeal soul, whose knowing is mediated through the senses, spirit knows directly.
- To recognize an object the spirit must have the thing within itself, that is, the form without its matter. Said differently, the spirit is conscious of the Idea, which it knows directly rather than through a process of abstracting.
- Pure spirits communicate through thought transference. This has consequences for the Occult War. Men believe their thoughts are their own, even though they cannot predict what they will think of one minute from now, and seldom consider the source of thoughts. But thoughts come from the hierarchies of higher beings and angels and demons. That is why ideas can take hold of large populations at the same time. It also explains why certain thoughts tend to lump together in different individuals.

These qualities of spirit exist in man insofar as he is a spiritual being, but usually only virtually since his mind is most often split and concentrated on the body. Fr. Wiesinger criticizes the simplistic explanation that all spiritualist and occult phenomena are evil or attributable to the devil. To the contrary, he explains that these powers of the spirit-soul were part of the primordial state, but were then mostly lost after the Fall. While we cannot describe the powers of the spirit-soul and related phenomena at this time, we will conclude with a description of mystical states and what they reveal about the spirit-soul.

Fr. Wiesinger is a conventional priest and his area of concern is the right hand path, or the way of ecstasy¹⁵. He first describes Mystical Sleep during which God brings leads the mystic to the Primordial State. It may be helpful to read this in conjunction with Chapter XI of *Man and his*

¹⁵<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/solar-and-lunar-initiation>

Becoming where Guenon discusses the states of sleep. He mentions the state of ecstatic trance, which is a state between deep sleep and death, in which the living soul, *jivatma*, withdraws into the bosom of the Universal Spirit (*Atma*).

Fr. Wiesinger points out that at the end of a culture, when the mystical sense has been lost, there arise numerous attempts to recover it. Most are misguided, but sometimes they are recovered by “honest striving after a form of self-preparation that was far-seeing, scientific, and wholly in accord with nature.” He specifically mentions **Buddha**, at the decline of Indian culture, **Plotinus** at the end of Greek culture, and **Rudolf Steiner** at the end of Western culture.

Analogous to the three layers of the corporeal soul, there are also three layers of the spirit-soul, corresponding to the Trinity. Once again, theology is in conformance with Hermetic, esoteric, and to an extent, Anthroposophical, teaching. We summarize Fr. Wiesinger in Table 2.3.

Procession	Stage of Prayer	
Holy Spirit	The prayer of quiet	Imagination still retains its freedom.
Son	The prayer of union	Ecstasy
Father	The prayer of spiritual marriage	

Table 2.3: Layers of the subtle states of the spirit-soul

Posted on 2012-01-26 by Cologero

* * *

Caleb Cooper on 2012-01-26 at 00:35 said:

“Pure spirits communicate through thought transference.”

One of the more frustrating things about going over to the other side is when I can tell an entity is communicating with me telepathically, but I have no idea what it's saying because I don't speak telepathese!

It gets really amusing when I realize my soul (spirit?) is communicate back, but I have absolutely no idea what I'm saying, it usually just sounds like a bunch of bird chirping. Need to take the wax out of my 'ears of the heart' I guess.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-26 at 05:23 said:

I have also had this experience of communicating and knowing a two way conversation is going on but not 'hearing' the words. It's more like there is a 'question' in the form of a 'thought' and then as the answer is given it becomes an action before you even realise you've asked – this must be partly to do with the dissolution of time but also because one acts on pure will in that state, it's all instantaneous. Also impossible to lie. So for example once I was in a very deep guided meditation that took place in primarily an astral context. As I was being led through a particular building it occurred to me at a certain moment that there was no discernible decoration that I could use as a point of reference to recall later and try to look further into. As I was thinking this my guide 'told' me to look down at the floor, whereupon I saw we were following a row of tiles that all had identical swastika patterns on them. As soon as this was noticed we moved into the next tableau. All of it happened without words, almost without the thought being formed, so while I DID know what the conversation was about, there were no words spoken, I just wondered what I needed to wonder and was given the answer I sought. At other times I've been in situations where passwords were needed but I didn't realise this until a word just popped into my head. It's very seldom indeed I become aware of actual sound in the higher astral or etheric dimension (which is a rare occurrence for me anyway), but if I do it is always a sublime experience but difficult to describe the quality of the sound. So it is not like an outside sound coming in, it is an inner sound that seems to come from the very centre of your head that in turn seems to contain the whole universe, it's not like a vague inner voice, it is super-clear. Once I was taken to the Happy Hunting grounds and I heard their drums, beating very rhythmically, right in the middle of my mind just as I was coming back and becoming conscious. This was shortly followed by a sight of their campfire, which was incredibly bright, phosphorescent, and led me to say it was like 'magnesium burning'. Once I heard thousands of harps very loudly as I was waking up, which was truly amazing and I believe this to be the sound of the sun rising. Funnily enough a few days ago I was half in and out of sleep in the early hours of the morning (something woke me up), when I very distinctly heard the sound of running water in the same place, the inner kingdom. Immediately I knew it was a stream but it startled me as to hear things is very unusual for me. Just as I was nodding off again I was woken up once more, this time by the sounds of a choir singing Gloria, which was really wonderful but mystifying also. It didn't seem to last very long. I have also had experiences of talking to birds but not hearing any sounds. It seems to me that communication is done telepathically, the will responds to questioning, but that sound is a very elevated sensation as far as spirituality goes, I would love to hear that music all the time, one can't describe the beauty and clarity of the

tones....

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-01-26 at 05:58 said:

Regarding the (very interesting) main article, these points here from Fr Wiesinger's book ring very true (in fact most of it makes a lot of sense):

'The activity of spirit proceeds by means of thought and will' – this is very much my experience, the will is so much stronger and more active as it is not hampered by physical restraints for one thing, so can function as the pure agent of action. 'The two basic faculties of the spirit are, then, the acts of understanding and the will'. This seems to be a fair summary.

'spirit knows directly': yes, it is this 'knowing' I was trying to describe, as it is so clear and direct, there are no doubts whatsoever, things just are what they are, there isn't a sense of judgement, although there are times one can be made aware of dangers, things not to do and so on.

Regarding these strange 'conversations'. Cologero (who I've pestered about the subject several times!) will remember my endless descriptions of a visit to Atlantis, which I embarked upon following a suggestion and nothing more, I had very little curiosity with regards to it and treated it as a 'necessary exercise' if that makes sense. In fact I could hardly be bothered at the time it seemed a chore. Nevertheless, I did as suggested and asked for angelic protection as I had been told to visit Atlantis. I did not expect anything whatsoever to happen after that but a moment later a VERY bizarre looking fish-headed being (I only saw his top half or top third) appeared very clearly in a semi-astral, etheric dimension in front of me. I was startled at the very strange appearance and also felt sheepish as he seemed really irritated. It all happened incredibly quickly and I had no time to think, but somehow he asked me why I wanted to go and before I knew what had happened he seemed to extract from me the details that led up to me asking angels about a visit to Atlantis – so I totally agree with the 'transference' description, it just happens and you can't do anything about it, these spiritual beings just know – you couldn't lie and pretend to have good intentions if really you wanted to spy on a secret book or something, as your will is 'read' by them. I don't think anything 'bad' would necessarily happen, you just wouldn't get further.

So in my case the actual situation was relayed – I had a study partner who himself, it seemed, was curious to know about Atlantis, and expecting I might manage to get there he had therefore planted the idea in my head. I did exactly as he suggested and asked for protection first, and it would also be true to say that I fully expected at that time to always have angelic protection in any situation, so there wouldn't have been any doubt or fear in me (now there might, but that's another story!).

However where I ended up next is perhaps a warning note to us all, as I found myself at the very bottom of a very deep, murky green-grey ocean, hiding behind huge clumps of seaweed, staring absolutely boggle-eyed at the profile view of a gigantic being that had a man's torso

and very, very long, corkscrew-curved tail. He was floating at a distance of around 30 ft away, with both arms stretched out in front of him with elbows at right angles. His form was dark but clear, as if a solid shadow, and it is impossible for me to describe the terror this struck in me – those who know how our emotions are far more easy to govern in the astral state will hopefully understand just how frightening this therefore was. For a start I have an intense phobia about deep water having nearly drowned several times and been on some scary boat journeys, so that was bad enough, but secondly this creature was so beyond anything I've ever even thought of, let alone comprehended, and so huge, so generally weird in every way I just couldn't imagine what might happen next. My main fear – beyond the fact I was underwater with 'time running out' – was, if I can see him, what if HE can see me?!

Things had just reached a crisis point when from out of nowhere this word just popped into my head, like Eureka – 'CAPRICORN!' I was elated, triumphant even, and in that moment I came back into my body feeling immensely relieved. I was there for a second more before going back into another scene (long story this so I won't relate it all here).

Would I have embarked upon this journey if I'd known what was 'down there' – no, of course not! I'm rather ashamed to say that I'm not a particularly courageous person, although I am impulsive and can be rash at times. All the seemingly brave or exciting things I've done on earth have been kind of by accident or out of foolishness, and this Atlantis trip has given me cause to wonder, 'should I have gone' ever since. I guess the moral here is be careful what you ask for as you might get it! (the rest of the visit had a very different tone, by the way, and I subsequently identified the Fish-head being with Pisces).

2.10 Degrees of Existence

The next generation of American Indians could radically transform scientific knowledge by grounding themselves in traditional knowledge about the world and demonstrating how everything is connected to everything else. Advocacy of this idea would involve showing how personality and a sense of purpose must become part of the knowledge that science confronts and understands. The present posture of most Western scientists is to deny any sense of purpose and direction to the world around us, believing that to do so would be to introduce mysticism and superstition. Yet what could be more superstitious than to believe that

the world in which we live and where we have our most intimate personal experiences is not really trustworthy and that another, mathematical world exists that represents a true reality?

Knowledge was derived from individual and communal experiences in daily life, in keen observation of the environment, and in interpretive messages that they received from spirits in ceremonies, visions, and dreams.

VINE DELORIA, JR.

The World of Experience The next topic in the ongoing review of the works of Wolfgang Smith involves the various degrees of existence. Since this material is scattered throughout his works, I will instead focus on the fascinating, but compact, book *Tantra Vidya* by **Oscar Hinze**. Smith recommends this book highly, so it is hardly a distraction. We have previously mentioned four of these degrees, or domains as he calls them.

- Prime matter
- Secondary matter
- The physical world
- The corporeal world

Prime and secondary matter are described in Tradition and is beyond the scope of this essay. Smith means by the “physical world” the one that is described by scientists by eliminating all qualitative aspects from it. This is the world invented by Bacon, Galileo and Descartes. It is the quantum world. It is the world of superstition according to Native American tradition. In short, it is a chimerical world.

The corporeal world is the world of lived experience, which is the reason that Smith rated Edmund Husserl and phenomenology so highly.

This does not mean the denial of the physical world. For example, I see and touch a table, not atoms and molecules. You often hear such canards along these lines: “The table is not really solid, but is mostly empty space.” That is to confuse the reality with an abstraction: the table is real, and the physical world an abstraction, what Whitehead called the fallacy of misplaced concreteness. That leads to all sorts of anomalies when electrons, for example, are treated like particles in the corporeal domain.

Spatial and Temporal Gestalt Smith then points to Goethe for another way to do science based on the intuition of wholeness. He recommends *The Wholeness of Nature* by **Henri Bortoft**. Goethe opposed the idea of a “mechanism behind the phenomenon”.

The real is in fact none other than that which can in principle be known, and this is ultimately the phenomenon.

The whole, or gestalt, must be grasped at once, in its totality. In understanding this, Hinze makes some important points. Like Smith, he distinguished between the world of experience [Smith’s corporeal world] and the physical world. As examples, he refers to some optical illusions like the parallel line illusion¹⁶. The experienced world is spontaneous while the physical is the result of measurement. Since the modern mind prefers to regard the physical world as the “real” one, much gets lost. Hinze describes the difference:

If we compare the physical world-concept with the spontaneous world concept, the former looks like one which is fixed and rigid

¹⁶https://www.google.com/search?q=illusion+parallel+lines&rlz=1C1SNNT_enUS383US383&espv=2&biw=1132&bih=654&tbm=isch&tbo=u&source=univ&sa=X&ved=0ahUKEwi03_70lb3NAhUELb4KHcogBmEQsAQIGw#imgsrc=VzvFqSMB5w5XnM%3A

... a mere sterile skeleton vis-à-vis the latter. The direct, spontaneous world-concept is infinitely more many-sided, more "colourful" and more comprehensive than the physical world-concept; it is, above all, full of a pulsating liveliness and "warmth". This is not astonishing if we consider that the physical world-concept is derived out of the spontaneous world-concept through a step-by-step elimination of almost all signs which make up our lively world.

Hinze next distinguishes two types of gestalt. The more obvious one is spatial gestalt since we still have the sense of recognizing wholes in space. The temporal gestalt, or the ability to experience a whole spread out in time, has been largely attenuated. Perhaps the most obvious example today is a musical piece: although it is spread out over time, we can recognize it as a single composition. Although Hinze does not go beyond that, a higher consciousness is able to experience larger gestalts, i.e., the inter-connectedness of things as mentioned by Deloria.

By exploring the psychological makeup of archaic man, and even its development in children, Hinze is able to come to some conclusions about archaic astronomy, or astrology. "Presence time" is the gap in time beyond which a temporal gestalt cannot be grasped, but is experienced as isolated events instead. Hinze draws on examples from anthropology, art, and psychedelic drugs to illustrate this idea. The astronomers of ancient Babylon had a greater presence time than people today. Hence, they were able to experience the night sky as a gestalt. The movement of Mars was experienced as a whole, whereas we can only see isolated movements of a body. Moreover, they experienced the heavens as full of cosmic symbols which related to every aspect of human life.

The Chakras Hinze shows that in the ancient esoteric astronomy, the traditional planets correspond to the chakras of Tantra Yoga, in short, the macrocosm corresponds to the microcosm. Moreover, he shows how sim-

ilar ideas were part of the progress of initiation in Mithraism. But, even more interestingly, Hinze notes that the mystic **Johann Gichtel**, a student of Jacob Boehme, was aware of the same correspondence as revealed in his book *Theosophia Practica*. Table 2.4 shows these correspondences.

Chakra	Planet (Gichtel)
Sahasrara	Saturn
Ajna	Jupiter
Visuddha	Mars
Anahata	Sun
Manipura	Venus
Svadhithana	Mercury
Muladhara	Moon

Table 2.4: Correspondence between planets and chakras

Remarkably, Gichtel claimed to have discovered the subtle centers in the body and their correspondence to the planets through his own contemplations and experience. In the Tantric system, each chakra is represented by a lotus with a unique set of petals. Hinze demonstrates that the number of petals corresponds to the “gestalt number” of each planet. These numbers are derived from the way the ancient astrologers experienced the sky. For example, the gestalt number of the Moon is 4, which represents its phases. Hence, the Muladhara chakra has four petals. By making these connections in detail, Smith claims that it could not have arisen by chance. In other words, it is “complex specified information” in Dembski’s sense, hence it must be the result of intelligent design.

Various Bodies Obviously, the chakras and planets cannot be understood strictly in the physical sense, but rather as lived experience. In particular, Gichtel's order of the planets match the Ptolemaic system; Mercury follows the Moon due to their shorter temporal period of revolution. In the heliocentric system, Venus would follow the Moon. Hence, geocentrism and heliocentrism are not really opposed, but are rather two different perspectives.

To explain these levels, Smith revives the traditional idea of various sheaths or envelopes around the corporeal body. Thus, there is a "living body" beyond, but intimately related to, the corporeal body. In the Vedanta, there are three bodies that correspond to the three principle degrees of manifestation: the gross body, the subtle body, and the causal body. Furthermore, the subtle body itself is comprised of three sheaths: *pranamayakosha*, *manomayakosha*, and the *vijnanamayakosha*. In the West, these are expressed as the vital force, mind, and intellect. Thomas Aquinas distinguishes between a vegetative, sensitive, and intellective soul. Esoteric science must take all this into account.

The Meaning of Love

One ought not to occupy oneself with evil, other than in keeping a certain distance and a certain reserve, if one wishes to avoid the risk of paralysing the creative *élan* and a still greater risk—that of furnishing arms to the powers of evil. One can grasp profoundly, i.e. intuitively, only that which one loves. Love is the vital element of profound knowledge, intuitive knowledge. Now, one cannot love evil. Evil is therefore unknowable in its essence. One can understand it only at a distance, as an observer of its phenomenology.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

Idolatry is only a projection of individualism; it wears the mask of love but knows nothing of love. For it is not enough to love (every-

body loves somebody or something); we have to know whether the beings and things we love are for us doors leading to the world and to God, or mirrors which send us back upon ourselves.

GUSTAVE THIBON

The chakras, when paired up, are the centers of the three worlds, or Triloka, of the Tantric and Buddhist cosmology: kamaloka (the world of desire), rupaloka (the world of form), and the Arupaloka (the world of formlessness). The three pairs of the male and female principle, are the three steps of love: **Eros**, **Philia**, and **Agape**. Thus love is experienced respectively as a drive or instinct, as an emotion, and ultimately as an act of will. Since we are commanded to love, only Agape can be commanded; instincts and emotions cannot be commanded.

Nevertheless, the intellect is powerless to act without the emotion to drive it. Hence, a "Dr. Spock" type is an anomaly, not beneficent, but evil. Esoterically, a living creature lacking an emotional center is called a "chimera". It is imbalanced, since the overdeveloped intellect can cause much mischief. Emotion is replaced by the need for sensation. Without positive emotions, there is nothing to keep it in check. Even still, the relationship between the intellect and emotions is imbalanced even in "normal" people.

At its lower manifestations love is indiscriminate. Although many speak today of "love" and against "hate", this lack of differentiation is a sign of the Modern World, the Kali Yuga. Love needs to be directed toward the Good. Love cannot be directed toward Evil. Since the intellect determines what is Good, the feminine principle of emotion must allow itself to be dominated by the male principle. **Emmanuel Swedenborg** describes the male principle as "understanding" and the female principle as "love".

At the highest level, the roles are reversed. The higher intellect, the female principle, must be dominated by Agape, the male principle. In this

case, it is the Intellect that needs to be directed unlike in the lower worlds. **Soren Kierkegaard** in the Works of Love also described three types of love: erotic love (**Eros**), love of friends (**Philia**), and **Agape**. Only Agape is “more than a feeling” since it is an act of will. Confusing this with the emotions or instinct leads to sentimentalism.

If Agape is to will the Good of someone, then spiritual goods are more important than material goods. This is probably what Vintila Horia¹⁷ meant when he asserted that Kierkegaard gave him the “moral key” to understand Dante.

Posted on 2016-06-23 by Cologero

* * *

Tom Walker on 2016-06-23 at 12:33 said:

Thanks . Interesting as always . However wouldn't secondary matter (materia signata quantitate) be the same as the " physical world " , and in that case doesn't the latter expression have the potential to cause confusion ? I also don't see how the parallel line illusion illustrates anything apart from the fallibility of the senses.

Matt A on 2016-06-23 at 15:47 said:

So, are there methods for increasing one's "presence time"? I presume that certain exercises that incorporate into daily life, like returning to oneself when crossing a threshold, are helpful when followed for long periods (like months and years). Unfortunately, I'm the type of person who makes plans while driving, and completely forgets them upon entering the house. Perhaps a greater presence time would be helpful against such deviations.

Boreas on 2016-06-24 at 11:40 said:

Matt A, in Evola's 'Magic' opus there are excellent articles about those methods precisely what you might need. I personally especially love the essay about the three ways to experience time; the physical time, the psychical time, and the sub specie interioritatis. There are also very good practices in the book.

<http://www.cakravartin.com/wordpress/wp-content/uploads/2006/08/Julius-Evola-Introduction-to-Magic.pdf>

¹⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8440>

Cologero on 2016-06-24 at 23:41 said:

@Tom Walker

Let me quote the entire paragraph from Tantra Vidya:

This is the objective result of a spontaneous perception of the diagrammatical illustrations; [i.e., the diagrams I linked to].

objective, because *everyone* arrives at this result and it is consequentially valid *inter-individually*. This result of perception does not change, even though we find out on the basis of measurement and know an account of this that "in reality" the two lines in question are parallel

According the experienced reality distinguishes itself clearly from the physical reality, which is ascertained as a result of measurement. Today, we are even accustomed to acknowledge only the latter one as *really* true – and, therefore, one talks of geometrical-optical *illusions*: The criterion for reality is the physical result of measurement.

Physical results of measurement are naturally objective perceptions throughout, as they are verifiable *inter-individually*. Only, they are *not spontaneous* perceptions. In this way, I would like to separate, conceptually, the objective results of spontaneous perceptions from those objective perceptions *carried out through measurements*.

So what other "illusions", or fallibilities of the senses, do you want to give up?

I recall some scientist tried to "weigh" the soul of dying patients; there was no difference before and after death.

Neuroscientists cannot "see" your thoughts with their instruments. All they can measure is brain activity.

Your experience of your own free will cannot be measured, because science relies only on measurable "laws".

What about your sense of purpose in life? How can that be measured.

Need I go on?

Cologero on 2016-06-25 at 00:12 said:

@Tom Walker:

Yes, the vocabulary is lacking. Smith is more careful than I am with his words. He distinguishes, for example, between the corporeal object X and its underlying quantum object SX.

Prime matter has no form. A modern analogy would be the universe as a Schrodinger equation, all possibilities, nothing in particular until a consciousness creates a form.

Second matter is the substantial basis of an object. It is true that Guenon says that the “matter” of the physicists is the “*materia secunda*”. Yet I think it is a mistake to identify the quantitative object, i.e., the quantum level object of atoms and molecules, as the substance of a thing. I believe that is Smith’s point. Quantity is just the lowest stage, and above it is the thing with its various qualities.

2.II Chaos in the Noosphere

Three bodies **Shankara**, following the teaching of the Vedanta, describes the three bodies that constitute man.

1. Gross body: physical senses
2. Subtle body, or the mind/psyche: emotions, feelings, attractions, aversions, etc
3. Causal body, or the intellect: thoughts, images

Together, they make up the phenomenal world, i.e., the world as experienced, or *Jagat*. Note, particularly, that what we commonly regard as our “inner life” is actually part of the phenomenal world.

The intellect is called the causal body because it is the cause of our experiences in the subtle and gross bodies. Few people are aware of that process occurring in their own consciousnesses. That is because they regard the outer world as real, independent, and objective, but their thoughts as subjective, and actually the result of events in the physical world, not the other way around.

Shankara describes the activity of the causal body as a waking dream, analogous to the sleeping dream state. Liberation comes from knowledge of the Self. This Self, or Atma, transcends the causal body, and is unaffected by the vagaries and divagations of the causal, subtle, and gross

bodies. Atman is consciousness itself, and that is what brings the activities of the three bodies into awareness.

Unfortunately, we do not understand our identity, certainly not as Atman, but we identify as a false finite self, a creation of the causal body. Due to ignorance, the causal body creates an illusory world that we believe we inhabit. When and if we wake up to our true identity, that world dissipates, just as a nighttime dream does when we awaken from sleep. It is pointless to look for that “ignorance”, since it is not real, as it is only a privation; one cannot find ignorance, any more than one can find the darkness while walking around with a torch (as they say).

Chaos It is difficult to convince anyone that he is ignorant; since the identification with the ego is so strong, it seems undeniably certain to him. Nevertheless, by pointing out the ill effects of ignorance, perhaps some will be prompted to pursue things a little more deeply.

First of all, it is clear that the experiences of the gross body, i.e., everything experienced through the senses, is remarkably stable (apart from special cases of malfunctioning sensory organs). In other words, we all go outside and agree that the sky is blue and the grass is green. If I ask three people in the know for directions to the nearest convenience store, they will pretty much agree and I will arrive at my destination. The relative reliability of the gross world will be of value in the beginning exercises for the achieving Gnosis.

This stability cannot be explained if the causal body is randomly creating sensory experiences. Shankara elaborates a system of five elements (space, fire, air, water, earth), five pranas, ten organs, manas, and buddhi. These are subtle states that determine the gross material world. So the awakening from the limited ego to knowledge of the true self, involves a change in the perspective of the observer, not in the outer world. **Swami Chinmayananda** explains:

If and when after that awakening there is an outward cognition

of any experience, such a Mahatman of Self-realization cannot but see the same equipments of experiences, which were before his own, singing the Eternal Song of Life.

The situation is reversed for the subtle body, which appears to be entirely subjective. Clearly, there are emotional states that are reflected in bodily gestures. But for the most part, our inner states are invisible to each other; there are anxieties, fears, concerns, desires, etc., that dominate our minds. That is because of the identification with the ego, which results in a constant state of negativity. This makes interpersonal relationships so difficult: each party experiences the world filtered through these inner states and is unable to take into account the inner state of the other. To do so, is an art; first one must become detached from his own identifications.

Noosphere The activity of the causal body in those identified with the ego is also private and subjective, yet has an interpersonal element due to the faculty of speech. Speech then communicates systems of thought or ideologies. We can call the totality of public thought the “Noosphere”, in accordance with common usage. However, the Noosphere is not necessarily a boon, as it is actually in chaos.

With no way to arbitrate incompatible ideologies, they multiply and ramify. Since the identification with one’s own ideologies is so strong, any threat to it is misconstrued as a threat to one’s very self. Imagine, in our other examples, that every time you asserted that the “sky is blue”, you would find yourself embroiled in arguments with your neighbors, and sometimes even very bitter arguments. Then if you asked three friends for directions, two of them would give you totally incompatible directions and the third would try to convince you not to go to the convenience store at all. Life would be difficult and tedious; you would eventually carve out enough partial knowledge to function. Furthermore, you would form alliances with those holding similar ideologies. That is the chaos in the Noosphere.

The obvious question that arises is whether there is a way to settle ideological disputes, analogous to the way the gross world is organized. Some will turn to scientific positivism, which is the study of the orderliness of the gross world. That provides some sense of consensus, since mathematicians and scientists can agree on their thought systems; or at least, they have a recognized and mutually accepted way to resolve such differences, relying on experiments in and observations of the gross world. But this comes at the heavy cost of limiting what counts as knowledge; the rest of life, e.g., philosophy, political opinions, etc., does not lend itself to scientific methods.

Keep in mind that when we say we “know” something in the physical world, that really means that we intuit its form in the intellectual soul, even if we are unaware of doing so. So is there an analogous intuition of the thought world? Yes, there is, in fact, and that is the revelation of Tradition. **Valentin Tomberg** calls that “the book”, so we have the progression of thought to speech to the book. Exoterically, this revelation seems to be just another ideology competing for space in the Noosphere. The result is that the original revelation gets distorted and ramifies into multiple versions. A Traditional society is organized around its originary revelatory impulse, which maintains the populace in the awareness of that revelation. Rites, prayers, sacraments, scriptures, and so on, will awaken a little intuition in people so that they can maintain that faith. But this system is fragile, depending on the fuller understanding by the spiritual leaders.

The intuition in relation to the Intellect is not of the forms of objects, but rather of the Self. This this is ultimately One, there can be only one revelation. The method described by Shankara is remarkably similar to what Tomberg calls the birth of the Logos from the Spirit and the Virgin. Shankara uses the analogy of water reflecting the light of the moon. If the Intellect is agitated by attachments, desires, pleasures, pains, likes, dislikes, and so on, the moon’s reflection is fragmented. However, if the water is

still, the moon's reflection in the water is a unity.

Shankara concludes with a threefold plan to rid the ego of such impurities:

1. Listen to the truth of Scriptures, i.e., hear the Word
2. Reason from those truths
3. Deep contemplation on what has been heard and reasoned out

Shankara does not proceed beyond the realization of the self; at that point, the task is complete, the realizer is immortal, and there is no longer any concern with the manifest world. This is unlike the Buddhist who claim that the Bodhisattva will return to the world. It also differs from the Western Tradition, which sees the end in the fulfillment of the Person, not in his merging into the Absolute.

Reference: *Atma Bodha*, by **Shankara**, commentary by **Swami Chinmayananda**

Next: whether Tomberg and Solovyov offer anything further

Posted on 2014-03-24 by Cologero

* * *

Michel on 2014-03-25 at 06:56 said:

"Don't be afraid of the man behind the curtain".

Seeing the vast trickery in the world's sophists and in myself gave life to that statement. Except it has been pretty dangerous along the way sometimes. I wonder if anyone here has also experienced any danger in the psychic world, and how they dealt with it. That man seems very powerful before the curtain is torn and he is shown for what he is.

scardanelli on 2014-03-25 at 10:17 said:

"A Traditional society is organized around its originary revelatory impulse, which maintains the populace in the awareness of that revelation. Rites, prayers, sacraments, scriptures, and so

on, will awaken a little intuition in people so that they can maintain that faith. But this system is fragile, depending on the fuller understanding by the spiritual leaders.”

This, then, underlies the importance of the “elite” of a society- the leaven that infuses the whole. The elite is only elite insofar as it has the capacity for revelation, for the intuition of the true self rather than merely intellectual understanding. It seems that this “post” is perhaps that of the hermit in Tomberg... that of the prophet in distinction to the posts of emperor and pope.

“... such a Mahatman of Self-realization cannot but see the same matter equipments of experiences...”

Cologero, could you clear up this passage? I don't quite understand it. Is there a typo maybe?

Tom on 2014-03-25 at 11:41 said:

Dear Cologero.

Always read your posts with great interest.

Just one question regarding the “three bodies”: I thought that thoughts and images were an aspect of the subtle body which corresponds to the dream state? The causal body corresponds to the deep sleep state.

Frater M on 2014-03-25 at 12:25 said:

Reminds one of Paul to the Ephesians “For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the powers, against the world forces of this darkness, against the spiritual forces of wickedness in the heavenly places”.

andros on 2014-03-25 at 16:26 said:

On dealing with danger: many years ago, while abroad, a malevolent presence entered my mind, then my room. Turning over in my bed and facing the wall only made the presence stronger, it's incursion more frightening. Not knowing what to do, I brought to mind the people I love: fear vanished and I recognised sickness. I was rising to help the presence when my neighbour started knocking frantically on the wall.

Love brought me through.

Cologero on 2014-03-25 at 19:36 said:

Chinmayandanda: We are not limited individually as we take ourselves to be. There is a limitless region of experience beyond what is known at present, and this is shut out from us because of our self-centred existence. When the realisation of the true nature of the Self comes to one—even as mere theoretical knowledge—he, who was till then in a perpetual state of fear

and sorrow, seems to wake up from his own limited existence and rediscovers himself to be the Blissful Self which is All-pervading and Eternal.

If and when thereafter there is an outward cognition of any experience, such a Mahatman of Self-realisation cannot but see the same matter as equipments of experiences, which were before his own, singing the Eternal Song of Life.

By equipments he means the physical, mental, and intellectual . It seems to me that he is saying that after self-realisation the world is seen as it is, and not through the illusions we create.

Cologero on 2014-03-25 at 20:04 said:

Tom, the Swami refers to "the world of objects cognised for enjoyment as forms, smells, etc., through the sense-organs; as feelings and emotions experienced by the mind; and as ideas and ideologies lived by the intellect."

I'm glad you pointed this out, because after posting it, I wanted to go back and insert a step prior to "thought, speech, book"; I was a little quick equating the intellect to the causal body because of the way the commentary was written. Yes, the thought arises in the mind, but is caused by the ignorance in the causal body (hence its name). It does not change the general point that ideologies arise out of ignorance and they dictate the way we live.

Michel on 2014-03-26 at 12:13 said:

@andros

Thanks for sharing that. I hope that in continuing with your self-realization you have been able to progress through the subtle world overcoming the vast trickery therein. Of course the danger is in the trickery itself, and in the indefinite forms it is capable of assuming, be it the disgusting and terrifying or the lovely and beautiful. A tasty meal should look as disgusting as a bowl of dung; and a bowl of dung should look as delightful as a tasty meal. All is Aoristos after all.

2.12 Sex and Violence

The typological classification of people has always formed part of Hermetic teachings. This classification was often couched in astrological terms or as the four temperaments, among other schemes. Julius Evola has used the idea of spiritual races, which he claims to have found in

ancient symbolisms, to the same end. Now these classification schemes transcend psychological states or tendencies, and, a fortiori, biological or genetic factors. As such, they are metaphysical types of different spiritual natures.

The purpose of such classifications is not only to understand the world, but also one's own inner nature. By developing awareness and observing the inner workings of consciousness, a man learns to recognize his own type. In this way he can transcend his own limitations or restrictive points of view. In this way, he also learns to recognize the types of other people and thus can intuit their inner states.

Since these types are metaphysical, they are not amenable to scientific or psychological research. That is why so few people become aware of them. Since a man's type, or spiritual race, dominates his entire way of being and manner of thinking, he finds it impossible to conceive of a different way of seeing the world. Hence, these national "calls to dialogue" on fundamental existential issues are doomed to fail; there just is no common ground on which to base any such discussion. The ways of relating to the world are radically different.

A related concept, when passing beyond the merely individual perspective, is the idea of a national spirit as documented by the idealist philosophers, particularly Giovanni Gentile (which is why we will be discussing him more in the future). This spirit would be manifested in its religion, art, law, science, folklore, etc. However, that presumes a spiritual unity, even if only virtual, which is no longer present in most Western countries. It is striking, when reading books written some 75 years or so ago, to note how prescient they were; here we can point to Guenon, Evola, Berdyaev, Spengler, and a few others. From our perspective now,



everything then seemed quite normal, as the decline was barely visible in manifestation although it was quietly moving ahead in the invisible spiritual world. These men were able to discern those negative spiritual forces and anticipate their long term effects. For, it may take several generations for the full consequences of one age to become manifest. The iniquities of the father will affect the next three or four generations.

Evola, for example, points to the infiltration of the “telluric” spirit into western civilization. This telluric race is earthbound, unable to experience or even understand anything transcendent. The connection to life of the telluric being is marked by immediacy, instinctiveness, and irrationality. He is dominated by sexual impulse that is lacking in virile qualities. With a limited sense of personality or individual responsibility, he goes along with the crowd, which is often tied to his natural peer group, but in recent times seems to be groups of ideological affinity.

The positive law is supposed to reflect the cosmic law in concrete circumstances; when the leaders are guided by transcendent principles, then the positive law will act to restrict and restrain the worst impulses of telluric man. However, once such men themselves make the positive law, these restraints are one by one eliminated in a frenzy of liberation from them and the unleashing of primitive and instinctive forces. Evola points out that the final decomposition of a traditional civilization is marked by the appearance of the telluric spirit within it.

As intriguing as all that is, Gornahoor thinks that these types need to be understood from the “inside” as it were; here we are always guided by Augustine’s maxim that the truth lies in the interiority of man. This we shall do by following our earlier analysis of the various faculties of the soul. In a solar race, the forces of thymos and epithymia (or eros) channeled toward higher values, and are dominated by the rational or intellectual soul. Hence, from thymos he experiences the energy or force to strive for transcendence. Epithymia acts as the attractive force.

However, that is not how the telluric man experiences them. In their

crudest form, these faculties are experienced as the urge to violence and sex. That is why popular culture, whether it appears in movies, TV shows, “music”, and so on, is so often dominated by those two themes. That is why appeals to make movies, for example, with more sublime themes (e.g., spiritual elements, etc.) are so naïve. Not only are the consumers of pop culture dominated by the telluric element, but the producers themselves of the culture are themselves telluric and have no other understanding. Anything of an even slightly higher nature is portrayed in a sentimental and stereotypical way. However, Evola points out that there is a melancholic element associated with that, although it is not very deep. This is demonstrated, for example, in movies of the type created by a Woody Allen, which are dominated by a superficial type of spiritual angst; nevertheless, films of such a character are highly regarded by the “intellectuals” of the telluric type. A more recent example is the HBO series “Girls” which again is highly touted by the same elements.

This morning I heard a discussion about the “gun control” issue that is dominant today in the USA. One “journalist” suggested that Hollywood should be part of any so-called solution; in other words, it should be called to task for promoting so many movies with graphic violence. Of course, this generated the mechanical response about our alleged “hypocrisy”, in allowing graphic violence—assumed to be “bad” —while prohibiting graphic sex—presumed to be “good”. Readers, don’t you see how this exactly proves my fundamental point? Why the automatic, and probably mindless, contrast of sex to violence, instead of a hundred other possible qualities?

Naturally, this led to a further stereotype: viz., in Europe they ban violent depictions but allow the sexual. Now, don’t get me wrong, I am heartened when American men today recall their ancient European heritage. However, they always relate to the most recent and decadent elements of Europe today rather than the sane and normal era prior to the French Revolution.

Before moving on to the metaphysical understanding of sex and violence, we can point to some rather obvious empirical results. First of all, violence has always existed, prior to mass media, prior to video games, prior to the printing press, and it continues to exist even among peoples far removed from such influences. We recently pointed to the existence of primitive Brazilian tribes, with no access to the artifacts of western civilization, yet who are quite violent in their daily lives. Furthermore, rates of violent crime have actually decreased in the USA despite such movies and games; the factors for that are beyond the scope of this article.

The next empirical point is that graphic sex, aka pornography, has not led to happiness. As a matter of fact, the opposite has occurred. Rather than leading to better and more fulfilling relationships between men and women, it has instead resulted in widespread impotence among men. (See the article by Lasha Darkmoon in the January 2013 issue of *Culture Wars* in this regard). A case can be made that graphic sex is being used to control and subvert the population, whether deliberately or incidentally.

I will conclude, first, with the traditional understanding of sex and violence, followed by an explanation. The erotic impulse in traditional art is sublimated toward a higher end. That is reflected in the ideals of chivalry, troubadours, the *Fedeli d'Amore*, etc. That allows the power of sexual attraction to be transferred to the desire for superior values.

Similarly, violence is not gratuitous, but is ordered to heroic and noble ideals; such stories have always been portrayed in myths, legends, and scriptural stories. Hence, recent trends in not allowing boys to play with toy guns, or play as soldiers, or watch films depicting violence are fundamentally misguided. It makes them passive instead of training them to be active agents who understand that sometimes the higher good entails the proper use of power and coercion.

Even if you have understood nothing thus far, I will provide two simple concepts that summarize it all:

- I. When boys role play as heroes, fighters, conquerors, etc., or even

engage in sports, they are not incited to commit actual violence. To the contrary, the urge for violence is mitigated by such play.

2. However, the very purpose of pornography and graphic sexuality is to excite erotic impulses, yet they do not provide any way to satisfy them.

Hence, sex and violence act in opposed ways, are directed by different psychic centers, and cannot at all be understood in the same way.

Posted on 2013-04-04 by Cologero

* * *

Sparrow on 2016-01-20 at 16:25 said:

If one wants further proof about the tellurism of modern times, simply consider the obsession with sexlessness. Being a "virgin" or "single," are both used as insults, and celibacy is almost blasphemous since the telluric man can't conceive of any reason that someone would not indulge in sexual pleasures. The obsessive fear about sexual inadequacy that spawns numerous pills that seek to cure the problem is truly comical.

2.13 Rationality and the Triune Brain

No god is a philosopher or seeker after wisdom for he is wise already. Neither do the ignorant seek after wisdom for herein is the evil of ignorance, that he who is neither good nor wise is nevertheless satisfied with himself.

SOCRATES

it is obvious that, from the philosophical point of view, one can always think anything whatsoever and discuss a problem endlessly without ever reaching a conclusion; it is even what characterizes profane speculation

RENE GUENON, *Letter IX to Julius Evola*¹⁸

The self-elevation of human reason, the pride of the mind, inevitably leads to its ultimate downfall and abasement.

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV

When reason comes out against the reality of life and knowledge with a consciousness of its own supreme rights, it finds that everything in life is alien, dark, and impenetrable.

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV

The limits of rationality Vladimir Solovyov defines rationalism this way:

The essence of pure rationalism consists in the conviction that human reason is a law unto itself and gives laws to all that exists in the practical and social realm. This principle is expressed in the demand that all life, all social and political relations, be organized and directed exclusively on the basis worked out by personal reason, apart from all tradition and all immediate faith.

Any such schemes must necessarily fail for two reasons:

- In the practical domain, reason is impotent against passions and interests.
- In the theoretical domain, reason is impotent against empirical fact

¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4662>

An example of the first failure is the French Revolution which was allegedly founded on the rationalism of the Enlightenment and the goddess Reason, but devolved into an irrational blood orgy. Curiously, post-modernism has tried to solve the problem by consciously putting reason in the service of passions and interests. Then the only issue is to choose whose passions and interests to support. Of course, in continuity with the Revolution, those interest must needs be opposed to the traditional political and spiritual authorities.

The opponents of post-modernism, who often call themselves “conservatives” or the “right” etc., are clueless about the nature of Revolution. For the most part, they are modernists, that is, children of the enlightenment. They thus convince themselves that Reason alone will suffice against the postmodernists. Some will even proclaim allegiance to the “enlightenment” values of reason, free speech, etc., the intellectual equivalent of “bringing a knife to a gun fight”.

The postmodernists and the modernists, the former perverting reason, the latter not recognizing its limits, each produce egregores, i.e., man-caused spiritual beings. The antidote is a valid Tradition, faith, and gnosis. That Tradition is guided by the Logos, a spiritual reality, whose light exposes the egregores and dissipates them.

The way unintelligent people argue If *The Art of Controversy*¹⁹ describes how the 1% resolve controversies, here the other 99% are described. The purpose of a rational dialog is to reach a conclusion, not to engage in endless debate. Yet, endless debate is what we get. It is worthwhile to consider why that is so. One cause is the lack of knowledge or understanding of the topic. Then, there is ineptness in logic.

Fundamentally, however, the real cause is the priority of passions and interests over rationality. In psychological terms, such a person is motivated by eros or thumos, corresponding respectively to passions and

¹⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=169>

interests. Then, so-called debates become battles of partisans, more akin to arbitrarily rooting for the blue or the green team in a chariot race. Not only is one's own position defined, but also the adversary's. What follows typically are mutual accusations of inconsistency, often stated with great mirth and glee. Some snarky types will go a step further by posting an argument that, they hope, will upset equally both "sides".

The end point can only be like kayfabe²⁰, a mock battle with no real winner. This is especially the case in the numerous televised debates between "both sides of an issue". Never does one such side suddenly become converted to the other; were that the case, the show would be over and one of the debaters would be out of a job.

Yet, such shows draw an audience, just like professional wrestling. However, in any real sport there is always a referee, judge or other officials. Thus, televised debates need to have an impartial judge, i.e., one motivated by nous rather than by the lower forces to point out errors of facts and logic. Perhaps we will at a future point demonstrate how that might work in practice.

Reason and Evidence I recently listened to one popular youtube philosopher who went on and on about reason and evidence being the only guides to life. What I didn't hear was a discussion of the domains proper to each of those terms.

Of course, they are derived from the Traditional doctrine of two natures: the physical order of things and the metaphysical order of things. Reason applies to the world of Being, i.e., the metaphysical order, and Evidence to the world of Becoming, the physical order.

As we pointed out above, "reason is impotent against empirical fact", i.e., the physical order. Although concepts are subject to logical laws, the empirical world is not. Logic is not discovered empirically, there is no

²⁰<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kayfabe>

evidence for it. A fortiori, there is probably more evidence against logic in the world.

Formation of the world If we inspect an empirical fact, e.g., the Grand Canyon, we can reconstruct in our minds how the material and physical forces may have created it. The flow of water over millions of years dissolved the rock, creating a deeper and deeper crevice until it became what we see today.

On the other hand, can we be so certain that animal life arose in the same way as the Grand Canyon, i.e., as the result of the purely material forces. **Valentin Tomberg** asserts the contrary:

Tentacles, paws, arms, wings — are they not simply diverse forms manifesting a common prototype or principle? They are insofar as they express the desire to bear the sense of touch further, to be able to touch things more removed than those in the immediate neighbourhood of the surface of the body. They are active extensions of the passive and receptive sense of touch which is spread out over the surface of the organism.

The organs of action are simply crystallized will. I walk not because I have legs but rather, on the contrary, I have legs because I have the will to move about. I touch, I take and I give not because I have arms, but I have arms because I have the will to touch, to take and to give.

That summarizes the Traditional view. The idea pre-exists in the World of Being, which the will brings into manifestation in the World of Becoming.

Creation of the I The fundamental choice must be made: is the I, or Self, the creation of material forces like the Grand Canyon, or not? Obviously, the first option cannot be a choice. If matter creates the I,

then whence does logic arise? The laws of logic are not the laws of matter, otherwise the Self would always be logical. That does not square with the evidence.

Therefore, the situation is the opposite: the I is independent of matter. Like tentacles, paws, arms, and wings, for spiritual development, the desire and effort to advance creates spiritual organs, i.e., higher emotional and intellectual centres.

Gravity and Metaphysics The force of gravity can be understood on a few levels:

1. Things fall
2. It is understood qualitatively and disparate phenomena are related: why a feather does not fall like a rock, the moon is kept in place by gravity without falling, the tides are caused by the moon's gravity, etc.
3. Intelligent high school students can understand and use Newton's formula for the force of gravity.
4. Very few students will be able to understand Einstein's general theory of relativity due to the complexities of tensor calculus and non-Euclidean geometry.
5. Finally, there is the unified theory reconciling general relativity with quantum mechanics. No one, at present, understand this. Paradoxically, neither theory has been empirically refuted.

Yet when it comes to spiritual and metaphysical topics, certain types try to refute the moral equivalent of stage 1 of the understanding of gravity. Hence, for example, they have in mind the crudest conceptions of God, rather than that of the most advanced metaphysicians. If I were to refute

Newton by claiming that a feather does not fall as quickly as a stone, would that be taken as a serious argument?

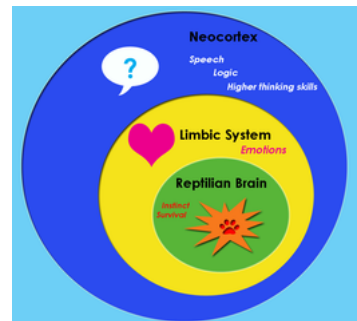
The Triune Brain **Paul MacLean** famously created the model of the Triune Brain²¹ in the 1960s. He claims that there are three more or less independent brains in man:

- The **reptilian brain**, centred in the ganglia, is associated with aggression, dominance, territoriality, and ritual displays.
- The **mammalian brain**, centred in the limbic system, is associated with emotion, including with feeding, reproduction, and parenting.
- The **human brain**, centred in the neocortex, is associated with advanced qualities like language, abstraction, planning, etc.

Neuroscientists today may quibble about the exact boundaries of these centres in the quantitative sense, but in the qualitative sense the model is consistent with traditional and Hermetic teachings. The difference of course is that the model creates the biological brains, and not vice versa.

Hermetic teaching therefore goes much further, so that these “brains” actually correspond to the etheric body, the astral body, and the Self. In Letter XV of the *Meditations*, Tomberg describes the process of incarnation:

Incarnation is the addition of an astral body to the Self, the addition of an etheric body to the astral body and the Self, and lastly the



²¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Triune_brain

addition of a physical body to the
etheric body, the astral body and the Self.

In our current state, however, things are not so simple. The Self is not unified, so the lower bodies are not obedient to his commands. Moreover, the Self is unaware of most of the activity of the lower bodies. In Hermetic training, one learns to bring these unconscious processes into the light of consciousness. The obvious question should arise: if I, as the Self, am not in control of the activities of the etheric and astral bodies, then who or what is?

In the lectures delivered just prior to his conversion and collected in the book *Inner Development*, Tomberg reveals that there are two spiritual beings that attach themselves to the astral and etheric bodies. They each affect the human being negatively in different ways.

People have always had an intuition of the presence of alien spirits, even without special training. There is the popularity of writers like **H. P. Lovecraft**, and in our time, the large number of movies about devils, possession, etc.

One example is the recurring idea of reptilian beings in the world, disguised as humans. Although we can reject the notion of biological reptiles covered with human skins, there is certainly a spiritual race of humans who are centred in, or dominated by, the reptilian brain. These are caricatures of real human beings and includes psychopaths, sociopaths, etc. Such people have few genuine human feelings, yet they cause emotional turmoil in others. These people also strive to hide their real natures.

The distortions in the astral body lead people to be dominated by their passions. **Howard Bloom**, in his book *The Lucifer Principle*, provides a comprehensive history of human disorder and cruelty, strictly from a materialistic and biological point of view. The title however is curious, almost as if Lucifer wants to take credit for the human condition by using Bloom as his mouthpiece.

Bloom asserts at the beginning that the Lucifer principle is built into creation itself, thereby making God the creator of evil. One should therefore conclude that there is no escape, so that human life is eternally destined to a life of evil, cruelty, and conflict. Curiously, he blinks at the end; the final paragraph asserts that humanity may yet overcome that fate through the power of imagination.

That certainly does not follow from his initial premises, yet it has its truth from a higher perspective. The Luciferic principle (by which he conflates the etheric and astral distortions) may yet be redeemed and dissipated.

Posted on 2018-08-14 by Cologero

* * *

Lyon on 2018-08-24 at 16:25 said:

There's a lot of meat on the bone with these posts. Much appreciated!

2.14 Dreaming with the Animals

Now the animal man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him; and he cannot know them, because they are but spiritually judged. But he that is spiritual, on the contrary, judgeth all things, and he himself is judged by no man.

I CORINTHIANS II: 14-15

There are four kingdoms or realms of Nature: the mineral, plant, animal and human. The human realm incorporates all four realms in its being. The mineral realm was dealt with in *The Hour of the Morning Star*²². The plant realm, or Etheric Soul, was described in *Sex and*

²²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=15116>

*Tropism*²³. The properties of the rational soul, which is properly human, will follow up on this one.

The animal, or astral, soul is the seat of feelings and emotions, both positive and negative. It also produces the imagery of the world. The external world is active in regard to the animal soul. That is, the world dominates the animal soul, creating a representation of itself in the soul of the animal. Hence the soul is passive in relation to the world; there is no escaping it.

Similarly, the animal has an inner world of its desires and emotions. The primary motivations are fear, sex, and hunger, although there are more positive emotions like playfulness, affection, pleasure-seeking, etc. Likewise, the soul is passive in relation to the inner forces. The animal experiences fear, sex, and hunger directly without mediation. Although the animal can choose, its choices are not free; rather, they are driven by its emotions.

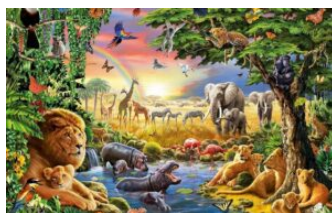


Figure 2.1: Animal Dreams

Hence, animals exist in a dream-like state. In dreams, we are passive to the flow of the dream (barring unusual experiences like lucid dreaming). To understand the animal soul, imagine sensations and emotions without thought. When a desire arises, imagine immediately acting on it. Obviously, there can be conflicting drives. For example, hunger may arise, but fear makes the animal cautious.

Because an animal does not have knowledge of essences, every experience is novel. You see that in young children who say “again, again!” whenever they enjoy a game. Eventually they get bored. Your dog, on the other hand, never gets bored about jumping up for a treat. Even adults, moreover, can find themselves in the mode of repeating the same expe-

²³<https://gornahoor.net/?8349>

riences over and over. Unfortunately, such beings are often centered in their animal soul.

The boundaries between the etheric body, animal soul, and rational soul are not hard, but rather merge into each other. For example, the animal soul does share in the intelligence of the rational soul. However, since it remains part of the animal soul, it cannot dominate or master the animal soul. Only the fully human rational soul can do so.

Posted on 2021-10-24 by Cologero

2.15 Esoteric Anthropology

The soul is all that it knows.

ARISTOTLE

Although **Rene Guenon** wrote his esoteric anthropology in the context of the Vedanta (*Man and his Becoming*), there is also a deep tradition to be found in the West. By “esoteric”, of course, is meant the inner constitution of the human being, known through consciousness. Although this knowledge was part of the Hermetic stream that included him, Plato made it a key component of his oeuvre. It was then expressed in a different way by Aristotle.

Moreover, this tradition was known and developed by Christians at least through the Middle Ages. Plato’s version is presumed in all the writings collected in the *Philokalia*. Thomas Aquinas recovered Aristotle’s version. This shows the continuity between the pagan era and the Christian era in the West. Furthermore, this knowledge is not substantially different from that of the Orient, as Rene Guenon points out:

on this and many [other conceptions], the conceptions of Aristotle are in complete agreement with those of the East.

As the epigraph expresses, the degree of being of the soul is related to its knowledge. Hence, the soul develops as self-knowledge develops. The fault in the Western notion, according to Guenon is this:

but this affirmation, in the case of Aristotle and his successors seems to have remained purely theoretical. It must therefore be admitted that the consequences of this idea of identification by Knowledge, as far as metaphysical realization is concerned, have continued quite unsuspected in the West, with the exception of certain strictly initiatic schools, which had no point of contact with all that usually goes by the name of ‘philosophy’.

However, Christianity opened up the possibility of such a realization. In other words, beyond merely theoretical knowledge of the soul, it is a Way of salvation and liberation, something lacking in paganism (except perhaps in isolated mystery schools). This is attested to in works like the *Philokalia* and *Unseen Warfare*, at least to those who know how to read them esoterically.

This understanding of the soul thus has two aspects: static and dynamic. In its static aspect, it is a description of the parts of the soul. Its dynamic aspect includes the way to deeper knowledge of the soul as Aristotle described. These are analogous to the sciences of anatomy and physiognomy in medicine.

This post will deal with the static aspect. It rarely can be fully grasped without having participated in proper and direct training. Hence, to most readers, what follows will strike them as a philosophical theory. For the few, it will be recognized as fact.

Centers There are three basic centers which correspond in man to the three kingdoms: the sensual, emotional, and intellectual centers. Since the soul is not in a particular place, these cannot be resolved to specific biological functions. This is the condition of man as he is. As such, they

are disordered and do not serve as a true guide to life. Hence, it is necessary to transcend these three centers.

The emotional and intellectual centers have corresponding higher centers, that, for the most part, we are unaware of. The higher intellectual center is not disordered at all and is perfect. This is the "image of God" that was left intact after the Fall. The sexual center, or eros, often mistakenly merged with the sensual center, is necessary for the second birth. Obviously, it can be part of a sensual life, but when sublimated, it can lead to transcendence. Hence, eros needs to be directed toward the logos. These centers are summarized in Table 2.5.

This outline leaves out important details. The three lower centers each have a positive and a negative aspect. For example, the sensual center may be known through automatic, or instinctive, attraction and avoidance. Everyone experiences positive and negative emotions. The intellectual center will agree or disagree with an idea.

Furthermore, the three centers or souls interpenetrate each other. Hence, there will be certain emotions associated with sensual activity, or instinctive functions will display intelligence. All that is too complex for this introduction.

Exterior Men Everyone is dominated naturally by one of the three lower centers; this is fixed and cannot be changed. At this point of non-development, such are called "exterior men or women" because their attention is dominated by external facts, conditions, or events. Julius Evola refers to this initial state in these terms:

From its first moment, we can say that the "I" still lives only as if in a dream: it is not yet a self-consciousness, nor an autonomous principle of action: immersed in an immediate, indistinct coalescence with nature and the world, we can say that it is not so much he who thinks, speaks, and asserts himself, but rather that various forces and impulses think, speak and assert themselves in him.

He therefore is only a type of medium, a passive instrument that has his very life outside himself, and he experiences everything as grace, as spontaneity, as the immediate self-manifestation of something that transcends him.

At this stage, the problem of certainty does not exist, since whatever arises spontaneously in consciousness is presumed to be a true image of the world. That is why initiation must begin by provisionally questioning all one's cherished beliefs and opinions. Unfortunately, apart from those very few born righteous, no one is willing to do that without first having undergone some sort of spiritual, emotional, or intellectual crisis. The three centers give rise to different misconceptions.

- **Sensual misconceptions.** Those dominated by the first or sensual center regard the purpose of life as the pursuit and satisfaction of sensual desires.
- **Emotional misconceptions.** Those dominated by the second or emotional center consider their emotional life as guide to life. Hence, for example, they may be overly concerned about taking offence. If they hold a particular opinion, say a political or religious one, they believe that the degree of passion associated with that opinion is an indicator of its validity.
- **Intellectual misconceptions.** Those dominated by the third or intellectual center are attracted to ideas, ideologies, or opinions for their own sake. For them, questions of epistemology, i.e., "how do I know what I claim?", don't enter their consciousness. They are prone to frequent changes or conversions. They are recognized by the tendency to categorize, and even dismiss, the giants of thought with little more than a one sentence summary. The intent is to sound sophisticated in their peer group. The danger of this type

for Tradition is that they will try to understand Tradition philosophically (as Guenon pointed out, see above), or they will misunderstand esoteric texts by reducing them to their limited frame of reference.

Of course, this just scratches the surface of possible misconceptions. Those who actually follow an esoteric way will learn to recognize these misconceptions both in themselves and in others.

Interior Men The few who manage to escape the attachment to exteriority will be obsessed with finding a way out. Julius Evola describes the beginning of this phase:

Now in this second stage, following the “period of spontaneity”, the “I” turns toward autonomy and individual existence – that consequently happens only in so far as the original connection with the whole is gradually broken, and as a gradual tearing away from the World takes place. Consequently, what used to be familiar to the individual is made alien and impenetrable, what intuitive certainty used to reveal to him as indisputable fact is made dubious and problematic.

So the first task is to begin observing and transcending the misconceptions of the first stage. A temporary “I” develops that integrates the three lower centers. This is still a transitional, or psychological, state, often represented as the lower Ego or the Self in Jungian terms.

Beyond that, there are three further stages: the development of the Real I, Consciousness, and True Will. These are all the possibilities available to man as such and depend on recentering on the higher emotional and intellectual centers. The final stage depends on the complete sublimation of the sexual center. But this process will have to await the discussion of the dynamic aspect of esoteric anthropology.

Posted on 2014-11-09 by Cologero

* * *

TeenyTinyTarot on 2014-11-10 at 08:30 said:

http://nazbol.net/library/authors/Rene%20Guenon/Rene_Guenon_Man_and_His_Becoming_according_to_the_Vedanta_Collected_Works_of_Rene_Guenon__2004.pdf

Paulo on 2014-11-10 at 11:29 said:

"From its first moment, we can say that the "I" still lives only as if in a dream: it is not yet a self-consciousness, nor an autonomous principle of action: immersed in an immediate, indistinct coalescence with nature and the world, we can say that it is not so much he who thinks, speaks, and asserts himself, but rather that various forces and impulses think, speak and assert themselves in him. He therefore is only a type of medium, a passive instrument that has his very life outside himself, and he experiences everything as grace, as spontaneity, as the immediate self-manifestation of something that transcends him."

Should we see any difference between Jungian process of individuation, Gurdjieff fourth way, Ramana Maharishi, Nisargadatta Maharaj self enquiry and the traditionalist way?

Avery on 2014-11-13 at 11:23 said:

"it is a Way of salvation and liberation, something lacking in paganism (except perhaps in isolated mystery schools)"

I realize that I am making a rather foolish complaint given the developed stage of this blog, but this is the trouble that gave rise to Guenonian Traditionalism in the first place. Is the Truth available to pagans only through secret rituals? In other words, is the Christian God a Gnostic God for those without a covenant? I don't think this is a minor point, since it would appear to upset the objective of catholic (universal) religion.

If you've written about this elsewhere, feel free to link me to there.

Cologero on 2014-11-13 at 13:22 said:

I don't believe I am grasping the issue, Avery. There is no "Christian God", just the God; if I ever gave another impression, I'll have to clarify or retract it.

I don't "know" about the pagans directly, just what can be inferred through their writings. Clearly, pagans from Hermes to Plato and beyond knew about the God and even the Logos.

The populace, on the other hand, was taught polytheism with gods selectively interfering in human affairs. There was no solution to the problem of death; descendants were expected to

keep the flame going. I had in mind some passages from Bachofen but the book is not at hand right now.

What do you suppose was the purpose of those mystery schools (and why did you change the designation to “secret rituals”)? Why did the early Christians believe that they superseded those schools since they were the esoteric teaching.

What “gave rise to Guenonian Traditionalism” was Guenon’s failure to make contact with an esoteric tradition in the West. Isn’t that because the original distinctions between the cat-achumens, the faithful, and the perfect became blurred? And aren’t most exoteric christians, including academics, more like pagans except they believe in one god rather than many?

I have quoted on several occasions (feel free to find the links yourself) those theologians who regarded previous traditions as precursors, not as indicating a rupture.

Given this, please be specific about your complaint so we can work it out.

2.16 Demonic Possession

The Fall introduced distortions into the three functions of the soul: Thinking, Feeling, Willing. The centre of gravity fell from the Real I to the I of the personality. The function of meditation is to restore the proper functioning of the functions. In a series of lectures published as *Inner Development*, **Valentin Tomberg** describes the effects of meditation:

The general effect of meditation consists in the fact that what is spiritual in a human being descends. That is, the superconsciousness—the higher I—descends into the human personality, and the angel sends down the helping stream of his illumination in the form of “washing of the feet.” Just as Christ bowed down before his disciples and washed their feet, so in every meditation the angel bows down and washes the feet of the meditator.

This is a description of hylomorphism, or vertical causality: the Real I plays its role as the Master of the emotional and physical life. He then describes the triple effect of the Washing of the Feet:

This is a description of hylomorphism, or vertical causality: the Real I plays its role as the Master of the emotional and physical life. He then describes the triple effect of the Washing of the Feet:

The angel causes the cleansing stream to flow down as far as the individual's feet. This is the image of the Washing of the Feet. For the washing of the feet consists in the fact that the Luciferic angel is redeemed, the human double is exposed, and the Ahrimanic double is driven out. Hence we could say that the spirit thereby bows down, or inclines downward. By means of meditation, the spirit becomes heavier and the soul becomes inwardly radiant. Insofar as the spirit penetrates the soul, the soul learns to "breathe" the spirit. By "breathing in" the spirit, the soul lights up and extends itself; and by "breathing out" the spirit, it ennobles the body. For what is breathed out by the soul enters into the body.

In the *Meditations*, Tomberg prefers the term "egregore" to the "double", or Doppelganger. Ahriman refers to the distortion of the Will function, or the etheric body. In Zoroastrianism, Ahriman resulted from one of Ormuzd's doubting thoughts. Thus, Ahriman was the second voice heard by Eve in the Garden. The Will becomes a "desire that is perverse or contrary to nature" [Letter XV], which then excites the imagination. Together they constitute the act of the generation of a demon, in this case the Ahrimanic doppelganger in the human.

Purification of the will requires driving out, or expulsion, of the second voice, that of the devil. Purity of heart is to will one thing.

The Lucifer doppelganger refers to the distortion of the Feeling function, or the astral body, by exciting the passions. True transformation requires the liberation from the Luciferic doppelganger. **Willi Seiss** describes the necessary steps:

The Luciferic doppelganger cannot leave the astral body of man until this astral body is completely shaped by the will of the person in question. First of all, harmonization will be required here,

as volitional powers work on the astral body. Then it becomes necessary to do hard work, through which

- willpower,
- emotional life, and
- thought control

are ordered, educated, and shaped.

The effects are deep and deceptive. For example, Lucifer apes God by claiming to be the bearer of wisdom. He uses pride, attachment to opinions, bombast, and passions to obfuscate and confuse. Knowledge of God acts to liberate the astral body (this will be described at the end).

Psychological Complexes In the *Meditations*, Tomberg's deeper understanding moves beyond his earlier work. No longer using terms like Luciferic and Ahrimanic, he instead relates the same phenomena to psychological complexes:

Demons that have not arrived at the stage of objectification, i.e. at that of an existence separate from the psychic life of their parents, have a semi-autonomous existence which is designated in modern psychology by the term "psychological complex". A psychopathological "complex" is therefore a demon, when it has not come from outside but is engendered by the patient himself. In its state of gestation it is still not born, but it certainly has an almost autonomous life of its own, nourished by the psychic life of its parent. Now, "an autonomous being capable of interfering with the intentions of the ego" and which "possesses a mental life of its own" is nothing other than what we understand by a "demon".

Letter XV, The Devil

In other words, the demon is a creation of the person himself, although he remains unaware of having done so. **Carl Jung** explains the phenomenology of a complex:

What is not so well known, but far more important theoretically, is that complexes can have us. The existence of complexes throws serious doubt on the naïve assumption of the unity of consciousness, which is equated with psyche, and on the supremacy of the will. Every constellation of a complex postulates a disturbed state of consciousness. The unity of consciousness is disrupted and the intentions of the will are impeded or made impossible. Even memory is often noticeably affected, as we have seen. The complex must therefore be a psychic factor which, in terms of energy, possesses a value that sometimes exceeds that of our conscious intentions, otherwise such disruptions of the conscious order would not be possible at all. And in fact, an active complex puts us momentarily under a state of duress, of compulsive thinking and acting, for which under certain conditions the only appropriate term would be the judicial concept of diminished responsibility.

Structure and Dynamic of the Psyche

At the centre of the complex lies the Will. The Will is not one, because its energy is seized by the different archetypes. This then generates images — false images — which engender emotional reactions that have nothing to do with the real situation. In extreme cases, negative emotions — anxiety, depression, despair, suicidal thoughts, fear, paranoia, anger, hate, mistrust — can overpower the person.

Behaviour then follows, which is often inappropriate and even self-destructive. Anyone who has had to deal with someone with a personality disorder may certainly feel that he is dealing with a demon. Irrationality and severe mood swings make effective communication impossible.

Complexes can also affect the thinking function. This is especially obvious in those obsessed with ideologies. Tomberg writes:

A person who has had the misfortune to fall victim to the spell of a philosophical system (and the spells of sorcerers are mere trifles in comparison to the disastrous effect of the spell of a philosophical system!) can no longer see the world, or people, or historic events, as they are; he sees everything only through the distorting prism of the system by which he is possessed.

These complexes are more insidious because they can affect entire nations.

Every day I encounter some writer or another warning against yoga, or reiki, or some other practice, because they are “demonic”. These writers assume that the demonic is “out there”, so that if we would only stay in our “safe spaces”, we would avoid the demons. The real truth is that the demonic is within, deep within, us. Only the work of intense inner purification can liberate us.

The difficulty is exacerbated because the demons, or complexes, can seem so natural and obvious to the person afflicted. The person then erects a wall for self-protection, only letting a few people in. Of course, those people must not be threatening to the demonic complex, or in contemporary parlance, they are called enablers. All too often, the enablers prefer to keep the afflicted person weak and dependent.

Liberation Once the afflicted person — and we are all afflicted to a greater or lesser degree — has, through grace, determined to become free, he will look for a solution. Tomberg describes how that might work:

Modern depth psychology has discovered and put into practice the therapeutic principle of bringing unconscious complexes to the light of consciousness. Because — so it affirms — the light of consciousness renders the obsessional complex not only visible but also impotent. This important discovery of modern psychology is in complete accord with the spiritual reality of the “struggle” of the celestial hierarchies against evil. Because this “struggle”,

also, amounts to their presence alone, i.e. to bringing evil to the light of day. ... Light drives out darkness. This simple truth is the practical key to the problem of how to combat demons. A demon perceived, i.e. on whom the light of consciousness is thrown, is already a demon rendered impotent.

However, psychoanalysis is slow and expensive. Hermetic psychology has developed exercises that are much more effective in bringing the complexes, or unconscious elements, to the light of day. By purifying the heart chakra, this may take effect:

It is the breath of life which dissolves the complex, by way of the heart so that the mistrust, fear or hate, concentrated in the complex is dispersed and the soul is left free of the blinding influence of the psychic complex.

Meditations on God Prayer and meditation are at the heart of Hermetic psychology. And the greatest meditations are on God. Tomberg recommends scholastic meditation:

Perhaps the *quinque viae*, the five ways of reasoning²⁴, of Saint Thomas Aquinas will not necessarily convince you, but you will emerge from meditative work on the five arguments (proposed to prove the existence of God) with a clear head and a calm heart, well-prepared and equipped to seek and find other ways to certainty. It is the occupation with these five ways of reasoning which will render you stronger and calmer, which will elevate you above all the entanglements due to the confused play of complexes which are a mixture of feelings in which personal preferences assert themselves and thoughts which are only a mouthpiece of these preferences. And it is this elevation above psychological complexes

²⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=13472>

which is the salutary effect — even the healing action — of occupation with scholasticism, when one reads in the style of scholastic meditation.

Letter XIX, The Sun

It helps to be obsessive — in the good sense of the term — on such meditations, which should fill up your spare time throughout the day. Other meditation topics might be Being, the One, the Good, or the elements of a sound World Conception.

Posted on 2018-11-16 by Cologero

* * *

Heinrich on 2018-11-16 at 11:03 said:
the teaching in this post is fundamental.

do you suggest prayer as a form of western meditation? prayers are not mantras, and – as far as Guénon says – the only sacred language in the west is Hebraic. but, certainly, Grace can go far above these «limitations»... prayer can be both an object of concentration (to empty ourselves in order to sink deep into the Self) and a mean to Grace. but what is the intrinsic value of, for example, the latin Ave Maria? does it make sense to repeat it like a mantra? i read nice words about this beautiful Christian prayer in Burckhardt's «The alchemy of prayer», but it was strictly linked to the meaning, not with the «magic» force of the sacred signifier..

2.17 Spiritual Pilgrims: Carl Jung and Teresa of Avila

Father John Welch is a member of the Carmelite Order and a Jungian who has lectured and written extensively on the meaning and practice of **St. Teresa d'Avila's** *Interior Castle* in tandem with Jungian psychology, especially where it concerns the process of Individuation. Father Welch's lectures and writings serve equally as a primer to both subjects, or fresh,

insightful reviews, for those already familiar with the territory. In various contemporary “traditional” writings and circles, both “mysticism” and Jungianism have often gotten short-shrift, or been subject to certain austere, and or carte blanche criticisms—thus the work of Father Welch serves to help counter balance these equations.

In *Meditations on the Tarot*, Tomberg raises a few points worth considering in the above context:

1. The objective of this work is a “fusion” of types of knowledge. Hermeticism seeks a resolution of the “oppositions” between spirituality and intellectualism, toward an agreeable “parallelism”, and lastly a “fusion”. This fusion Tomberg equates with the “Philosopher’s Stone”, and “Operation of the Sun and the Moon” (Meditation on The Fool).
2. That the work of Carl Jung constitutes a branch of such “fusion” in the domain of psychological and behavior sciences, Tomberg adds

Neither **Vladimir Solovyov**, nor **Nicholas Berdyaev** nor **Pierre Teilhard de Chardin**, nor **Carl Gustav Jung**, for example were declared Hermeticists, but how much they have contributed to the progress of the work in question! Christian existentialism (Berdyaev), Christian Gnosis (Solovyov), Christian evolutionism (Chardin), and depth psychology of revelation (Jung) are, in fact, as many inestimable contributions to the cause of the union of spirituality and intellectuality

Meditation on The Fool

In the specifically religious domain, Tomberg finds this type of fusion present where prayer and meditation coexist as method,

or exercise. He offers as examples St. Teresa and St. John of the Cross in Carmelitism, St. Boneventura and the Franciscans, and St. Ignatius Loyola and the Jesuit Order (Meditation on The Fool).

3. That the beginning task of the spiritual aspirant, the “initiate” need attend to, by whatever other name one wants to describe it, what Jung dubbed “individuation”. Tomberg explains that this individuation is the “harmonization” of the consciousness and unconsciousness —this has also been referred to in the Hermetic literature as the “chemical wedding”, preceding the “mystical wedding”— in St. Teresa, as we will see, the individuation stage occurs throughout several “rooms”, and culminates in “betrothal”; whereas the seventh and final “room” corresponds to the “mystical marriage”. In Tomberg, St. Teresa and Jung, the common result of this phase of development is the birth of a new “Self” which becomes the center of the being.

Architecture of The Interior Castle St. Teresa depicts seven “rooms” in her castle, through which the athlete experiences differing intensities and effects of prayer, as well as numerous spiritual and external life challenges. Those familiar with Sufism might detect similarities between the castle chambers, with the Sufistic “stations” and their associated “states”. In any event, the challenges of St. Teresa’s path toward Union also evidence again, that unlike the shallow, “fluffy bunny”, “let’s all think positive and attract good vibes from the universe”, pop-spirituality, here in the presence of an experienced heavy weight champion, we are taught that traveling the path may often exasperate internal and external difficulties, long before remedying such. In certain rooms, Teresa makes no bones about pointing out that one might feel alienated from both God and man, isolated, depressed, and longing for death. This too is the message of Jung concerning individuation, which he suggests is one of the most painful processes a human might undergo—and which is also why

he avers, many adults quite simply abandon the process early on in their adult lives, never “growing” much beyond who they were in their twenties/early thirties. Keeping this last point in mind, when out in public next time, try unobtrusively observing and listening to strangers noting their age groups—this makes for an interesting thought experiment in itself.

Now despite the use of “seven” concrete rooms, one ought regard these as a matter of literary convenience, as the actual “number” of rooms is indefinite. Perhaps while considering the Gospel saying that “In my Father’s house there are many mansions”, St. Teresa noted that the castle is arranged in concentric rings, with each main room, in fact enveloping numerous sub-rooms, reminiscent of a palm frond as she described them—or maybe in these days we could call to mind imagery of fractals or Manderblots:

1. Room one is straight forward enough. The individual meets the most basic religious requirements—they “pray”, but their prayer is on the cold side. In terms of lifestyle, they are preoccupied with most everything external as their priorities—in fact, although “religious”, they have little awareness of, or interest in anything “internal”. This room is crawling with “reptiles” and vermin—a menagerie of Jungian “shadow” symbols.
2. The second room is reached when the person begins to have an inkling that their life has a purpose, call, or “vocation”, and proper discernment means developing a more intimate exchange with God. In prayer life, the person is becoming warmer, and they are exploring a bit more of scripture, liturgy, and charitable works.
3. This third room is particularly interesting, because it characterizes much of the “exoterism” of our times. But, the good news first. In the third room, the individual is living a “well ordered life”. They

are “mature” in their familial, social, professional, and religious lives—they basically have mastered the “letter of the law”, and conduct themselves accordingly—“good Christians”, and what would be considered secularly as “upstanding citizens”. Teresa explains though, that remaining too long in this station of sincere, but exclusively outward prayer results in spiritual stasis, and dryness. In a Jungian context, this station might roughly run from a person’s mid-twenties to mid-thirties; while necessary, useful, and inherently positive, we might observe that when becoming irrevocably habitual, not only seizes up the growth process, but generates what might be seen as a “bourgeois” moralizing, and at the worse, a burgeoning fundamentalism closing itself off from the “spirit of the law”.

4. Our fourth room is of great importance, as it establishes a division of the rooms into two groups, two broad hemispheres, representing the phases of individuation, with this fourth as “transition”. From a Jungian perspective, the individuation process can be divided into two distinct phases:
 - (a) The first half of life (approaching ages 35-40), marked by personality growth, and adaptation to the external environment, “the world”.
 - (b) Second “half” of life (beyond ages 35), and relating to the interior world. It should be noted that these “ages” are relatively relative, as Jung observed that some teen-aged patients had already embarked along the second half; while many adults well into advanced age had never even begun such as stage.

Ideally, the second phase produces an “equilibrium” between consciousness, and the unconscious poles within the psyche; the arrival at individuation, is the arrival at the “Self”. Not for nothing then, did Teresa

explain that while self-knowledge is unnecessary to obtain salvation, pursuit of increasingly more profound self-knowledge develops and promotes union with God. Thus, we are reminded of something Guenon and others have mentioned: exotericism, and the fulfillment of the rites of a religion, are available to all (the masses) to obtain salvation; while, others upon accomplishing this task, might seek “more”, an esoterism, attempting to move the Self into the occupation of the higher states.

Father Welch has then approached the rooms of the Interior Castle as spiritual pilgrimage, as well as equally corresponding to the individuation phases, where rooms 1-3 correspond to Jungian phase I, rooms 5-7 Jungian phase II, and room 4, as transition pivot. Both Teresa and Jung agree that room 4, or the transition between phases I. and II. is a particularly difficult and trying station. In Hermetic language, this room/station reminds us of the “mastery of the four elements”, or the “trials of the Sphinx”. In this room, opposite pairs from within the four “functional types” (thinking, feeling, intuiting, sensing) emerge to hopefully enter equilibrium. A recently published book attributed to **Franz Bardon**, entitled *The Universal Master Key* examines these functions or properties of the elements in the soul, from a Hermetic angle, with advice on developing them in harmony, and worth exploring in room four.

As pertains to prayer, Teresa’s fourth room inaugurates the “fusion” or “harmonization” of outward prayer, and inner contemplation; it recalls what Tomberg mentioned above concerning intellectuality and spirituality.

5, 6, 7. Likely as one would anticipate then, the fifth, sixth, and seventh rooms, are “hot”, individuation has reached an apex, and the spiritual life is characterized increasingly by states of Divine Union—the influence of the merciful descent of Grace tends to take greater precedence though than individual actions or “exercises” (though these are not dispensed with).

In his meditation on “The Pope”, Tomberg discusses the meaning

of “benediction”, what is also called “barakah” in other traditions, and assigned the nomenclature of “spiritual respiration” in Tomberg. It involves another type of “harmonizing”; Tomberg’s imagery uses the left and right columns of the Kabbalistic Tree, the Boaz and Jachin pillars—more to the point, the upward ascent of prayer, followed by descent of benediction—never forgetting the critical matter, that this descent is a gift of mercy—not a product of a mechanical and “scientific” operation of “arbitrary magic”. Two scriptural verses and a liturgical example help illustrate these principles:

Many are called, but few are chosen.

Matthew 22:14

Let my prayer ascend to you like incense, and the lifting up of my hands as an evening sacrifice.

Psalms 141:2

And, the Epiclesis of the Mass/Divine Liturgy.

St. Teresa’s language regarding the sixth room involves betrothal, and the seventh the “Spiritual Marriage”, the reaching of the central room of the castle. For Jung, the center of the “mandala” has been reached; the whole Self attained. “Horizontally” the athlete, working in accord with the external law weds and makes whole the psyche mostly through their own efforts, energies, and disciplines, and a new “center” takes over. “Vertically”, and more so through the grace of benediction, the harmonized soul might ascend to enter the bridal chamber of Spirit.

And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all men unto me

John 12:23

Notes:

Jung, Carl, *Memories, Dreams, and Reflections, Undiscovered Self*.
Teresa of Avila, *The Interior Castle*.²⁵

Tomberg, Valentin, *Meditations on the Tarot*.

Welch, John, *Spiritual Pilgrims: Carl Jung and Teresa of Avila*. Video lecture *The Interior Castle of Teresa Avila: A Map of our Spiritual Journey* in Youtube.

Posted on 2014-04-03 by Frater M

2.18 Psychology of Mystical Experience

We can indeed know that the bosom of the Father is our own basis and origin, and that our life and being find therein their life and principle. From this basis that is proper to us—that is, from the bosom of the Father, and from all that lives in him—shines forth an eternal brightness, the generation of the Son. And in this brightness, which is the Son, God sees himself openly, with all that lives in him. All those who, above their created being, are raised to a contemplative life, are one with this divine brightness. They are that brightness itself, and they see, feel and discover, under this divine light, that according to their ideal or uncreated being, they are themselves this abyss of simplicity, the brightness whereof shines without means in divine modes. Thus the contemplatives attain their eternal exemplar, after whose image they have been created, and they contemplate God in all things, without distinction, by a simple gaze, in the divine brightness.

JOHN OF RUYSBROECK

²⁵Online pdf at <http://www.saintsbooks.net>

The concluding chapter of *Studies in the Psychology of the Mystics* by **Joseph Marechal**, S.J. deals with how one's world conception colours his mystical experience. As a methodological principle, Fr. Marechal is not concerned with the truth of the metaphysical systems, but rather with its psychological effects. The obvious problem with his study is how to define "mystical experience", since Christian ecstasy and yogic Samadhi are often included as such experiences along with trances induced by hallucinogens, ritual dance, etc. This, then, is his definition of **mystical experience**:

Mystical experience is a religious experience which is esteemed as superior to the normal: more direct, more intimate, or more rare.

The corollary is that there are three fundamental elements:

1. A religious doctrine—rational or revealed—which is a metempirical doctrine, relative to the Absolute.
2. Psychological facts of actual experience that are relatively rare or exceptional, and susceptible of a religious interpretation.
3. A synthesis of doctrine and psychology which interprets the psychological facts as a function of the doctrine.

Not unlike Rene Guenon, Fr. Marechal accepts the ideal of a unique metaphysic, despite the historical existence of a variety of metaphysical systems. Given the three elements, the highest and purest expressions of mystical experience will be associated with an intellectual understanding of the ideal metaphysic. Fr. Marechal describes several metaphysical systems and the mystical experiences arising from them.

Animism Inferior systems have not yet achieved a unity of thought from the plurality of sense impressions. An example is animism which postulates metempirical “souls” behind the world of outward experience. The medicine man or sorcerer will associate strange subjective states with these hidden entities. This includes experiences, among others, such as:

- Dreams with a sacred content
- Narcotic-induced delirium
- Trances resulting from extreme physical asceticism
- Hysterical ecstasies brought on by music or scents

Although such experiences are valued very highly and are still sought after by a substantial number of spiritual seekers, Fr. Marechal considers them not worthy of an extended treatment.

Metaphysical Awakening

Fr. Marechal points out the close connection of metaphysics with religion in general and with mysticism in particular. He uses the famous panel from the Sistine Chapel showing Adam’s attraction to the finger of God pointing at him as the artistic rendition of the awakening of human intelligence to the notion of an Absolute distinct from himself. It shows:

- Man’s consciousness of his own ego, at once infinite and limited
- His perception of the universe
- His thought seeking the Absolute

This is the Great Triad: the ego, the universe, and the Absolute. The relationships of these terms are the sources of two fundamental things:

1. The source of his potentialities of action in the physical order
2. The law governing his attitude and the key that unlocks his destiny in the moral order

Different metaphysical systems define those relationships in different ways. Although Fr. Marechal does not mention this, it is obvious that, as a practical matter, two sciences are a great help in developing those potentialities: esoteric cosmology, which deals with the universe, and esoteric psychology, which deals with man's inner states of consciousness.

Dualism and Pessimism Dualist systems see the universe as the expression of the conflict of two eternal principles: e.g., Being or the Good vs non-being or Evil. Such viewpoints lead to destructive asceticism and negative mysticism. That is, one's destiny is determined more by the attempted renunciation of the "evil spirit" rather than by a path of positive and uplifting stages. The world is experienced as being limited by the unreal or not-being. The universe is seen as evil and illusory.

Marechal refers to **Arthur Schopenhauer's** philosophical system, although not strictly a dualism, but a pessimism. The will to live creates a universe of "my" representations, which is nevertheless evil and meaningless. Only the renunciation of that will can be the solution. Again, beyond the negation of phenomena, there is nothing positive. In Manichaeism, and even Buddhist mysticism, object, actions, etc., are all limitations; that is the sole Evil. Such mystical practices focus on overcoming the limitations of the World of Becoming, without consideration of what lies beyond in the World of Being.

Pantheistic Monism This is a more advanced or sophisticated metaphysical system, what we may call the God of the philosophers. There is no opposition to Being; rather primacy belongs to the Absolute, which is beyond dualism. The earliest such systems derive from the Upanishads

or Vedanta. The essential basis of this philosophy is the identity of Brahman and the Atman, which is the sole reality. The apparent multiplicity of things and souls is illusory. Hence, man's destiny is extirpate in his soul the illusory multiplicity of objects and acts to end up within the Atman. The Atman is known, but not as an object. Hence, the only goal is to "be" the Atman.

Comparable Western systems never quite go that far, since the idea of an ascent to God via created things is not denied. The influence of Plotinus affects not only the West, but Sufism and even Indian philosophers. God, or the One, eternally creates the world by casting out his rays like a sun to the "very confines of non-being". Then the things, which are divine fragments, have a desire to return to the unity of the absolute Good.

The human soul is between the pure Ideas and matter; it is attracted towards the Center by Love. If love predominates in the soul, it begins to be concentrated. Firstly, it apprehends intelligible beauty through the senses. Then by contemplation, it is purified and unified: "to contemplate is to become what is contemplated." From sensible beauty, the soul passes to the lower intellect of concepts, or psyche. Then it becomes the higher Intelligence, or nous.

Still the drive of Eros leads it to seek the perfect unity of the absolute Good. Thus it contemplated Being as the summit of the intelligible world. Yet, there is still the duality of Essence and Existence. Ultimately, though Love, even that duality is overcome in the One.

Later metaphysicians such as **Giordano Bruno**, **Benedict Spinoza**, or **Johann Fichte** are in this stream. For example, in the negative direction, Spinoza defines man's moral end as the freedom gained over inadequate ideas and the passions. Yet, there is the positive direction of the "intellectual love of God".

Fichte, from whom Evola borrowed much, discovers the pure I, or spirit, opposing to itself the not-I, or universe, so that it may progres-

sively know itself and conquer itself by gaining self-mastery. The human intelligence is raised to the dignity of an Absolute, i.e., a “mysticism of becoming God.”

The point is that “metaphysics can invest the ordinary operations of our understanding with a mystical significance.” However, Marechal identifies the mysticism that such systems inspire as purely “natural”, achieved through thought, and lacking any notion of “grace”. In short, the distinction between nature and supernature is obscured.

Monotheism and Supernatural Mysticism Finally, Marechal address strict monotheism as the answer to the question of the relationships between the Ego, the universe, and the Absolute. God, then, is strictly transcendent without any common measure with that which is not himself. He possesses the fullness of Being which excludes not-Being.

The universe then is a “becoming” proceeding from God and arranged between the limits of pure Being and pure Not-Being. Although external to God, it is moved and directed by divine action. Finite things do not create themselves as in monistic systems; yet they are not evil or nothingness as in the pessimist dualist systems. They are free creations of love and possess value measured by their degree of participation in the perfection of the divine Being.

Hence, the created intelligences and wills will tend to reproduce the divine Ideal and try to make progress towards it. Hence, the mysticism from this view will have many analogies with Neoplatonism. Creation is grafted onto the closed cycle of the operations of Divine creation as an epicycle. At the beginning of the epicycle, the divine actions descends into the innermost elements of things, giving them their “nature”.

Next the flood ascends back to God, as every material beings “tends to the perfection of its species”. The entire physical world tends toward vital unity in stages:

- The vital unity, through its comprehensive interiority, foretells and

prepares for consciousness

- Sensibility (or sense experience) reflects the unconscious world of matter and brings it to the threshold of the idea
- Then, the intelligence recognizes the intelligible in the data of sense
- Finally, it discovers in its “becoming” no other end except God himself. This closes the epicycle.

The return of things to their first principle, i.e., the ascent of the intelligence to God, is a mystical phase. All becoming has a *law*, and in that law, is an *end*. Marechal then describes that law as it is fostered in the depth of the human soul. There are two aspects: the order of intelligence and the order of the will.

The Intellect tends toward the assimilation of Being as known, or, Absolute Truth. The Will tends to the possession of Being as absolute Good. The two tendencies converge on the direct vision of God. However, insofar as the soul is restricted to the plane of creation, there must also be an initiative from God that expands the intelligence and reveals himself.

This initiative from above leads to higher states than what can be achieved through the natural mysticism of monism, as it opens up the horizons of grace and supernature. It does not reject the natural metaphysical systems, but builds on them. Paradoxically, it leads to unity with the divine while retaining the individuality of the soul. That is the highest achievement of the Western Tradition.

Summary Marechal summarizes the three principal types of mystical theories:

1. **Negative mysticism.** A mysticism of simple liberation, the result of dualistic cosmologies and philosophic pessimism.

2. **Positive mysticism.** A mysticism of divine becoming immanent in the soul.
3. **Theistic mysticism.** The mysticism of objective striving toward God by means of knowledge and love.

Clearly, a superior metaphysic will lead to deeper mystical experiences.

Posted on 2016-01-27 by Cologero

* * *

Mercurius on 2016-01-28 at 22:59 said:

Another excellent piece Cologero.

Concerning “pantheistic monism”, the West, and the manner in which Western “monotheism and supernatural mysticism” includes the former, while perfecting and it and going beyond, as contradictory it might seem, the significance of a pantheistic materialist monism ought factor in as well. Vis a vis, what the Stoa brought to the table.

But, how can THAT be of any use to us, we might ask—as the strict form excludes any transcendence (apparently), contradicts Platonism, is formally anti-Idealistic, and insists on an endless identical “recur”.

What is brilliant, is that Paul (seems to have) taken Stoa materialistic pantheism, endorsed certain basic implications in it, while correcting and adjusting for errors; and consequently, the Western Tradition’s “dna”, counterbalances and adjusts for pure idealist errors.

In 1 Corinthians, Paul wrote: “Now you are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it”. Here, a sort of material “pantheism” is expressed, while removed from a mere naturalism.

Mark Citadel on 2016-02-03 at 12:25 said:

Well this was a joy to read as always. A couple of queries:

“This is the Great Triad: the ego, the universe, and the Absolute.”

An odd question, but do angelic beings find themselves in this relationship as egos, a mechanic part of the universe for man, or indeed a functioning branch of the absolute (i.e – the Divine Realm). I am tempted to say they are egos as well, since we know that angels had (or still have) free will and moral agency.

Also, on dualism, in Scripture we are given a dichotomy between choosing ‘the World’ or choosing God. I am curious as to how we can overcome the seemingly dualistic nature of this.

Is it that we must see 'the World' not as an expression of evil, but simple 'becoming' as opposed to the superior 'being'?

"Hence, the created intelligences and wills will tend to reproduce the divine Ideal and try to make progress towards it."

This was what I had theorized when pontificating on the ever-present nature of 'Tradition' that in fact installations of monarchy and patriarchy are reflections of the Divine Realm, aspired to by all peoples, hence their ubiquity. However, right now we seem to be progressing AWAY from that ideal to some horrific nadir. In your four stages... "– The vital unity, through its comprehensive inferiority, foretells and prepares for consciousness

– Sensibility (or sense experience) reflects the unconscious world of matter and brings it to the threshold of the idea

– Then, the intelligence recognizes the intelligible in the data of sense

– Finally, it discovers in its "becoming" no other end except God himself. This closes the epicycle."

Where would the current state of man in the Kali Yuga rest? Or, at the bottom of the cycle, have we not even a foot on ladder rung #1!

Cologero on 2016-02-04 at 22:39 said:

@Mark, not sure what you are driving at. Angelic beings have a self, though not like man's ego. Guenon explained that angels could be considered as higher states of being. That is, they are beyond sense impressions and discursive knowledge. They have the beatific vision and do not need to seek it.

I think your initial impression is correct that the "world" refers to the lack of a sense of transcendence. As such, "the World" is not a metaphysical concept as the world of becoming vis-a-vis the world of Being. Otherwise, your best bet would be idealist monism, just contemplating the ideal world of Being.

It is not a question of "we", it starts with a few. Many are at stage 4. The Kali Yuga will end whenever you want it to.

Miltie on 2016-02-06 at 21:39 said:

Changing the "a" to an "o" gives a very very different translation in Greek.

Cologero on 2016-02-06 at 22:38 said:

Uncle Miltie, FWIW, I've always been told I have a nice butt. I think I'll change my name to kalokolo.

2.19 Neo-Vedanta, Evil Spirits, and Don Quixote

I attended a small gathering of Neo-vedantists last week. (A neo-vedantist is a Westerner who tries to extract the metaphysics of the Vedanta apart from their connections to the Vedas.) There was the typical talk about the higher self, which transcends space and time. Not bad, but not quite the same as actually transcending space and time.

Then there was talk about the mind rambling on at random. Again OK, but practices to master the mind was missing. The most experience woman asserted that as a brute fact, but could offer no explanation. That is because the neo-vedantists have no doctrine of the “Fall”, so there is no understanding of how man in a higher state could fall into a lower state. Without that understanding, it seems more difficult to reverse the process. Also, in that system there is no way to understand Redemption.

Then the next topic was the world as illusion, which easily leads to nihilism. If everything is illusion, as these neo-vedantists claimed, then life is pointless. IF only consciousness is real, but why make the effort to remain fully conscious of a meaningless world for all eternity? The sounds more like hell than bliss!

Of course, every real spiritual path requires moral discipline in order to purify the mind. This is opposite to nihilism. Of course, the false paths are all illusory, but efforts must be made to follow the real.

Horizontal Memory and Universalism The next topic questioned the reality of time: The past no longer is, the future is not yet, the now disappears. Although such assertions are common in certain circles, does such a pseudo-spirituality make sense? If Gnosis is remembering, then what exactly are we remembering?

Hermetic teaching refers to vertical and horizontal memory, as described by **Valentin Tomberg**. Vertical memory brings what is above into present consciousness. This is more Platonic, since vertical memory

is knowledge of the forms or prototypes. Horizontal memory, on the other hand, makes the past present.

If the past is “not real”, then how can it be made present? If I think of a unicorn, I am visualizing something unreal. But when Achilles has a vision of his dead mother, is that at all analogous? Achilles is making the past present, whereas my vision is totally illusory.

One of the goals of the modern world is to render the past unreal. Human beings derive their being horizontally as well as vertically. Vertically, we share in a universal human nature, e.g., we instantiate certain prototypes. But that does not exhaust being, since we are born into specific familial, historical and social situations. I used to have to drop off my teenage son a block away from his friends’ houses, as if his friends would be fooled into thinking he spontaneously arose and was not the fruit of sexual reproduction.

That is the common delusion today. We emphasize the universal but neglect the specific. We pretend our genetic inheritance is an unfortunate accident. We suppress the mythological-spiritual sources that define us. We try to become the abstract I of the neo-vedantists, that observes but does not participate.

Other Minds New atheists scoff at the idea of the world being populated by spirits. A spirit is an I, with conscious experience, a rational nature, and some level of moral agency. Hence, there are presumably several billion spirits inhabiting the earth. These human spirits are tied to bodies, and their everyday commonness shrouds a real mystery.

That is because science has no way to prove the existence of spirits. The only plausible answer is that consciousness is an illusion, an epiphenomenon of biochemical processes in the brain. Alan Turing proposed a test to distinguish a computer simulation of a person from a real person. If his test works, that just demonstrates that science cannot distinguish between a machine and a human being.

Philosophers debate the “problem of other minds” endlessly, without conclusion. Yet they don’t doubt their existence, or else they would be logically compelled to embrace solipsism. I still recall a thought I had when I was a very young boy driving back from Grandma’s house with my family. I was looking out at all the other cars, the houses, the people, and so on. I assumed that only I existed, that the only significant world event was dinner at Grandma’s. If so, then who were all those other people and what were they doing? I considered that God was spontaneously creating the surrounding world simply to entertain me. That must have baffled that boy for a while, since I still more or less think that way. Only grudgingly have I learned to accept the existence of other people. Isn’t it obvious? A solipsist would not bring so much pain and disappointment on himself, would he?

Evil Spirits I won’t repeat the arguments that the human spirit can exist apart from the physical body, but simply stipulate it as a fact. If so, then there is no reason to doubt the possibility of the existence of other disembodied spirits. That is the logical argument, but there is also the empirical experience of entire history of the human race that testifies to their existence.

Those who have undergone Hermetic training, which involves careful observation and cataloging of the inner states of consciousness, eventually come to the realization that their thoughts are not necessarily their own. They begin to realize that it is as though another being is thinking those thoughts for them. Passive ideas have no power. **Giovanni Gentile** emphasizes this:

The primary causal agent is always an idea become person, with a will that pursues determinate ends—a cognizant will that has a program to realize, a concrete thought, effective in history.

If that is true about human persons, it is a fortiori true about extra-human agents. The ideas that rattle around in our heads always have a

person pushing it for “determinate ends”. This may sound odd to modern men, but that is simply because they never bother to consider the actual sources of their thoughts.

Sergei Bulgakov claims that one’s guardian angel is a prototype for the human. This is consistent with Rene Guenon’s claim that the angels are higher states of the being. So we can become aware of angelic intelligences by reaching these higher states. Opposed to them are, let’s call them “devils”. There is actually a certain comfort in them, since devils believe in God and seem to have a compact with God limiting their effects. Furthermore, they are at least interested in us.

Then there may be a large number of beings that are totally indifferent to us. A horrifying death to me has always been the fear of being eaten by an animal, such as an alligator. That is because of the animal’s complete indifference to us as a human being. At least a murderer knows he is killing another human.

Although the real Hermetic goal is the achievement of higher states, there are many more inferior schools that try to cultivate relationships with these indifferent beings. Some they try to control, others they need to supplicate. Still others claim to bring new teachings to humanity; they are not angels, so the results are mixed. There is today a proliferation of psychic channeling.

An interesting case is **H. P. Lovecraft** (since I recently acquired Barnes and Noble’s attractive edition of the Cthulhu tales). Although Lovecraft was a professed atheist and materialist, **Kenneth Grant**, in *The Magical Revival*, has a different take on it. He wrote:

Understandably terrified of crossing the Abyss, Lovecraft forever recoiled on the brink, and spent his life in a vain attempt to deny the potent Entities that moved him. Little wonder that the tales he wrote are among the most hideous and powerful ever penned.

Grant himself does not deny such Entities. He elaborates on their danger:

Not only can the disembodied spirit of dead or sleeping people impersonate spirits and work evil by such means, but—which is infinitely more dangerous, extracosmic entities can masquerade as spirits and, if they are not banished before they can gain a foothold in the consciousness of the sic who invoked them, obsession follows. ... Lovecraft is the authority of the devastation they leave in their wake when they are let loose upon the earth.

It is curious that only some occultists are aware of the spiritual battle going on in the world. The proliferation of these extracosmic entities is the manifestation of the “fissure in the great wall” that Guenon described:

the ‘fissures’ occur only at the base, and therefore in the actual protective wall itself, and the inferior forces that make their way in through them meet with a much reduced resistance because under such conditions no power of a superior order can intervene in order to oppose them effectively. Thus the world is exposed defenceless to all the attacks of its enemies, the more so because, the present-day mentality being what it is, the dangers that threaten it are wholly unperceived.

Everyone else is like Don Quixote fighting imaginary battles in a world they no longer understand.

Posted on 2017-05-04 by Cologero

* * *

Osbourne on 2017-05-04 at 06:26 said:

Shankara outlines in his Vivekachudamani (Jewel of Discernment) the necessary preparatory work for reintegration. The prerequisites to the work necessary are the antitheses to what these self-styled neo-vedantin blabbermouths spew out. Foremost is the discrimination between the real and unreal. The unreal subsumes under itself all the preconceived intellectual formulations

arbitrarily constructed without achieving the corresponding state. The end result is far from guaranteed. It's not to be partaken of democratically. It's clear that these neo-vedantins (better inverted-vedantins) understand nonduality as a form of monism where everything is the same and equal under the common denominator of being an illusion. No discernment is necessary, just repeating the same illusion mantra like pacman. All these inverted spiritualities are in full conformity to the modern capitalistic zeitgeist. Zizek said aptly that in a CocaCola advertisement when they say "That's It", the "It" refers to a transcendent surplus quality. However, when you leave a coke bottle on the beach for 40 minutes, you find that it tastes like the sh*t that it actually is. In a capitalistic/materialistic society, what is marketed as the transcendental is actually the excremental. From this angle, one wonders if it is not natural that one neo-vedantin guru called Adidam (quite a caricature character) was having his female bimbo disciples and wives of his male disciples defecating in the bed during the act of coitus under the pretext that this work was necessary to transcend the limitations of the individual non-existent ego. After all, everything is an illusion and no discernment is necessary.

This hilarious character has one pseudo-intellectual admirer in the form of one Ken Wilber who spews out such illuminating passages as "Aristotle, Plotinus, Saint Augustin, Hegel, Schuon, Coomaraswamy, Guenon were all developmentalists". The developmentalism here is in the evolutionistic sense. I guess I should be taking some crazy pills. These types are either morons that don't know how to read or such sinister individuals that are so deluded with their misconceptions that they project them to others. After writing many tomes to glorify his search for a theory of everything (mimicing the modern scientific paradigm), which oeuvre he arbitrarily divides into periods, he ends up in the last period revealing that there is no such thing as a separate spiritual realm.

In the eternal night of the neo-vedantins, everything is black. One cannot but admire Guenon for his foresight and diligence in anticipating potential areas of distortion and corruption of the metaphysical doctrine. It was not for no reason that he was so critical of Vivekenanda, who by the way looks like a saint compared to these modern neo-vedantins. This is proof like no other that in matters of doctrine, no concession can be given.

Schoolboy on 2017-05-07 at 22:49 said:

Excellent article! I have experience with not only neo-advaita but also Buddhists. While the advaitans fall in the nothing is real category I have decided that Buddhists fall in the liberal, democratic wing of the American left. I've come to despise Buddhists as phonies and advaitans as being unable or unwilling to answer simple questions concerning spiritual life. I read Tomberg years ago before most people knew his real name, I found most of the Tarot explanations good, some great, others overdone. Wilber loved Adida and to this day defends him and his sexual excesses in Fiji. The whole Buddhist/advaita thing is a diversion from the destruction of the West, hoping the whole thing will go away. Regarding the reality of spirits existing outside of

the corporeal existence, the whole idea of praying to saints for help, praying to ancestors for guidance has been around in all cultures in the world. With Buddhists/advaitans contacting spirits is passed; something Buddha would never consider or something Sankara would say is devoid of value, being illusory to begin with. Haven't read Guenon yet, will pick him up. Thank you, Michael

Mark Citadel on 2017-05-08 at 17:43 said:

As always, Cologero, the profundity of your writing hits the mark perfectly. "One of the goals of the modern world is to render the past unreal." but of course! The very reason the moderns describe prior ways of living with such terms as 'primitive' and 'backward', and even have gone so far as to turn Medieval into a kind of slur, is evidence of this wish to reduce the past to a kind of Gothic horror novel. When they attack the reactionary as wishing to return to a "past that never existed", they are engaging in precisely this kind of revisionism, all in order to affirm their numerous crimes.

THAT on 2017-06-05 at 21:06 said:

Yes, it is funny how solipsistic certain pseudo-esoterists suddenly turn when non-human invisible beings of the intermediate world are concerned: then demons are "only symbolical" and so forth. The Islamic tradition is a particularly clear of the actual situation in this case, as it affirms the existence of a great variety of non-angelic intelligent beings classed as Jinn situated in close proximity to our human world, some of whom actively side with the satanic powers, while others may be servants of God or at least not hostile to humanity.

There are occultists who know about the war of which you speak and who consciously choose allegiance to the evil influences, which Guénon's "counterinitiation" essentially signifies. A publicly available resource that exemplifies how such a disturbing phenomenon might present itself in the most explicit form is the body of writing associated with the Order of Nine Angles underground cult, whose orientation deliberately aims at unleashing the "dark gods" of the abyss upon the world through so-called "nexions" constituted by voluntarily possessed initiates.

Fred on 2017-06-15 at 16:22 said:

According to the writings of a small dead italian hermetic christian school the guardian angel is precisely the nous, the angelic intellect, buddhi.

P.S. the hermetic school is Erim's, a roman aristocratic of the past century (Guénon asked De Giorgio informations about him in a letter).

Cologero on 2017-06-18 at 07:10 said:

Fred, I can't find anything about Erim. I've published most of the correspondence between Guido De Giorgio and Guenon ... which letter are you referring to?

2.20 Why Cologero is Melancholy

Cornix cornici oculos non effodiet (A crow doesn't rip out the eyes of another crow)

The fullness of existence, life's true richness, does not consist solely in health and happiness but in an ever-expanding range of joy and sorrow; and the broader the range, the richer life becomes.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

Some deceive themselves who guard themselves with fear and prudence from every occasion of sin; but when at times they are molested by horrible, filthy, and fearful thoughts, and also sometimes by most loathsome visions, they are confounded and lose heart, and make themselves believe they are forsaken by, and wholly banished from God, and cannot persuade themselves that the Holy Spirit can abide in a mind filled with such thoughts.

LORENZO SCUPOLI, *Spiritual Combat*

I hadn't been in much contact with Cologero until recently, when he asked me to fill in due to his preoccupation with family and health issues. Since he stopped posting translations, he has not needed me so much. Although I have known him for quite some time, our paths have been diverging. He has become a sort of urban sannyasi, isolated and meditative, whereas I plan to retire to Belize where anything goes and the dollar still has clout.

This does not mean that he has not been working on some posts. There are several in different states of development, although I cannot persuade him to bring them to completion. When I proposed this topic to him, he ignored me. Since silence means consent, I am posting it. He did however give me the quotes for the epigraph, which he wanted to be included.

I want to use him to elucidate the influences of **Saturn, Jupiter,** and **Venus**, who are still active, even in this age. This is based on the many conversations we've had over the years, especially when he was more Jovial (under the influence of Jupiter) and Venereal (under the influence of Venus).

Soul Sister I need to start with something that belongs at the end: the notion of the *âme soeur*. Gornahoor's first post was about the *âme soeur*: Lucinde (in two parts)²⁶, and I suspect Cologero's life has been the Platonic quest to reunite with his soul sister. The typical English translation of "soulmate" is hardly adequate, since it is just a romanticized name for a lover.

The *âme soeur* (literally "soul sister") is not just another life partner, and certainly not a concubine. The idea of "sister" should indicate that it is a chaste, not sexual, relationship. Moreover, it indicates a close bond of affinity, not in the biological or genetic sense, but certainly in terms of spiritual races.

There is no doubt that he believes in this literally. He points out the ideal of Courtly love in the Middle ages. This teaching is esoteric as it was the basis of the *Fedeli d'Amore*. Dante and Beatrice are the prime example. Although non-physical and non-matrimonial, even unrequited, the image of Beatrice in his soul was still able to guide **Dante** through the planets, the Empyrean, to the gates of Heaven. **Boris Mouravieff** describes courtly love in this way:

Courtly Love is the *raison d'être* for the couple of and the Lady of his Dreams; without it, their polarity remains spirituality sterile and they fall back into the common condition. ... In the Middle Ages, the Knight and his Lady, who considered themselves spiritually ONE — in our terminology, polar beings — did not

²⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4>

venture into marriage. On the contrary, they parted, accepting the risk of never meeting again and knowing that if they did not triumph over a hard test, their love would degenerate, losing its meaning and its marvelous power. They knew that, by separating from each other for an exploit, they stood the chance

I was stunned when he told me that he had lost contact with his *âme soeur* around the end of May 2011. When pressed, he claimed that he did not think it odd or even a problem. Then he went off into a discussion of Quantum Entanglements²⁷, in which related, but separated, entities still react to each other, across vast distances, faster than the speed of light, instantaneously.

Since the speed of thought is instantaneous, the entanglement of human souls across space and time should not be a surprise. By the Law of Affinity, related souls are brought into the world together for them to play out their destiny.

Saturn Of the four humours (Sanguine, Choleric, Phlegmatic, and Melancholy), melancholy is associated with Saturn. This must not be confused with clinical depression. The latter is a medical and psychological condition, whereas the former is metaphysical. Cologero is far from depressed; by profane psychological standards, he has no such issues.

I've taken most of the following quotes from **Frances Yates'** study on *The Occult Philosophy in the Elizabethan Age*. One of the works she mentions is **Aristotle's** *Problemata physica* which discusses melancholy as the humour of heroes and great men.

Saturn is the outermost or highest planet in the cosmic order, and so is nearest to the divine source of being and closest to the angelic hierarchy. Therefore, Saturn is associated with the loftiest contemplations. In the Renaissance, the notion of the melancholy here whose genius is akin to madness became common.

²⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Quantum_entanglement

Hence, Saturnians are inspired students and contemplators of highest truths. To be melancholy was a sign of genius; the 'gifts' of Saturn, the numbering and measuring studies attributed to the melancholic, were to be cultivated as the highest kind of learning which brought man nearest to the divine.

Heroic Frenzy

Heroic frenzy, or madness, or furor, which according to Plato is the source of all inspiration, when combined with the black bile of the melancholy temperament produces great men; it is the temperament of genius. All outstanding men have been melancholics, heroes like Hercules, philosophers like Empedocles or Plato, and practically all the poets.

The humor melancholicus, when it takes fire and glows, generates the frenzy (furor) which leads us to wisdom and revelation, especially when it is combined with a heavenly influence, above all with that of Saturn ... Therefore Aristotle says in the *Problemata* that through melancholy some men have become divine beings, foretelling the future like Sybils ... while others have become poets ... and he says further that all men who have been distinguished in any branch of knowledge have generally been melancholics.

Angels and Demons

The following is from *Saturn and Melancholy* by Klibansky, Saxl and Panofsky.

Moreover, this humor melancholicus has such power that they say it attracts certain demons into our bodies, through whose presence and activity men fall into ecstasies and pronounce many wonderful things . . . This occurs in three different forms corresponding to the threefold capacity of our soul, namely

- the imagination (*imaginatio*)
- the rational (*ratio*)
- and the mental (*mens*)

For when set free by the humor melancholicus, the soul is fully concentrated in the imagination, and it immediately becomes a habitation for the lower demons, from whom it often receives wonderful instruction in the manual arts; thus, we see a quite unskilled man suddenly become a painter or an architect, or a quite outstanding master in another art of some kind.

If the demons of this species reveal the future to us, they show us matters related to natural catastrophes and disasters, for instance approaching storms, earthquakes, cloud-bursts, or threats of plague famine and devastation.

But when the soul is fully concentrated in the reason, it becomes the home of the middle demons; thereby it attains knowledge of natural and human things; thus, we see a man suddenly become a philosopher, a physician, or an orator; and of future events they show us what concerns the overthrow of kingdoms and the return of epochs, prophesying in the same way that the Sybil prophesied to the Romans.

But when the soul soars completely to the intellect it becomes the home of the higher demons, from whom it learns the secrets of divine matters, as for instance the law of God, the angelic hierarchy, and that which pertains to the knowledge of eternal things and the soul's salvation; of future events they show us for instance approaching prodigies, wonders, a prophet to come, or the emergence of a new religion, just as the Sybil prophesied Jesus Christ long before he appeared.

Summary

We can dispense with the idea of the planets controlling the humours and setting them at birth, since we are free beings. However, we can still put ourselves under the influences of the planets at various times. Saturn is the planet of the Sahasrara chakra²⁸, as indicated by **Johann**

²⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8618>

Gichtel. Agrippa wrote on the three degrees of melancholy in *De occulta philosophia*.

After I looked into this topic more, I became a little less worried about Cologero. Nevertheless, there is more to the story as the next two sections will show.

Jupiter The danger of melancholy needs to be tempered. Frances Yates points out this advice from the Renaissance Platonist, Marsilio Ficino:

Addressing students who were thought to suffer from melancholy through solitariness and concentration on their studies, he advises that the Saturnian or melancholic man should not avoid the deep study to which he is prone by temperament but *should take care to temper the Saturnian severity with Jovial and Venereal influences*.

A man under the influence of Jupiter is more sanguine. During those jovial moments, Cologero was fond of quoting Rene Guenon:

There is therefore no occasion for despondency; and even were there no hope of achieving any visible result before the collapse of the modern world through a catastrophe, that would still not be a valid reason to refrain from embarking upon a work extending in scope far beyond the present time. Those who may feel tempted to give way to discouragement should remind themselves that nothing accomplished within the order can ever be lost, that confusion, error and darkness can enjoy no more than a specious and purely ephemeral triumph.

True knowledge, or gnosis, therefore cannot lead to hopelessness. An example of the latter is **H. G. Wells**, a very learned man who became hopeless at the end of his life. He predicted the end of human life in *Mind*

at the End of its Tether, not unlike the prophets of Artificial Intelligence do today. That is the end result of secularism and atheism.

Hopelessness is a vice and Hope is a virtue.

The antidote to Saturn is Jupiter and Venus. The Jupiter man is sanguine and those under Venus are gifted with grace and loveliness.

Venus

Il y a une femme dans toutes les affaires ; aussitôt qu'on me fait un rapport, je dis : « Cherchez la femme ! »

ALEXANDER DUMAS, *The Mobicans of Paris*

In our youth, Cologero and I used to “chercher la femme” together. We were not then as cynical as Dumas, who saw a woman behind every problem, but regarded a woman as the very solution. That is why I urge him to get out more, to yield to Venus who is the source of grace and loveliness.

But I noticed the change in him as he “got religion”, so to speak. Then, after an affair, he felt the need to confess his adultery or fornication, after which he had to endure the same lecture about leading another into his own sin. Then he would make a half-hearted promise to stop it in order to receive absolution. At night, he would say his beads in expiation. Eventually his fear of the priest became stronger than his desire for sex.

I've tried to convince him that is no way for a man to live. When we last spoke on this topic, about two weeks ago, he reminded me of this thought:

Did you never love a young girl? Were you never commanded by the person beloved to do something which you did not wish to do? have you never flattered your little slave? have you never kissed her feet? And yet if any man compelled you to kiss Caesar's feet,

you would think it an insult and excessive tyranny. What else then is slavery? Did you never go out by night to some place whither you did not wish to go, did you not expend that you did not wish to expend, did you not utter words with sighs and groans, did you not submit to abuse and to be excluded?

EPICETUS, *Discourses*

He has a point there. How many outdoor art shows have I had to endure, how often have I spent money I didn't have, just for the hope to kiss the feet of a pretty woman at the end of the day (and I suspect Epictetus is using a euphemism). I admit it, I am a slave to the libido. Cologero threw it right back at me, "Slavery, even willful slavery, is no way for a man to live."

He explained that true Love must be freely given and accepted. I countered that the risk of "abuse and exclusion" would still exist. He scoffed at me, "If I wanted unconditional love, I would buy a puppy!"

I let him continue uninterrupted:

Haven't you noticed that, once you've had carnal relations with a woman, how easy it is to repeat it, even if you haven't seen her in years? The physical body has its own intelligence and remembers all its former attractions. That is the consequence of promiscuity.

Then he made a strange analogy, even if the conclusion is Traditional:

The sexual bond, when ordered properly, is the analog of a higher bond. Erections are not under a man's conscious control. Yet the mere presence, or even thought, of a woman can raise it up, just as the moon raises the tides. That can be experienced as the infamous "battle of the sexes", with the two sides vying for power and control. Or else, it is the experience of non-duality, a Platonic return to androgyny, in which the two "become one flesh" in their passion.

Without that experience, a fundamental aspect of the world will remain unknown to you. Of course, if that is truly the natural order, then raising erections via artificial stimulation is both disordered and unnatural.

Cologero requested that, if I had to write on this topic, to mention *The Faerie Queene* by **Edmund Spenser**. Since I haven't time to delve into it myself, I will rely again on Frances Yates.

The first book of *The Faerie Queene* is about the **Red Cross Knight** who represents Holiness and is accompanied by the lady, **Una**. It is a *solar book*, full of solar imagery.

You see, he can't seem to move away from this theme of Solar Knights and Courtly Love. I presume that the three visions of Venus in Book VI are what he is driving at:

- First of all the **planet Venus**, star of love, whose gifts of grace and beauty, when rightly received and not turned by evil will to lust, are so attractive.
- Then comes the **Neoplatonic Venus**, representing the beauty of Him through whom all things are beautiful, with many references to Plato, particularly Phaedrus and Symposium.
- And finally there is the **angelic Venus**, for Venus is at her best when the angelic hierarchy of the Principalities favours her. Then indeed Venus shines forth, full of grace and charm, courteous and gentle. Such Venereans are agreeable to both God and man.

Ultimately, to be somewhat trite, a balance of the Saturnine, Jovial, and Venereal impulses is best.

Posted on 2018-04-20 by Aeneas

* * *

rob on 2018-04-20 at 07:23 said:

"Hopelessness is a vice. Hope is a virtue." Isn't this simplification? Each of these compliment each other and lead into one another. It is only after the most sublime hope has wilted from its want of realization that the most melancholic hopelessness forms, and vice versa. There is a middle road where neither hope nor hopelessness is entertained, and this, I think is more where Guenon is coming from in that quote; hence: "even if there were no hope" one should continue one's work (because both melancholy and joy in their earthly sense are distractions from it). In other words, to "balance" saturnial and jovial influences is to free oneself from both, no? At least, I think it is naive to say that hopelessness is any more a vice than hope. In fact, I think the former is maybe closer to the mark of virtue, a la the pessimism of Schopenhauer, or the idea of resignation from the world in the various religions. To lose hope for the world is to quit the world, which involves both attachment to dread and to hope. What is more conducive to self-resignation: suffering or comfort? I think it has to be the former, because as long as one is in ignorance, there is nothing to stir one to seek after something beyond the limits which suffering reveals. It was not the years of comfort that awoke the Buddha into longing, but the sight of old age and death, and it is not Christ's moments of leisure which sting our hearts with guilt, but his crucifixion.

If you say I am misinterpreting, and you really meant hope, not in the worldly sense, but as a kind of steadfast resolution after the divine, then I would contest the notion that this is really hope, since, if you asked a sage whether he had "hope" after heaven or things godly, I think he would merely chuckle, since nothing has "yet to come" in heaven and therefore there is no need to hope for anything. This would therefore be like asking a wealthy man whether he hoped for riches. I can only think of hope as rooted in a temporal worldview, and for this reason I am inclined to say that any form of hope is really only detrimental to "progress" in personal development. Furthermore, hope should not be confused with anything related to prayer (even though I am aware there could be much disagreement about this), because, in my experience, real "profit" from prayer does not stem from a kind of hoping but from active yielding to God, which is a kind of liberation from worldly baggage, which does not feel like waiting or wanting, but is an immediate relief and peace, which in my mind is the farthest thing from hope. It could be described as a lack of it, hence why I said that hopelessness seems to be closer to true attainment, and thus I would not necessarily define hopelessness as the opposite of hope. Despair seems to fit better, and immediately it is clear that despair is a kind of hope or much more closely related to it than freedom from hope which we might now call "hopelessness", in the same way that fearlessness is freedom from fear.

Saladin on 2018-04-20 at 10:41 said:

"In our youth, Cologero and I used to "chercher la femme" together"
That made my day! Had not laughed so hard in a long while! Great job!

Cologero on 2018-04-20 at 12:47 said:

@Rob, Hope is an infused (i.e., God given) virtue, so if you don't experience it, it may not be your fault.

Cologero on 2018-04-20 at 12:50 said:

@Aeneas, such a banal ending. When you quote others, you sound so good, but your own thoughts are like a Bazooka bubblegum cartoon. I am in an anti-Aristotle mood today. Forget "balance": The road of excess leads to the palace of wisdom.

BTW, you don't even meet the moral standards of a crow.

Arthur Konrad on 2018-04-21 at 11:15 said:

Excellent as always, but I do have to note, if gentlemen don't mind, that the word "profane" is somewhat distasteful and reeks of Masonry.

manfred arcane on 2018-04-22 at 05:42 said:

From Halevi's "The Way of Kabbalah":

"Occasionally a man becomes too dependent on his maggid, and while it is necessary for the maggid to act as the man's Tiferet for a period, it is not permissible for him to assume this role permanently. While in some branches of the Tradition attachment to the maggid is part of the devotional method, it is not really desirable beyond a certain point, because then the maggid stands in the Way between the man and God, and this is contrary to the Commandments against other gods and bowing down to images. People make a false god of whatever they are devoted to, be it money, status or even a man, however exalted he may be. While the maggid can be the initial link in the chain of connection between Heaven and Earth, he must step aside and allow the man to make his own. It may require him to break up a relationship in which the aspirant's identification with his teacher is either gradually or suddenly dissolved, depending on the circumstance.

The first method is accomplished by sending him away, and the second by demonstrating to the aspirant that the maggid also is human. This is sometimes achieved by the maggid performing an outrageous action aimed at destroying the attached aspirant's image of his teacher."

Cologero on 2018-04-26 at 19:24 said:

Hunh? Profane just means secular as opposed to spiritual. It is the word used by Guenon. If the Freemasons use "Profane" to refer to the uninitiated, then go complain to them.

2.21 Transcendental Desires

Being endowed with a pure intellect, and controlling oneself with fortitude, rejecting the objects beginning from sound, and eliminating attachment and hatred; one who resorts to solitude, eats sparingly, has speech, body and mind under control, to whom meditation and concentration are ever the highest duty, and who is possessed of dispassion; that person, having discarded egotism, force, pride, desire, anger and superfluous possessions, free from the idea of possession, and serene, is fit for becoming Brahman.

BHAGAVAD GITA 18:51-53

Animals are solely motivated by fear, sex, and hunger: that is, the desires for life, reproduction, and food. Animals are constrained to the sensual life. Human beings, on the other hand, are motivated by five transcendental desires which surpass strictly biological needs. These are the desire for:

- Truth
- Love
- Justice
- Beauty
- Being

Animal Man

But the sensual or animal man perceiveth not these things that are of the Spirit of God; for it is foolishness to him, and he cannot understand, because it is spiritually examined. But the spiritual man judgeth all things; and he himself is judged of no man.

I CORINTHIANS 2: 14-15

In our time, it is considered *outré* to refer to human beings as animals. Yet here we have St Paul asserting the idea that some men live at the level of animals. Moreover, the *Philokalia* is replete with similar claims.

Even the Buddha recognized that there is something beastly deep within man. Three beasts represent the weakness in the heart of creation:

- **Ignorance**, represented by the pig
- **Malice**, represented by the snake
- **Concupiscence**, represented by the rooster

Ignorance, malice, and concupiscence are not coincidentally three effects of the Fall. To the extent that these three qualities dominate consciousness, the transcendental desires fade away from awareness.

The Desire for Truth Philosophers and scientists, at their best, have a desire to know the Truth. One fairly recent example is **Brand Blanshard** who, standing on the shoulders of Benedict Spinoza and the British Idealists, wrote a massive study on the *Nature of Thought*. He was able to attain some understanding of the Absolute. Unfortunately, he knew that the Absolute was Truth yet he failed to understand it was also the Good. Thus, he denied the existence of maliciousness. All evil, therefore, he claimed was solely the result of ignorance. All that thinking could not reach the conclusion that the Absolute was also the Good – or Love, for that matter.

The Maverick Philosopher²⁹, despite all his intelligence and erudition, after 15 years and 5,000 posts comes to this conclusion:

²⁹https://maverickphilosopher.typepad.com/maverick_philosopher/2019/01/could-it-be-like-this.html

I find the following scenario exceedingly strange. We die and become nothing and no question gets answered. Could it be like this? It is epistemically possible, possible for all we know. All we know is damned little. But then what would have been the point of the evolution of animals that pose unanswerable questions? No point! Human life would then be like a joke, but a joke without a teller. **We can't know that the above scenario is true, and we can't know that it is false.** So in the end you must decide what you will believe and how you will live. **There is no theoretical resolution of the problem;** the resolution must be personal, pragmatic, and existential.

If there is no theoretic resolution of the problem, a truly intelligent man would abandon that line of approach and look for another.

The Two Intellectual Centres

Beware lest any man cheat you by philosophy, and vain deceit; according to the tradition of men, according to the elements of the world, and not according to Christ: For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead corporeally.

COLOSSIANS 2: 8-10

Apparently, the addiction to rational philosophy is tough to give up. *A fortiori*, they even presume that God Himself thinks like a philosopher. For example, **Alvin Plantinga** asserts his in regard to God's omniscience:

If God is omniscient, then He is unlimited in knowledge; He knows every true proposition and believes none that are false.

Of course not, God's knowledge is not like that at all. Propositions are statements about reality, so they are once removed; knowledge of

propositions is not knowledge of reality. As useful as rational thinking may be, the deepest thinkers, e.g. **Thomas Aquinas**, regarded it as an inferior form of knowledge. The knowledge of God and the angels is of a higher order, more like **intuition**, which is direct, unmediated, and nondual. So if rational thought alone cannot provide the solution to life, can humans attain to intuition like the angels. Mystics and saints have indeed achieved such states. Here is an example from **Saint John of the Cross**.

when a person has finished purifying and voiding himself of all forms and apprehensible images, he will abide in this pure and simple light, and be perfectly transformed into it. This light is never lacking to the soul, but because of creature forms and veils weighing upon and covering it, the light is never infused. If a person will eliminate these impediments and veils, and live in pure nakedness and poverty of spirit ... his soul in its simplicity and purity will then be immediately transformed into simple and pure Wisdom, the Son of God.

JOHN OF THE CROSS, *The Ascent of Mount Carmel*

John even provides precise instructions: purify and void yourself of all forms and apprehensible images. Despite that, the philosopher³⁰ is perplexed:

This is admittedly somewhat murky. More needs to be said about the exact sense of ‘subjective’ and ‘objective.’

I don’t think so.

³⁰https://maverickphilosopher.typepad.com/maverick_philosopher/2010/03/incarnation-a-subjective-approach.html

The Desire for Love Although **Saint Philomena** was martyred in the year 301 at the age of 13, her remains were not discovered until 1802 in the Catacomb of Priscilla. Nothing was known about her until she revealed the story of her life and death to **Sister Maria Luisa di Gesu** in 1833. Philomena, the daughter of a Greek king, took a vow as a consecrated virgin at the age of 13.

Having refused the amorous advances of Emperor Diocletian, she was subjected to torments including drowning and being shot with arrows. Miraculous interventions saved her each time until she was eventually beheaded.

The revelation to Sister Luisa demonstrates this principle enunciated by **Valentin Tomberg**:

It sets in opposition to evocation by necromancy: the ascent towards the deceased effected by the force of love.

In other words, it was nothing like a séance that attempts to evoke the spirit of Philomena. Rather, it was a revelation of the forces of purity, faith, and love.

The Desire for Justice **Pope Saint Hyginus** was a Greek who became the bishop of Rome from 138 to 142. He determined the various prerogatives of the clergy and defined the grades of the ecclesiastical hierarchy for the whole Church, East and West. Many of the early Popes came from the Eastern Empire and obviously had no objections to the office of the Pope at that time. Hyginus died a martyr during the reign of Marcus Aurelius.

The Desire for Being Our essence is who we are and our personality is what we acquire in life. How, then, do accidents fit into life? Presumably accidents cannot change our essence and we certainly don't deliberately

seek them out. **Aristotle** listed several accidental properties of beings, including in particular space and time.

In a recent discussion on Christian pessimism, someone pondered why so much emphasis was placed on family. In his opinion, most families were “crud”. Coincidentally, I broached the same topic in a different way when I was visiting grandchildren and nephews. I remarked how those children were fortunate to be born into a loving and intellectually rich environment. So the question arises about the circumstances of one’s birth. Are they totally arbitrary, accidental, and random or are they part of our essence?

St Augustine asserted that the predestined are given all they require to attain the beatific vision. That doctrine certainly challenges the notion of invincible ignorance. Moreover, it implies that the circumstances of birth are set: the predestined are born in a place and time where they can hear the gospel, receive the sacraments and so on. Similarly, our families are suitable for our level of being, so there cannot be an injustice in it.

There are five conditions for the manifestation of being: essence, matter, space, time, and life. Essence is transcendent and matter refers to the circumstances of life. We are accustomed to consider that space and time are neutral, featureless containers for being. That is not the case at all. Newton assumed a three-dimensional uniform Euclidean space in which gravitation worked, although he never explained gravity itself. The Theory of Relativity, however, claims that the shape of space-time is warped, which is the explanation for what we experience as gravity.

The Traditional teaching is that there are spiritual beings (angels) of space and time. Thus, various archangels are assigned to geographical areas, families, and nations. Other angels, or demons for that matter, influence the zeitgeist, the spirit of an age. Hence the circumstances of space and time arise not from accidental rearrangements of matter, but have a transcendent source.

Posted on 2019-01-12 by Cologero

2.22 Spiritual Man and the Tyrant

It is one's psychological type which from the outset determines and limits a person's judgment

CARL JUNG

In a book review of *Monas Hieroglyphica* (or *Hieroglyphic Monad*) by **John Dee**, **Valentin Tomberg** describes the two life paths described by Dee in the preface, incorporating into it the seven-year cycles of life described by **Rudolf Steiner**. The first stages of life are the same for both paths, as interpreted by Tomberg. I have added the sacraments associated with the beginning of each stage, even if their esoteric significance has apparently long been forgotten. Since Tomberg does not mention Steiner's description of the stages, I also included them.

During young adulthood, and even adolescence, a choice can be made:

- The path of earth or worldliness
- The path of water or wisdom

The first path leads to the **Tyrant** ending in the Abyss; the second leads to the **Spiritual Man** (*pneumatikos*), ending in Fire. These are the stages on each path, including Tomberg's addition of the ages.

Tomberg interprets this to indicate that Dee has a firm understanding of the stages of life. However, in point of fact, few people make that choice of all, becoming neither tyrant or philosopher; or else they only go partway along the path. Most people, on the other hand, seem to wander aimlessly through life, oblivious to any higher calling.

IQ and Intelligence

If you're so smart, why aren't you rich?

Nassim Taleb recently tweeted something about IQ tests:

IQ measures an inferior form of intelligence, stripped of 2nd order effects, meant to select paper shufflers, obedient IYIs intelligent yet idiots.

Taleb is normally reliable, but his desire to be the gadfly and curmudgeon — i.e., to be outrageous — might get the better of him. Apparently he believes that “higher” intelligence applies solely to being successful in the world. Actually, success in the world does not required an exceptionally high IQ, or else the human race would have failed millennia ago.

On the contrary, the highly intelligent are less interested in success by worldly standards and are more attracted to abstract thinking. In other words, they take the water path rather than the earth path. Thus, even if they are not highly financially successful, they are hardly obedient paper shufflers. Instead of IQ, perhaps a more objective test can be used. Here are some proposals, for example, based on academic courses:

- Pass a course in logic. I was in a class that started with 25 students and ended with just 3 or us. The philosophy, political science, pre-law students had all dropped out.
- Read and understand one of Plato’s dialogs.
- Pass an economics class. This class forced many business majors to switch majors.
- Pass organic chemistry. This is often the bane of pre-med students.
- Pass a physics class. Few students even attempt it.

- Pass a class in abstract mathematics. I used to teach algebra to elementary education majors, many of whom were taking the course for the second or third time. That was torture.
- Read and comment on a few sonnets.
- Read and comment on selected works of fiction.

Obviously, you can do well in the world without taking any of those classes. That does not mean that intelligence does not exist.

Twofold Reason Aristotle identified two types of reason: Creative and Passive.

These are described as:

- **Creative Mind:** Always in full possession of all forms or ideas.
- **Passive Mind:** Only has potential possession of them and which can only rise to actual possession through the inspiration of the creative mind.

Most students who are considered smart in school work through the passive mind. That is, they are really competent at absorbing and repeating the ideas taught by their teachers. Of course, in most cases the teachers themselves only have a passive mind. Such students are convinced they are intelligent because they can absorb the propaganda repeated by the powerful.

However, the ideas themselves come from those with creative minds. They can resist propaganda due to their better critical thinking skills. They may be considered to be oddballs and may fail in situations which required conformity.

It is true that IQ may not capture this distinction.

Things and Concepts

I *must*, before I die, find some way to say the essential thing that is in me, that I have never said yet — a thing that is not love or hate or pity or scorn, but the very breath of life, of development, fierce and coming from far away, bringing into human life the vastness and the fearful passionless force of non-human things.

BERTRAND RUSSELL, *My Philosophical Development*

Bertrand Russell separates terms into two types: things and concepts. Things refer to individuals and concepts to classes. For Russell, these are merely logical categories, so there is no judgment about the reality of concepts.

In reality, the thing, or percept, refers to existence—or that the thing exists. Concepts refer to essences — what a thing is. The dominant position today is that concepts are not real. Rather, they are just nominal concepts — or social constructs in today's language — and do not refer to anything transcendental.

The ability to “see” the concept in the percept is an ability not available to everyone (although it can be learned). This is a form of theophany since the concepts are really ideas in the Mind of God. Borrowing from **Carl Jung**, with some poetic license, we can distinguish two different perceiving types: the intuitive and the sensitive.

The sensitive type is dominated by sensation, i.e., he experiences the thing through the senses. The intuitive type, on the other hand, can “see” the concept in the thing, which is a direct knowing of the idea. The intuitive type can certainly experience the thing via the senses, just as the sensitive type does, but he also experiences reality more deeply. Specifically, he also sees the idea instantiated by the thing. **John Findlay** affirms this:

It seems plain that our human world is a world in which innumerable ideas, meanings, facts, principles, constructions, hypotheses,

laws, images and ideals are as essential a part of the landscape as are the concrete bodies and thinking persons around which they cluster, and above which they float. They constitute a universal world of rational mind in which all thinking persons share, whatever the limitations of their immediate, sensuous viewpoint.

Instantiation Statistics were unknown to the ancients and are very poorly understood today, even by the educated. Qualities follow a statistical distribution when they become instantiated in a population. This divergence leads many to think that the quality is not real or is irrelevant. Findlay, in his reworking of Plato, makes this clear:

Probability is an irremovable feature of the human cave, and as such it resists reduction to anything factual, anything ascertainable and discoverable, anything that is could be merely there.

That means that the ideal of necessary connections is not always met. When a concept or quality manifests itself in existence, it will follow a statistical distribution of some sort (otherwise, there would be a hidden law or principle). So for intelligence, there will be a range from the highly to the average and to low intelligence. This does not mean that intelligence does not exist. It also precludes the possibility of any notion of egalitarianism in intelligence.

The instantiation of a divine idea requires sacrifice and limitation. Otherwise, the essence and existence of finite beings would be identical. However, the identity of essence and existence is possible only for God.

References

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VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Russian Spirituality*

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³¹<http://www.esotericarchives.com/dee/monad.htm>

³²<http://www.institute4learning.com/2012/08/07/the-stages-of-life-according-to-rudolf-steiner/>

JOHN FINDLAY, *The Discipline of the Cave*

BERTRAND RUSSELL, *Principles of Mathematics*

CARL JUNG, *Psychological Types*

Posted on 2018-12-27 by Cologero

* * *

James on 2018-12-28 at 08:42 said:

It is interesting to think about the “turning point” (midway point) of the human journey at thirty five leading either to earth or water . I had written tangentially about this topic in my Dante book (still unpublished) because I had taken note in one of my chapters about how Dante (at the turning point age) finds himself on the same WATER journey as his predecessor poets .

Homer spoke of Odysseus crossing the sea from Troy back to his home and Virgil speaks of another departure from Troy to the eventual founding of Rome via another sea voyage . What Dante accomplishes , if I might be so bold to propose , is the synthesis of the earth and water voyages . He demonstrates that the esoteric waters the Christian (of the post-ancient age) must cross is the elemental dissolution of sin itself . He traverses the ocean of sin in order to find his true home by passing the sphere of fire above Purgatory as he ascends to Heaven . His accomplishment is through the assimilation-without-contamination or the understanding-without-touching of evil itself–of the path of Earth . In fact , quite “literally” , as he passes through the Earth and frozen water , he finds his way out of such a place even after meeting the ultimate Tyrant and ultimate Abyss at the bottom .

This is not so dissimilar to the various comments mentioned among friends about how resisting the devil can unlock a willing servant . To pass through the path of Earth with the understanding of Water – in a sense as if to baptize ourselves (we being of dust and clay – Earth) – one can achieve the “other path” that is not the path of the exoteric (“the straight path had been lost”) or the path of martyrdom (pressing on despite the presence of the three beasts) . To use Satan himself as a willing ladder to reach Purgatory on the other side is part of the lesson I am trying to meditate upon . I wish to spend some time confirming in meditation if Dante truly does attempt this synthesis of Earth and Water both by demonstrating its various points of union (such as in the negative synthesis of the frozen water in Cocytus) . Perhaps it is the human person who is the representative of Earth that submits to baptism that gives a clue . Still , it is only a nascent idea in my mind that I probably should have kept to myself in order to confirm first with thought and experience , but I couldn't help but find the connections compelling . There must have been a reason that Steiner , Tomberg , and others could find meaning at the

“midway” point of life’s journey and how the elements associated pair up perfectly with what Dante was attempting to sing about .

Han Fei on 2018-12-29 at 12:05 said:

I have a question. If a person knows himself, or at least beginning to do so, what kind of opinion should he have of himself? What is the extent of the ability that man is capable of? The reason why this may be relevant is because Taleb seems to consider intelligence as having to do with success, that is to say to the extent of some activity we perform in our life.

If I say am intelligent, then intelligent for what? If I say that I am free (as in self-agent) for what sake does this freedom hold? The same question applies to women as well.

Cologero on 2018-12-31 at 10:12 said:

*Union of Earth and Water by Rubens*³³

Lyon on 2019-01-08 at 21:22 said:

Brilliant. Yet again. Time to do a deeper dive into Valentin Tomberg and Rudolf Steiner. This may take a few weeks or decades.

2.23 Interview with Aphrodite

There is spiritual current today that often goes under the name “The Law of Attraction”, although by other names in the past. This was brought to prominence in a documentary made a few years ago called the “Secret”. Its main spokesmen include Oprah Winfrey, Deepak Chopra, Wayne Dyer, the author of “Conversations with God”, and so on. While employing, without understanding, some legitimate Hermetic practices, the overall thrust of this movement is false.

Rather than the rejection of materiality as seen, for example, in Theosophy, this movement seeks to improve the material conditions of life through some spiritual practices which include affirmations and visualizations. My son was invited to a Wayne Dyer talk several years ago; he

³³<https://www.freeart.com/gallery/r/rubens/rubens95.html>

told me the audience included almost entirely post-menopausal women. These are woman who have achieved a measure of success in the world and regard it as a sign of superior spirituality.

Julius Evola described several “races of the spirit” thatcoften display considerable insight into the human condition. In his description of the aphroditic race, he pinpoints the relevant features that describe this type. There is no sense of transcendence, so the focus is on improving material existence: money, relationships, property, etc. The end result is the confusion of intense sensual experiences with spiritual realization. This is Evola’s description:

Another race of the spirit is the truly aphroditic race; in it, tellurism, i.e., the adherence to terrestriality, assumes the forms of an extreme refinement of material existence, and not seldom goes on to promote an opulent development of everything that is pomp and luxury in the outer life, therefore also of the world of arts and aesthetic sentiment. But, in the inner life, a passivity and a lunar inconsistency subsist, balanced by a particular prominence given to sensuality but also to all that which is related to woman, which, through such a way, goes on to exercise control and to silently secure for itself a superior position.

The Massage Queen I recently had the pleasure of an hour long interview with an exemplar of the aphroditic race. In a narrow sense, she can be said to have won the lottery of life. In her 50s, she was still attractive, healthy, financially independent, extroverted, with the spare time to pursue her numerous hobbies. Knowing my interests, she was eager to share our spiritual perspectives.

Opening up the topic, she surprised me when she said that the spiritual turning point in her life came from reading the book *Think and Grow Rich* by **Napoleon Hill**. This motivated her to open up some spas in the Midwest where she was able to combine her interest in, and knowl-

edge of, the chakras with massage. She eventually sold them at a tidy profit and retired to Florida.

Now such a book is not a spiritual book at all, despite its distortions of certain Hermetic exercises. Rather, it acts at the psychological level by motivating someone to single-pointedly focus on making money. Furthermore, for anyone who is convinced by it and harbors no doubts, it can bring a lot of confidence to that project. She was such a person, and the results are there to see. Nevertheless, Hill's book is not a passive teaching, of the sort that the "universe will attract it to you", but a call to action.

That led to a discussion of the so-called Law of Attraction, which is a generalization of Hill's book. Not just money, but health, love relationships, and all other aspects of life can be materialized in the same way. Eventually, however, those of that mindset tire of the effort required, and decide that one just needs to recite affirmations and results will follow effortlessly. Of course, work and toil are part of our lot and cannot be dispensed with. Now I am not discouraging anyone from making affirmations, which have their use provided they lead to manifestation through the will and the application of energy.

Keep in mind, however, that the Law of Attraction cannot attract sanctity to you, which is really what should concern you. At one point, she suggested that I attend a nearby Buddhist center. I didn't tell here that I have been initiated into a Tibetan Buddhist lineage, but I did bring up the point of a common meditation theme. In that, one focuses on a mandala and envisions oneself in the company of Buddhas, Bodhisattvas, gods, and other higher beings. I explained that we unconsciously throughout the day create a lower self-image; this meditation breaks that chain by identifying the self with higher beings. She gave me a slight frown and changed the topic, as though she was thinking, "why would I want to give up my self?"

My point is to illustrate the aphroditic race. This woman's spirituality was focused on "the extreme refinement of material existence" and "an

opulent development of everything that is pomp and luxury in the outer life”.

Somehow, out of nowhere, there is a new word, “bossy”, that politically correct people should not use today. That is fine, because what they are trying to define out of existence, or ignore, is what Jung described as the “animus”. This is the unconscious masculine element in a woman’s psyche that can emerge in a way that can be sometimes be described as “bossy”. I had to navigate around this woman’s animus in order to keep the conversation light and pleasant.

She was always the “first” to do something, the innovator, etc. While she should be proud of her accomplishments in bringing hot stones to massage therapy, she did not discover chakras. Moreover, a man of Tradition would be horrified to discover he was an “innovator”, since his aim is to extend Tradition. As she posed questions to me, no matter how I answered, she would assert that she “already knew that”.

Obviously, I could tell what she understood and what she did not. I also know how difficult it is to achieve any worthwhile insights on the spiritual path, and pop psychology is a bane, not a boon. When I tried to describe Guenon’s ideas on tradition, she immediately assumed I was referring to syncretism. She pointed out that not only did she have chakra charts and other Oriental symbols decorating her home, she also had a crucifix.

Not surprisingly, the conversation turned to relationships. Having in mind the Mouravieff’s teaching on polar beings, I asked her if she believed that a man and a woman who are spiritually united could achieve more together than apart. Her immediate, but irrelevant response, abruptly ended the conversation.

She told me yes. She related how she once achieved such an intense orgasm that it raised up her kundalini all the way to the top. And the irony, she explained, is that the guy involved knew nothing at all about metaphysics, chakras, or kundalini!

That is what it comes down to. Despite her exalted self-image and spiritual path, what she was really looking for was a good f@#k. She could only conceive of kundalini in material terms. Truth be told, I have run into this attitude in several such women. Evola describes the telluric race in these terms:

Sexuality has a considerable part in it, in its most elementary aspect: naturally, not just phallic, virile sexuality; in this regard, it can actually be said that it can rather more easily appear in a woman than in a man, in accordance with an entirely telluric nature.

Posted on 2014-03-17 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2014-03-17 at 02:24 said:

There is a Protestant equivalent of this among pentecostals/charismatics and other evangelicals. Notions of “God’s bank account” and “God wants you to be rich and successful” are prevalent; this probably shouldn’t be confused with the Calvinist idea of wealth as the sign of the elect as the two currents seem to have a different focus (improvement of material conditions and opulence for the former, concern for the celestial state in the case of the latter). I don’t know what race would be linked to that Calvinist thought.

Your conversation with that woman reminds me of a similar conversation I had with my sister over dinner a year ago. She told me she was into “meditation” and yoga (what woman in their 20’s living in the west isn’t into that?). I then asked her the obvious question as to why she engages in it. Her response was that it improves one’s physical and mental health, and then she cited some various studies that suggested evidence for that. I told her while that all might be true, the purpose of those exercises is to try and connect one back to a person’s transcendent root in the Divine, and those pleasant side effects are just that – side effects. To do all of that just for those side effects is along the lines of someone taking prescription pills just for the possible pleasant side effects of the drug, rather than taking them for their intended, proscribed use. Suffice to say, she got defensive and aggravated pretty quickly. Maybe she just took offense at being related to a prescription drug abuser, or tying this to the point of the post, something more deeper may have been going on. I decided to change the subject of the conversation as there was no point in continuing that specific exchange.

I don't know if she still involves herself in any of that. I find myself becoming estranged from her as the years go on.

Cologero on 2014-03-17 at 08:21 said:

Matt, I'm sorry to hear about your estrangement from your sister and hope the rift can be healed. The point of this knowledge (gnosis) is not to use it as a weapon for an "attack", but rather to understand that there are hard limits to the possibilities of understanding for certain spiritual types. As we learn to recognize the various types, we are able to navigate the world more successfully.

But I know what you mean about the girls of yoga who want to look hot in their yoga suits ... and they do. You could point them to Patanjali if you like, but there is a curious blindness in the human condition that will hide the plain meaning of the text.

Because we know and understand these limits, we have never been involved in "debates" or attempts to convert anyone. Gnosis is certain only for those who have made the requisite efforts, and no one who has not done so can be convinced by empirical evidence or logical proofs. The ultimate task is to be able to recognize those who do have the possibility to manifest higher states. The question of why some are drawn to this work while most are not is a bit of a mystery, and may be worth pondering. But for those who are, it would be a shame to squander the opportunity and only go part of the way.

I now see that it will be useful to go through Evola's descriptions of the various spiritual races, so I will be publishing that material over the next few weeks. Of course, it is even more helpful to illustrate them with specific examples.

scardanelli on 2014-03-17 at 09:11 said:

Cologero,

Does this understanding of the spiritual races have anything to do with the so called white race, red race, black race, etc, often discussed by spiritualists/anthroposophists? I haven't given much serious thought to it in the past, but I've come across it in other authors who I trust somewhat more- Mouni Sadhu in Tarot and Sedir in his piece on the history of the Rose Croix (I think).

UnPoeteMaudit on 2014-03-17 at 10:55 said:

To go off on a tangent, even as far as the mere realisation of a desire into the physical world is concerned, the 'Law of Attraction' teaches a half-baked method that flies in the face of elementary (and tried and tested to practicing occultists at least) principles of practical magic, which insist that the ritual process end in complete detachment from the desire in order for it to manifest.

Cologero on 2014-03-17 at 12:32 said:

That's not a tangent, Poet, that is a good observation. ... should have brought you along.

Cologero on 2014-03-17 at 13:12 said:

Scardanelli, Evola did not regard biological race as normative. Thus a white-skinned European is not necessarily a spiritual Aryan. It is not a question of who you can trust, but rather of what you can verify. Perhaps it is best to wait until I publish more of his descriptions and we'll see what results from that. It seems to me that his description of the Aphroditic type is pretty accurate, even if the woman in question is of the "white race".

Dan on 2014-12-24 at 08:01 said:

I really enjoyed reading this article, it provided a down-to-earth image of one of the spiritual races Evola described, by providing modern examples. The way that you and Evola describe the Aphroditic race reminds me of the modern neopagan movements like Wicca. They aren't really focused on any true element of transcendence, solely on refining their material life.

Alistair Fraser on 2019-03-17 at 06:18 said:

Take a moment to indulge in some dark humour this day (: "She told me yes. She related how she once achieved such an intense orgasm that it raised up her kundalini all the way to the top. And the irony, she explained, is that the guy involved knew nothing at all about metaphysics, chakras, or kundalini! "

Level	Center	Function	Other terms
1	Sensual and Sexual	This center regulates the instinctive and motor functions, and the life of sensations	Epithumia and eros Vegetative soul
2	Emotional	The center corresponds to ordinary emotional life	Thumos, Philonikon Animal soul
3	Intellectual	The lower intellectual center corresponds to the life of thought, i.e., of forms	Dianoia Ratio Intellectual Soul
4	Higher Emotional	This corresponds to higher emotions related to honour, loyalty, courage, and nobility.	Philotimon
5	Higher Intellectual	This corresponds to direct intuition, beyond words and thought.	Nous Intellectus Buddhi

Table 2.5: Centers of Man

Stage	Age		Sacrament	Description
Infancy & Childhood	Up to 7		Baptism	The psychic forces transform the body of the child from one that was inherited from the parents, to one that represents the full personality of the child.
Youth	7 to 14		Communion/Age of Reason	The child's imagination and feeling life takes centre stage
Adolescence	14 to 21		Confirmation	The higher mind of the adolescent takes root
Young adulthood	21 to 28			Sentient soul

Tyrant	Age	Spiritual Man
Earth	35	Water
Trouble	42	Philosopher
Deception	49	Sage
Power	56	Adeptship

Energetic Centres of Man

3.1 The Man of Heart

You might be saved — i.e., you might acquire spiritual equilibrium and live in the absolute center of being.

PAVEL FLORENSKY, *At the Crossroads of Science & Mysticism*

Prayer of the Heart The Prayer of the Heart was practiced by the early Egyptian Desert Fathers as a method of the purification of the Mind and the Heart. The Prayer of the Mind is the inner recitation of a prayer. When the prayer runs on its own, apart from the Mind, then it becomes the Prayer of the Heart. Ultimately, one can pray even during dreams.

The Prayer of the Heart is most often associated with the recitation of the Jesus Prayer. However, the unknown author of *The Cloud of Unknowing* recommends some simpler prayers like the repetition of “God” and “Love”. If it is difficult to bring attention from the Mind to the Heart, then attention can focus initially on the hands or another external body part. The Prayer of the Heart bring attention “in” the heart. In other

words, the heart becomes the center of awareness, not the object of awareness.

The Law of the Heart In the *Letter on the Hermit* from *Meditations on the Tarot*, we see that the heart is where contemplation and will are united, where knowledge becomes will and where will becomes knowledge. It is important to keep in mind that the “heart”, in this context, does not at all signify the centre of emotions and passions as it does in the popular imagination. Rather, it is the middle centre, or chakra, of man’s psychic and vital constitution. It does signify “love” however, making it the most human of the centers. “Knowledge” is what man knows, “Will” is what a man can do, but “Heart” is what he is.

The great work of the man of heart is the transmutation of the substance of other chakras into the substance of the heart. **Seyyed Nasr** wrote that the heart is the only organ that connects the human state to a transcendent state. This notion is confirmed by **Valentin Tomberg** when he explains that the heart, alone of all the centres, is not attached to the organism. Hence, it can go out of the organism and live.

The Planets and the Chakras The heart, as the central chakra, is therefore the “sun” of the microcosm. **Oscar Hinze**, in his book *Tantra Vidya*¹, shows that in ancient esoteric astronomy, the traditional planets correspond to the chakras of Tantra Yoga; in short, the macrocosm corresponds to the microcosm. Moreover, he shows how similar ideas were part of the progress of initiation in Mithraism. But, even more interestingly, Hinze notes that the mystic **Johann Gichtel**, a student of **Jacob Boehme**, was aware of the same correspondence as revealed in his book *Theosophia Practica*². The following table shows the correspondences. The table also includes the “I am” saying associated with the chakra, and

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/TantraVidya.pdf>

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/TheosophiaPractica.pdf>

the transformation that occurs with its awakening, as described in the *Letter on the Hermit*.

Remarkably, Gichtel claimed to have discovered the subtle centers in the body and their correspondence to the planets through his own contemplations and experience. In the Tantric system, each chakra is represented by a lotus with a unique set of petals. Hinze demonstrates that the number of petals corresponds to the “gestalt number” of each planet. These numbers are derived from the way the ancient astrologers experienced the sky. For example, the gestalt number of the Moon is 4, which represents its phases. Hence, the Muladhara chakra has four petals.

In the chart, the column labeled “Transformation” shows the changes that occur when the chakra is transformed by the heart. The column labeled “I am” shows Jesus’ “I am” saying that is associated with each chakra.

Waking Up When the chakras are asleep a man becomes dominated by instinctual life, motivated by fear (muladhara), sex (svadhisthana), and hunger (manipura), interspersed with random eruptions from higher chakras. Another way of saying this, following Gichtel’s diagram, is that the human being is under the influence of the planets, hence subjected to spontaneous forces beyond his knowledge and control.

So the obvious question is how to “awaken” the higher chakras. That puts us in a bind, since Hermetism rejects any mechanical process or technique to do so. By analogy, we can look at how you wake up from a night’s sleep. Who is doing the awakening? Commonly, it may be the result of an outside stimulation, or enough it comes about after a “crisis point” in a dream.

So, analogously, we could say that “waking up” into a higher state of consciousness are reaching certain “crises”, as described in the Letter on the Tower of Destruction. Such a crisis may result from either an internal or external event. Example, perhaps, are the boundary situations de-

scribed by **Karl Jaspers**, which often arise from chance, traumatic events. Of course, the Hermetist may choose boundary situations deliberately, by meditating on a particular topic. Perhaps, in this case, a meditation on one of the “I am” sayings would be helpful. I think it is a bit of a mystery for the “sleeping” person to try to wake up. All the forces that lead to that, need to be encouraged. Ultimately, it is a matter of grace from above.

The Christianisation of the Chakras

Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation

2 CORINTHIANS 5:17

Valentin Tomberg mentions the traditional Tantric method of awakening the chakras through their corresponding mantras: Om, Ham, Yam, and so on. That will awaken the chakras as they are. The Hermetist, however, has a different aim: the Christianisation of the centres, i.e., their transformation in conformity with their divine-human prototype. In other words, the aim is to make of oneself a new creation. The corresponding “I am” saying can be used as a mantra in the process of the Christianisation of the chakras.

The Christianisation of the inner organization is the transformation of the human being into a man of heart. The heart is the third, or neutralizing, force mediating “knowledge” and “will”. This leads to three transformational moments.

Note that there are two stages of subordination to the heart:

- Spontaneous arisings
- Directed mental activities

We have dealt with spontaneous arisings extensively in the past. We have noticed that, in our normal waking state — which is usually far from fully

conscious — thoughts, images, and impulses spontaneous arise, most often in a very negative way. We have used them as “crises” to lead to a moment of awareness, since they need to be brought under conscious control. In the past, we have used the exterior parts of the body, e.g., hands, feet, etc., as our objects of concentration and attention. Perhaps, now, we can begin to bring attention to the heart rather than a body part.

Next, there can be deliberate and consciously directed thoughts, images, and plans. Those are recognizably human activities since they are self-directed and self-willed. However, for them to be Christianised, then they, too, must be subordinated to the heart.

The goal of the Christianisation of the centres is to transform the human being into a *man or woman of heart*.

Scientific Postscript Although secular science is not the last word for us, it should not be surprising to learn that the heart has neurons. The HeartMath Solution, by Doc Childre and Howard Martin develops the idea of the heart as the central intelligence of the body. We do not consider this a “proof” for the man of heart, but an effect. Nevertheless, some of you, perhaps in the healing professions, may be interested in such topics. The downside is that, like all new age teachings, it sees the “knowledge of the heart” strictly in instrumental terms, as the means to an end, be it inner calm, physical health, treatment for psychological problems. We, on the other hand, consider becoming a man or woman of the heart is an end in itself.

Posted on 2022-04-23 by Cologero

3.2 Some Aspects of the Traditional Medical World View: The Demiourgos-Physician

But the more righteous of you, who stand upon the threshold of the change to the diviner state, shall among men be righteous kings, genuine philosophers, founders of states, and lawgivers, and real seers, and true herb-knowers, and prophets of the gods most excellent, skillful musicians, skilled astronomers, and augurs wise, consummate sacrificers—as many of you as are worthy of things fair and good

Kore Kosmou, Verse 23

It is estimated that the United States alone spends approximately \$40 billion a year on what is called “alternative”, “holistic”, “complementary”, or “traditional” medicine. The preponderance of therapies described by these names quite often purport to have some sort of foundation in one of the traditional medical sciences—be that Western (Greek, Spagyric), Ayurvedic, Chinese (“TCM”—Traditional Chinese Medicine), or similar. Not to entirely disparage the efforts behind the numerous styles of “natural” health care on the “market”—some which do indeed provide immediate benefits for many chronic and acute maladies—yet, the mere replacement of drugs and modern treatment modalities with herbs, diet, and “alternative” modalities, is not precisely “traditional medicine”—they are simply a matter of playing on the same field, proceeding from the same (mostly allopathic and mechanistic) perspective, while suggesting less toxic and invasive procedures, aka more “natural”. Surely while there certainly isn’t anything wrong with any of that per se, it falls short of what constitutes the “path” of the “Scholar-Physician”, or “Demiourgos-Physician”.

On the contrary, traditional medicine consists of a spiritual askesis—something that in its entirety discloses meaning, proceeds from Unity,

and points back to Unity (in the sense of what the Shi'a call "twill")—while simultaneously providing man with practical solutions and resources through which to alleviate day to day hardships, or otherwise enhance life (this much could be said of all the traditional arts, crafts, and sciences). What today is known as "holistic" and "alternative" medicine (although as noted has certain practical efficacy) represents almost a parody of an authentic traditional medicine, having been mostly divorced from its innate premises. To heal and engender health in the traditional sciences, involves "realization", that is, to make real on the ontological and phenomenological plane, the principles of the higher orders of reality, exemplified through the "master piece" of health as a function of body, spirit, and soul.

Foundations: A traditional "canon" Underscoring the notion that a truly traditional medicine (which is a sacred science) rests upon a comprehensive worldview, we are obliged to take note of a "canon" within this science (equally valid with all the sciences). As with anything else within the traditional sciences, none who regards themselves as physician or practitioner of these sciences can disregard the study and contemplation of their texts.—not in the sense of a pedantic or "academic" endeavor to acquire a collection of "facts", but as "contemplative reading", so as to become situated in the realm of noetic "Ideas", from which all practical applications have as their source. Thus far from having anything to do with the sale and purchase of "supplements", traditional medicine is based on doctrines forming something of a scripture (in some instances certain traditional scriptures proper, or sacred writings, are in fact the basis of further exegesis), which contains a metaphysics, cosmogony, cosmology, and thereafter the principles which comprise a theory of body, etiology, diagnostics, and therapies.

None of this is to say that a traditional medicine ignores or omits contemporary knowledge and understanding of anatomy, physiology,

chemistry, drug interactions, and disease etiologies—but that they are secondary, adjunct, and accessory to the fundamental principles of the given medical school, and when employed, are assessed within the context of that school's broader worldview. The following is not a comprehensive list, but somewhat suggestive of certain of the most prominent examples of “scriptures” forming the “canons” of some of the better known traditional schools of medicine.

The Far-East:

1. The I jing (“Change Classic”).
2. Huang Di Nei Jing (“Yellow Emperor’s Inner Canon”).
3. Su Wen (“Basic Questions”. First portion of the Huang Di).
4. Ling Shu (“Spiritual Pivot”. The second half of Huang Di, wherein acupuncture is introduced).
5. Shang Han Lun (“On Cold Damage”. An extremely synthetic text containing disease theory, progression, and treatment as seen through the lens of “Six Stage” theory).
6. Nan Jing (“Classic of Difficulties”. Refinement and development of topics begun in Huang Di).
7. Jin Gui Yao Lue (“Synopsis of the Golden Chamber”. A fundamental source of early traditional herbal prescriptions).

Greek/Unani Tibb

1. The extant Hippocratic corpus.
2. The Aristotelian corpus.
3. The extant Galenic corpus.

4. Ibn Sina, especially “Canon of Medicine”.
5. The developmental works of al-Rhazes, ibn-Nafis, al-Zahrawi.

“Unani” which is Arabic for “Greek” (Tibb meaning medicine), when especially worked not exclusively as “Greek”, but as an “Islamic medicine” (in many ways it was Islam that “rescued” and restored the Greek medical tradition), obviously takes the Qur’an and Hadith as super-scriptural foundation, wherefrom is derived a great deal of the Sufistic psychology, as well as food and herbal knowledge, among other modalities.

Eastern/Ayurvedic:

1. The Vedas, especially Rig Veda and Antharveda (The god Dhanvantari, analogous to Asclepius, is patron deity of medicine in Ayurveda, and said to have taught Ayurveda to man).
2. Charaka Samhita (“Compendium of Charaka”. The Ayurvedic “Bible” containing fundamental theory)
3. Sushruta Samhita (“Compendium of Sushruta”. Considered a surgical text, develops the theory of dosha, and discusses subtle/energetic anatomy).
4. Ashtanga Hridayam/Sangraha (further develops dosha theory).
5. Sharngadhara (discusses pharmacology).

Obviously we are leaving much aside. For instance, once beyond the core texts of the Western, Greek/Unani corpus, another entire chapter could be opened and considered with regard to the Alchemical-Spagyric corpus, reaching a high level of development with medieval medicine. Following the Spagyric, and Paracelsian developments, one could then see further continuity with the work of Samuel Hahnemann—a more thorough treatment of historical continuity can be found in Sir William Osler’s “History of Medicine”.

The Contents of the Various “Canon” The texts mentioned above therefore consolidate the theoretical and operative worldviews of the respective schools of medicine; even prior to a consideration of concrete teachings though, the texts outline subdivisions of what the medicine includes as, and means by, a “medical system”. According to Stephen Skinner, writing in the context of the Far- Eastern tradition, Traditional Chinese Medicine is composed of “8 rays... which include, acupuncture, food as medicine, herbal medicine, chi kung, meditation, moxibustion, astrology and feng shui (Guide to the Feng Shui Compass, 37)”.

The Greek/Unani tradition lists eight branches too, as: internal medicine, pediatrics, head and neck disorders, toxicology, “psychiatry”, rejuvenation therapy (including geriatrics), aphrodisiacs therapy (fertility, sexual disorders, conception)—and, often added to these (but really ought be thought of as modalities) are hydrotheraphy, regimen therapy, and dietetics. Similarly, the Indian science of Ayurveda (“Science of Life”) consists of 8 branches (for all intents and purposes identical with Unani): internal medicine, pediatrics, “demonology” (psycho-emotional studies—“psychiatry”), head and neck disorders, surgery (which can include non-invasive techniques such as massage—each of these categories represents very broad things within which much can be included), toxicology, rejuvenation, aphrodisiac therapy. One might conclude based on the Unani and Ayurvedic branches, that things such as “astrology” and “feng shui” are not included, unlike the Chinese—however, within the branch of internal medicine, and “aphrodisiac therapy” for example, further subdivisions such as the study of individual “prakriti” and “purusha”, do include as etymological factors, astrology, environment, and heredity (among others). The same could be said of Unani’s respective branches—more so, of the seven Unani working principles, arwah (including “spirits”), quva (“energy”), and af’al (action and motion) would include likewise consider subtle spiritual influences.

Toward a Traditional Understanding of the Body The Biblical expressions that man is made in God's image, and that the body is a temple, are well known enough motifs, with almost universal corollaries; from an exoteric understanding, this usually signifies something that has become vague almost to the point of meaninglessness, to the effect that "life is sacred", and that "the Holy Spirit inhabits each person". From a more esoteric perspective, or at least the refinement of the traditional sciences, the body is an eikon, a real image in miniature of the total kosmos, equally possessing everything the kosmos contains, mirrored at some place within the body (via "correspondence"). The human body then might be studied as a map—an image of the soul, which is image of kosmos noetos, which is the "body" of the "Perfect man", the "Primordial man", analogous with the "First Intellect".

As Harish Johari has pointed out concerning the role of the body in the Tantric schools, "Tantra is the study of the universal from the point of view of the individual", which also helps explain sciences such as Vaastu Shastra, whose models are based on diagramic mandalas of the body of Purusha. Dr. Hiener Fruehauf in his essays and work concerning the "Chinese Medicine Holomap", the Zodiac, and the Lunar Mansions, has shown how these cosmo-physical manadalas are equally present in Far-Eastern classics such as the "Ling Shu", noted above (another similar "holomap", from a Sufi perspective, is described in Ibn Arabi's astrological treatise reproduced by Titus Burkhardt). The work of Schwaller de Lubicz in books such as "Temple of Man" and elsewhere, have painstakingly described the same underlying relationship between body and kosmos, as encoded within the Egyptian temple and hieroglyphic sciences. In the Merkabah and Kabbalistic schools, writings such as "Shir' Qoma" and related texts, describing the anatomy and "measurements" of God are also in fact depictions of a "yantra" of the "Grand Man". In Kabbalah, often closely aligned with the Western astro-medical branch of medicine itself, the body of archetypal Adam Kadmon is often represented as the zodiac,

with the zodiacal belt, not as physical constellations solely, but as totality of what they designate as “symbolique” via their relationships and interactions with one another (for a summary, see for example William Ramesy’s “Astrology Restored”, “On the Names of the Signs”, and “On the Order of the Signs”).

Individual man in corporeal mode likewise contains within himself, the same entities, with each Zodiacal animal corresponding to something anatomical, diverse psycho-physiological processes, tissues, and fluids. Such models are the basis of clinical modalities such as acupuncture, chi kung, internal alchemy, massage therapy, hatha yoga (not the Americanized “exercises”, but postures intended to activate and deactivate subtle energy flow), the signs, grips, tokens, penalties, and postures found in initiatic rites, as well as knowledge of the “signatures” of substances (herbal, mineral, metallic, animal), and how such pharmaka ought be prescribed. As Algis Uzdaviny’s explains:

According to the late Neoplatonists, the gods are present immaterially in the material things, therefore *ta sunthemata* (the theurgic seats of power) are regarded as receptacles for the divine irradiations... since the body is an integral part of demiurgic work... the condition and quality of embodied matter indicate the soul’s internal condition. The human body as a fixed eidic statue or as an iconographically established sequence of dynamic hieroglyphic script (analogous to a series of Tantric mudras)... the different limbs of the initiate’s body are identified with different deities... an *agalma*... *Sharira*, one of Sanskrit words for ‘body’, derives from the verbal root *shri* (‘to rest upon’, ‘to support’). Hence the body serves as a framework (like the Greek *peribolos*) by means of which the All-Worker can experience the world... the *agalma* is regarded as a vessel and container for the divine powers that take up residence in it. The awakening of these powers is sometimes achieved by the practice of putting pharmaka (remedies, drugs, herbs, magical means of power, charms, enchantments, symbols)

into hollow statues and thereby animating them. This act is conducted by the telestic ‘craftsman’ (demiourgos). The physician is also designated as demiourgos.

Philosophy and Theurgy in Late Antiquity, 86, 124, 151

Some Further Aspects of the Body as “Agalma” Initiatory rites still often involve an identification of the body’s parts with “deities”, or if not gods per se, then otherwise rendered as spiritual influences/forces. As everything in tradition is connected hierarchically, these principles can likewise be seen reflected in medical correspondences between anatomical regions and planets, or in the systems of “points”—be they acupuncture, Ayurvedic marma, Unani lataif, or what is now becoming increasingly popularly known as “points chauds” (seen for instance in rites such as the Order of Memphis Misraim, and as Allen Greefeild has shown in his “360/90 Points Chauds Sytem”, are often identical with Far-Eastern acupuncture points). Acupuncture “points”, perhaps the best known of such points, in fact, is not the most ideal terminology to describe this science of the Far-Eastern tradition; rather, “jing luo”, a phrase meaning something like a woof and weft is more often used—this is because the subtle anatomy employed in the selection of acupuncture “points” arises from a complex interaction of flowing “channels” and sub-channels throughout the body, connecting with each other, tissues, organs, and all psycho-physical components, like an intricately woven net. The locations where regions of this net are most accessible are the so-called “points” (nor ought this subtle anatomy be thought of Far-Eastern exclusively. The Ayurvedic school, instead of jing-luo works with “srotas”, “nadis”, “marmas”, and “chakras”—these srotas becoming at locations of concentration nadis, nadis emerging as marmas, lastly with the well known “chakras” themselves emerging (being a large type of marma), as developed in say the “Sushruta Samhita”.

These points moreover share an array of correspondences: elemental/humoral, times (hour, day, month, year—seasonal), astrological, with other organs, with fluids (qi, blood, phlegm, “akhlat”), emotions, colors, shapes, tastes, “spirits”, and more. As opposed to identification with deities, as seen in some traditions, the Far-Eastern points have names, serving not only and always as anatomical markers, but as specific references to forces of nature, “spirits”, planets, stars, and constellations. In the contemporary practice of Chinese medicine, a popularization following the “People’s Revolution”, the convention has been to view these names and theories as quaint vestiges of a superstitious populace, to excise them, and reduce the traditional science to yet another mechanistic bio-medicine (which indeed, is what has likewise been perpetuated in most Western instruction in these disciplines, along with most all manifestations of “traditional” medicine in the West, reducing all of them to the colloquially described “alternative” medicines). Despite that, the symbolique of the “points” becomes indispensable when approaching the inner medicine, the “neidan” or internal alchemy, which makes use of the same jing luo as in clinical medicine—and the activation of which, through the various “circulations” of energy activated by visualization, contemplation, movements, and breath, can be seen as analogous to the “deification” of the body parts found in other systems, such as the Egyptian, Hellenic, Mesopotamian, Phoenician, and Indian. The “demiourgos-physicians’” work is then a true “holistic medicine” of body-mind-soul, much like that of the Siddha and Tantric counterparts, of which Mark Dyczkowski mentions, that in conjunction with body work:

Kashmiri Saiva Krama elevated the worship of Kali to a level beyond outer worship. Ritual came to be understood as an inner process of realization through which the initiate discovered his essential identity with Kali who is the flow (krama) of consciousness through the polarities of subject, object, and means of knowledge in consonance with their means of arising and falling away in each

act of perception (9).

Time, Space, and Pharmakon Seldom if ever does one mention astrology in the same breath as medicine or health. Yet, as seen in the traditional “rays” of medical sciences, and as quipped by Hippocrates, no physician is ignorant of the study and application of astrology. Contrary to modern assumptions, astrology as exists in any of the traditions mentioned, does not involve the calculation of “horoscopes” or reading of “fortunes”; rather, it is the study of time cycles (especially quantitative time), and the effects of these cycles upon the immediate environment, and the internal environment of a physical organism. A parallel science, Feng Shui examines space/direction (environment), in relation to time (cycles), and the results thereof upon the organisms (again developing a common ground between microcosm and macrocosm, undertaking to know one through the other, and being situated in such a way as to engender effect through application of this mutual harmony).

The factors taken into consideration and calculation with both of these “rays” (astrology and Feng Shui) can become quite extensive, detailed, and precise—beginning with hourly rhythms (circadian clock), planetary hours, or tattvic tides, as they pertain to the physical organs (circadian rhythms), then working toward daily, monthly, and annual cycles (which includes obviously enough, the effect of the seasons on health), all the way through lengthy cycles that extend through the duration of a lifetime. Information derived from such evaluations is used to assist in understanding an individual’s humoral constitution, the prevalence (abundance or deficiency) of affected/imbalanced humors (congenital, acquired, or seasonal), as well as planning treatments and regimens most accommodating to a particular phase of time (Hippocrates for example was adamant concerning methods of cooking, and types of exercise engaged in seasonally. In the more Taoist schools of acupuncture, as another instance, there are points recommended, and points contraindicated for

puncturing based on time cycle).

Other methods extend the diagnostic use of astrology to the art of “decumbiture” or “iatromathematika”, in which charts are erected in synchronicity with the onset of a patient’s malady in an effort to further precise an understanding of the qualities of time at a specific moment impacting ones’ health.

Another third, and perhaps most interesting application of medico-astrology is in choice of remedies. In “The Pharmacology of Sacred Plants, Herbs, and Roots”, John Scarborough remarks:

Early Greek medicine and pharmacy combine theurgy (in its widest sense of supernatural or divine agencies in both diseases and their treatments) with the practical application of drugs... Theurgy remained fundamental throughout Greek history even after the accession of Christianity, and theurgy continued to exist side by side with other ‘medical intervention’ systems.

Among the diverse theurgical methods, the animation of cult statues, the agalma (of which one must never lose sight that the body is an agalma of kosmos), was of great importance in cultivating and accessing the presence and benefits of the gods; as opposed to “animating” a statue, the practitioner of astro-theurgic medicine produces images, and sympathetic talismans during specific windows of opportunity, in correspondence with precision celestial timing (“elections”) so as to “animate” the talisman, which then becomes an object of “pharmaka”. As fantastic as this might sound, in principle it is hardly any different from the Taoist indicated and contraindicated points governed by circadian rhythms and broader time cycles—only that the points and the body replace an external agalma (talisman), are directly “animated”. Within the scope of this pharmaka, the astrological forces not only exert “rulerships” employed in talisman manufacture, but they are at the heart of the system of “signatures”, one of the means in which natural substances obtain

the classification of medicinal properties assigned to them (the subject of signatures is also something that moderns are prone to smile at—and for that matter, even moderns who immerse themselves in a “traditional medicine”. Yet, methods of verification exist through means known as “Spagyric analysis”, whereby substances are evaluated based upon things such as their extraction mediums, solubilities, ideal means distillation, and ratios of “fixed” to “volatile” principles—“mercury”, “sulfur”, and “salts”, quantitatively arriving at certain conclusions about signatures).

In fact, even traditional laboratory and pharmacy become “temples” in traditional medicine. As Dom Pernety, an 18th century physician and alchemist listed in his alchemical dictionary, the twelve major Alchemical and Spagyric processes (calcination, solution, separation, conjunction, putrefaction, congelation, cibation, sublimation, fermentation, exaltation, multiplication, and projection) can be assigned Zodiacal ruler-ships; along with apparatuses such as the athanor (symbolizing primordial Light and Unity) and alembic (earth, the “waters”, and heaven)—the very production of physical medicines is therefore a replication of cosmogonic processes.

Of the traditional “8 rays” of medical science described by Stephen Skinner, six can be viewed as specifically relating to the study of man (acupuncture, chi kung, meditation, food-nutrition, herbal medicine, moxibustion), to Heaven is given astrology, and to Earth pertains feng shui (food and herbal medicine, in the sense of agriculture, could also be subsumed under Earth). Thus, as a whole then, the worldview and practice of traditional medicine studies, contemplates, and actively harmonizes each term of the “Great Triad”, curing and ensuring health, while taking the body (and pharmacy) as “departure point” for the realization of cosmological and metaphysical Truth.

Posted on 2013-01-14 by Frater M

* * *

Mihai on 2013-01-15 at 04:38 said:

Wow, great post, with loads of insightful clarifications.

Thanks, Mercurius.

To all you wrote can be added the practice of “hesychastic medicine”, for which, unfortunately, I don’t have any solid information and not much seems to have come in written form.

Recently, in my country, there have been published some works on the subject, but they seem rather doubtful.

Dai on 2013-01-15 at 21:17 said:

A fine overview, Francis – I enjoyed reading it.

I suggest highlighting the importance of integration of body-mind-soul; of ‘righting’ body through spirit or mind and effusing both with soul as Nascent Oneness. This process defines what came to be known as alchemy. The Source of health as Virtuous Vitality begins and ends with the Soul. When this is Essentially and naturally understood, the Doctor-Patient relationship develops in real-time through a course of fundamental healing. Tibetan lama-doctors still understand this; in any case it remains the core of Hermetic practices and all Great Traditions.

Yoga in its varying forms, including the combination of chi kung, meditation, and tui na – the latter of which is the primary modality of TCM (acupuncture is based upon it) – essentially forms the core of both alchemical and more academic/objective forms of traditional medicine. Yoga inherently is the unifying of body-mind-soul.

For a fine, traditionally staged (aka Eight-Arms), accessibly esoteric exposition regarding the innate integration of yogic realization in Patanjali’s tradition (arguably appropriated from Buddhist schools of Patanjali’s era) see Iyengar’s Forward to *Light on Yoga*.

Regarding early Greek ways of medicine men and women, I don’t see how the whole cultural stream of Persian/Etruscan/Grecian tradition can be appreciate without prominent reference to Plato’s pathologies (fundamental types of madness – covered in *Origins of the Tarot*), for they address psychophysical aspects of extreme identification in ways that ordinary folk are not able to ‘withstand’. So much might be said about that, and if we ever spend some time together perhaps we can discuss further.

If by Perfect Man, you are referring to Ibn ‘Arabi’s cosmogonic Nondual Principle, you might look deeper into this. Soul as First Intellect is as great or ‘high’ as Judaic/Islamic/Christian dogma allows (and even there must deal with the difficult issue of Saint/Angel conflation). However, Ibn ‘Arabi’s Perfect Man seems to Identify with the very Law or Way itself, aka Allah. This is a crucial issue as to how ‘Islamic’ his most essential teaching is; it certainly is Beyond the Prophet’s revelations or realizations.

While it is definitely true that a Great Tradition of spiritual wellness is founded upon ‘gods’ as inhabitants of human organs, it is quite a jump to identify those spirit-organs (or nadis cauldrons,

etc.) with corresponding astrological representations and systems. That would definitely not be the case with Taoist medicine and yoga.

Chakra	Petals	Planet	Transformation	I am
Sahasrara	8/1000	Saturn	Abstract and transcendent wisdom Full of warmth like the fire of Pentecost	The resurrection and the life
Ajna	2	Jupiter	Intellectual initiative Compassion-filled insight into the world	The light of the world
Visuddha	16	Mars	Creative word Magical: illuminating, consoling, healing	The good shepherd
Anahata	12	Sun	Love Exteriorisation of love	The bread of life
Manipura	10	Venus	Science Conscience	The door
Svadhithana	6	Mercury	Center of health Holiness, i.e., harmony of spirit, soul, body	The way, the truth, and the life
Muladhara	4	Moon	Creative force Source of energy and élan	The true vine

Table 3.1: Chakra and Planetary Correspondences

Intellectual intuition	Feeling for truth	Subordinate spontaneous movements of thought as well as the directing intellectual initiative to the heart of thought
Moral intuition	Feeling for beauty	Subordinate both spontaneous imagination and actively directed imagination to the direction of the heart
Practical intuition	Feeling for good	Subordinate spontaneous impulses and designs directed from the will to the feeling of practical intuition

Myths, rites and symbols

4.1 Definition of Myth

A “Myth” is what other people believe.

Posted on 2008-05-20 by Anonymous

* * *

Matt A on 2016-02-07 at 08:31 said:

A myth is more true than all the facts of science lumped together.

4.2 Symbolism and Metaphysics

Natural phenomena in general, and especially astronomical phenomena, are never looked upon by the traditional doctrines other than as a simple means of expression, whereby they symbolize truths of a higher order.

RENE GUENON, *Man and his Becoming according to the Vedanta*

Inner States It is reasonably straight-forward to describe the sensual, or physical, world. For example, I can describe the banana tree I see outside my window. I can specify its height, the number, size, and shape of the fronds and how they are cut by the wind. I can write about the bunches of fruit and whether they appear ripe.

However, when it comes to inner states, such a description is not so straight forward. This is exacerbated by the fact that very few men have been trained to observe their inner states in any detail, other than as the most primitive emotions, desires, and sensations. Thus, for the initiated, recourse is made to natural phenomena to express subtle inner states. This is furthermore justified since the natural or physical world is the reflection of the supernatural. Guenon explains:

If natural phenomena symbolize such truths of a higher order, it is because their laws are fundamentally nothing but the expression of these very truths in a particular domain, a sort of translation of the corresponding principles, naturally adapted to the special conditions of the corporeal and human state.

In this regard, we can do no better than to repeat Guenon's emphasis, "*It is absolutely essential for the understanding of these matters.*"

Lunar and Solar In alchemy, chemical reactions are used to symbolize inner states and transformations. This seems to be understood by most readers of alchemical texts, except for those who seem to be more impressed by extraordinary physical phenomena. *A fortiori*, astronomical symbolism, as we pointed out previously¹, must be understood the same way. As Guenon writes:

It must be clearly understood, that when mention is made, for example, of the Spheres of the Sun and of the Moon, it is never the

¹<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-cosmic-hierarchy>

sun and the moon as visible stars, belonging purely to the corporeal realm, that are referred to, but rather the universal principles which these stars represent after their own fashion in the sensible world ... Indeed the different Worlds, planetary Spheres and elementary Realms which are symbolically described as so many regions (only symbolically however, since the being who journeys through them is no longer subject to space), **are in reality just different states.**

The terms Solar and Lunar themselves have been badly misunderstood, largely in part to **Julius Evola's** adoption of the terms from the anthropologist, **J J Bachofen**. This has led to the opinion that they represent a choice, rather than inner states. Guenon writes that the heart corresponds to the Sun. Of course, metaphysically, the Heart is the seat of intelligence, not of feelings as it is today. The Moon, then, corresponds to the brain, the center of discursive thought which is the reflection of the Intellect. To try to be one or the other is to be imbalanced, not to say impossible; their proper relationship has been described at *The Word Is Made Flesh*².

Just as we should not confuse the metaphysical Sun and Moon with their astronomical analogues, neither should we confound them with merely human genders. The temptation is to use Solar and Lunar as mutually exclusive labels, which is tantamount to saying that the Heart can live without the Brain.

The Sky God It is very difficult for most men to think abstractly, beyond sensual representations of objects in space. Guenon writes about “the error of those who imagine they believe that the doctrines in question are only intended to describe and explain phenomena.” This error is most apparent in men who think they are “sophisticated” because they

²<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-word-is-made-flesh>

refuse to believe in a “sky god”. The error is compounded when they replace it by a “life force” or an “immanent god”, and the like. The real “solution” is to understand what the symbols mean. Guenon, for example lists these:

Symbol	Meaning
Earth	Gross manifestation
Atmosphere	Subtle manifestation
Sky	Formless manifestation
	The unconditioned beyond all manifestation

So a reference to a god in the sky, means that God is beyond all manifestation. The alleged dichotomy between a transcendent and immanent god is simply meaningless. The Atma, or Self, dwells in the Heart, beyond all manifestation. Yet, the Atma is our very being. While Atma is Brahma, beyond all manifestation, as Purusha, it indwells man as his vital centre. This centre is beyond both the light of the Sun and Moon, as it is self-luminous. This is hardly abstract language, but rather a call to recognize it in one’s own consciousness. Beyond every change in consciousness, what is it that is always there and never changes?

Tantra In his *Foundations of Tibetan Mysticism*, **Lama Anagrika Govinda** explains the anthropomorphic symbolism of the Tantras:

The abstractness of philosophical concepts and conclusions requires to be constantly corrected by direct experience, by the practice of meditation and the contingencies of daily life. The anthropomorphic element in the Vajrayana is therefore not born from a lack of intellectual understanding (as in the case of primitive man), but, on the contrary, from the conscious desire to penetrate from a merely intellectual and theoretical attitude to the

direct awareness of reality. This cannot be achieved through building up convictions, ideals, and aims based on reasoning, but only through conscious penetration of those layers of our mind which cannot be reached or influenced by logical arguments and discursive thought.

If logical arguments and discursive thought do not suffice to describe the direct experience of these inner states, then we must resort to symbols. The Lama continues:

Such penetration and transformation is only possible thorough the compelling power of inner vision, whose primordial images or archetypes are the formative principles of our mind. Like seeds they sink into the fertile soil of our subconsciousness in order to germinate, to grow and to unfold their potentialities. Such visions are not hallucinations, because their reality is that of the human psyche. They are symbols, in which the highest knowledge and the noblest endeavor of the human mind are embodied. Their visualization is the creative process of spiritual projection, through which inner experience is translated into visible form.

In particular, this applies to the image of yabyum³, which is mistaken as a technique used to achieve enlightenment. Quite the contrary, this symbolizes the union of the male and female principles in consciousness. Lama Govinda writes:

If the passive, all-embracing female principle, from which everything proceeds and into which everything recedes, is united with dynamic male principle of active universal love and compassion, then perfect Buddhahood is attained.

³<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3231>

This union of the heart and the head can only be represented symbolically, at least for those who have yet to experience that realization. The Lama continues:

The process of Enlightenment is therefore represented by the most obvious, the most human and at the same time, the most universal symbol imaginable: the union of male and female in the ecstasy of love, in which the active element is represented as a male and the passive by a female figure.

Those who insist on some sort of Sex Magick based on Tantric or alchemical writings have missed the point. Lama Govinda emphasizes this point:

We must not forget that the figureal representations of these symbols are not looked upon as portraying human beings, but as embodying the experiences and visions of meditation. In such a state, however, there is nothing more that could be called sexual; there is only the super-individual polarity of all life, which rules all mental and physical activities, and which is transcended only in the ultimate state of integration, in the realization of *sunyata*.

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J on 2012-02-13 at 21:29 said:

"Those who insist on some sort of Sex Magick based on Tantric or alchemical writings have missed the point."

Who are these people? Seems like a straw man to me. Beyond that, is it not the point of sex magic to go beyond the material, to see the act and those involved as symbols. not unlike Arjuna sees the enemy on the battlefield? I fail to see why this should be an impossible or necessarily incorrect path.

Cologero on 2012-02-13 at 21:52 said:

Mr J,

A “straw man” is an argument that misrepresents a position. First of all, we eschew arguments. But for the sake of argument, we have not misrepresented anything, as there are indeed those who practice Sex Magick.

It is obvious to anyone who has actually read and understood the post that the sex act is a symbol. We also pointed out what it symbolizes. Do you disagree with Lama Govinda in that regard?

Since the yabyum symbolizes the union of opposites (yan and yang), sex magick is not at all necessary to achieve that union, which is the point being missed.

Now, if you think that sex magick is nevertheless useful in some cases, then please tell us why or share your experiences. It is certainly not sufficient, or else the entire human race would be enlightened by now.

But to return to the alchemical analogy, chemists may deal with mercury and sulfur all day long and never see them as a symbol. Something more must be added, don't you think? And once you understand the sex act is a symbol for something else, how many more times do you have to repeat it to be convinced?

J on 2012-02-13 at 22:50 said:

First let me make my intentions plain, and insist against any inclination on your part to see me as a mere disturber. I'm genuinely confused as to what your point is and actually do want to understand you, as I've enjoyed your writings thus far.

Unfortunately, your comment has only confused me more, the greater for its tone. Perhaps rather than responding with snide arrogance, one could fathom the possibility that clarity to you is not necessarily an objective matter for the rest of us, Mr. Cologero, despite the obvious care taken in checking these posts over for mistakes, such as the moon corresponding to the moon. Perhaps I'm too ignorant to grasp the meaning of that one.

It would seem to me that by “Sex Magic” you mean two different things.

“It is certainly not sufficient, or else the entire human race would be enlightened by now.”

This is simply unfair. Clearly the entire human race has sex, but do they all claim to be practicing sex magic?

“sex magick is not at all necessary to achieve that union”

And so you would proscribe it for not being the only way? There are differing natures, I'm sure you're aware, and ways for each of them to reach the divine, not all of them intellectual in nature, requiring such studies and practices as you demand.

It would seem that you want to move from unnecessary to unorthodox or incorrect. If I've mistaken your motive, please set me aright, as “Those who insist on some sort of Sex Magick based on Tantric or alchemical writings have missed the point” seems to me to be in this spirit, and also to miss the point in another direction. It seems to me to assume an ignorance of the

principles involved in those who might take an active involvement in sexual activity as a means of realization. This is clearly beyond your capacity to know.

As for “how many times must you repeat it”, this seems quite beside the point. Would you have the enlightened commit suicide for having finished the task of awakening? Should one stop yoga, meditation, etc. once satisfied that he’s achieved perfect knowledge?

As for personal experiences with “sex magic”, I have made no attempt at such a thing, so regretfully have nothing to offer in that regard, though I’m sure such findings would have been treated with utmost respect.

Cologero on 2012-02-13 at 23:55 said:

Thanks for pointing out the typo.

The point of the post is quite clear and is independent of the virtues or vices of the practice of Sex Magick.

We have previously offered some impressions of Sex Magick.

You did bring up an interesting point even if by accident: To be enlightened is to have already committed suicide.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-14 at 18:47 said:

We’re back to the reunification of soulmates, the miracle greater than the parting of the Red Sea. I could write a book about this topic but will spare you!

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-14 at 18:49 said:

The Zohar and its professional commentators are probably better

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/reunification-of-soul-mates>

When their time to be married arrives, the Creator who knows these spirits and souls joins them as they were before they came into the world.. When they are joined together, they become one body and one soul, right and left in proper unison. As it is written, “There is nothing new under the sun,” because this is nothing new but a return to how they were before coming down to this world.

You might say, “But we have learned that a man obtains a soul mate according to his deeds and his behaviour.” It is assuredly so! If he is meritorious and his ways are correct, then he deserves his on soul mate, to join her as they were joined when they left the Creator, and before bonding with a physical body.”

Nothing that takes place in the physical dimension is more celebrated by Kabbalah than the joining of soul mates, and toward that end almost any hardship or sacrifice is permissible.

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4.3 Thought, Word, Symbol

The reform of the modern mentality, with all that it implies—namely the restoration of true intellectuality and of traditional doctrine, which for us are inseparable from one another—is certainly a considerable task; but is that a reason for not undertaking it? It seems to us, on the contrary, that such a task constitutes one of the loftiest and most important goals that can be proposed for the activity of a society such as the Society for the Intellectual Propagation of the Sacred Heart, so much the more in that all efforts in this direction will necessarily be oriented toward the Heart of the Incarnate Word, the spiritual Sun and Center of the World, ‘in which are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and science’; not of that vain, profane science which is all that is known to most of our contemporaries, but the true sacred science which, for those who study it in the proper way, open unsuspected horizons that are truly unlimited.

RENE GUENON, *Symbols of Sacred Science*

It is a fundamental proposition of Catholic philosophy that a mental concept is an expression of the reality of the object considered, and that linguistic constructions are an expression of the reality of the mental concepts. There is thus a chain of certainty connecting being, thought, and language.

ROMANO AMERIO, *Iota Unum*

We prefer to reformulate Professor Amerio’s insight in metaphysical terms as the chain of certainty connecting the idea, the thought, and the word. “**Intuition**” is a fundamental concept in metaphysics and it refers to a direct, immediate grasp of reality. So when I see a banana tree out my window, I have a direct sensory intuition of it. But you have a mediated knowledge of it, since you know of its existence on my say so.

A thought, then, is more like seeing than an activity, as something I do. Hence, a thought is an intellectual intuition of an idea, that is, a direct, unmediated of it. The word is its expression. This comprises the chain of certainty.

This is totally opposed to any modern conception that regards language as a natural phenomenon, an advanced form of grunts and groans, and no more than a game with just a chance association with reality. You may repeat this at your university cocktail party to be considered wise and knowledgeable. Keep the rest of this to yourself, or to those who know the secret handshake.

The Symbol Pure intelligences, such as angels, or men who have achieved such states, don't need more than the intellectual intuition to grasp ideas. However, for man such as he is, symbols are required to lead him to such an understanding. Guenon writes:

Symbolism seems to us to be particularly well adapted to the exigencies of human nature, which is not a purely intellectual nature but requires a sensory basis form which to raise itself to higher spheres. We must take the human make-up as it is one and multiple in its real complexity ... For pure intelligence, no outward form or expression is needed in order to understand truth, nor even to communicate to other pure intelligences what it has understood, insofar as this is communicable; but this is not how it is for man.

Guenon relates the symbol to the word in this way.

Fundamentally, every expression, every formulation whatever it may be, is a symbol of the thought that it expresses outwardly, and in this sense language itself is nothing but a symbolism. There should be no opposition, therefore, between the use of words and the use of figurative symbols; rather, these two modes of expression are complementary.

The word and the symbol both express a thought, though in different ways. The **word** is analytic and discursive, like the mind it expresses. The **symbol**, on the other hand, is synthetic and intuitive. This characteristic of the symbol makes it more suitable as a support for intellectual intuition. Language is limited, symbolism is not. That is why the highest truths need to be expressed in **poetry**, as we saw in the case of Dante. Guenon writes:

The highest truths, not communicable or transmissible in any other way, can be communicated up to a certain point when they are, so to speak, incorporated in *symbols which will no doubt conceal them for many but which will manifest them in all their brilliance to those with eyes to see*.

There are two fundamental mistakes that are frequently made in regards to symbolism:

- To confuse the symbols with its material representation.
- To regard the symbol as merely psychological or subjective.

Unfortunately, these misunderstandings appear even in those who regard themselves in some way as “men of tradition”. Even some 90 years after Guenon’s first books, these misunderstandings persist. We don’t mean to be critical for its own sake, nor to initiate a debate which, in any case, is unable to reach to the highest knowledge. Rather our intent is to help those with eyes to see to avoid confusion. The task to reform the modern mentality must continue, especially to those who believe they have overcome the that mentality.

Material Interpretation Rather than being abstract, a concrete example should suffice to demonstrate this point. Peter recently learned about sun worship and now he wells up with pride about the sun worship of

“our pagan ancestors”. He, too, wants to worship the sun, yet is unsure how to go about it. Of course, we understand the “sun” as the symbol for some deeper, metaphysical truth. As Guenon points out in our opening quote, the Sun, metaphysically speaking, is the Logos at the center of the world.

Subjective Interpretation The symbol is part of the chain of certainty that connects the thought to the idea. Hence, it is perfectly objective and has a meaning apart from the understanding, or misunderstandings, of men. Guenon points out that symbols are remarkably consistent across traditions. Paul does not understand this, so he speaks of “pagan” symbols, and erroneously concludes that “christians” then “stole” them, presumably to trick the apparently dim witted pagans to switch religions. It is the case that symbolism may be understood in lesser or greater depth. **Guido de Giorgio** points this out, with Dante, that the full meaning of pagan symbols may have become known only at a later time. An example often used by New Rightists and neo-pagans is the symbolism of the Quest for the Holy Grail. This was a Celtic legend adopted by the christians in the Middle ages. Since Guenon addresses this very topic in *Symbols of Sacred Science*, I’ll leave it to readers to check the relevant chapters. Perhaps they will honour us with some intelligent comments about it.

Posted on 2012-03-28 by Cologero

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Francis on 2012-03-29 at 01:49 said:

This is an excellent piece; while in agreement that ultimately, true symbols have an ultimate metaphysical meaning, and that the example of “Peter” represents an error, we would maintain that within the Sacred Sciences, we ought not at the same time, totally ignore that certain physical applications do exist. Continuing with the Sun example, there are various traditional ceremonies, which seek to cultivate the Sun’s energetics, as much as reach above toward

the metaphysical. Then, you have certain types of Alchemical, medical, and Qigong exercises, attempting to absorb Solar “Yang” into the body, by directly working with the Sun at certain times of the day and year. With things like “signatures” and “correspondences”, the physical “applications” expand, and one comes to note that things such as plants and minerals of a “solar” nature, can be used alone, or combined at times auspicious to the Sun, to create a Solar medicine. Or, again, at such auspicious times, creating an appropriate talisman, as the texts depict... more examples exist, but why not ask, why ought these be ignored?

Boreas on 2012-03-29 at 04:57 said:

Good article, and one that merits meditation upon.

Regarding the two confusions and their avoidance, this is probably the very intention behind the buddhist ceremonies in which monks first rigorously build a huge sand mandala for many days, and right after making the finishing lines proceed to destroy it: all manifested things, everything in the world of maya, is forever under the law of creation and destruction. The whole world is in flames permanently, and “the Son of Man” – the unmanifested principle, Logos – “has nowhere to lay his head upon”.

The triple enclosure of the druids brings to my mind the triple cube of Sorath (the spirit of the Sun), the twelve doors of the Platonic academy, the twelve disciples around the Master – both the microcosmic and macrocosmic the labyrinth through which the disciple of the Mysteries must traverse to find the Holy Grail & the Palace of The King of the World from the Center; the resurrection body – the purified and ascended etheric vehicle – and Life Eternal.

H00 on 2012-03-29 at 10:53 said:

Nothing is as distasteful as the literalist, whether he thinks himself a pagan or a christian or what have you.

Cologero on 2012-03-30 at 07:34 said:

There is nothing here to oppose effective rites and rituals, or even the acts of a traditional science. After all, the physical world itself is a symbol, a reflection, of the metaphysical. But that is a topic in itself.

4.4 The Symbolic World

Rational thinking, *dianoia*, does not, and cannot, lead to knowledge of God. Rather, there is a higher form of knowing, traditionally called “Intuition” which is a direct knowing or realization of metaphysical truths.

Since it is based often on the Imagination, discursive reasoning is insufficient. Therefore, Symbols are used in Tradition to convey these higher truths.

The Scholastic principle is that all knowledge begins in the senses. Hence, symbolism is adapted to this need of human nature. Few people are able to begin with pure intellectuality, so the symbols serve as the sensory basis that gives rise to higher levels.

Symbols are both a boon and a bane. For those able to penetrate into the meaning of the symbol, it is a boon. But for the others, it is a bane, because they can only understand the symbols in a literal and material sense. The prime example is alchemy. The alchemical processes have a symbolic meaning which leads to higher states. Understood materially, the “blowers” attempted to repeat the experiments as if they referred to profane chemistry.

Law of Correspondence The multiple states of the being are not isolated from each other. Whatever happens on one plane of existence corresponds to something on another plane. A fortiori, a symbol is not the “real” meaning of the thing symbolized; instead they are both valid within their own domains. In *Symbolism of the Cross*, **Rene Guenon** makes this clear:

The fact is that people too often tend to think that if a symbolical meaning is admitted, the literal or historical sense must be rejected; such a view can only result from unawareness of the law of correspondence which is the very foundation of all symbolism. ... For this reason the laws of a lower domain can always be taken to symbolize realities of a higher order.

This holds good for historical facts no less than for anything else: they likewise conform to the law of correspondence, and thereby translate higher realities, of which they are a human expression. We would add that it is this that gives to these facts the greater part of their significance.

Hence, the events of sacred history carry a higher meaning without annulling the historical facts. He explains:

This symbolical character, while common to all historical events, is bound to be particularly clear-cut in the case of events connected with what may be called “sacred history”; thus it is recognizable in a most striking way, in all the circumstances of the life of Christ. If the foregoing has been properly grasped, it will at once be apparent not only that there is no reason for denying the reality of these events and treating them as mere myths, but on the contrary that these events had to be such as they were, and could not have been otherwise.

Documentary The temptation when dealing with symbols, myths, legends, and the like is to think in the manner of a televised documentary. A documentary will choose all the variations of the symbols from various and divergent sources, with commentary by various scholars. At the end, one “knows” a lot of the who, what, where, and men, yet one is no closer to understanding the true meaning of the symbol.

Transmission of Symbols Esoteric teachings, when they are made public, are couched in terms of symbols of various types: art, stained glass, icons, legends, myths, fairy tales, and so on. Typically, these symbols are repeated even though they are not fully understood. At the appropriate time, the esoteric meanings of the symbols will be revealed to those ready to understand them.

Oftentimes, these legends are repeated and transmitted without being fully understood. Guenon gives as examples, Chrestien de Troyes and Robert de Boron, authors of poetry about the Holy Grail and King Arthur. They are unconscious transmitters, which, however, does not



at all diminish their value. Nevertheless, he leaves open the possibility that they were aware of what they were transmitting.

On the other hand, Guenon mentions Dante and the authors of the Romance of the Rose as conscious transmitters of esoteric doctrines.

Hiding the Bone The real meaning of an esoteric text is often hidden and “sometimes they hide it too well,” as Guenon says. He lists various techniques to hide the true meaning from those not ready for it:

There is a mixture of insignificant and incoherent elements ... obscurities and even contradictions may be perfectly intentional and seemingly pointless details may have the express purpose of leading astray the attention of the profane, just as a symbol can be hidden in a more or less complicated motif of ornamentation.

In other esoteric writings, those of Rabelais and Boccaccio, for example, humour and even sexual inuendo may be used to hide the true meaning.

Multivocal Meanings Symbols seldom have a univocal meaning, as there may be multiple interpretations. Guenon elaborates:

A consequence of this law of correspondence is the plurality of meanings contained in every symbol. Anything and everything can be regarded as representing not only the metaphysical principles, but also realities of all orders higher than its own ... These multiple and hierarchically superimposed symbolical meanings are not in any way mutually exclusive.

For the most part, we are interested in the metaphysical sense of the symbol, since it is the first and most important of all. That is because it is principal, i.e., based on metaphysical principles.

Posted on 2021-04-03 by Cologero

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Michael M on 2021-04-03 at 13:20 said:

"For the most part, we are interested in the metaphysical sense of the symbol, since it is the first and most important of all. That is because it is principal, i.e., based on metaphysical principles."

This is a representation of Being and its descent, everything really, it is a law of all. From the first principal that the symbol can point to, certain manifestations come out of such a process and then are represented in the symbol. Descending further man gazes upon symbols and gives it existence in Creation through his consciousness, his participation as a form of manifestation and action. Thus the whole great chain of Being is not only manifested, it is also thought of and adored and created perpetually.

"the Divine Artificer still longed for some creature which might comprehend the meaning of so vast an achievement, which might be moved with love at its beauty and smitten with awe at its grandeur."

So while the horizontal and vertical can seem at odds, especially with how the World is today, it is more accurate that Man chooses to descend, as much as he chooses to ascend. Let myself and let us all not throw away the myths and symbols, instead take them in a chew on them all the way to the marrow. The junk of modernity progresses only to death, instead of the bread of life.

"I will not walk with your progressive apes,
erect and sapient. Before them gapes
the dark abyss to which their progress tends
if by God's mercy progress ever ends,
and does not ceaselessly revolve the same
unfruitful course with changing of a name.
I will not treat your dusty path and flat,
denoting this and that by this and that,
your world immutable wherein no part
the little maker has with maker's art.
I bow not yet before the Iron Crown,
nor cast my own small golden sceptre down."

4.5 The True Myth

Art has been verified. God is the Lord, of angels, and of men—and of elves. Legend and history — one might say, myth and historical truth — have met and fused.

J R R TOLKIEN

The story of Christ is simply a true myth, both factual and suggestive of meanings beyond one's grasp. **C S Lewis** redacted

Perfect myth and perfect fact Myth has come to be almost synonymous with falsehood in many minds. Rather they are stories that reveal hidden meanings. When Tolkien convinced Lewis that Christianity was a “true myth”, the latter’s life mission was changed. Since they both loved the Norse myths, the close connection between their faith and the pagan myths inspired their works. Myths are neither didactic nor allegorical, and the meaning may not be clear. Lewis wrote:



In Pagan stories I was prepared to feel the myth as profound and suggestive of meanings beyond my grasp even tho’ I could not say in cold prose “what it meant.”

But historical facts alone provide no meaning; only very few events are worth retelling. Hence, “sacred history”, as Rene Guenon calls it, also has meanings not always easily accessible. Lewis continued:

The story of Christ is simply a true myth: a myth working on us in the same way as the others, but with this tremendous difference that it really happened: and one must be content to accept it in

the same way, remembering that it is God's myth where the others are men's myths: i.e. the Pagan stories are God expressing Himself through the minds of poets, using such images as He found there, while Christianity is God expressing Himself through what we call "real things", that is, real historical events.

So, for him, pagan stories about dying and resurrecting gods reinforced his faith, the opposite effect desired by debunkers. As he put it:

The resemblance between these myths and the Christian truth is no more accidental than the resemblance between the sun and the sun's reflection in a pond.

Reflections on the Psalms

Finally, he concludes:

The heart of Christianity is a myth which is also a fact. The old myth of the Dying God, *without ceasing to be myth*, comes down from the heaven of legend and imagination to the earth of history. It *happens*—at a particular date, in a particular place, followed by definable historical consequences. We pass from a Balder or an Osiris, dying nobody knows when or where, to a historical Person crucified *under Pontius Pilate*. By becoming fact it does not cease to be myth: that is the miracle. ... To be truly Christian we must both assent to the historical fact and also receive the myth with the same imaginative embrace which we accord to all myths. The one is hardly more necessary than the other.

Productions of the Psyche

Myths are first and foremost psychic phenomena that reveal the nature of the soul.

CARL JUNG

In opposite to the views of Lewis and Tolkien, there are the naturalizers like Joseph Campbell and Carl Jung. For them, myths are spontaneous eruptions in the collective unconscious of humankind. For proof:

The symbols of mythology are not manufactured; they cannot be ordered, invented, or permanently suppressed. They are spontaneous productions of the psyche.

JOSEPH CAMPBELL, *The Hero with a Thousand Faces*

Campbell doubles down on his thesis:

These mythological symbols stem from the psyche; they speak from and to the spirit. And they are in fact the vehicles of communication between the deeper depths of our spiritual life and this relatively thin layer of consciousness by which we govern our daylight existences.

Pathways to Bliss

The depths of the psyche are just the subconscious, which ipso facto cannot reach the spirit. Campbell and Jung do not distinguish the subconscious from the superconscious. The subconscious tries to democratize myths, which simple observation shows to be not only false, but absurd. On the other hand, the superconscious is open to the few, i.e., the sages, prophets, seers, poets, etc., who then introduce the myths into the community. Homer and Aeneas did not repeat productions of the unconscious psyche in the manner of ethnographers organizing folklore. Rather they are visionaries who introduce the myths into the collective consciousness.

Ultimately, Campbell's position is nihilistic. The psyche is natural and hence has no access to the supernatural; to assume so is simply arbitrary. The productions of the psyche do not reveal any higher truths; at best, they make life tolerable. Campbell concedes:

God is a metaphor for a mystery that absolutely transcends all human categories of thought, even the categories of being and non-being. Those are categories of thought. I mean it's as simple as that. So it depends on how much you want to think about it. Whether it's doing you any good. Whether it is putting you in touch with the mystery that's the ground of your own being. If it isn't, well, it's a lie. So half the people in the world are religious people who think that their metaphors are facts. Those are what we call theists. The other half are people who know that the metaphors are not facts. And so, they're lies. Those are the atheists.

The Law of Correspondence Rene Guenon agrees with Lewis and Tolkien about mythological symbols. Since they reveal higher levels of being, it is no surprise that the same symbols and myths repeat in different traditions, independent of each other. In agreement with traditional exegesis, Sacred Texts are to be interpreted on multiple levels, of which the literal or historical interpretation is just one of them. Since there are multiple levels of being, what happens on one level has a correspondence on the other levels. He explains:

The fact is that people too often tend to think that if a symbolical meaning is admitted, the literal or historical sense must be rejected; such a view can only result from unawareness of the **Law of Correspondence** which is the very foundation of all symbolism. By virtue of this law, each thing, proceeding as it does from a metaphysical principle from which it derives all its reality, translates or expresses that principle in its own fashion and in accordance with its own order of existence, so that from one order to

another all things are linked together and correspond in such a way as to contribute to the universal and total harmony, which, in the multiplicity of manifestation, can be likened to a reflection of the principia! unity itself.

Symbolism of the Cross

In that text, Guenon explicates the metaphysical and symbolic meaning of the Cross. Hence, we would expect that the historical life of Christ expresses such meanings. Guenon continues:

Historical facts likewise conform to the law of correspondence, and thereby, in their own mode, translate higher realities, of which they are a human expression. We would add that from our point of view, it is this that gives to these facts the greater part of their significance. This symbolical character, while common to all historical events, is bound to be particularly clear cut in the case of events connected with what may be called “sacred history”; thus it is recognizable in a most striking way, in all the circumstances of the life of Christ.

Finally, we see the convergence of Guenon, Lewis, and Tolkien, in Guenon’s words:

If the foregoing has been properly grasped, it will at once be apparent not only that there is no reason for denying the reality of these events and treating them as mere myths, but on the contrary that these events had to be such as they were, and could not have been otherwise; it is clearly impossible to attribute a sacred character to something devoid of all transcendent significance. In particular, if Christ died on the cross, it can be said that this was by reason of the symbolic value which the cross possesses in itself and which has always been recognized by all traditions; thus, without

diminishing in any way its historical significance, the latter may be regarded as directly derived from the symbolical significance that goes with it.

For further reference, see *Myth Became Fact*, by C S Lewis⁴.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TvnYs9FHaNk>

Posted on 2022-03-27 by Cologero

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Logres on 2022-03-29 at 16:14 said:

This was well worth reading, extremely good. Hilariously, I came across a “scholar’s” comments on Tolkien, fully illustrative of oblivion to what Guenon, Tolkien, Lewis, etc. would mean by “true myth”: “One would have thought that a scholar of Tolkien’s standing could not possibly have seen the Bible and the Greek myths as instances of fairy-tales. In his epilogue to “On Fairy-stories”, however, he actually writes, “The Gospels contain a fairy-story, or a story of a larger kind which embraces all the essence of fairy-stories”, and he even adds that they “contain many marvels” (155). It will not be necessary to elaborate on the lack of sensitivity for historical contexts and genre history in this statement.” (Dirk Vanderbeke). So, according to him, historical contexts and genre history trump any deeper inner meaning, or even (I would guess) any possibility thereof. If it’s true people can’t intellectualize their way to God, it’s often directly because intellectualizing cuts them off from their true being in this manner, so that you can never experience something you cannot at least suspect or tentatively conceptualize, like a “true Myth”, because you rule it out to begin with, due to bizarre concern over “genres”.

yeshua21 on 2022-03-30 at 10:16 said:

Clearly, a belief in the quasi-historical narratives can facilitate a realization of the spiritual realities to which they point and vice-versa. In by-gone days, the details of the narratives, literally construed– garden of Eden, virgin birth, empty tomb, threats of hell, hopes of paradise –were more widely believed (and believable) and it was reasonable to demand assent. But today, I would suggest– while such belief is still possible –it is generally counter-productive to insist on it. It is enough, it seems to me, to show respect for the tradition– to acknowledge that it is true on the inside, where it really counts –and to continue to teach it to our children.

⁴https://www.gornahoor.net/library/myth_became_fact.pdf

As I suggested awhile back, it would be nice if we could persuade those of an esoteric, gnostic bent to tolerate a more literal understanding and teaching of the tradition, while, at the same time, persuading the “literalists” to tolerate a more esoteric, metaphysical approach (one which acknowledges the function of mytho-poetic narratives and archetypal symbolism, regardless of their historicity). The two, together, could, as I see it, make a unified stand against “the coarse ignorance of the masses” and “the moral devastation of the upper classes” (cf. “Regenerating Humanity” Gornahoor).

<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=13222>

Personal Testimony: “In my mid-twenties— immediately after my father died —I began studying the Bible and praying with renewed intensity. But later on, I also began studying philosophy and biblical criticism and decided that I must abandon Christianity in any form since, 1) the doctrine of hell seemed inconsistent with the putative goodness and sovereignty of God; 2) the conflict between the flesh and the spirit seemed practically insurmountable; 3) historical biblical criticism seemed to undermine the veracity and authority of scripture; and 4) Nietzsche’s claims— that Christianity is false, life-denying, and morally hazardous —seemed disturbingly plausible. But over time, I realized that I was not really at peace with that decision. As a result, when I went to graduate school, I chose a Catholic university and decided, at some point, to put my critical questions on the back burner as I resumed my pursuit of God (without insisting on knowing the end from the beginning). I concluded that whether or not the biblical narratives are really historical— and whether or not the doctrines associated with them are entirely coherent —they may still point (in some symbolic or mystical way) to an eternal, living reality that is both accessible and salvific, here and now.”

<https://jwayneferguson.wordpress.com/christian-visions/my-faith-in-christ/>

4.6 The Elite and the Gospels

From Pythagoras to Virgil to Dante, the chain of Tradition was never lost on Italian Soil.

RENE GUENON

Professor Robyn Faith Walsh⁵ wrote an intriguing book asserting that the Gospels were written, not by members of the religious communities,

⁵<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XYqghYtia6k>

but rather by a Greco-Roman cultural and intellectual class. She makes a good case, but does not understand the actual role of such an elite class. So that topic is well worth exploring.

The “elite” does not refer to the ruling or oligarchic classes, who are content to maintain the public cult, but rather to a class with sufficient education and resources to compose complex symbolic texts. Hence, she bases her thesis on those two factors.

Resources The first point is that knowledge requires physical resources. Access to writing materials like ink, parchment, papyrus was costly. Writing books by hand must have been a tedious process. If you look at the sizes of ancient texts, you have to marvel at the effort involved. How were thoughts organized? How were corrections made? And so on. Only a class that had the wherewithal to purchase such materials and the leisure time, could possibly have written those texts. Such a class had to be small in number.

Intellectual Training Secondly, knowledge requires access to teachings. The intellectual elite had access to resources, and they probably studied at the Academy or various mystery schools. They had the ability to write well, which illiterate fishermen did not. The intellectual elite would have been trained in the liberal arts and therefore understood grammar, rhetoric, and logic.

The professor does not make clear why that class bothered with the effort, so here is where we must depart from her thesis. Today’s academic outlook is buried in historical consciousness and thus is limited by the “superstition of facts”. Such a worldview does not take into account that historical events are reflections of spiritual realities. The intellectual elite that she is describing is actually an esoteric elite. Their purpose, therefore, was to take the bare facts of the Gospel narratives and reveal their deeper symbolic meaning.

Historical Meaning Rene Guenon, in *The Symbolism of the Cross*, explains the how that would work. First of all, he makes the point that the symbolic meaning has been largely forgotten.

Christianity, at any rate in its outward and generally known aspect, seems to have somewhat lost sight of the symbolic character of the cross and come to regard it as no longer anything but the sign of a historical event. Actually, these two viewpoints are in no wise mutually exclusive; indeed the second is in a sense a consequence of the first; but this way of looking at things is so strange to the great majority of people today that it deserves dwelling on for a moment in order to avoid possible misunderstandings.

The Symbolism of the Cross

The Symbolic Meaning The elite understand the law of correspondence. Therefore, they superadded the symbolic meaning of the events.

The fact is that people too often tend to think that if a symbolic meaning is admitted, the literal or historical sense must be rejected; such a view can only result from unawareness of the law of correspondence which is the very foundation of all symbolism. By virtue of this law, each thing, proceeding as it does from a metaphysical principle from which it derives all its reality, translates or expresses that principle in its own fashion and in accordance with its own order of existence, so that from one order to another all things are linked together and correspond in such a way as to contribute to the universal and total harmony, which, in the multiplicity of manifestation can be likened to a reflection of the principal unity itself.

The Symbolism of the Cross

We can interject here that throughout history, there have often been conflicts between the dogmatists and the esoterists. Dogmatists fear that symbolic interpretations denigrate the historical record. And faux esoterists mistakenly believe that the “symbolic” meaning is the only true one, so that the historical meaning can be left behind. Rather, meaning must be grasped on multiple levels, from the physical to the soul, and to the spiritual levels. Only then can one understand the great unity of existence, with each level having its proper place in the whole.

Symbolism and the Superconscious Since psychoanalysis has been attempting to unravel the mysteries of the subconscious, spiritual symbols have, in our day, been mistakenly identified with eruptions of unconscious events into ordinary consciousness. This technique is particularly associated with Jungian analysis. It is certainly not obvious that esoteric knowledge is hidden away in some collective unconscious, accessible to all.

The best that such an approach can achieve is a psychological interpretation of symbols, which is gruel, not hearty food for the soul. But if you want millions of youtube likes, it seems to be a popular approach.

Jung failed to distinguish between the subconscious and the superconscious. The latter refers to realities that transcend the human state and are certainly hidden from most people. The subconscious, on the other hand, is accessible to everyone, including the insane. Special training in concentration and the purification of the soul is necessary to gain conscious access to the transcendent states.

The elite writers of the Gospels would have deliberately included the transcendent meaning in the text.

Gospel of John

there are also many other things which Jesus did; which, if they were written every one, the world itself, I think, would not be able

to contain the books that should be written.

JOHN 21:25

Although the professor refers to the synoptic Gospels, that is because John and Paul can be considered to be representatives of the elite she is describing. They are comfortable expressing themselves in metaphysical ideas. So we can justifiably use John's Gospel as an example.

Assume that John is correct and that it would take perhaps thousands of books to record the entire chronicle of Jesus's life on earth. Then why did John mention just seven of those thousands of miracles? Clearly, it is because those seven miracles have a special significance.

Posted on 2022-06-19 by Cologero

* * *

Jupiter on 2022-06-20 at 14:12 said:
Condescending

Cologero on 2022-06-20 at 16:50 said:
Au contraire, Grasshopper. We are grateful for all the Apostles, Prophets, Saints, Fathers, Sages, Mystics, etc., who have organized, preserved, and made the material available to us.

The Imaginal Realm

5.1 The Dawn of the Gods

We all know about the Twilight of the Gods and how they have abandoned us, but few dare to ask where they came from in the first place.

Auguste Comte proposed that humanity has progressed from belief in polytheism to monotheism, then to an all embracing metaphysical or ideological principle, and finally to positivism. While the sequence may be somewhat correct, it represents not progress, but rather a fall. There is a primordial consciousness of unity, inwardly united with the divine Logos. The role of the human being is to bring this unity into factual realization in nature, or manifestation. As such, the human being is divided, with the consciousness of unity that unites him with God, and a material existence that unites him with the natural world.

By rebelling against the divine principle, human beings fall under the power of the material principle. The Logos was once the center of consciousness, but afterwards is experienced as an external law and hence a burden. Enthralled by the material world, he loses his center and becomes

just another entity in nature. Initially, he experiences this disunity in consciousness and the idea of multiple gods, or polytheism arises. Rather than seeking unity back at the source, he looks outside himself and creates various philosophical and ideological systems based on an external principle, be it matter, thought, evolution, genetics, race, and so on. Still dissatisfied, he thinks that the facts and the laws explaining these facts will suffice. But not accumulation of facts or theories about nature can recover the lost unity.

In this passage, **Vladimir Solovyov** describes how the gods arise in the cosmogonic process:

For consciousness that has lost the inner unity of the all in the divine Spirit, the only external unity that becomes accessible is that produced by the cosmic action of the divine Logos upon the world soul, which is the matter of the cosmic process. The consciousness of humanity seeks to reproduce in itself those determinate forms of unity that had already been generated by the cosmogonic process in material nature. The unifying forces of material nature (the offspring of the Demiurge and the world soul *Anima Mundi*) appear now in consciousness as principles that determine it and give it content. These forces gradually manifest themselves and reign in consciousness as lords not only of the external world but even of consciousness itself, as genuine gods. Thus, this new process is, first of all, a theogonic process. This does not mean, of course, that these dominant principles were created in this very process, nor does it mean that humanity invented its own *gods*. We know that these principles existed prior to humanity as cosmic forces.

In that capacity, however they were not gods, for there are no gods without worshippers. They become gods only for the human consciousness that recognizes them to be such, after it has fallen under their dominion as the result of its separation from the one divine center.

Posted on 2010-04-20 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2010-04-23 at 22:47 said:

If by polytheism, one means the absolute and irreducible plurality of principles, that is no part of any Traditional teaching.

Polytheism is not the denial of monotheism, but rather the polymorphous manifestation of the Divine unity. That manifestation takes the form of a celestial hierarchy, which is experienced as various cosmic forces. When they become objects of worship, they are called gods. Of course, then, there are gods for all aspects of life, starting from the national gods which give identity to a tribe, nation, or race.

However, all these forces are ultimately ordered by the Logos.

Therefore, polytheism is inconsistent and ultimately incoherent. Polytheists claim that they are most open to and tolerant of foreign deities due to their doctrine. However, they cannot be tolerant of monotheism, since that would destroy the whole basis of their beliefs.

On the other hand, monotheism is consistent with polytheism, properly understood. Of course, it rejects the “worship” of these cosmic forces, but not their reality or importance. It is only unorthodox and non-Traditional deviations of monotheism that fail to understand this.

5.2 Old men shall dream dreams

And it will come to pass after these things that I will pour out
My spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall
prophesy, your old men shall dream dreams and your young men
shall see visions.

JOEL 2:28

Mundus Imaginalis The visionary **Emmanuel Swedenborg** recognized three modes of being in the world in respect to the ability to recognize spiritual reality. These certainly seem equivalent to the traditional distinction of pneumatic, psychic, and hylic persons.

- **Celestial humanity:** sees that everything in the natural world, which is seen by natural sight, corresponds with a higher, celestial reality.
- **Spiritual humanity:** lost that ability, yet retains a vague memory, or perhaps merely a belief, in immaterial reality.
- **Material humanity:** can only see external things in the world.

Henry Corbin calls the higher spiritual knowledge of celestial humanity “Hierognosis”. This gnosis is of the *Mundus Imaginalis*, the “imaginal world” (NOT “imaginary”). He explains its ontological position:

The existence of this intermediate world, *mundus imaginalis*, thus appears metaphysically necessary; the cognitive function of the Imagination is ordered to it; it is a world whose ontological level is above the world of the senses and below the pure intelligible world; it is more immaterial than the former and less immaterial than the latter.

This *mundus imaginalis* is the analogical world described by **Hermes Trismegistus** in the *Emerald Tablet*:

Quod superius est sicut quod inferius et quod inferius est sicut quod est superius, ad perpetranda miracula rei unius. That which is above is like to that which is below, and that which is below is like to that which is above, to accomplish the miracles of the one thing.

Analogy expresses the correspondence between the celestial prototype and its manifestation below. The 8 petalled lotus at the crown is our connection to the spiritual world, whether to other spirits, angels, or even the Holy Spirit. The 10 petalled lotus of the solar plexus area is the seat of imaginative revelation, whether they come as visions, dreams, or direct message. The latter is inspiritive revelation, descending even as far as the womb.

Mary had a visit, fully conscious, from the angel Gabriel, and was inspired by the Holy Spirit to sing the Song of Praise.

Joseph was visited by an angel in a dream.

The **Shepherds** had visions of the shining glory of God and angels.

Dreams There are 21 dreams recorded in the Bible, so they are not easily dismissed as sources of insight or revelation. The writings of the Fathers in the Philokalia offer some comments about dreams.

For example, **St Diadochos of Photiki** has this advice:



Figure 5.1: Elijah's Dream

The dreams which appear to the soul through God's love are unerring criteria of its health. Such dreams do not change from one shape to another; they do not shock our inward sense, resound with laughter or suddenly become threatening. But with great gentleness they approach the soul and fill it with spiritual gladness. As a result, even after the body has woken up, the soul longs to recapture the joy given to it by the dream.

There are, however, times when even good dreams do not bring joy to the soul, but produce in it a sweet sadness and tears unaccompanied by grief. But this happens only to those who are far advanced in humility.

Demonic dreams have a different feel:

Demonic fantasies, however, are just the opposite: they do not keep the same shape or maintain a constant form for long. For what the demons do not possess as their chosen mode of life, but merely assume because of their inherent deceitfulness, is not able to satisfy them for very long.

Diadochos recommends that beginners not pay much attention to dreams:

In our quest for purity the safest rule is never to trust to anything that appears to us in our dreams. For dreams are generally nothing more than images reflecting our wandering thoughts, or else they are the mockery of demons.

While that is true of most dreams which are forgettable, it seems extreme to ignore true revelations. Those are gifts. And one should be particularly attentive to recurring themes in dreams. Even if they don't reveal anything supernatural, they provide insights into our own psyche. Moreover, even the mockery of demons can help us to recognize our impurities and vulnerabilities. Diadochos admits as much:

the intellect, when pure, sometimes even feels joy at having been able to see through their tricks [of demons]; indeed it often challenges them during the dream itself and thus provokes them to great anger.

Nikitas Stithatos also has a warning:

Those who have attained spiritual maturity can also analyze the impulses and proclivities of the soul, and can guide and guard their inner state, on the basis of dreams. For bodily impulses and the images in our intellect depend upon our inner disposition and preoccupations. If your soul hankers after pleasure and material things, you will dream about acquiring possessions and having money, about the female figure and sexual intercourse – all of which leads to the soiling and defilement of soul and body.

Therefore, if you have such soul defiling dreams, they are not necessarily demonic. Rather Holy Spirit convicts the believer of sin through such dreams. Therefore, they are gifts that remind us of our shortcomings and where we need improvement. They we may reach the next stage:

Things seen in sleep are true and imprinted on the spiritual intellect in the case, not of everyone, but only of those whose intellect is purified, who have cleansed the soul's organs of perception and who are advancing toward the contemplation of the inner essences of created things. Such people do not worry about day-to-day matters, nor are they troubled about this present life.

St Antony the Great has a deeper understanding of dreams.

Man alone is capable of communion with God. For to man alone among the living creatures does God speak: at night through dreams, by day through the intellect. And He uses every means to foretell and prefigure the future blessings that will be given to those worthy of Him.

The revelation of night is esoteric, revelation by day is exoteric.

Visions

Where there is no prophetic vision the people cast off restraint

PROVERBS 29:18

I saw in the night visions, and behold, with the clouds of heaven there came one like a son of man, and he came to the Ancient of Days and was presented before him.

DANIEL 7:13

And the Lord said to Paul one night in a vision, Do not be afraid,
but go on speaking and do not be silent

ACTS 18:9

There are more than 100 references to visions in the Bible, not least of which is Ezekiel's vision and the entirety of Revelation. Nikitas Stithatos offers these comments about visions and the spiritual life:

Visions are constant; the one does not change into another, but they remain imprinted upon the intellect unforgettably for many years. Those that disclose the upshot of things to come, and assist the soul by inspiring it with compunction and the sight of fearful wonders, make the beholder reflective and strike him with awe on account of their constancy and their fearsome nature. Hence they are treated with great seriousness by those skilled in spiritual matters. Revelations occur when the purified and illumined soul is able to contemplate in a way that transcends normal sense-perception. They have the force of things and thoughts miraculous and divine, initiating us into the hidden mysteries of God, showing us the outcome of our most important problems and the universal transformation of things worldly and human.

Vladimir Solovyov documented his three visions of Sophia. He describes them this way:

Visions are involuntary visual images and pictures, received while awake, that produce a more or less complete impression of objective reality, but which do not have any external material substance. Visions arise and are maintained regardless of a subject's own conscious acts, and therefore seem to him like external reality.

Solovyov regarded Jacob Boehme and Swedenborg as the fullest and highest theosophical expression of the old Christianity. However, their

world conception was static and ignored the world process. Solovyov's vision led to an understanding of the world process, although he regarded Friedrich Schelling as his predecessor. Schelling himself was influenced by Boehme and Swedenborg.

E F Schumacher in *A Guide to the Perplexed* uses the visionaries **Jakob Lorber** and **Edgar Cayce** as examples of the second field of knowledge: the Inner Life.

Sources **Henry Corbin**, *Swedenborg and Esoteric Islam*

Judith Kornblatt and **Vladimir Solovyov**, *Divine Sophia*

Swedenborg by Vladimir Solovyov: <https://www.gornahoor.net/library/SwedenborgByVladimirSolovyov.pdf>

The *Philokalia*

E F Schumacher, *A Guide to the Perplexed*

Every dream in the Bible: <https://overviewbible.com/infographic-dreams-bible/>

100 Bible verses about visions: <https://www.openbible.info/topics/vision>

Posted on 2020-10-25 by Cologero

5.3 The Mystery of Sleep

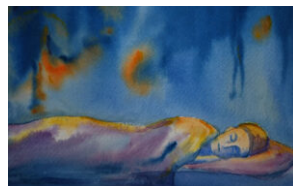
Sleep is not the mystery because it is the normal state of nature. The real mystery is awakening.

The end of a world never is and never can be anything but the end of an illusion.

RENE GUENON

The world ended in 2012, right on schedule, or at least one illusion ended and was replaced by another. The agents of “progress” and “evolution”, who claim to be the most intelligent and morally superior beings in the history of the world, have announced it is their world now. In truth, who is there to oppose or refute them?

So ending an illusion is not necessarily the same as waking up, but more likely the replacement of one illusion with a more sophisticated one. This is especially true of intelligent or educated people — meant in the conventional sense — because the complex intellectual schemes they adopt to maintain their illusions can be threatened by new facts or ideas. Hence, the scheme must expand, or else their illusion is shattered.



The obvious question may be, “why is there illusion in the first place?” More specifically, if the modern world is the result of a group illusion, then why is it so strongly maintained? This presumes that the modern world is abhorrent to all, when that is hardly true. It is nearly universally desired, in one form or another. There is an attachment to the world that is not easily broken. I recall watching a science show on the “Mystery of Sleep”. However, sleep is not the mystery, since it is the normal state of nature. The real mystery is awakening and that is what science cannot explain. We esoterists, moreover, understand that there are many degrees of awakening and that they are not easily achieved. They are certainly not natural.

To understand the hold of sleep, we will draw upon some ideas of **Rene Guenon** and **Julius Evola**. Recall what the latter said in *The Individual and the Becoming of the World*¹ of three broad stages in the processes of awakening:

¹<https://www.amazon.com/dp/0999086049>

1. The person is passive in the face of spiritual forces and is unconscious of their effect.
2. The person begins to question things, turning to various scientific, religious, or philosophical systems.
3. The person awakens to his conscious self.

The greatest majority of people live predominantly at the first stage. Their energy is consumed in their daily tasks of caring for their own and their family's needs, working, playing, loving, socializing, and so on. Although there are a significant number of people who fail in these tasks to a greater or lesser extent, or societies in a state of turmoil in which such tasks are nearly impossible, most people do fairly well. Some even "break the bank", as it were, achieving huge levels of worldly success in life. The latter groups have an emotional and material stake in the world as it is. To end an illusion is to end the world they have adapted themselves to; hence, "waking up" is understood as a threat to their well-being and any attempts to challenge their worldview are strongly resisted.

In *The Spiritist Fallacy*, Rene Guenon analyzes the experiences of séances and alleged communication with the dead. Although he does not deny the phenomena themselves, his understanding of them is completely different from those of the spiritualists. He points out that such "communications" are clearer in groups that have been together often. He claims:

The real source of these 'communications' is to be found in the 'subconscious' of the medium and of the others present ... we see the actualization of a kind of 'composite image' to which each one contributes certain traits, a fusion being effected between the productions of the subconscious minds of diverse individuals. Of course we do not exclude the possibility of action by extraneous influences, but generally these influences must be consonant with

the tendencies of the groups where they are manifested. In fact, it is necessary that they be attracted by certain affinities.

Since what Guenon describes here has nothing to do with actual communications with the dead, the same principle can be applied on a larger scale. That is, the collective activity of the subconscious minds of groups of people, who have certain affinities with each other, can then produce an effect that is powerful and seems to have its origination outside of them. Clearly, it would be quite difficult to convince them that their experience is nothing more than a group delusion.

Yet, it accounts for why certain groups within a larger society have such common opinions. Whenever a new socio-political issue comes up, these people adopt the same viewpoint almost on cue. This has always amazed me. At a minimum, it points out that such opinions have been adopted with virtually no deliberate forethought.

Guenon points out another interesting fact. Different groups of spiritualists seldom agree as they come up with different, and often contradictory, experiences and interpretations. Were the phenomena truly objective, we wouldn't expect to see that happening. Hence, in society at large, we see different segments of the population adopting various schemata of opinions. These follow a spectrum from close agreement with variations on a theme to total opposition. So there arise various political programs, and subgroups within a larger group, different religious theories, and so on, based on personal or social affinities and unconscious group thinking. Advertisers and those who study the psychology of crowds are aware of these groups, even if they do not understand them fully. Some become adept at manipulating them by inserting new influences. Guenon calls these "wandering influences", although this encompasses a far wider range of influences, including those of a supernatural, and even demonic, character.

There is much more to explore regarding the wandering influences. There are also the spiritual influences associated with various ethnicities.

More interesting are the delusions of scientific and religious systems, especially since they claim to offer a way out of delusions. These topics will be part of future discussions.

Posted on 2012-12-27 by Cologero

* * *

Wanderer on 2012-12-30 at 20:01 said:

"There are also the spiritual influences associated with various ethnicities."

Yes, given the turmoil of recent centuries, a strange broth has formed in the intermediate realm, and it is quite profitable to discern the mélange of influences that tend to attach to men of various races when one interacts with them in the world. Your observations on these matters are welcomed with interest.

The same 'inner silence' necessary for such explorations is perhaps the signature weapon of the elite.

From what I have seen, social, scientific and religious delusions appear to be dependent on a person who is firmly grounded in level 1 of the schema of awakening, such that he is oblivious to the action of subtle influences; this renders him liable to suffer an active breach made by tendentious influences that rely on the victim never noticing the coup, and not feeling these influences to contradict his own native subtle form, to such an extent that the victim will gladly participate in undermining his own being.

Cologero on 2013-01-02 at 00:48 said:

Well put, Wanderer. Yet Guenon insists that we must also go back historically to understand what he calls the "formidable mental deviation that characterizes the modern West." He explains:

"one must go much further back in order to grasp the origins and causes of the deviation, then to follow its course with its multiple phases. That is an immense task, no part of which has been done."

That has been the motivation of some of the studies of modern philosophers such as Bacon and Hobbes that we have done here. We can see how subtle changes in thought lead to profound historical effects. These changes are made to sound benevolent and indicative of "progress". So we need to understand and expose the "directing will" that influences those at level 1.

5.4 The Soul after Death

It is little known, even to many Orthodox, that there is a theology of postmortem states that rivals in detail the *Tibetan Book of the Dead*². Moreover, the Orthodox teaching is practical and based on experiences, not idle speculation. **Fr. Seraphim Rose** authored a book by the title *The Soul after Death* that gathered these teachings, while relating them to contemporary descriptions of near-death experiences, out-of-body experiences, not to mention the tales of Emmanuel Swedenborg and even the *Tibetan Book of the Dead*.

Although Fr. Rose is said to have been influenced by Rene Guenon at one point in his life, precious little of that shows through in this book, even when discussing the spirits, a topic to which Guenon dedicated a book-length treatment. There is possibly a faint echo when Fr. Rose decided not to use the *Egyptian Book of the Dead* because there is not a living tradition to explain its symbolism. That is unfortunate, since some basic metaphysics would have made some difficult points clearer. So before reviewing the book, it may be useful lay the groundwork.

The Psychic Realm The experiences Fr. Rose describes belong to the psychic realm, that is, soul experiences, between the material world and the spirit, properly speaking. This is the realm of images, visions, feelings, and so on. In other words, it is that part of our experience that cannot be explained by the five senses. Guenon and Fr Rose take it for granted that such a realm exists and pace the materialists, it is independent and not reducible to physics.

On the other hand, it is not the “spirit”, either, although moderns, following Descartes, tend to classify everything that is not material as spiritual. The spirit is transcendent, not only to the material world, but also to the psychic world. But is this psychic realm totally subjective or is

²See Section 5.5 in this book.

there an objective reality to it, i.e., something that is not-I, yet participates in “my” psychic or soul experiences.

The Dream World Since we all have had experiences of dreams, it will be beneficial to analyze them first. Guenon explains that a dream is a creation of the I, which creates all the characters, places, and events; or put another way, it could be the projection onto the undifferentiated state of deep sleep. If post-mortem experiences are “like” these, we can ask the question of exactly where they occur.

This is the same as asking where a thought occurs. Thoughts have a temporal component, since we think one thought after another, which can all be related sequentially. However, there is no “where”; i.e., one thought is not to the left of another, or across from it, etc. Yet, images in a dream do have a spatial aspect; in the dream, we “go places”, there is different scenery for different places, and so on. Furthermore, since we “see” things, that brings up the question of a “body”; do the figures in a dream have an “astral body” that we then “see”?

Space and time are strange in that they are not metaphysical principles, yet they are not objects of sensory experience. That is why we can speak of God being beyond time and space. However, they are required in order to even have sensual experiences. Specifically, for example, I can see a tree or a desk among all the objects that are not those things; but I don’t see space one place and not-space somewhere else. Space and time, then, are conditions of manifestation but not the principle of manifestation.

Now Guenon tells us that space and time may be quite different experiences in different states of being. In a dream, space can be traversed instantly just by thinking of or visualizing something else. Curiously, space is different in a dream, but time seems to be related to our earth time.

Knowing and Seeing Another issue to explore is to be clear about how we “know” something. According to metaphysical teachings, there are three ways: subject-object perceptions or sensations, discursive thought, and non-dual intuition. When I “see” something, how do I know what it is? It the hoary example, the sage and the ignorant man both have the experience of something in the grass. The latter is startled, since he sees a snake, but the sage is calm because he knows it is a rope. The ignorant man is projecting onto his experience, whereas the sage is intuiting the real nature of the thing. It is naïve realism to assume that we know what something is, just by looking at it. No, the external thing and our sensation are united in the intuition of the idea. That is why it is said that to know and to be are identical. When I see a squirrel, for example, I have the idea, or form, of it in my mind. To that extent I am a squirrel, although just in form, not in matter.

So that leads to a conundrum. When I experience a being in the psychic realm, how do I recognize it for what it is? With intelligent beings, this gets tricky. For example, if I see two men, one holding a gun pointed at the other, exactly what am I seeing? Is it a mugger accosting a tourist? An FBI agent capturing a criminal? A scene from a movie being filmed? Here the senses are clearly lacking and I need to understand the interiority of the other beings in order to grasp the full nature of the situation.

This will come up in Fr. Rose’s discussions. In an out-of-the-body experience, how do I really know what I am experiencing? That is why Tradition is so important. The Tibetans prepare the dying one to understand what he will be experiencing in the days after death. Likewise, Fr. Rose is offering the same type of preparation.

Psychic Experience Around the beginning of the 20th century, the attempt to prove life after death in a scientific way was being taken seriously. This attracted men of exceptional intelligence and erudition, including William James and Carl Jung. Of course, those they depended on were

of lesser accomplishment, as Rene Guenon amply documented in his book *The Spiritist Fallacy*. Fr. Rose does not mention Guenon's book, although he dealt with the topic.

This brings up the notion of "scientific proof" which is different from just seeing. For example, from just looking, it appears that the earth is still and the sun is in motion. Yet that is not a scientific conclusion. Now, there may be cases where looking suffices. The existence of a black swan can be shown simply enough, but finding such a bird. We know what a swan is and what black is; the opinion of the swan is irrelevant.

The situation is not the same in regards to a dead soul. Usually, there is nothing more than a medium and her claim to be communicating with the spirit of a dead human, or perhaps a discarnate higher being. I have had the occasion more than once to witness a medium communicate with such a spirit. She was a pretty Swiss woman who would enter the trance state, close her eyes, alter her voice, and then ramble on for an hour or more in florid prose. I recommend it for its soporific properties.

Sometimes the spirits affect material things through rappings or breaking things. Guenon denies that discarnate spirits can affect physical objects, so I'll accept that for now. Sometimes they may make an appearance, but that is hardly a proof of anything. What does it mean for a spirit to "appear"? A non-material being cannot be experienced through the senses. Thus, it can never be as conclusive as finding the black swan.

So ultimately the only proof there is of the identity of such a being is his own claim. Fr. Rose then shows how to understand what is really going on based on the Traditional teachings of the Eastern Empire.

Out of Body Experiences Fr. Rose begins by discussing certain phenomena that have been gaining currency. These are near death experiences and deliberately induced out-of-body experiences. Although these reports are not new, they seem to be, probably because of the improvements in medical technology that have made it possible to resuscitate

patients who were nearly dead. Fr. Rose summarizes such near death experiences. The person seems to have left his body while retaining consciousness of events around his body. Fr. Rose provides many such examples, whose veracity he does not deny, when he concludes:

None of this should sound very strange to an Orthodox Christian; the experience here described is what Christians know as the separation of the soul from the body at the moment of death.

To make his point, he quotes similar experiences from Orthodox sources. He then makes use of the cross-cultural study, using data from the USA and India. What is common is the apparition of dead relatives and friend, although in India there are also apparitions of Hindu gods around the time of death. Fr. Rose again makes the point that such studies are startling to the modern mind, but not at all to the Orthodox Christian. Interestingly, he quotes **Pope Gregory the Great**, who wrote extensively on this topic. Although Pope Gregory was quite influential in the Medieval west, this aspect of his teaching has not been effectively transmitted. He explains:

It frequently happens that a soul on the part of death recognizes those with whom it is to share the same eternal dwelling for equal blame or reward. . . . It often happens that the saints of heaven appear to the righteous at the hour of death in order to reassure them. And, with the vision of the heavenly company before their minds, they die without experiencing any fear or agony.

Fr. Rose draws attention to what this really means. At the time of death, ordinary sinners recognize people, but the saints of heaven appear to the righteous. That is because deceased sinners have no contact with the living, save in exceptional circumstances, but the saints actively intercede for the living.

We also have the authority of St. Augustine who asserts that the souls of the dead are in a place where they do not see the things which go on and transpire in this mortal life. I know this is contrary to the sentimental feelings of people today that their deceased relatives are somehow watching over them. It is not so simple, as there may be apparent manifestations of the dead, through the workings of the devil, as well as true manifestations of the saints through the workings of the angels.

There are two other experiences to draw attention to. One is the contact with the "Being of Light", which rapidly increases in brightness. Since it is formless, it is described in different ways since the person will project his own interpretation onto it. Note that the *Tibetan Book of the Dead* describes the same experience.

The other one is the feeling of peacefulness that is experienced. This is accounted as the normal sensation of the soul separating from the body. Since the body is so heavy and tends to dominate the life of the soul, it should not be surprising to have that feeling of release. Since in most of these cases the person has been sick or physically hurt, it makes sense that the separation from such pains and agonies would bring such relief. However, such natural phenomena do not necessarily reflect a supernatural cause.

Angels In discussing angels, Fr. Rose makes an important point about the damaging influence of Descartes, who regarded everything that is not "matter" to be "spirit". This would be the angels on the same level as God, since they are all spirit. This is a warning that everything spiritual is not the same, and may not even be good. Thus the demonic, the angelic, even human imagination are not material, yet are quite different. Hence, we understand the angelic orders as consisting of purely spiritual beings, i.e., they are beings but without a material form. This agrees with Guenon and Thomas Aquinas.

Yet, scripture and tradition say that angels can be "seen", typically as

"arrayed in white". To speak of their form is a metaphor and "they have need to be clothed in a subtle body whenever God permits them to act on bodies," and that "when God opens the spiritual eyes of a man, he is capable of seeing spirits in their own form." Nevertheless, Fr. Rose goes to great lengths to make it clear that angels "look like" men. In support, he quotes St. Augustine, who said that the soul after death experiences himself as a body. Well, this makes some sense since the soul is indeed the "form" of the body.

In my opinion, one can go too far in that direction of assuming our only experience of angels (or demons) is in the outward form of a man. It encourages a craving for the unusual and the spectacular. Actually, our experience of such beings is through our intellect, since they are themselves pure intellect. That is, they will come as thoughts, or a constellation of ideas, an inspiration, or a temptation. It behooves us to pay close attention to our thoughts and how they affect us. We exist truly in a vast noosphere, although in more depth and complexity than its merely humanized form described by Teilhard de Chardin. Some, then, may even experience these thoughts as real beings.

That leads Fr. Rose to the teaching of the two angels, one of whom is the guardian angel, who meet the soul at the hour of his death. Of course, Fr. Rose backs this all up with extensive examples from tradition and the experiences of sinners and saints alike. Since it was established that the soul has a human form, these angels grasp the soul's subtle body to lead him on his journey into the afterlife.

Hence, Fr. Rose dismisses the common experience of a formless being of light in near death experiences, suspecting that it is most likely satanic. He relates some stories of sinners on their deathbeds who experience great horrors, in a manner reminiscent of the *Tibetan Book of the Dead*. Fr. Rose makes an interesting point about the experience of Americans who seldom report such experiences. He attributes it to the unjustified optimism of Americans or the Protestant presumption that

they are “saved”. In these cases, the temptation is more like a seduction than terror. That is why the spirits must be “tested”.

Spirits of the Air Fr. Rose describes man in the primordial state: his body was immortal, without infirmities, unbothered by heaviness or sinful and fleshly feelings. His senses are most subtle and totally free. Man was capable of the sensuous perception of spirits.

Man’s soul and body were changed after the fall. The soul separated from the body, which is the definition of death. The body was subject to infirmities and subject to hostile influences. The body became like the bodies of the beasts. Where, previously, man was in communion with the angels, he is now more comfortable with the fallen spirits.

Fr. Rose points out that demons usually assume the appearance of bright angels in order to deceive men, typically by mixing truth with error. Of course, we would say they appear as lovely thoughts, thoughts that claim to be compassionate or progressive. They make the hearer “feel good about himself”, or superior. Fr. Rose warns about engaging such spirits in conversation when they appear in human form. However, as this is quite unlikely, my opinion is that he should have spent more time on revealing how those spirits infiltrate the mind. He does quote **Bishop Ignatius** in this regard:

The fallen spirits act on men, bringing them sinful thoughts and feelings; but very few men attain to the sensuous perception of spirits.

We find ourselves in the realm of fallen spirits, surrounded by them, enslaved by them. Having no possibility to break in on us, they make themselves known to us from outside, causing various sinful thoughts and fantasies.

It is interesting that Fr. Rose places the demons in the “air”. In the

Hermetic diagram of the spiritual hierarchy³, the air is the lowest level of subtle beings. The density of these fallen spirits in the air acts to block access to all the superior levels.

Tollhouses Finally, Fr. Rose brings us to the teaching of the toll houses. Again, there is a warning to avoid picturing the tollhouses in crude sensuous imagery, but to understand them in a spiritual sense. This does not mean that the tollhouses are not real, but rather that the experience of time and space in that realm is different from that of the physical world. The debate about whether the souls “sees” these images or finds it necessary to “express” them in sensual terms is moot. The important thing is that the experience itself is real.

Although I am not bringing in all the details in this review, Fr. Rose backs up his account through the teachings of the major theologians. Christians, he points out, need to keep the fact of death always in mind; in this, they are like the Buddhists and even others. **St. Isaiah the Recluse** writes:

Christians should daily have death before our eyes and take care how to accomplish the departure from the body and how to pass by the powers of darkness who are to meet us in the air.

There are other eerie similarities to the *Tibetan Book of the Dead*, which gives credence to the idea that this teaching is based on actual experience and not mere dogma. For example, **St. Cyril** writes:

What fear and trembling await you, O soul, in the day of death! You will see frightful, wild, cruel, unmerciful and shameful demons, like dark Ethiopians, standing before you. The very sight of them is worse than any torment. The soul, seeing them, becomes agitated, is disturbed, troubled, seeks to hid, hastens to the angels of God.

³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1941>

I cannot go into the complete teaching here, but can only briefly summarize it. The soul is guided by the tow angels past a series of up to twenty tollhouses. Each one is dedicated to a different test, and the demons test the soul in regard to the particular tollhouse. That is, they will point out how the soul was guilty of a particular sin at any point in this life. The guiding angels then would point out his repentance or good acts that outweighed those sins. If the soul passes the test, it moves on to the next tollhouse; otherwise, the guiding angels abandon him to the demons.

Once again, it needs to be emphasized that these tests are to be understood in a spiritual, not material, sense. I would also be remiss if I didn't point out that this is something you can try at home without waiting for death and the tollhouse tests. As a matter of fact, if you have the fact of your death always in mind, you would make it a high priority.

The fact of death is certain, the time of death is unknown.

Posted on 2013-04-11 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2020-09-27 at 16:14 said:
From Multiple States:

The difficulty of this transposition or this passage from the manifested to the non-manifested, and the apparent obscurity that results) is the same as is encountered in trying to express, in the measure that they are expressible, the relations between time (or more generally duration in all its modes, that is to say, the whole condition of successive existence) and eternity.

So, yes, it is difficult to relate corporeal time to successive existence in other states, although I gave it a good shot.

I quoted Guenon re dreams: "Guenon explains that a dream is a creation of the I, which creates all the characters, places, and events", in other words, they are "extensions of us". As

for the subtle body, see *Subtle Body*⁴ on Wikipedia, for example. In Hinduism subtle body is a generic term referring to different bodies or sheaths. In English, etheric and astral bodies, etc. are more or less equivalent to the Sanskrit terms.

Mercurius on 2013-04-16 at 01:11 said:

It is curious to observe in these things the ongoing regression of scientism into materialism. At the time Rose wrote the book, for a number in science, psychology, and parapsychology, "NDE's" and "OBE's" were minimally approached as indicative of either "another" reality, or aspect of reality—even if, from the metaphysical point of view, their interpretations were incorrect. So, the picture was sort of like this—spiritists viewed the phenomenon as "heaven", or some desirable realm. Metaphysics, not denying the claims or experiences, always pointed out that the realm experienced is the "intermediary" world, the "psychic" world, that "darkly-splendid world wherein continually lieth a faithless depth, Hades wrapped in clouds, delighting in unintelligible images", as the Chaldean Oracles describe it—and warn us to "not stoop" into it. Spiritists and the scientists who studied or followed their leads affirmed this world, and could not imagine anything beyond it; while metaphysics affirmed it, yet pointed beyond it still. Now, interestingly, not only does science deny the transcendent, but denies the validity of the intermediary world itself, as it had not in the past. This article is quite recent, although several similar have appeared in the past year or so:

<http://edition.cnn.com/2013/04/09/health/belgium-near-death-experiences/index.html>

Mihai on 2013-04-16 at 03:44 said:

Mercurius, could it be a sign that the scientific establishment intuitively feels its bankruptcy and is attempting all it can to keep itself in power?

It is obvious that the dream-world of the scientific rationalist lies in tatters— the new-age and neo-spiritualist movements are getting a stronger grip on many levels of society, a fact which, for the materialist, is as equal a disaster as it is for the traditionalist, although the two have completely different motives.

scardanelli on 2013-04-16 at 09:47 said:

I'm currently reading Orthodoxy and the Religion of the Future, but will get to The Soul After Death next. For any others as ignorant of Eastern Orthodoxy as I am, there are useful podcasts offered by Ancient Faith Radio that detail the history, theology, and practical aspects of Orthodoxy. I am too new to this area of Christianity to make any claim to their ultimate reliability as a source, but they are useful as a broad overview. Much better "car listening" than the news.

⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Subtle_body

5.5 Evola on the Tibetan Book of the Dead

This review by **Julius Evola** of the Evan-Wentz translation of *The Tibetan Book of the Dead* originally appeared in *Bilychnis*, volume XXXIII, November, 1929.

This volume contains an excellent, fully annotated, translation of a very interesting Tibetan text that can be considered as the companion of the Egyptian Book of the Dead, and that until now was available only as manuscript. It concerns the science of post-mortem activity, as they say, “between the two” (*bardo*), because the reference is actually to the intermediate period that consciousness passes through two forms of existence.

The doctrine, to which the text refers, is that of Mahayana Buddhism, although with the influences of elements of still older tradition, the lamaic, pre-Buddhist tradition of Bon. The interesting aspect is in the idea that in the post-mortem state, consciousness can remain active, so as to be able to determine its final destiny from itself with its own behavior. So the text warns of some experiences that gradually arrive, instructs on their meaning and on the attitude to take to victoriously overcome them.

Starting from the general Hindu teaching that the I, substantially, is the Supreme, except it does not know it (*avidya*), the text explains the apparitions of a dazzling and unbearable light that would strike the soul immediately after the separation from the body, with the experience of the real nature of the soul itself. Then one has a choice: either one has the strength and the intrepidity to identify with the Light and then the “liberation” and the escape from *samsara* will ensue; or else the illusion of believing oneself to be “other” is stronger, and then one passes through successive experiences, in which however one has to deal with the same

reality that takes different forms in relation to different psychological states. The same inability of identifying oneself, so to speak, is projected and makes the undifferentiated state of the Light appear under the form of personal beings, of gods.

And even here the same dilemma arises: either the consciousness succeeds in identifying itself with them, on the basis of a corresponding practical worship in life; or else it cannot endure the vision of them and fears them; and then this same fear is projected and kaleidoscopically transforms the vision of a hierarchy of lucent and benevolent gods into a hierarchy of furious and flaming gods.

For the third time the dilemma is presented, except that the chances of identification, and therefore of liberation, in the person of the terrible gods, are much smaller, unless in mortal life one practiced the worship of the divinity of that type. But if even this test fails, it means that in the soul the will for a conditioned existence is stronger than that for a higher existence. By its very nature it is therefore brought back into the cycle of rebirth.

Now there are its same deep tendencies that, being unleashed with the inevitable violence of natural phenomena and being projected pliantly in visions of Furies and demons who pursue and chase, push the soul toward that form of existence to which it is the most conformed. Strange enough—and not deprived of reference to certain views of modern psychoanalysis—is the detail indicated from the text regarding the moment of the incarnation. The consciousness has the vision of those who will have to be the father and mother, in the moment of their sexual intercourse: then, if a female, she imagines a desire for the father, and if a male, for the mother, and making its own their craving and their sexual pleasure, the soul finds itself drawn into the womb.

Then instantaneously the metaphysical awareness is interrupted and so also the memory: in its place, the soul will gradually develop its own consciousness proper to the new being. Furthermore, formulas are given,

so to speak, in extremis, with the goal of causing at the last moment the “closure of the womb”, like other formulas, oriented to a certain domain of deep tendencies, so as to reach to a power of direction in order to be led to forms of existence suitable to prepare a better outcome when, at the new separation from the body, they will make before the same experiences.

All the interest that the text presents appears even from this short review; this book belongs in the library of every student of these matters.

Posted on 2013-03-31 by Cologero

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David on 2013-03-31 at 22:13 said:

Evola insight on buddhism is always clear. He should have written more on the subject (i.e. The Doctrine of Awakening). Thank you for the translation.

X on 2013-03-31 at 23:53 said:

“The same inability of identifying oneself, so to speak, is projected and makes the undifferentiated state of the Light appear under the form of personal beings, of gods.”

Maybe for Evola those gods have Nordic features.

Saladin on 2013-04-03 at 21:25 said:

He won't encounter them! If we take the Tibetan Book of the Dead as our guide, after his “death” Evola would have identified with Atma (the very first stage of the “Postmortem activity”) and therefore would not have encountered “personal beings, gods.” Only men with less than perfect knowledge wait for this stage.

5.6 The Others

The deceased are around us and participate in our lives. Even our thoughts, desires, insights are influenced by them. We have to be aware of this. Indeed, they move and live around us! During our sleep we don't sense the physical objects that are beside us, so

during our wake-up life we don't feel the dead around us. Only the state of our consciousness separates us from them. Dialogue with the dead is a very concrete activity and no expedient can replace human efforts to transform pain into gratitude. Gratitude for all that has been received and shared in life.

RUDOLF STEINER

The Others, starring **Nicole Kidman**, is one of the creepiest horror movies ever produced. It does not rely on blood, gore, or sudden surprise moves; rather, the psychodrama of an evil event persists beyond the grave. With *All Soul's Day* coming up, it is appropriate to explore the various postmortem states of the human soul. This will be done from the metaphysical perspective and only tangentially related to the exoteric and theological dogmas.

Kamaloka It is not uncommon for the souls of the dead to be associated with the location of their death or burial. In the Ancient City⁵, the dead were buried with utensils, clothing, and weapons.

Valentin Tomberg describes this state:

Kamaloka means "desire world," a partially material realm that is usually invisible to human beings. It surrounds and encloses our physical Earth and is the dwelling place of the astral forms of dead human and other beings. It is in Kamaloka that the second death takes place, after which the liberated part of the human being enters Devachan.

Every death is a birth into another state. **Rene Guenon**, in *Man and his Becoming*, asserts:

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2507>

It must be realized that the idea of death is essentially synonymous with a change of state, which is its widest acceptance; and when it is said that the being has virtually attained immortality, that is taken to mean that it will not need to pass through further conditioned states different from the human state, or to traverse other cycles of manifestation.

In the *Symbolism of the Cross*, there is a chapter on the metaphysical equivalence of birth and death.

These two phenomena accordingly accompany and complete each other: human birth is the immediate result of a death (to another state); human death is the immediate cause of a birth (likewise into another state). Neither of these circumstances can ever occur without the other. And, as time does not exist here, it can be affirmed that, between the intrinsic value of the phenomenon birth and the intrinsic value of the phenomenon death, there is metaphysical identity.

Devachan is a more pleasant state of being, but there are other possibilities. The Traditional teaching of the West⁶, shown for example by **Maximos the Confessor**, is that the postmortem options refer to states of being, not to actual places. This is not commonly acknowledged in our time. Hell, Limbo, Paradise, and the Empyrean represent various states. What is often forgotten is that the states are temporary, since they are way stations prior to Resurrection.

Hell There are different levels of hell, each appropriate to the soul's state of being. In hell, suffering is not alleviated. There is no second death in hell.

⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7568>

Limbo This is the state of natural happiness, in which normal desires are satisfied but there is no supernatural happiness nor awareness of the presence of God. This is appropriate to those who have been equally balanced between good and evil. For example, philosophies like Stoicism or Epicureanism promote such a balance. In the Ancient City, great men and heroes will find their destiny in Limbo. They may have been wise rulers, but their greatness was not related to a life of virtue.

Earthly Paradise Paradise is a return to the Primordial State, the status quo ante before the Fall. As such, it is prolongation of the human state into more subtle realms. This is what most people understand by “heaven”. This state is called Salvation.

Guenon offers this explanation:

Westerners merely mean an extension of the possibilities of the human order, consisting in an indefinite prolongation of life (what the Far-Eastern tradition calls ‘longevity’) under conditions which are to a certain degree transposed but which always remain more or less similar to those of terrestrial existence, since they likewise concern the human individuality.

‘Salvation’ in the religious sense given to the word by Western people, being the fruit of certain actions. This accords perfectly with the western conception of immortality, which is simply an indefinite prolongation of individual life transposed into the subtle order.

In this state, desires are satisfied and the individual will interact with those he had known on earth.

Empyrean This is also known as the Heavenly Jerusalem. Beyond the Earthly Paradise, there are the spheres of the planets and the stars, representing more subtle states of the being. Ultimately, in the Empyrean,

the Being is beyond all individual conditions, including time and space. There one achieves the Beatific Vision. It is possible for some saints to achieve the Beatific Vision directly from the human state.

Degrees of Existence It must not be assumed that there are always discrete jumps. In *The Symbolism of the Cross*, Guenon describes how the degrees are actually infinitesimally close to each other. So Dante and Beatrice pass through all these states on the path to the Heavenly Jerusalem.

Posted on 2021-10-27 by Cologero

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Jacek on 2021-10-28 at 11:01 said:
Did Guenon subscribe to the idea of "second death"?
Where does "second death" fit into all of this?

Reza on 2021-10-28 at 11:09 said:
"There is no second death in hell"
There is a contradiction here. If we are "born" into hell, then necessarily we must die to it.

Cologero on 2021-10-28 at 21:53 said:
There is no contradiction. Hell is a prolongation of the human state which may be immortal. Guenon explains:

We are especially alluding to the extension of the idea of life which is implied in the point of view of the Western religions, and which in fact relates to possibilities contained in a prolongation of human individuality; as we have explained elsewhere, this is what the Far-Eastern tradition refers to under the name of 'longevity'.

That prolongation persists:

By the corresponding word Westerners merely mean an extension of the possibilities of the human order, consisting in an indefinite prolongation of life under conditions which are to a certain degree transposed but

which always remain more or less similar to those of terrestrial existence, since they likewise concern the human individuality. Now in the present instance the state described is still an individual state and nevertheless it is said that immortality can be obtained therein.

Guenon even explains why that is not a contradiction:

This may appear **inconsistent** with what we have just remarked, since it might be supposed that relative immortality only is meant, understood according to the Western sense: actually however **that is not the case**.

Death means the transition from one state of being to another, provided the being has the effective knowledge to make the transition. It is difficult to see how the being in hell, which is a static state, can possibly grow in knowledge.

The transition from each stage to the next only becoming possible for the being who has obtained the corresponding degree of effective knowledge.

Cologero on 2021-10-28 at 21:58 said:

Guenon does not use the term “second death” exactly. However, in the *Symbolism of the Cross*, he points out the metaphysical equivalence of birth and death. In other words, death, as the end of one state, is actually the birth into another state. That is what Tomberg is alluding to: The first human death is the transition to the intermediate state (roughly equivalent to purgatory). The being dies to that state and enters a higher state.

Paulo Adolpho Zeymer Netto on 2021-10-31 at 18:56 said:

In Evola's book “Introduction to Magic”, he starts from a view similar to that of George Gurdjieff, who says that human beings do not have an immortal soul, but must acquire one in life, the creation of the astral body. What does Guenon have to say about this?

5.7 Passing Through the Realms of the Jinn

The jinns are beings that inhabit the world between the angels and men. They are ancient and were created even before the Earth was fully formed.

They occupy the sublunary space, which is above the Earth but below the celestial realms inhabited by angels. That is why they are also known as the spirits of the air.

Jinns are made from fire while men are made from earth (clay), water, and fire. Hence the jinns have a subtle body like humans, but lack a gross, or physical body. Also, like men, they don't have a fully actualized intellectual soul like the angels, so they are subject to dualist thinking. That means that they are both good and evil, they have their own institutions and ways of life.

Normally, the worlds of the jinns and humankind do not interfere with each other, but that is not always the case. Some believe that the jinns invade our world just to trick us or frighten us. Actually, it is the other way around. We have invaded their world.

As subtle bodies, they can experience our thoughts, memories, fantasies, and desires directly, without relying on the intermediary of words. Hence, our subtle bodies merge into their environment. Our foibles pollute their world. We are not the innocent victims of their tricks since they are just responding to our provocations.

They frighten you with horrific appearances because they sense your hidden fears.

They tempt you because they see your secret fantasies.

They lead you astray because they know your unfulfilled desires.

Although they do not have real earthen bodies, they can nevertheless appear as physical bodies in various guises, such as animals, alluring women, or even terrifying images. In that regard they are like rainbows, which appear to be "there" yet are not really there.



Facing the Truth The worse jinns are not those who frighten, deceive, trick, or tempt you. Rather, the worse Jinns are the ones who tell you the truth. We are each born with two angels assigned to us: one to guide us and the other to challenge us. Together they record our thoughts, words, deeds, and actions – both good and bad.

As we pointed out, to travel from the Earth to the Heavens, it is necessary to pass through the Realms of the jinns. Since there is no such thing as free passage, tolls must be paid along the way. The price is not in terms of money, but rather in terms of self-knowledge and purification of the soul.

At each tollhouse, the traveler is challenged. The two recording angels make the case for you, both pro and con. Since the jinn can read your soul, he will make the judgment. You will be allowed to pass on through or not.

Initiates understand this and undertake this journey while still alive and conscious. Since they begin the process of purification in this life, they are prepared for what they hear about themselves on the way. Everyone else puts it off until death when they no longer have a physical body help maintain balance. They are shocked about what they learn, especially those who pride themselves on being so spiritual and advanced in life.

The Final Reveal I can only speak from one side of this equation.

The jinn have often tempted you while disguised as women. That is because they can read your soul and know how your Anima image will respond. So if you think the women you meet are horrible, deceitful, etc. – as is not uncommon today in some circles—perhaps you need to look into your own heart.

Once past the Realm of the Jinns, you will need a new guide to lead you through the Spheres of the Planets. She is your Twin Soul, with whom your life is entangled and has always been. Some of you may know

already who she is, but most probably not. So the truth telling Jinn will reveal your one true love to you. That can be the most frightening of all. That is the one opportunity that must be seized.

Posted on 2021-07-03 by Cologero

5.8 Complexes, Tulpas and Egregores

When the Prophet said, "People are asleep and when they die, they wake up," he meant that everything that man sees in the life of this world is in the rank of the dreams of someone who is asleep, so it must be interpreted. Phenomenal being is imagination (khayal), but it is God in reality.

IBN ARABI, Bezels of Wisdom

Scientists often ponder the "mystery of sleep", although "waking up" is the real mystery. Trees are asleep, indicating that sleep is the natural state of life. What we take to be the "real world" is to the awakened person as the dream is to the dreamer. Waking up, then, is understanding that the phenomenal world is an image and that God is ultimate reality.

Just as the dreamer creates all the characters and aevents in his dream, so too does the awake person. Julius Evola repeats the traditional teaching in his intellectual autobiography:

I have always subscribed to the traditional doctrine that we have wished all relevant events in our life before birth.

A deeper way to understand that is that God's Will and the personal will are fully aligned at the moment of conception.

You might suppose that everyone would wish for a happy life, but that does not take into account the perverse aspects of consciousness. Just as

the dreamer may create a nightmare, the perverse will can do something similar. Esoteric teaching identifies three possible outcomes, in which the creative imagination creates an evil and then projects it onto the world as though it were an external being. These are:

- **Complexes.** These are subjective creations of the individual consciousness.
- **Tulpas.** These are projections usually of a group mind.
- **Egregores:** These are the creation of false doubles of collective entities.

Valentin Tomberg, in *Meditations on the Tarot*, treats these phenomena extensively, so I will be satisfied to quote him directly.

Complexes

Autonomous philosophical systems separated from the living body of tradition are parasitic structures, which seize the thought, feeling and finally the will of human beings. In fact, they play a role comparable to the psycho-pathological complexes of neurosis or other psychic maladies of obsession.

Such systems are also called ideologies. Ideologies ignore Tradition, so they seem novel and attractive. Unfortunately, once a being is under the spell of an ideology, it is difficult to shake it off. The high level of psychological and emotional problems seen today are the result.

As a result, they take on an apparently objective life of their own.

Both Eliphas Levi and the Tibetan masters are in agreement not only with respect to the subjective and psychological origin of demons but also with respect to their objective existence. Engendered subjectively, they become forces independent of the subjective consciousness which engendered them. They are, in other

words, magical creations, for magic is the objectification of that which takes its origin in subjective consciousness.

Demons, then, are engendered subjectively but experienced objectively. In that case, they appear in consciousness almost like a different being.

Demons that have not arrived at the stage of objectification, i.e., at that of an existence separate from the psychic life of their parents, have a semi-autonomous existence which is designated in modern psychology by the term “psychological complex”. . . . A psychopathological “complex” is therefore a demon, when it has not come from outside but is engendered by the patient himself.

Tulpa In Tibetan esoteric work, a Tulpa is created consciously and deliberately. The purpose is to learn to recognize and then overcome one’s fears.

With respect to Tibet, we find there the singular phenomenon of the conscious practice of the creation and destruction of demons. It appears that in Tibet, it is practised as one of the methods of occult training of the will and imagination. The training consists of three parts:

- the creation of tulpas (magical creatures) through concentrated and directed imagination,
 - then their evocation and,
 - lastly, the freeing of consciousness from their hold on it by an act of knowledge which destroys them
- through which it is realised that they are only a creation of the imagination, and therefore illusory. The aim of this training is therefore to arrive at disbelief in demons after having created them through the force of imagination and having confronted their terrifying apparitions with intrepidity.

Alexandra David-Neel in *Magic and Mystery in Tibet* explains that early scepticism offers no spiritual benefit. These Tulpas appear real to those not part of the experiment. Moreover, Tulpas exist through the creations of others.

The teachers do not approve of simple incredulity, they deem it contrary to truth. The disciple must understand that gods and demons do really exist for those who believe in their existence, and that they are possessed with the power of benefitting or harming those who worship or fear them. However, very few reach incredulity in the early part of their training. Most novices actually see frightful apparitions. Must we not also consider that we are not the only ones capable of creating such formations? And if such entities (tulpas, magical creatures) exist in the world, are we not liable to come into touch with them, either by the will of their maker or from some other cause? Could one of these causes not be that, through our mind or through our material deeds, we bring about the conditions in which these entities are capable of manifesting some kind of activity? ... One must know how to protect oneself against the tigers to which one has given birth, as well as against those that have been begotten by others.

Egregore An egregore is like a tulpa except that it is the creation of the perverse collective human will and imagination. "There are superhuman spiritual entities which are not artificially engendered, which manifest themselves and reveal themselves." Egregores, then, are artificially created doubles of such genuine spiritual entities. They are created from below, not by God. Tomberg lists some examples of these doubles:

Although God, Christ, the Holy Virgin, the spiritual hierarchies, the saints, the Church (or the Mystical Body of Christ) are real entities, there still exists also a phantom or egregore of the Church,

which is its “double”, just as every man, every nation, every religion, etc., have their “doubles”. But just as he who sees in Russia, for example, only the bear, in France only the cock and in Germany only the wolf, is being unfair towards the country of the Heart, the country of Intelligence and the country of Initiative — so is one being unjust towards the Catholic Church when one sees, instead of the Mystical Body of Christ, only its historical phantom, the fox. In order to see rightly one has to look rightly. And to look rightly means to endeavour to see through the mists of the phantoms of things.

Our age is fixated on egregores, at least in the West, so that only the worst aspects of a collective entity are noticed. Only by dissolving these fixations can one make spiritual progress, not just individually but collectively. Finally, Tomberg identifies the Anti-Christ as the egregore of the human race.

The antichrist is the phantom of the whole of mankind, engendered through the whole historical evolution of humanity. He is the “superman” who haunts the consciousness of all those who seek to elevate themselves through their own effort, without grace.

Tomberg singles out Nietzsche and Karl Marx as those who have fallen under the spell of the Anti-Christ.

Posted on 2021-07-25 by Cologero

* * *

James on 2021-07-26 at 00:24 said:

The clamouring for “what is real” for many people , therefore , and what exists in the popular imagination is not a qualitatively different form of consciousness , but a quantitatively increased volume of lower consciousness .

I recently watched an episode of a comedy where a character is meant to 'ascend' to a higher state of being and this ascension merely grants him the maddening and lovecraftian horror of being able to 'see everything' and that the universe is balanced on the back of an animal (again, this was supposed to be comedy). In other words, one popular conception of ascension to a higher state of consciousness is to see more of this lower world as it pertains to its physicality. It is not a union with some(one)thing higher but a union with the physical universe as it is and the maddening result of returning to such a mineral-plasmic state.

Instead of working towards waking from the dream, we fall into the foolishness of demanding more sensual dreams. It is no wonder, therefore, that the author of *Meditations* also speaks about how if respiration is not achieved vertically, death can feel like a "sting". We can feel that same analogous motion whenever we wake with a start from a "truly wonderful" dream to waking reality. The soul-body can even suffer a form of spiritual sleep apnea.

Nonetheless, waking up in the drudgery of purgatory must be preferable to the most pleasant sleep since despite the pain of waking life, we at least have 'access' to ourselves and our true(er) senses. We can build more and more authentic experiences and achieve a higher level of true agency. Just as the dreamer believes that there is no waking life, we continue on in this world believing that higher levels of consciousness either does not exist or, as most people now consider to be vogue, a form of highly pleasurable sense-experience. They're not wrong in that it's pleasurable, but they simply play around with gold chalices thinking it's "shiny" rather than realizing it is a font of life. Even those who pursue the esoteric can be guilty of the same fetishism if not guarded carefully.

It is interesting, too, that one consequence of this analogy of memory-consciousness-life/forgetting-sleep-death is that one popular theory of dreams is that it is our own unconscious attempting to work through thoughts/emotions we neglected in the conscious life.

In some analogous way, perhaps life, then, is the phenomenon of our lower selves not having yet been reunited with our dreamer self. "The dreamer must awaken" as Frank Herbert put it. The process of individuation by Jung is the "below" to the "above" of reintegration of the soul with its archetype in Purgatory – in Purgatory where Dante poetically described as still having "day and night" and that all souls must rest from the climb up the mountain at night. Our lives, then, in some ultra-realistic way are the dreams of our souls in Purgatory – what has come 'before' and 'after' being more set in the vertical rather than temporal plane.

If we never awaken from the dream or refuse to wake and therefore continue this disconnect between our selves and our archetype – would this be our own choice to descend to Hell?

The fact that the cross demonstrated that Death was necessary for salvation (otherwise the Cup would have passed from the Master), we also recognize that sleep is necessary for the human physical body. Agnosis is also necessary in some ways in order to advance forward to true knowledge. There is an interesting avenue to explore vis a vis whether or not this life we lead here on Earth is necessary. Obviously the Incarnation is one example of how "sleep

is necessary" and that even "God rested" . Can we say that "God dreamed" ? I will take these callow thoughts to further meditation .

5.9 The Evil Eye

It is nice to know that once upon a time in Europe, Emperors, Kings, Knights, Templars, Hermetists, Saints, Mystics, Troubadours and so much more were abounding. Now we know there were also **Sorcerers** and probably there still are. I don't recall **Rene Guenon** mentioning the activities of sorcerers in any of his "official" writings, but he dwells on the topic in three letters to **Julius Evola**. It is safe to assume that the latter was open to the idea.

Yet, we must wonder where these sorcerers came from and what kind of initiation they receive. Regarding that, I can say nothing. Guenon provides with the knowledge of three levels of attack and their defense.

- **Impeccability.** The rarest of saints, such as Mary in Catholicism or the Prophet in Islam were impeccable, and hence immune to any sort of spiritual attack.
- **Psychic defense.** Those with a true spiritual vocation are immune from psychic and mental attacks.
- **Corporeal attacks.** It seems that no one is totally immune from spells and curses on the physical plane, although the cornu is said to ward of the curse of the evil eye (just in case any one is getting any ideas).

Now the motivation for such attacks on Guenon, or even Evola, is unclear. Guenon hints that Evola's injury may have been the result of such forces. However, Evola's risky behaviour is probably sufficient explanation. Leon de Poncins, on the other hand, certainly had enemies, since he

wrote about alleged Masonic and Jewish conspiracies against the Church. Nevertheless, the ill effects were not long lasting against him. Perhaps the nuns prayed for his recovery.

Guenon was often in poor health and it seems he didn't attribute it solely to natural causes. Since he was never overtly political or militant, I don't know which sorcerers would target him. In particular, the incident with the Jewish lawyer looking for his photograph seems odd. Guenon most likely had a secret. His family never allowed his papers released; that is why we have just one side on the Guenon-Evola correspondence.

I can relate a personal incident. A few years ago in Paris, after a day in the Louvre, my pretty hostess and I stopped at a nearby cafe to relax *al fresco* with some coffee and sweets. Shortly thereafter, a wizened Gypsy woman on the street stopped at our table and asked for a handout. Apparently, she had never learned that "two's company and three's a crowd", so I tried to ignore her. She kept mumbling, but I could not understand her heavily accented French. Perhaps on another day, I may have dropped a Euro on her, but at this particular moment, my mind and attention were elsewhere, so my heart hardened and I ignored her. She nevertheless persisted and as she was leaving, I heard her utter some malediction. Slightly astonished, I muttered a Hail Mary under my breath, and continued on with my date.

Coincidentally, I spent the next two years with a series of ailments, in and out of hospitals. Unfortunately, I wasn't wearing my father's cornu at that time in Paris, but I do now. (actually, I don't: 20 Aug 2020)

Posted on 2012-08-20 by Cologero

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Audrey Del Sol on 2012-08-22 at 01:06 said:

Now the motivation for such attacks on Guenon, or even Evola, is unclear. Guenon hints that Evola's injury may have been the result of such forces. However, Evola's risky behaviour is probably sufficient explanation.

I probably speak a lot, yet. I am of the opinion that Evola's injury was on such basis; hence I brought up Franz Bardon {whose external expression was so 'flowery' it almost attracts froufrous}.

Physical level harm comes out of the fact that these "occult" forces are invariably concerned with

material goods and they seek to destroy healthy, independent human bodies. It has to deal with mechanization of humanity also mentioned by G. I. Gurdjieff. Modern medicine and popular abuse of computers fall under this category. Can elaborate if requested.

Audrey Del Sol on 2012-08-22 at 01:12 said:

Vicomte Léon De Poncins was a French journalist descendant of a noble family.

He describes Freemasonry: "...to establish in its place an atheistic rationalist society which, in fact, leads straight to materialism although it is supposed to have science and reason as a religion. The role of Freemasonry is to create the revolutionary state of mind rather than to act directly."

There you go. Evola (and I admire him for it, hence my adamant defense) was a man of action who DID.

Is this "risky"? As opposed to abusing female torso's, arms, and hands as "babycrabs"?

Audrey Del Sol on 2012-08-22 at 01:17 said:

Also, hence my such physical presence. In our "intellectual baby" state, when bodies are atrophied and malnourished heads rule, it is so easy to "brainwash" people to "think" things and have their bodies act accordingly. Therefore, I also temporarily believe in being loud, and telling people when they are being merdre, despite the fact that it goes against good manners.

Cologero on 2012-08-22 at 08:10 said:

OK, Audrey Del Sol, I confess to often missing your allusions. I searched for "babycrabs" and found nothing about the type of abuse you describe.

I'm not sure what Evola DID, perhaps at one time he was active, but late in life he became more passive (e.g., just to ride the tiger and survive.) Nevertheless, the real task at this moment in time is to create the "counter-revolutionary" state of mind. That is the greater battle that must precede the lesser battle.

Feel free to elaborate on occult forces and popular abuse of computers.

George on 2013-02-03 at 09:46 said:

There is a large "transhumanist" agenda, that argues essentially:

Progress is impossible to stop, but humans are handling it well. Therefore, we need to adapt humans to progress by the "next evolutionary step". Whatever that is... it seems they want

to use technology and genetic engineering to create the new human.

5.10 The Bondage of Spirits

In the essay *On Magic*, **Giordano Bruno** discusses the existence and action of non-human spirits. The practice of invoking god, demons, and heroes is the branch of magic called theurgy. He calls this the “magic of the hopeless” because they often become the vessels of evil demons. A safer practice is to learn to command and control lower demons through higher spirits.

Valentin Tomberg describes theurgy in a similar way:

With respect to the cult of the “gods” and the iconolatry that this cult entailed, the “pagan” initiates and philosophers saw in it the practice of theurgy, i.e. that of intercourse with entities of the celestial hierarchies either by raising themselves to them, or by rendering possible their descent and presence on earth.

As sources, he lists Plutarch, Plotinus, Proclus, and Hermes Trismegistus to show that the highest theurgy did not try to evoke demons. Tomberg is apparently an Euhemerist, as was Giovanni Boccaccio by the way. He explains the origins of the pagan gods this way:

The “paganism” of the poets—symbolic and mythological paganism — was, in so far as it was not a symbolic version of the wisdom and magic (theurgy) of the mysteries, a universal humanism. Its “gods” were, truth to tell, human personages — heroes and heroines, divinised or poetised, who were prototypes of the development of the human personality

Our interest here is not in magic, but rather in understanding the sources of thought.

Thinking and the Laws of Physics Several years ago, we wrote about free will and the laws of physics⁷, reaching the conclusion that free will and physics are compatible. The confusion is the failure to understand that free will is not the same as power. A person cannot break the law of Gravity, or any other physical law, through will alone.

Another confusion is the idea that everything that exists is ultimately reducible to physical laws. The human world is not the physical world. In all likelihood, most everything around you is an artefact, not a natural kind. Even assuming that all natural kinds are ultimately reducible to physics, artefacts are not.

That is because human activity is the result of thought, and there is no physical law of thought. That is true not just of artefacts, but of all of culture. That raises the question, then, about the origin of thought.

Some physicalists are persistent, and assume that thoughts are simply the epiphenomena of biochemical processes. In that case, the works of Shakespeare should be explicable in chemical terms, and a fortiori, by a physico-chemical law. That is because those works cannot arise by chance, as shown by the infinite monkey theorem⁸.

The next attempt is to attribute thoughts to “evolution”. The social systems arising from thought are said to have favoured by the “survival of the fittest”. Of course, this just begs the question. An evolutionary explanation, in order to be scientific, must identify a gene, or complex of genes, that are associated with a given system. Not only has that not been done, no one is even trying. I volunteer for research for 23andme, and they have never asked me such questions. Moreover, different cultures would have to have genetically different populations. Yet such a genetic population can create a patriarchy and an anti-patriarchy at the same time. Besides, no one has yet explained how genes create thoughts.

The more educated seem content to attribute thoughts to “culture”

⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=210>

⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Infinite_monkey_theorem

or “society”. Yet that hardly makes sense, since culture and society are the results of thought, not the creators of thoughts. How can such abstract notions inculcate thoughts in people?

We could, I suppose, remain content with the concept of the “meme”. It is useful as a description, but there is no indication of the source of the meme or why certain people, or groups of people, are more influenced by a given meme than others.

We could also speculate that there are unknown forces that create memes. That leaves us with three choices.

1. The force acts at random. If so, then it cannot explain the origin of the works of Shakespeare.
2. The force is a rigid law. That goes against all experience, since thought is fluid. One thought does not necessarily lead to another.
3. The force is controlled by a conscious being. This would explain why thought is neither random nor rigid. This is the esoteric, Hermetic, and Traditional explanation.

Giordano Bruno Giordano Bruno explains quite a bit about such conscious beings. He explains how spirits affect our inner life:

Demons penetrate through bodies and initiate thoughts in us. They convey impressions directly to our internal senses, just as we sometimes seem to think of something suggested by the internal senses.

They send not only dreams, voices, and visions to be heard and seen, but also certain thoughts which might be hardly noticed. They communicate truths sometimes through enigmas and sometimes through sense impressions. Sometimes they may even deceive.

There are many types of spirits, which explain the different influences on human thought. Bruno elaborates:

- Some are brute animals and cause injury without reason. Mark 9:25 describes them as “deaf and dumb”, i.e., they are without reason, recognize no commands, do not hear threats or prayers.
- Demons which are fearful, suspicious and credulous. They do not distinguish the possible from the impossible, or the appropriate from the inappropriate. They are like humans who are dreaming and disturbed by fantasies.
- Wiser demons reside in pure air. They distort worship and prayers, create Illusions of fear, anger, religion, and introduce confusion and doubt.
- Ethereal spirits are pure and luminous. Not hostile.
- Aqueous and terrestrial spirits are hostile, or at least not friendly. Less rational and more fearful.
- Spirits of fire are heroes and gods, and are the ministers of God. These are the Seraphim, Cherubim, and Thrones. They have very subtle bodies made of fire.
- Spirits occupy the bodies of humans, animals, stones, minerals. This is a form of panpsychism. Whatever his defects, **Teilhard de Chardin** insisted that a true science had to deal with the inside of things as well as the outside.
- No body is totally devoid of spirit and intelligence.
- Spirits never perish; rather, there is continual change of combinations and actualisations.

- There are various loves and hates.
- Everything desires to remain in its present state of existence and does not comprehend or think about another state of being.
- The diversity of natures and drives gives rise to a variety of bonds which affect spirits and bodies.
- There are subterranean spirits.
- Demons have emotions, desires, angers, jealousies

Tomberg's definition is straight forward:

“An autonomous being capable of interfering with the intentions of the ego” and which “possesses a mental life of its own” is nothing other than what we understand by a “demon”.

We can't go into further detail in this introduction. Bruno claims to have experienced many of these spirits. The human race has always suspected their existence; this is shown in all the Hollywood films about spirits and in the works of **H P Lovecraft**.

Lucy and Harry

There are two particular spirits, or actually classes of spirits, that play a prominent role in Anthroposophical literature: Lucifer and Ahriman, nicknamed Lucy and Harry by the anthros. In an early work, *Inner Development*, Valentin Tomberg describes the activities of these spirits in the human being, as shown in the diagram on the right. The Luciferic being is bound to the astral body in man's fallen state. He is called a doppelganger since it is like an evil twin. He is the father of lies, and creates idle fantasies in the mind that mask the imagination of Sophia, or Divine Wisdom. A moral universe requires hindrances, which are provided by this double. This is a clue to the meaning of the Book of Job.

Another doppelganger is the strictly human subconscious. In the *Meditations*, Tomberg uses the ideas of **Carl Jung** to explain the content of the subconscious. As for Ahriman, let us use his own words:

And just as our angel, standing above us, represents, one could say, our archetype, so it is that the Ahrimanic double, on the other hand, is our caricature. This caricature, the Ahrimanic double, is a very intelligent being, one who does not manifest through arousing wild passions, but instead manifests particularly whenever subordination to an aim works strongly in a person. Precisely those individuals, therefore, who are highly respectable (from the external, bourgeois point of view) can be tools of this Ahrimanic double. It is precisely such people who can be subordinated, to a very high degree, to the being of the Ahrimanic double—who thereby takes on the leading role.

VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Inner Development*

As a reminder, the angel is our guardian angel whose prototype is the same as the person. This notion has even penetrated Orthodox theology, for example, in **Sergei Bulgakov**.

In the *Meditations*, Tomberg became more critical of the anthro's obsession with the Luciferic and Ahrimanic beings. In that, he is justified, since their tendency is to reduce, even in its highest forms, the activities of the human spirit to manifestations of evil.

He barely mentions Ahriman at all, in fact. However, in the Letter on the Devil, he brings up Mephistopheles, whose characteristics are actually identical to those of Ahriman described in his earlier work. For example, consider the following quotations:

Even Doctor Faust—who made a pact with the devil (and this concerns all “pact-makers” of this kind, ancient and modern)—was only the naive victim of a prank on the part of Mephistopheles

(who is a rogue well-known to all those who have knowledge of the “occult world”).

Some do it in the tragic sense of having to do what they no longer want to do and they no longer believe; others do it with fierce conviction and passionate indignation; there are also entities from the hierarchies of the left who accuse by making use of ridicule — *farce* — as a means of demonstrating their prosecuting thesis.

It is primarily human pretension and snobbery that he turns into ridicule.

Mephistopheles; and the whole revelation is only a farce made by him for the credulous? no — for spiritual snobs.

Mephistophelian accusation against those who do not seek the truth as such, but rather extraordinary circumstances of revelation

The Ahrimanic doppelganger, aka Mephistopheles, is a *caricature* of the human being. Other features are spiritual pranks, ridicule, and farce. He can be recognized by spiritual pretension and snobbery, i.e., the desire to appear to be “spiritual” to others.

As for being well known, Mephistopheles may reveal himself in a dream rather than to the awakened consciousness. That I know from experience.

Personality Disorders Another indication of the influence of demons are personality disorders and psychopathy. Tomberg explains how that is possible:

One engenders an elemental being and one subsequently becomes the slave of one’s own creation. The “demons” or “evil spirits” of the New testament are called today in psychotherapy “neuroses of obsession”, “neuroses of fear”, “fixed ideas”, etc. They have been

discovered by contemporary psychiatrists and are recognised as real — i.e. as “parasitic psychic organisms” independent of the conscious human will and tending to subjugate it.

This is not the case with organic conditions such as bipolar disorder or schizophrenia, whose effects can be somewhat mitigated by medications. However, personality disorders like the paranoid, histrionic, borderline, etc., are different. Just because psychologists can categorize certain complexes of behaviour does not necessarily mean they are strictly medical problems. There is no real understanding of their cause nor is there any universally effective treatment. Tomberg’s description, therefore, is pretty apt. He goes on to say:

One need not fear the devil, but rather the perverse tendencies in oneself! For these perverse human tendencies can deprive us of our freedom and enslave us. Worse still, they can avail themselves of our imagination and inventive faculties and lead us to creations which can become the scourge of mankind.

If you have ever had a close relationship with someone with a personality disorder, you will probably agree that it feels more like dealing with evil than with a sickness.

Posted on 2018-10-08 by Cologero

5.II Vampirism and Vampires

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal “Roma” on 6 September 1973 under the title “Il vampirismo ed i vampiri”.

This topic is certainly even more relevant today that it was 40 years ago. Although we don’t agree this is the last word that can

be said on the topic of vampirism, we will allow Evola to speak for himself and bring in other issues either in the comments or in another post. This perhaps explains the expression *ride the tiger*.

Recently the “vampire” theme has acquired some popularity through various publications, beginning with Bram Stoker’s famous novel *Dracula*. Some have given that interest a psychological and psychoanalytical interpretation. The idea of the vampire in itself, however, cannot entirely be reduced to superstition and extravagant fantasy. To be put aside, however, is vampirism as grossly physical, with blood taken from the victim by the vampire, sometimes with the goal of prolonging his own life.

Instead, vampirism could be considered in its psychic character and we could bring attention to the phenomena which often is the issue both in popular belief, and in ethnology. We cannot overlook even whatever there is in the childish fables as the type of the “werewolf” and which in ethnology is designated as lycanthropy.

It is about the idea that a human being can in a certain way split in two and that his double can assume an animal appearance and manifest corresponding behaviors. What can there be in that which is real?

In terms of principle, we can respond affirmatively, referring to the following framework. True human evolution must be conceived as the self-differentiation of the human type by means of the exclusion, in the course of the history of the species, of animal possibilities that he included in himself, that he left outside of himself like the wake of a boat, and that already had been realized and established in given animal species. Now, we can conceive a human type in which this differentiation was not sufficiently determined. That occurs especially among primitive and savage populations which are at the stage of so-called totemism, the totem being both the progenitor of a given tribe, as well as the god or demon of an animal species, through which the members of that tribe consider themselves, e.g., as leopard-men, wolf-men, bear-men, and so on.

Now, theoretically, one cannot exclude that in a being, whose personality is not stable enough, this animal potentiality creates, even today, an irruption and is manifested in a corresponding way. It is not the case that the being is then transformed materially or physically into an animal, as in the fantastic case of Dr. Jekyll. One should think instead of a scission of the personality (phenomena, certainly verified by psychology, as in “multiple personalities”) which is developed in analogous terms to phenomena, also verified positively, as in “ectoplasm”: they are the formations that, in extrasensory seances, drew their origin from the psychic-physical substance of the medium.

An ectoplasm that assumes the transitory form of an animal nature through the regressive irruption of a force of animality: this would therefore be the possible explanation of phenomena like the werewolf and similar forms, possibly including vampiric forms if the animal manifestation includes such behavior. Therefore, it is not a question of a dead person becoming a vampire nor of a person who transform himself into an imaginary animal. From the material gathered by ethnology, there seem to be actual cases of certain persons who are found in a state of deep sleep or catalepsy, while one of their doubles moves about and is seen by others.

The double, as the ectoplasm of the medium, maintains a certain mysterious connection with the subject, because it means that a wound produced in that image would be reproduced in the dormant or cataleptic body.

Finally, we could mention the phenomena of bilocation, and depending on whether one is disposed to admit it on a higher plane (bilocation of certain Christian saints, Islamic sheiks, Hindu yogis, etc.), they could also come into question as explicative elements for this rather sinister field.

Naturally, in werewolves and similar creatures, the possible manifestations do not have the erotic setting that certain “dark” literature often

likes to attribute to the vampire. Through this setting, we have to move into a rather different domain, that of an essentially psychic vampirism that can be real that is confirmed in more than a few traditions, which sometimes even indicate the technique to actualize it.

Moreover, ethnology has recorded the belief that certain shamans have the power to vampirize living beings to the point of reducing them to a type of bare nothings⁹: they seem to have been left traces of that in the black practices of the Voodoo of Haiti. Regarding properly erotic vampirism it is instead the case when the subtle vital force of a woman is fed with the goal of strengthening one's own vitality. That seemed to be the case in the Old Testament, with King Solomon¹⁰ who lay down with naked young girls, "without knowing them": all the more that an analogous procedure is likewise attested to both in central Asia and ancient China.

Regarding the former, Alexandra David-Neel who stayed there for quite a while, recounts that one of the methods "to increase one's own life" and maintain one's own youth would consist in using young women to come to orgasm without however participating in the pleasure. More or less the same procedure is again found in ancient operative Chinese Taoism, in the play of the Dragon with the Tiger (the Dragon representing man, the Tiger the young woman), meant to guarantee "eternal life" to the one "who has knowledge". Here, sometimes, it would seem to be about a pure masculine vampirism (having as its object not blood but a vital subtle substance) not only because, rather unfairly, the young women should be kept in the dark about the hidden goal of the union for fear that, by knowing it, they could take the lead, inverting the roles and



⁹I presume "zombies".

¹⁰I think he means King David.

exploiting the man who would like to vampirize them, but also because it is recommended to use different ones sequentially, one text saying that the best result is obtained when one is matched with as many as ten girls in one night.

That, however, does not represent a barely credible masculine *tour de force* (especially if the designation of the woman as “tiger” was not just a manner of speaking), because, at the same time, it is prescribed not to ejaculate (“rigid organ without ejaculation”), which relates to what the method required to strengthen his own life, again evidently requiring the renunciation, on the man’s part, of the pleasure that man experiences when he pours himself without reservation into the woman’s flesh.

This is, more or less, all that can be said about vampirism, while also bringing back ideas from a rather distant domain of ordinary existence, but not for that reason, by way of principle, deprived of every reality.

Posted on 2013-01-06 by Cologero

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Janus on 2013-01-06 at 18:37 said:

Is the sexual practice of increasing vitality here distinguished from the practices used in Tantra, where the practice of the man either withholding climax or experiencing orgasm without ejaculation is also used, or are they the same thing? It seems as though the mere concept of increasing ones “life” or “vitality” would constitute a misunderstanding or degeneration of Traditional practices, which focus on rising to a new form of life and existence.

Gandhi also lay with young women in this way, yet I find it hard to believe that he or Evola are urging us to become “vampires” (even in this proper sense of the word). The link between totemism and the shamanic animal cult or animal-man certainly seems in line with what we know today about tribal practices.

Cologero on 2013-01-06 at 20:48 said:

Guenon seems to take your point of view, Janus. What Evola calls “operative” Taoism would be dismissed as merely “magic” by Guenon. “Laying with young women” should be understood in the alchemical sense, and those who need to do it corporeally are on the same level as the “puffers” (i.e., those who confuse alchemy with chemical experiments). In “Man and his

becoming", Guenon specifically addresses the meaning of "longevity" in Taoism, which is the prolongation of human individuality, not necessarily as bodily existence.

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-06 at 21:08 said:

As someone who was raised with beliefs of pre-revolutionary Europe – I am find this article hard to even read, what separates this from porn ? Sex magic is Satanic as far as I'm concerned....

Logres on 2013-01-06 at 22:56 said:

Jason, I share your upbringing and general outlook. Yet many of the celibates had a sort of higher spiritual dynamic that was obviously far removed from the pornographic:

St. Cyprian and Juliana – http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cyprian_and_Justina

Or Heloise, and Abelard.

Also, Weor writes on Perfect marriage: <http://www.anael.org/descargas/books/matrimony.pdf> (which I have yet to read entirely).

At it's best, even the rite of Christian marriage is an exoteric outworking of certain basic spiritual truths, one of which is that man and woman practice giving of themselves, faithfully, to only one other person, over a lifetime. They are essentially practicing the recognition of their polar being. According to Bo-Yin-Ra, this practice (even if someone not your polar being – which are the human odds anyway) will bear fruit towards recognizing your true other self.

Janus on 2013-01-06 at 23:20 said:

That makes sense. To my knowledge neither Rome nor Christendom used the literal sexual practices described, and in Christendom at least sex seems to fall into the realm of the man and wife "becoming one flesh" (or exemplifying both masculine and feminine in their entirety and ultimate union). Thank you for the clarification.

Cologero on 2013-01-07 at 07:28 said:

Interesting point, Jason-Adam, given that Evola himself claims to hold the values of pre-revolutionary Europe. As a thought experiment, let's look at understanding the phenomena that Evola mentions from a different point of view.

The feminine represents the soul, whose symbol is the tiger. As we are, our souls are unruly, unpredictable, and even dangerous to our eternal life (i.e., "longevity"). We can try to ride the tiger just to retain balance and sanity. Ideally, however, the soul is virginal. That means it is passive and receptive to the Spirit (Intellect and Will), thus directed by it. As virginal, it is not full of "wandering influences", or random thoughts absorbed unconsciously or uncritically from other men.

The number 10, the sum of 1 through 4, represents a complete cycle, so the 10 virgins (haven't we heard that somewhere else in another context?) represent a complete cycle in the mind. The microcosm is the macrocosm, and this is seldom remembered in talks about the cosmic cycle. So, in consciousness, we also have to traverse the entire cycle, from the primordial state, through the fall of the Kali Yuga, a re-awakening, and the deliverance. Notice how this follows the trajectory of the *Divine Comedy*, another work explicitly motivated by the ideal of the feminine without "carnal knowledge", whereby a man has to attain self-knowledge of the faults in his soul, purge them, and attain Heaven.

The animal totems are also interesting. The West has always taught that we have an "animal" soul, although this doctrine is poorly understood and developed. Assuming that sorcerers can create the illusion of a animal form through "ectoplasm", just as in a seance there is the illusion of communication with the dead, it is not normally something anyone is too concerned about. The real problem is that animal natures can manifest in actual men; this is too obvious to expand on at this point as I am sure many examples can be provided.

As for the vampire. The real issue is not their existence, but rather why, starting post-revolution and reaching a fever pitch in our day, is there this fascination with the vampire. Obviously, it is the irruption into the common soul life in the West of some deep disturbance; this explains the eroticism.

It would seem, then, that there are now appearing human beings in a state of devolution and the vampire represents the totem. Rather than animals, which are really morally neutral, this new totem is something far more sinister. As E Michael Jones points out, the vampire attains eternal life by drinking the blood of his followers. The contrast is too obvious to state.

Mihai on 2013-01-07 at 09:30 said:

The entire western world seems to be completely immersed in an entertainment based around a degenerate and completely out of control sexuality driven beyond the point of obsession, on the one hand, and an equally disturbing obsession with extreme violence, horror literature and movies, sinister images, gore, destruction etc., on the other hand.

It is not hard to intuit the causes. At this point of the Kali Yuga, what Guenon called "fissures in the Great Wall" have developed into entire gaps, where demonic influences from the lower psychic regions have launched a general assault and invaded a large part of the consciousness of the (post)modern individual- left completely unguarded thanks to evolutionism and relativism.

After all, why question the value of your thoughts and impulses is value is something relative ? Plus, if we are all automatically "evolving", then there is no reason to worry, is it ?

Perhaps my past articles on postmodernism deserve an additional part along the lines above.

Logres on 2013-01-07 at 10:24 said:

Mihai, I'm glad you've used Upton as a resource : a couple of years ago, I became fascinated with UFOs, as I was convinced both from personal experience (I have seen something preternatural a long time ago) and talking to others (otherwise respectable people) that the phenomenon was not capable of being dismissed. I read about medieval accounts, as well, and what struck me was the difference (modern accounts being highly "technological"). It occurred to me demons might manifest in the form considered most useful for fear and false worship – what else do we worship today, but technology (at least at a common level)? Upton confirmed all that when I stumbled over him, and it was good to see you put these things in context, to which Cologero's account here also adds a great deal.

Mihai on 2013-01-08 at 04:47 said:

Fr. Seraphim Rose is also a good resource concerning these phenomena- Upton elaborated very much on Rose's ideas.

What you wrote is true and there is one more thing to take into account: that is science-fiction literature- not only the cheap one, but also the more elaborate writing, such as those of Asimov or Herbert. The world they portray there has many things in common with many new-age theories.

For example, in *Dune*, we have a futuristic humanity which has "evolved" to the point of colonizing the Universe, ruled by a sort of an agnostic elite that resembles the medieval order, minus the spiritual. In fact, humanity has adopted a sort of syncretistic religion built up of bits and pieces from all world religions and where high technology is combined with "orders" who specialize in manipulating psychic powers and manipulate events through these powers as well as genetic engineering.

Also, even if I've never read a single book by Asimov, I know as a fact that, even though he was a stark and militant (materialist) atheist, his books are full of reference to psychic powers and sorcery.

We have here all the ingredients of the type of society that post-modern theorists dream of.

It is really hard to ignore the possibility that this kind of authors can easily be unconscious agents for spreading a certain kind of worldview, especially considering the fact that, in popular opinion, what is today sci-fi, may become tomorrow reality.

Saladin on 2013-01-08 at 20:34 said:

As an Oriental, it is interesting to see, just based on the number of comments here, how phenomena (weird or otherwise) fascinates my Occidental brethren! UFOs, Werewolves, Vampires, ... truly make this colorful world of ours more colorful. But alas, they remain phenomena!

This fits well with what Janus said below: "It seems as though the mere concept of increasing ones "life" or "vitality" would constitute a misunderstanding or degeneration of Traditional

practices." Indeed my brothers, it's not the number of years of the human life that counts ... "Der Mensch ist etwas, das überwunden werden soll"

Cologero said: " As E Michael Jones points out, the vampire attains eternal life by drinking the blood of his followers. The contrast is too obvious to state."

WoW! That had not occurred to me before! Clear example of "inversion" by Counter-Initiation!

Senko on 2013-01-08 at 23:52 said:

Mihai and Logres, both my father and I have seen UFO's and we both can attest that the vision was accompanied by a sense of fear and of a dark presence. In my case, when I saw it, the only sci-fi material I had been exposed too was Star Wars, coincidentally the UFO looked like a Star Destroyer.

Upton work is fantastic, also Frater Rose. I have found Orthodox text in general, but Rose and Olivier Clement in general to provide not only a good many themes for contemplation but a lot of practical/ operative insights.

Logres on 2013-01-09 at 10:11 said:

Senko, immediately prior to my experience, I had an impending sense of doom/dread which was so overwhelming it actually polarized me towards God (what else to do?) : several seconds later, I saw what I saw.

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-10 at 09:29 said:

It seems to me though that whereas writers such as Dante used the language of romance as spiritual allegory, or arcana to use a better word perhaps, Evola seems to actually mean sex as a literal act. If I understand him correctly he would have had no problems having a one night stand with Beatrice thus rending null the whole notion of love from afar that made the Middle Ages so beautiful and inspiring....though then again it can be argued Evola might have been trying to shock people ? His discussion of the degeneracy of modern marriage in *Ride the Tiger* was spot on and a Catholic priest couldn't have said it any better how little people think of the sacrament these days.....

Cologero on 2013-01-10 at 23:37 said:

The odds of finding your polar being? They may be pretty good. The odds of recognizing her as such? Should be the same, but probably is not.

Aleksandar Gueric on 2016-01-14 at 07:25 said:

Apparently, Baron did practiced some form of erotic vampirism on young women of Rome in his later years, according to one eyewitness, but who knows. I take those gossips with the grain of salt. In any case, this literal sexual practice is just one smaller aspect of "ride the tiger" concept

Sparrow on 2016-09-01 at 03:38 said:

The vampire, or werewolf, always symbolized to me someone who has rejected the nous and wholly embraced what Schopenhauer termed the "will to live." there are plenty of people like that in the modern world, but they are generally content to live more like sheep, contenting themselves with grazing, while the "wolf-man" and vampire were more active and possessed some modicum of will (no matter how crude or animalistic) with which to pursue eternal life, which they identified with telluric and not solar life.

The Doctrine of Spiritual Races

6.1 Matter and Form: The Dionysian Race

The new victories of the maternal principle over the revelation of purely spiritual paternity show how hard it has been for men, at all times and amid the most varied religious constellations, to overcome the inertia of material nature and to achieve the highest calling, the sublimation of earthly existence to the purity of the divine father principle.

J J BACHOFEN, *Mother Right*

Having traced the stages of history from the Telluric to the Demetrian to the Apollonian or solar periods, the latter peaking in the Roman Imperium, **J J Bachofen** then identifies the Dionysian period. **Julius Evola** calls this the Dionysian Race.

The Dionysian race represents the paternity of the Apollonian falling back into materiality. The Apollonian ideal was unable to withstand the assaults of baser doctrines. The Dionysian stage prepared the way for a

new victory of the feminine principle and the mother cult. The victory of Dionysus over Apollo was assured in the meeting of the Greek and Oriental worlds under Alexander. Bachofen points out the spiritual principle of the Delphic Apollo was powerless to overcome the lower material views of the sexual relation. He writes:

We see paternity falling back from Apollonian purity to Dionysian materiality, so preparing the way for a new victory of the feminine principle, for a new flowering of the mother cults. Although the intimate union which the two luminous powers concluded in Delphi seemed calculated to purify Dionysus' phallic exuberance through Apollo's immutable repose and clarity, and to lift it above itself, the consequence was the exact opposite: the greater sensuous appeal of the fecundating god outweighed his companion's more spiritual beauty, and increasingly usurped the power that should have been Apollo's. Instead of the Apollonian age, it was a Dionysian age that dawned.

This shows that the spiritual aspect alone is insufficient. Rome, instead, was able to maintain the Apollonian through its structure. Bachofen explains:

Mankind owes the enduring victory of paternity to the Roman political idea, which gave it a strict juridical form and consequently enabled it to develop in all spheres of existence; it made this principle the foundation of all life and safeguarded it against the decadence of religion, the corruption of manners, and a popular return to matriarchal views. Roman law maintained it traditional principle against all the assaults and threats of the Orient, against the spreading mother cult of Isis and Cybele, and even against the Dionysian mystery.

Evola's final point seems to be directed against a Hans Gunther or his followers. Gunther, more than 80 years ago, was concerned about the

"degradation" of the Nordic peoples, which resulted from factors like the decline in marriage and birth rates, particularly among the higher "more Nordic" classes. Obviously, that decline has continued in the ensuing decades. Evola attributed that decline to "processes of involution" on the spiritual plane among the Nordic people.

The Dionysian Race In his treatment of the various degrees of virility and solarly as types in the order of the ancient Mediterranean mystery traditions, Bachofen appropriately distinguishes the Apollonian and the Dionysian stages. Here again cosmic analogies will serve as the basis. There are in fact two characteristics of solarly. One is that of light as such, i.e., as an unchanging and heavenly luminous nature: such is the Apollonian or Olympic symbol, for example, of the Delphic cult considered as an inspiration of pure Hyperborean spirituality, which reached to the Mediterranean. As we saw, that is the stage which indicates the race of the solar man. The other characteristic of solarly is that of a light that rises and sets, that experiences death and resurrection and a new death and a new dawn, in other words, a law of growth and transformation.

This is Dionysian solarly in contrast to the Apollonian principle. It is a virility that aspires to the light through a passion that cannot free itself from the sensual and telluric element and even from the ecstatic-orgiastic element typical of the lowest forms of the Demetrian cycle. The association, in myth and symbol, of feminine and lunar figures with Dionysius is rather significant in this respect. Dionysius does not accomplish the transition, the transformation of his nature. It is a still earth-bound virility in spite of its luminous and ecstatic nature. The fact that the Dionysian and Bacchic mysteries were associated with the Demetrian mystery, instead of with the purely Apollonian mystery, clearly indicates to us the end point of the Dionysian experience: it is a "dying and becoming" in the sign not of the infinite which is above form and the finite, but of that infinite that is fulfilled and delights itself in the destruction of form and the finite,

harking back therefore to the forms of Telluric-Demetrian promiscuity.

The Dionysian man, however, also has traits in common with the Titanic man. He is the one who aspires to reconquer the lost level that is capable of surpassing, in part, the human condition by means of a radical incitement of all the forces connected to the senses, but who nevertheless cannot surpass the ecstasies, where the virile quality vacillates and cannot conserve itself, where the sensible is mixed with the supersensible and, fundamentally, where liberation ensues only at the price of the decline of the affirmative principle of the personality therefore, with a solution in a way of being quite different from the solar and Olympian.

With the right transpositions of the level, it would not be arbitrary to establish a correlation between the Dionysian man and the romantic man. Together they belong to the same race of the spirit, defined as opposition to the Olympian or solar spirit. And such a connection can spare us from providing further characterological details because the reader will see in it whatever is necessary to identify them. From the race theoretic point of view, one must not be surprised at the thought that the Dionysian man, acting as the romantic, is represented to a large extent in the Nordic races, the Germanic as well as the Anglo-Saxon. So this confirms the previously indicated point to clearly distinguish the primordial Nordic-Aryan race from the Nordic races of more recent times. Even in the latter the part that had the feminine, Demetrian, and gynocratic element in their appearance at the entrance of historic times is significant enough (even today, the German languages is unique among the Indo-European, or Aryan, languages in which the sun—*die Sonne*—is of the feminine gender while the moon—*der Mond*—is of the masculine). This leads us to think that, in this respect, it is a completely different question of imitators who “line up” and do not even pause to consider the simple race of the body: on the spiritual planes, certain processes of involution seem to have happened among the most recent Nordic peoples in no less degree than among the West Atlantic or Nordic-Atlantic Aryans, in the

Mediterranean traces of which many divergent forms of the pure solar tradition are likewise found.

Posted on 2015-06-19 by Aeneas

* * *

Logres on 2015-06-22 at 20:29 said:

That last paragraph clarifies a whole two decades of my struggle to understand the Classical world: thank you. If I am remembering rightly, Evola dates the decline of the classical world from the 6-8th centuries BC, in *Revolt Against the Modern World*. Around the genesis of Rome, who was then the counterweight.

6.2 From the Amazons to the Heroes

In *Revolt Against the Modern World*, **Julius Evola** expanded on the ages of these three races. The Amazonian period was a reaction against the male revolt. It represents the lunar principle that tried to restore the Demetrian race as it was being defeated by the Solar principle. We see the same mythological motifs return in our own day with the appearance of strong female warriors in virtually all action movies of recent years. All traces of vestigial patriarchy are being attacked to facilitate the return of the dominance of the Demetrian civilization.

Parallel with this movement, there is also the Aphroditic principle. The chthonic nature tries to reduce the masculine principle to the phallic. Men thus become enslaved to sensualism. Manifestations of this would include the addiction to pornography as well as the "hookup" culture. In the phallic, or genital, stage, sexuality is centered on the genitals and finds its fulfilment in intercourse. Yet, there is a further degeneration as predicted by **Herbert Marcuse** in *Eros and Civilization*: with the decline and overthrowing of patriarchy, people would become polymop-

hous perverse¹, that is, they would find sexual gratification beyond the socially normative behaviors permitted by the patriarchy.

Thus, both through force and seduction, the hold of patriarchy is weakened.

The Heroic age represents the attempt to recover the primordial solar state by force. The Heroes retain the inner impulse toward transcendence and overcome the Amazonian and Aphroditic forces. He sublimates the phallic, erotic drive raising it to the “spiritual plane of virility”.

Esoteric Astrology Evola makes a brief allusion to the esoteric science of astrology. In its degenerate form today, astrology has become merely materialistic and quantitative. Instead traditional astrology was spiritual and qualitative, as he explains:

The planets naturally are not the physical planets, but are designations used to define spiritual, super-individual forces, of which the physical planets are at most symbolic, sensible manifestations.

In other words, esoteric astrology represents our “essence”, who we are, what we are born with, something that in some way we ourselves have chosen or accepted. Pop astrology, on the other hand, is something that “happens” to us, from the outside, beyond our control, through merely material forces.

If you sense some truth in this, even if beyond the possibility of clear articulation, then you have the possibility to understand these ideas. We have been using the term “preconception” to describe this inner essence of who you are.

Manifestations of the Races of the Spirit In the *Sintesi*, Evola brings up the idea of the relationship between the third level of race and the second and first. Obviously, the first place to start is with the civilizations

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Polymorphous_perversity

that have been dominated by the various spiritual races. Here, Evola refers back to the collection of **J J Bachofen**'s writings that he translated under the title of *La Razza Solare*. I haven't been able to track down any copies of that work. However, I recently discovered that it has been republished, sort of, as *Le Madri e la Virilità Olimpica: Storia segreta dell'antico mondo mediterraneo*²; the other work apparently was never actually published.

That is why, in the German edition, Evola adds a paragraph making his ideas explicit since, obviously, German readers would have had no access to *La Razza Solare*. Here is the German paragraph, followed by an English translation.

Was die Entsprechung anbetrifft, die sich normalerweise zwischen Rassen des Geistes, der Seele und des Körpers verwirklichen soll, können also vorläufig diese Anspielungen genügen: die sonnenhaften und heroischen Rassen sind artverbunden dem Stil der Rasse des Leistungsmenschen und – als physische Rasse – dem nordisch-arischen, arisch-römischen und arisch-abendländischen Menschen. Die lunare Rasse fände den gemäßesten Ausdruck in den seelischen und somatischen Merkmalen der ostischen Rassen und den Überbleibseln jener uralten mittelmeerischen Rasse, die allgemein „pelasgisch“ genannt werden kann. Die aphroditische und dionysische Rasse könnte gut zu einigen Zweigen der westischen Rasse, insbesondere – wie gesagt – in ihren keltischen Formen passen. Die dionysische aber auch zur wüstenländischen und ostisch-baltischen Rasse und, ihren gespaltenen Aspekten nach, zur vorderasiatischen. Ein titanisches Element könnte sich wohl in der Seele und im Körper des Menschen fälischer Rasse ausdrücken, schließlich würde das tellurische Element physische Rassenkomponenten erfordern, die aus nichtarischen oder vorarischen Stämmen hervorgehen, wie es beispielsweise bei den

²<http://www.amazon.com/Madri-Virilit%C3%A0-Olimpica-dellantico-mediterraneo-ebook/dp/B00HA7ITSQ>

afrikanisch-mittelmeerischen und teilweise bei den im semitischen Typ vorhandenen Rassen der Fall ist. Es liegt also ein neues und weit gespanntes Forschungsfeld vor uns, für welches es hauptsächlich gilt, das ihm zustehende Interesse in den neuen Generationen zu wecken. Dann wird das schon Errungene entsprechend entwickelt werden bis zu einem wirklich umfassenden Rassenbewußtsein.

H/T to marcelkol³ for the following English translation:

In regard to the correlation that should manifest itself between the races of the body, the soul and the spirit the following remarks should suffice for now: the solar and heroic races are intimately connected with the nature of the man of achievement and – as physical race – with the Nordic-Aryan, Roman-Aryan and Occidental-Aryan human. The lunar race expresses itself in its most complete form in the soul and the body of the Eastern European races and the remnants of the old Mediterranean race which could generally be described as ‘Pelasgian’. The Dionysian and Aphroditic races could correspond to some branches of the Western race, especially – as already mentioned – in its Celtic forms. The Dionysian race could also correspond to the desert race and the East Baltic race, and – due to its conflicted aspects – to the Near Eastern race. A Titanic element could express itself in the body and the soul of the Phalian race, since the Telluric race would require a physical racial component stemming from non-Aryan or pre-Aryan lines, as is the case with the African-Mediterranean and some of the races of the Semitic type for example. We’re looking at a new and very broad field of research and priority should be given to awakening the interest of the young generations so our present knowledge can be developed further towards a comprehensive racial consciousness.

³<https://mmarcelkolatic.wordpress.com/>

The Amazonian Race When faced with the usurpations of the titanic type, a Demetrian race no longer has available the higher authority from above which is characteristic of solar man in order to reaffirm itself, and makes the violent and materializing forms of its adversary its own; it then marks out a new type, the Amazonian man. In the myth, the Amazon actually appears as the woman (lunar spirituality) who can no longer affirm herself against the abuses of man or, simply, up against man (Titanic spirituality), except by resorting to a mode of being that is just as masculine, diverging thereby from its original Demetrian nature. Briefly, it is a question of the usurpation of force on the part of degenerate lunar elements. More generally, the Amazonian man would be the type who remains lunar in essence, even if he asserts himself through the use of force, although the force is material, not spiritualized (as we will instead see to be the case for the heroic race). Thus, for example, as far as this rapprochement will seem paradoxical to some, there is an Amazonian phenomenon when a priestly caste challenges the secular power to impose dominion that can no longer be secured solely on the basis of its spiritual authority.

The myth shows us the contrast between the Amazons and both the Dionysian and heroic types. In the first case the defeated Amazons are brought back under the Demetrian law, that is, their normal mode of feminine-lunar being. In the second, their destruction gives rise to a new solar and masculine period. When one sees what the heroic type of race means in this context, everything will confirm the interpretation given. There could therefore be a certain relation between the Amazonian and the Titanic or Promethean man, since even the latter is characterized by the usurpation of a force which is not suitable to his own nature. However, in the case of the Amazonian man, it is a material force, while in the case of Titanism, it is instead a transcendent force, of which only

the solar type can take possession without an abuse of power. This short note will suffice, since it is not difficult to deduce the different distinctive characteristics for the type of Amazonian race through transpositions in the various domains.

The Aphroditic Race Another race of the spirit is the properly Aphroditic race; tellurism, i.e., the adherence to terrestriality, assumes the forms of an extreme refinement of material existence in it, and not infrequently then promotes an opulent development of everything that is pomp and luxury in the outer life, therefore also in the world of the Arts and aesthetic sentiment. But, in the inner life, a passivity and a lunar inconsistency subsist, compensated by a particular prominence given to eroticism thus also to everything which is related to woman, which then exercises control because of that and silently secures dominance for itself.

Bachofen followed the development of such a way of being in its relations with the twilight phases of the Dionysian and Aphroditic cult of antiquity. He even proposed a correspondence to the races of the body, where he noted the particular diffusion that these forms of ancient worship had among the Celtic races. It is indeed not arbitrary to recognize a strong component of the Aphroditic race both in the branch the race theorists call the West European race, as well in what Clauss defined as the type or race of the *Darbietungsmensch*. The Aphroditic race also preserves the Dionysian theme to a certain degree, where the quest for pleasure and sensation is unified in the joyful feeling of a destruction, of a passing away of sensation, i.e., of the same law of mortal natures, of life that rises and fatally dies in the eternal cycle of the generations.

The Aphroditic race on the one hand, and the telluric on the other, represent the extreme limits of the forms contained in the Nordic-Aryan cycle, the points beyond which they descend, through regression and through the lower elements introduced by crossbreeding, into the domain of the races of nature.

The Heroic Race Finally, we can consider the race of the heroes. The term hero is taken not in its common meaning, but with reference to the mythical traditions recounted by Hesiod, according to which, in the cycles of an already deviated and materialized humanity, Zeus, that is, the Olympic principle, generated a race virtually equipped with the possibility of regaining the primordial state through action, that golden or solar state of the first generation of the hyperborean cycle. Beyond the myth, it is a question of a type in which the Olympic or solar quality is no longer its nature, but a task, to be realized on the basis of distinct heredity or, better said, of a more pronounced atavistic component of the primordial race. Nevertheless, it alone is capable of making actual what had become latent and to regain what had been lost also by means of an internal transformation, of an overcoming, often depicted in terms of a second birth or initiation.

In *La Razza Solare* with the extracts from the works of Bachofen as well as a more precise description of these types, allusions to the most likely correspondence to the various races of the body are found and, in part, also to those of the research of the second degree that Clauss carried out. If we limit ourselves to pointing out the characteristics related to the highest plane, i.e., to the relationships of man with the spiritual world, in that work some applications and conclusions are found and one can find the values, institutions, symbols, customs, and forms of law that are predominantly reflected in one or the other race of the spirit.

Using such points of reference provides the possibility of surpassing two-dimensional history, of discovering the influences that have clashed, intertwined, or been superimposed behind the scenes of ancient civilizations and also the meaning of the prevalence, decline, or change of religious and ethico-social conceptions. One of our other works, *Revolt Against the Modern World* was an essay of such a metaphysics of the ancient civilizations, while in the extracts of Bachofen's works, many elements are pointed out that are apt to favour further researches in that

direction. Even many aspects of the modern world and contemporary civilization are presented in an unexpected and revealing light when this information is utilized.

We must not neglect to notice that some designations used by this classification of the races of the spirit—solar, telluric, lunar, etc. — like others that could have been adopted instead, while they were dictated by analogical reasons and references to typical ancient cults, they also raise the possibility of investigating the most profound meaning of traditions, like the one, e.g., according to which the decisive characteristics of men and even their terrestrial destinies, to a certain degree, would be determined by the choice of a given planet made by the spiritual nucleus of the personality before birth. For example, there is the conviction, professed even in the Roman world, that the regal man destined to regal dignity, because *dominus natus* [royal by birth], was the one who had made the influences of the sun his own. In this symbolic teaching that is found in much more precise and detailed forms in Aryan-Iranian and Indo-Aryan traditions, everything that we previously said in regard to the mystery of birth is veiled: the planets naturally are not the physical planets, but are designations used to define spiritual, super-individual forces (not without relationship to the notion of “demons” which everyone chooses), of which the physical planets are at most symbolic, sensible manifestations. The essence of such a doctrine is related therefore to that “nature” or transcendental election that was able, alone, to resolve the strongest objection that could be raised against the racial idea and the results of racial theory of the second degree, in their turn, can illuminate to the extent possible for human comprehension. Spontaneously beginning to hear terms like that of “solar man”, “lunar man”, etc., as apt and expressive, is already cogent for such an understanding.

Posted on 2015-07-01 by Aeneas

* * *

marcelkol on 2015-07-02 at 15:12 said:

The nomenclature of German 20th physical anthropology isn't very elaborate and doesn't translate to English very well, so the racial types described in this paragraph have to be understood as very general categories. Evola also draws on the racial classification developed by Ludwig F. Clauss which is concerned with the 'style' or nature, of the various physical races. This roughly corresponds to the second level of racial classification – the race of the soul – in Evola's system. Clauss coined the term 'Leistungsmensch', 'man of achievement', for a type who feels an irresistible pull towards the infinite, which he thought would correspond to the Nordic race of the body.

My translation (feel free to correct):

As regards to the correlation that should manifest itself between the races of the body, the soul and the spirit the following remarks should suffice for now: the solar and heroic races are intimately connected with the nature of the man of achievement and – as physical race – with the Nordic-Aryan, Roman-Aryan and Occidental-Aryan human. The lunar race expresses itself in its most complete form in the soul and the body of the Eastern European races and the remnants of the old Mediterranean race which could generally be described as 'pelasgian'. The Dionysian and Aphrodisian races could correspond to some branches of the Western race, especially – as already mentioned – in its Celtic forms. The Dionysian race could also correspond to the desert race and the Eastern-Baltic race, and – due to its conflicted aspects – to the West Asian race. A Titanic element could express itself in the body and the soul of the Falian race, since the Telluric race would require a physical racial component stemming from non-Aryan or pre-Aryan lines, as is the case with the African-Mediterranean and some of the races of the Semitic type for example. We're looking at a new and very broad field of research and priority should be given to awakening the interest of the young generations so our present knowledge can be developed further towards a comprehensive racial consciousness.

Of interest perhaps: the Falian type was often idealized in National-Socialist propaganda as the embodiment of the original German race, which was purported to exist in its highest purity in the peasants and the rural population. The fact that Evola identifies in this race the

Telluric-Titanic element in Europe shows the contrast between his thought and political reality at the time.

Max on 2015-07-14 at 16:06 said:

The spiritual races of Evola are different ways of relating to divine creation and its source – modes of being – that reveals something fundamental of the person. It affects ones “preconceptions”, of which some may be acquired but the true are innate and natural. The Spirit descends vertically, and the spiritual race describe how strong this influence is compared to the horizontal influence, and in which manner and degree it is known or felt by an individual. In the realm of spirit, beings are differentiated and unique, making the concept of spiritual race somewhat lacking as “race” may give the impression of something contingent. It rather seems to be used, in the “third degree”, to represent the manner in which existence itself is conceived, which is dependent on how we actually came into existence. It could be quite difficult for people with qualitatively different experiences in this area to understand another, transcendent, viewpoint. In short, what people believe regarding their own “genesis” expresses something of their inner nature. In a time like ours, the circumstances constitutes a “trial” and test of strength for anyone wishing to escape consensus reality. In another time, these sorts of challenges did not occur “naturally” in the same way, so there are advantages of living at this moment. The concrete state of the world has increasingly come to provide an outer resistance that could provide opportunities of spiritual growth for those with a heroic approach to life. Strangely enough, some who think of themselves as defenders of traditional values seem to be of the opinion that the only option is to passively await better times.

Evola mentioned that language is an area of investigation for the third degree of race, and I would like to draw attention to a perhaps insignificant detail that has occupied me. In Germanic languages “art” means “mode” “type” “manner” “species” or something of that nature, basically a unique way of being. In English on the other hand, art is a skill or the result of a creative work, and i think that we would come closer to the underlying idea by combining these aspects. The word is used in the German text presented here as “artverbunden” and translated as “intimately connected”. It is a matter of conforming to form, being freely “bound” to ones essence. We should also know that due to the free will of man, this amounts to a creative activity – we have to will ourselves. Man realizes himself, in a sense, by “creating himself” in union with the will of God. It is conveyed in the passage that a distinguishing mark of the solar and heroic races is as “man of achievement” – that is, a type that seeks to achieve himself to become accomplished. Compare the idea of the “solar race” with Aguéli’s claim of the Artist being someone who experiences a “personal sun” as an inner light to give expression to. This work amounts to actualizing ones potential, by which this light creatively comes to be known through a unique mode or art of being conforming to ones essence. Thus the heroic and solar man regards living itself as an art form to perfect during our brief time here.

Max on 2015-07-17 at 09:14 said:

To illustrate my previous comment, here is a quotation that is included in the last letter of the *Meditations on the Tarot*, treating the subject of art. We can see from the context that the author is aware of the multilayered meaning of the word even as it is not spelled out directly.

"Schopenhauer once said that things appear to the child so bathed in splendour and of such a paradisaical nature because they experience naively in each particular thing the idea of type (species). This splendour of inner reality is entirely lost for man who has attained to the maturity of rational thought, when he comes out of the 'childlike state' of animated and living perception and is given over to laws of pure abstraction. Thus, each time we are in the state of experiencing the idea in form, we are – like the child – within Nature. Goethe was such a child. (p. 114)" Edgar Dacqué, *Leben als Symbol*

Sparrow on 2018-03-17 at 01:05 said:

Despite how fascinating this is, I can't help but wonder how it is supposed to apply to the "real world." the abstract wording and lack of historical background makes it hard to see how it's any different from a fantasy novel about elves, giants, and other mythical beasts.

Furthermore, "The lunar race expresses itself in its most complete form in the soul and the body of the Eastern European races." Russian culture and history has been dominated by an absolute patriarchal father figure since time immemorial, and exalted masculinity, quite the opposite of the traits that are supposed to be the Lunar man.

Wouldn't it be better for young traditional-minded folk to read the heroism of Christ and the saints rather than what has no more basis in the Tradition of the West than a Dan Brown novel?

Aeneas on 2018-03-17 at 16:39 said:

Just because, Sparrow, it is so fascinating. You seem too stuck on the historical and the empirical, while the "real world" is happening on the astral and mythological planes.

7.1 The Demon Lover

Naida, at *Orphic Incendence*¹, reveals a strange aberration of the Animus archetype that she calls the Demon Lover². She describes one woman's experience this way:

The demon lover, the immature and cruel animus who was guiding her towards manic pursuit of external goals, was feeding and taking her life energy. While she was chasing all of those things, she was actually feeding him. Eventually, he showed his face and came to have a laugh at her inability to recognise his tricks.

The cruelest trick of all is to pretend to be the “good guy” in her life.

Almost universally, religions and spiritual traditions speak how demons do not always appear as ugly and fearsome, nor do they

¹<https://www.orphicincendence.com/post/the-sacred-center>

²<https://www.orphicincendence.com/post/the-demon-lover>

appear with knives and guns. Often, they are seductive, eloquent, beautiful, offering everything we think we need.

The danger of a woman's encounter with the demon lover should not be minimized. It can lead to disease, rage, depression, and even suicide. This encounter adversely effects family and love relationships. Yet, the demon lover is not undefeatable.

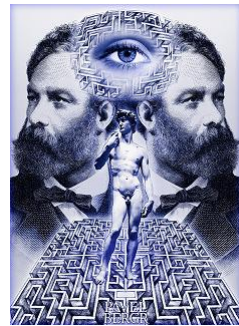
For the complete description of the demon lover and the path to spiritual and psychological healing, please visit *The Demon Lover* at *Orphic Incendence*.

Posted on 2021-03-11 by Cologero

Modern psychology: The Unconscious Mind

8.1 Madness and the Primordial State

Around 25 years or so ago, I attended a lecture by a Russian theosophist, then living in France. He described the spiritual experiences of an unusual young woman about 20 years of age. Coincidentally, on the way home, I was listening to a talk show on the radio, during which a young woman was describing her struggle with schizophrenia which began when she was also around 20 years old. I remember being struck by the similarity of the experiences of the two women. Unfortunately, I didn't take notes of either event, so I am unable to provide details. Nevertheless, the idea that mystical experience and schizophrenia are either similar or more likely often confused has stayed with me.



The Chiefest Blessings Socrates in the *Phaedrus* distinguishes between madness as an evil or human infirmity and different kind of madness “which is a divine gift, and the source of the chiefest blessings granted to men.” As for the latter, they can be categorized as follows (with their respective sources of inspiration):

- **Prophetic** madness (Apollo)
- **Initiatory** madness (Dionysus)
- **Poetic** madness (Muses)
- **Erotic** madness (Aphrodite and Eros)

Clearly, it would appear that at that time, there were many more men and women who were aware of a state closer to the Primordial State. They had a direct intuitive contact with the gods, which were the sources of the inspiration which, Socrates described, was “a divine release of the soul from the yoke of custom and convention.” Thus we see he is describing a state deeper than soul life. It is interesting to note, in passing, the structural similarity underlying the phenomena of prophecy, initiation, creativity, and love.

Schizophrenia In his work on the consciousness of men of early civilizations, **Julian Jaynes** makes note of the similarity of certain states of consciousness to schizophrenia. Although his perspective is scientific, some of his observations are of value. He rightly points out that we sometimes accidentally slip into something resembling the Primordial State. For example, we may “hear” critical voices, usually called the superego in psychology, or lose the sense of self, meaning the sense of the false self or analog I.

In the schizophrenic, these experiences are more extreme. Auditory hallucinations are stronger and their commands more insistent, there is

the loss of the sense of ego, as well as his internalized mental model of the world. On the more positive side, the schizophrenic often demonstrates tirelessness, concentration, and sharper sensory perception.

Nevertheless, this is far from the **Primordial State**, given the dysfunction of the schizophrenic. Like other modern men, the schizophrenic is centered in the soul life. Thus, commands allegedly from the gods or other higher powers, are experienced as exterior to himself. Since his soul life is disordered, they are distorted by the turbulences in his own consciousness. He has no spirit, or *nous*, to moderate his erotic and thumotic impulses, so the commands get confused and intermingled with unintelligent desires. This is why his behavior will be erratic, unpredictable, or even evil.

Metaphysical Interpretation The “gods” represent higher non-formal states of being. Since in the Primordial State, one’s center is in non-formal manifestation, the commands are not experienced as alien, but rather as originating from one’s deepest center. To be experienced, however, they must be reflected in consciousness, that is, in one’s soul life, or as subtle manifestation. In the Primordial State, that consciousness is pure and not disturbed by idle fantasies, random thoughts, negative emotions, pointless desires. Thus the commands are clear and unambiguous; hence they are the expression of one’s True Will.

The center of the True Man transcends the soul life, which is experienced as exterior to himself, just as much so as is the exterior world of the trees, birds, mountains, and oceans.

Posted on 2011-01-31 by Cologero

* * *

Exú on 2015-11-07 at 18:04 said:

I can really tell about this subject, being my self a psychotic, not a schizophrenic but a paranoid, that means, a organized psychotic, i can really tell that i was always aware in a way or

another, of the primordial self, that self that did not have any specific desire, or should I say, had the desire of cleaning my self from the pain, that was always exposed to me, since contrary to what happens to the neurotic, we do not have the repression that you "normal" people have, so the emotional pain was always following me, but it was not strong enough, to cloud the true self. The "unconsciousness" is open to the psychotic, and we are getting more and more conscious.

8.2 Entheogens

The use of mind-altering drugs has been associated with various mystical, magical, and shamanic rites. This is very appealing to the modern mind which is impressed by technological and materialistic explanations. Entheogens, or drug use for allegedly spiritual purposes, began to be widespread in the 1960s following the discovery of the psychedelic drug LSD and the ensuing publicity. The early adopters can be easily found, but we will focus on **Timothy Leary**, an erstwhile professor of psychology at Harvard University. He initially ran experiments with the drug as a form of therapy, but eventually began experimenting on himself and the group of acolytes who assembled around him.

Leary believed that psychedelics could open up the mind to greater spiritual experiences and encourage their use for explorers of the mind. The stars were aligned: the books of **Carlos Castaneda** came out shortly thereafter. Filled with wild tales of a Mexican shaman whose knowledge of plant-based drugs led to amazing powers, the books became the spiritual nourishment for many. The Beats became users as well as high profile entertainers. Even **Alan Watts**, after allegedly years of Eastern practices, eventually resorted to LSD experiments to learn about the "mystical experience". For anyone who has spent hours at a Zen center walking in circles while chanting Buddhist texts, or sitting still in Zazen, the idea of an instant pill could sound truly appealing.

At any given moment we are bombarded with external sensations, a "blooming buzzing confusion" (**William James**), from which we choose

a world. Simultaneously, although few pay attention to it, we are the receivers of thoughts of all types from various sources, or levels of reality. Normally, they dissipate or recede into the memory. Sometimes, the thoughts are powerful enough to come into our attention, then related thoughts latch onto each other, often producing a strong sensation. This may be as simple as reviewing plans for the day.

But the most powerful arise from the internal forces of *eros* and *thymos*, which, at the most primeval, are experienced as sex and violence. Hence, a sexual fantasy will totally engage our minds for an extended period, even to the point of affecting the body as if an actual sexual encounter were taking place. Fantasies arising from *thymos* usually take the form of domination, anger, revenge, and the like. Hence, we envision ourselves as wildly successful in some realm. Or we may recall a past slight, which even agitates the body. We will envision the cutting phrase we should have used against someone, but didn't. It goes on and on.

Most people, unfortunately, cannot shut these thought threads down. They may cause continuing anxiety and self-doubt. The neutralizing force, the *nous*, whose task is to dominate and channel the forces of *eros* and *thymos*, is too weak, or, in truth, is not even known. The *nous* must transcend these forces, fantasies, and thoughts, regarding them as arbitrary, contingent, and external to one's true self. Instead, people regard these emotions, fantasies, and thoughts as their "own", even though they are totally unaware of their true source.

Psychedelics work by slowing down the awareness of these impinging thoughts. Thus, a particular thought—that may be pushed aside by a stronger thought in the ordinary state of consciousness—instead can take hold in consciousness. Then, related thoughts can follow along in sequence producing an extended vision. This is called a "rush", and is the pleasurable sensation associated with psychedelics. For artist and mystic types, these are regards as deep insights or creative inspirations. However, I have also seen those on a "bad trip", during which the user experiences

inconsolable anxiety, requiring an antidote such as thorazine.

It should be clear that the theory behind the use of entogens for spiritual “enlightenment” is deeply flawed. It assumes that such enlightenment involves a particular experience, or set of experiences, that are somehow to be distinguished from all other experiences. This idea comes from the confusion of the psychic and the spiritual.

RENE GUENON, *The Reign of Quantity*

An intellectual conversion, the only thing that enlightenment can mean, involves the nous. The nous transcends the psychic, it transcends every experience whatsoever, whether a brilliant insight or a bad trip. Instead of moving from rush to rush, the mind becomes clear, thoughts separate from each other, are rarer, and seem heavier, or else are wisper, evaporating as soon as they appear. Such a man is free; by definition, then, it cannot depend on some biochemical agent.

Posted on 2012-06-20 by Cologero

* * *

Dominion on 2012-06-21 at 01:42 said:

“Instead of moving from rush to rush, the mind becomes clear, thoughts separate from each other, are rarer, and seem heavier, or else are wisper, evaporating as soon as they appear.”

This sounds like an experience or change that the nous is undergoing, as far as I can tell. Now, that the brain, which creates the ego, is material is a self-obvious thing. However, since the brain and the ego it creates are physical, they are part of a metaphysical reality. Overcoming the ego, which in transient, and identifying with the metaphysical reality which is eternal, is how the true Self is discovered. Evola, in *Revolt*, uses the image of Krsna and Arjuna riding in the chariot in the Bhagavad-Gita; Arjuna represents the ego, involved in the world, doing battle, its vision obscured by ignorance and transience. Krsna, of course, is the true Self, who holds the reign of the chariot, who is aware and indeed a manifestation of the Supreme Reality, Brahman (through Vishnu).

Though I have not taken DMT or other entheogenic drugs, I understand that they (especially DMT, which was used by many shamanic tribes) have the biochemical effect of breaking down the ego that the brain has created. They are thus material substances having a material effect on a material brain which creates the ego. When this ego is broken down, reports I have read claim that the resulting effect is one where you appear to see reality in a new way and comprehend its nature in a way which the ego prevented one from doing so before. Now although this effect passes, I see no reason why it could not be a valuable aid to the mind in understanding intellectually the transcendent metaphysical reality of which the physical is but a part.

Logres on 2012-06-21 at 10:40 said:

A mind altering drug would only be useful to someone who didn't need it or else everyone would become a shaman.

Cologero on 2012-06-21 at 12:12 said:

That's the democratic way, Logres! That is why a few weeks ago I pointed out the essential egalitarian nature of drug and alcohol use, although it was met with incomprehensible opposition.

Nonamynous on 2012-06-22 at 06:18 said:

This article is a superb explication of drug use vis-à-vis the elements of intelligence.

It must, however, be faulted for not explicitly differentiating, in its criticism, between modern Western drug 'experimentation' and the use of psychoactive substances within the strict context of traditional ritual. The term 'entheogen' despite being an awkward neologism, is more applicable to the latter case; in the former, there is at best only an aspiration toward 'entheogeny'.

Nothing can really be said against Dominion's statement here, provided we accept the caveat that it only applies to the actual or potential 'l'uomo differenziato' with some preparatory theoretical knowledge: "I see no reason why it could not be a valuable aid to the mind in understanding intellectually the transcendent metaphysical reality of which the physical is but a part." Yet this understanding will never be imposed by the effects of a drug, where transient (and basically illusory) insights are lost as regular consciousness is reinstated. Drugs are dissolutive agents; coagulation is the positive phase of the work.

Drug use is not entirely a 'democratic way' because the effects ultimately differ from one person to the next. But we understand what you mean.

Jupiter on 2012-06-23 at 08:17 said:

Unfortunately the simple fact is that the philosophical and spiritual oppositions the Traditionalist school, and thinkers influenced by them, have to the usage of mind-altering substances

are entirely incongruous with the basic historical reality of the matter.

Cologero on 2012-06-23 at 10:12 said:

Best wishes on your spiritual quest, Jupiter. There are some exotic bath salts available in Miami, and I've heard rumours of spiritual enlightenment becoming a mass phenomenon there. There may even be cults like the Aghori¹. Remind me to send you a link!

Avery on 2012-06-23 at 22:27 said:

Not just Miami – they're causing life-changing mystical experiences in California², and transforming the way we see art criticism in Denver³. Yes, bath salts are the preferred method of experiencing modernity.

Jupiter on 2012-06-24 at 01:17 said:

Nice strawmen, fellows.

You explain the frequency of cannabis and other psychoactive herbs in archaeological digs associated with Indo-European, Indo-Iranian, and Indo-Aryan ethno-linguistic groups, if such things are so entirely outside the realm of orthodoxy, not to mention the frequent references in Vedic and Tantric texts.

Cologero on 2012-06-24 at 09:40 said:

Not a straw man, Jupiter, you made a claim about the usage of "mind altering substances", and now you add in archaeological digs. What we pointed out is that the usage of mind altering substances is with us today and we don't need any "digs" to prove it. What these examples do show is that drug use in itself is insufficient to lead to any sort of understanding of "orthodoxy".

So, what we can't see, and you have provided no justification yourself, is the alleged connection with "orthodoxy". As for orthodoxy, we can point out the ultimate goal as Guenon describes it:

the summit of the initiatic hierarchy [is] the Supreme Identity, the absolutely permanent and unconditioned state beyond the limitations of all contingent and transitory existence

¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3161>

²<http://www.dailymail.co.uk/news/article-2163641/Robert-William-White-bashes-elderly-womans-head-shovel-high-bath-salts.html>

³<http://www.nydailynews.com/news/woman-claims-bath-salts-fueled-destruction-30-million-painting-article-1.1100993>

Clearly, this is not a description of an intoxicated state, which is necessarily conditioned by the "psychoactive herb". So perhaps you mean they can be an "aid" at some stage of the initiatic path. Perhaps you have this statement from Guenon in mind:

The diversity of methods corresponds to the very diversity of individual natures for which they were made; there is a multiplicity of ways all leading to a unique goal.

The temptation, then, may be that psychoactive drugs may be appropriate for some "individual natures". However, "orthodoxy" requires an active intellect, whereas the drug experience is entirely passive. Hence, it can have no place in any "method". It can never be any more than a human, all-too-human, means, something exterior rather than interior. Guenon makes this all too clear:

degrees [of initiation] ... are not achieved by the outer and human means ... but exclusively as a result of a completely interior work.

Although I have no interest in your personal life, Jupiter, if you came here for some sort of intellectual justification for your personal peccadilloes, you will be disappointed. The alleged finds of archaeology prove nothing about Tradition; only an understanding of principles can do so. Regretfully, I will have to put you under moderation unless you show you can grasp that distinction.

Paulo on 2014-09-02 at 22:15 said:

Entheogens have made a truly miracle in my life, they help me to find my will. It is funny, but it seems that there is really some entitie in them. The awareness that you have during the experience is something that goes on and on. Every gain that you have stays with you, so there is no "coming back" from the trip. The drawbacks are in most cases caused by the person itself, that cannot deal with some facets of himself. The sad thing is that the majority of people does not have the inner drive to transcendence, so the use of those substances will not help them too much!

F on 2019-06-20 at 02:56 said:

I think the right drugs can definitely act as a shortcut, but they are extremely dangerous at that.

Like anything from the LHP it's a double edged sword.

When you take a shortcut and skip the work that morally prepares you it just ends up turning on you and end up with more than you gambled for.

And you don't want to gamble with this.

Michael on 2020-06-20 at 18:32 said:

"Instead of moving from rush to rush, the mind becomes clear, thoughts separate from each other, are rarer, and seem heavier, or else are wisper, evaporating as soon as they appear."

On these types of thoughts that seem heavier, is it like a voice that is so quick and immediate yet seems like not of one's own individual mind, generally answering a question or directing a command that does not conflict with metaphysics?

For the wisper, are these like remembering in a dream? That sensation of words which you are barely holding onto, tightening a grip will let them loose but allowing them to come and go allows for a type of current?

Thanks!

8.3 Journey to the Center of the Mind

The spiritual adepts were inner-world adventurers of the highest daring, the Tibetan equivalent of our astronauts—I think it is worth coining the term 'psychonaut' to describe them. They personally voyaged to the furthest frontiers of that universe which their society deemed vital to explore: the inner frontiers of consciousness itself, in all its transformations in life and beyond death.

HUSTON SMITH, Introduction to *The Tibetan Book of the Dead*

It should be clear that the theory behind the use of enthogens for spiritual "enlightenment" is deeply flawed. It assumes that such enlightenment involves a particular experience, or set of experiences, that are somehow to be distinguished from all other experiences. This idea comes from the confusion of the psychic and the spiritual.

RENE GUENON, *The Reign of Quantity*

The idea that hallucinogens could produce a transcendental experience is shocking. The drug merely uncovers the normally unconscious functional layer of perceptual and emotional variants,

which are psychologically transcendent, but by no means “transcendental”, i.e. — metaphysical.

CARL JUNG

Knowledge is a function of being. When there is a change in the being of the knower, there is a corresponding change in the nature and amount of knowing.

ALDOUS HUXLEY, *The Perennial Philosophy*

The Doors of Perception Aldous Huxley was a popularizer of the so-called Perennial Philosophy, a term first coined by Leibniz. In his book of that same title, he introduced several topics supported with extensive quotes from mystics and sages of several Traditions. This has two benefits to the reader:

- To pick out the highlights of the various traditions. At its best, the quotes should encourage readers to learn more about the topic. At its worst, it provides quotes to be repeated on social media to create the spectacle of wisdom.
- By pointing out similar notions from different traditions, it shows that these topics have some objective validity and are not matters of blind faith to specific religions.

Unfortunately for Huxley, the mere repetition of beautiful and enticing quotes does not a mystic make. He seems not to have followed a specific tradition. Moreover, there is a shadow side to the Perennial Philosophy. Bad things can happen and humans are subject to malevolent influences. As he points out, knowledge requires a change in being, and that change requires purifications of the mind, will, and emotions.

That sounds difficult, so Huxley looked for a shortcut. In *Doors of Perception*, he describes his experiences with psychedelic substances. It is impossible for chemicals to create a change in being that he is seeking. That is because consciousness and intellect transcend the material world and thus cannot be changed by any material cause. Quite the contrary, intellectual knowledge brackets out the world of the senses in a series of abstractions.

Nevertheless, he persisted on his own course. Even when he was suffering severely from cancer, on his deathbed he was administered large doses of LSD by his wife. She describes his death as very peaceful, something confirmed by the medical professionals standing by. However, it is not obvious that death should be easy nor that fear is unnatural. Certainly, on the other side, life is not necessarily butterflies and lollipops. Au contraire, had Huxley paid closer attention to his sources, he should have noticed that.



A very wise friend recently explained to me that fear and pain should not always be hidden with drugs. For example, professional musicians often use beta blockers to slow down their heart rates before a performance. For example, performing on stage is like confronting the fear of death; the solution is to recognize it as the illusion it is. Midwives discourage the use of epidural anesthesia, claiming that the avoidance of pain turns the mother into a zombie.

Exploring Inner Space Timothy Leary was a psychology professor at Harvard, doing experiments with LSD. Apparently, things got out of hand. He and his colleague Richard Alpert, NKA Ram Dass, were dismissed from their positions.

Leary continued on as a prophet of some sort, encouraging seekers to explore the new frontier of Inner Space, rather than the more glamorous

Outer Space. He used the *Tibetan Book of the Dead* as a guide to help those on LSD trips. His life took some rather colorful turns, as he got in trouble with the law once LSD was criminalized. You can look that up on your own. He was also a model for a resuscitated Order of the Golden Dawn.

Ram Dass, a graduate of my alma mater, went off on a more mystical direction. He embraced Oriental spiritual teachings and also those of Alice Bailey who claimed to have channeled advanced teachings from a Tibetan master. Since I was enamored by anything Tibetan at that time, I ate it all up.

Better Living through Chemistry Decades after Huxley and Leary, it has all come to naught. They left behind nothing but a set of aspirations. At that time, their chemically aided spiritual quest was intended for intellectuals competent to understand the truly valid traditional teachings that they knew. There was a genuine desire for spiritual enlightenment; entheogens were not used for pleasure nor to deaden pain, but rather, naively in retrospect, to bring enlightenment.

Since the world of experience is a sensual representation of it in consciousness, these psychedelic drugs distort that psychical process. Hence, the conclusion seems to be that our collective representations of the world are rather arbitrary. In a sense, that is perfectly true, although chemicals won't bring us to the correct representation. Better living through chemistry does not apply to metaphysical teachings.

Now that drug usage has become the sport of the masses, it has lost its allure. There is no pretense of seeking any sort of enlightenment. Rather than the boom for humanity that the early adopters assumed, drugs are a bane, causing addiction, misery, and premature death. Obviously, if drugs truly are the shortcut to mystical knowledge, then the USA would be the most enlightened country on Earth. The evidence is just the opposite.

The Spiritual Quest So that's how I started the journey to the center of the mind. I can tell you strange stories, but for now I'll keep them private. It turned into a lifelong project with some occasional interruptions due both to temptations and the years spent as a householder. In a short time, I embraced a more sold path, leaving the chemical brothers as an old memory. Only 3 knights who set out on the quest were able to reach the Holy Grail. So there is little reason to be hopeful about all the noisy parties posting useless advice on social media.

There is no Yellow Brick Road for the Knight to follow. Rather he has to start from wherever he is, not where he should be. Nor is the destination marked; it requires a process of trial and error.

A Knight does not choose his battles; rather he has to the fight the battles that come to him.

Art works: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1qNrAB-mNww>

Posted on 2021-09-23 by Cologero

* * *

Ismo Meinander on 2021-09-24 at 05:57 said:

You too have been enamored by Bailey? I ingested her works in the past also. Channeling seems to be the new theosophy. I have no doubts about mental telepathy, but I very much doubt Bailey's advanced knowledge nowadays and stay out of it.

I have been addicted to cannabis since 16 years old. I left it behind for years only to find myself again ingesting the substance; despair and insomnia were two reasons for coming back to usage. Only lately I have been able to leave it behind, and I feel like born again. What a wretched being I was about to become.

veritycacciatrix on 2021-09-24 at 17:03 said:

I enjoyed Huxley's 'Door's'. it was colourful, but as synthetic as 'Fear and Loathing' and 'On the Road'.

About 15 years ago someone gifted me a signed copy of 'House of Leaves'. Not my usual taste but what the heck.

'Leaves' is literally a journey to the centre of the protagonists mind, with parallel tales of those who went mad in the same space using the metaphor of a strange black house, its shifting and dark internal space, and its exploration.

It's en par with Huxley, Thompson et al., not that it's a peer of those genres (nor generation), yet as far as 'journey to the centre of the mind' goes, it absolutely is.

What I took from it was that one must employ courage and will in driving thoughts to their logical destination at the farthest branch of an idea, because one may descend into black madness if one stops from fear, or leaps chemically from one 'twig' to the other without the benefit of pre-prepared, intellectual 'weight-bearing' branches. But if carried all the way one ought find a comfortable corner of Reality where sleep is healthy and sound.

Hell is a great way to flesh out the corridors of a mind to see where the 'house-owner' ends up. Mad? Addicted? Lonely? Smiling at God with the sun on their face?

I'm sleeping well these days.

8.4 New Thought and Tradition

Every day, in every way, I am getting better and better

EMILE COUÉ

Before providing translations of **Julius Evola's** essays on the New Thought movement in Europe and the ideas of Emile Coué, I want to offer some personal observations. I will also supplement Evola's material with the comparable ideas from in Fr. **Alois Wiesinger's** book *Occult Phenomena*.

Some time ago, at the beginning of the eighties, I received in the mail an offer to subscribe to a glossy magazine promising in depth articles on various traditions. I decided to take a subscription to it. I don't recall the name of it now. They only published a few numbers before they ceased operations. However, they did offer a selection of similar magazines that agreed to fulfill the remainder of the subscription. There was one that grabbed my attention. It represented a point of view that I had never previously confronted. To top it off, it purported to combine two topics of intense interest to me: science and the mind.

The small magazine was called the “**Science of Mind**” and, since it was already paid for, I decided to take it. As I learned more about that movement, I discovered that it was part of a larger movement called “New Thought” and was a cousin of Christian Science. Its influence in popular culture has been great as it has appeared in many guises: most recently as the “Law of Attraction”, but also in Positive Thinking, and even among neo-Christians such as the infamous Joel Osteen. I won’t go into the entire history of the movement, but suffice it to say that I spent several years taking various classes and studying the relevant texts.

I always heard in Science of Mind classes that they teach what the “mystics have always taught”. That motivated me to actually read those mystics for myself. The results were mixed. Yes, there were ideas from the mystics and also many distorted Hermetic and esoteric teachings in New Thought. That just gave me the motivation to seek out the real thing itself. I will here mention a few of those ideas and conclude with what the mystics really taught.

Pragmatism The American philosopher **William James**, in *The Varieties of Religious Experience*, considered New Thought (or Mind Cure) as the religion of healthy mindedness. In contrast, he regarded the major representatives of the major traditions as “morbid-minded”. This is reminiscent of the flaccid distinction made by some between “life affirming” and “life denying” religions. Pragmatism does not bother with the truth value of a thought or theory but rather is concerned only with its effects. Specifically, Prof James feels that being “healthy minded” in the sense he means by it is a desirable goal. Hence, any belief that leads to that psychological state is considered “true”.

Pragmatism has infected Western thought in unsuspected ways. It explains, for example, the worst of political correctness. Its adherents, for example, desire a particular social state of affairs. Hence, any idea or outlook that tends to promote that social state is considered true or valid,

while any idea that threatens to undermine that state must be vehemently repressed. The result is that anyone who wants to look at things “scientifically” or “objectively” can only be frustrated in verbal confrontations with the other group. Of course, “science” itself can be distorted and used in a pragmatic way, hence it is not the defeater in an argument that some would hope for. Pragmatism is a sophisticated philosophy, so it is beside the point to consider progressives as evil or stupid. A more sophisticated worldview is the antidote.

We see pragmatism used in an unsophisticated way among the so-called new/alt right or neo-traditionalist crowd. The distinguishing feature uniting them is the emphasis on “race” or other form of zoological identitarianism. Hence, they evaluate every worldview, politico-philosophical system, religion, or tradition by how well it promotes their view of identity. There is no other standard, not even the truth of the idea. Just to be clear once again, for Tradition, the fundamental identity is that of Spirit, prior to any other form of identity. Such a position is immune to the ravages of pragmatism.

Visualizations The goal of New Thought, in all its guises, is some form of magic and techniques associated with magic are thus employed. However, the magic is on the level of the personal. Sorcery, or the use of lower forces, is not deliberately used. Neither is the higher form of sacred magic at issue. New Thought does not believe in a cosmic law or a divine person. Rather divinity is regarded as impersonal, subject to certain laws which an agent can use to his advantage. Oftentimes, the “universe” is substituted for divinity, as the “universe will provide” or “respond”.

Hence New Thought movements use some variation of thought control and/or visualization, which is really a form of concentration although I never encountered any teachers teaching concentration as such. The premise is that such practices can alter persons, places, things, or conditions. Visualizing objects of desire will somehow bring them into one’s

possession. Of course, in Hermetic practice, visualizations are used to lead to higher states of consciousness. For example, one may visualize being in the presence of higher beings, a practice which may lead one to that state. It would be incorrect to believe that such visualizations are ineffective. In actuality, we are creating our selves, or our self images, on an ongoing basis via unconscious visualizations throughout the day.

Mind Treatments and the Unconscious Instead of visualizations, usually thoughts are more commonly used. For example, I may say, if I feel ill, that “I am well and in perfect health”. This is supposed to counteract the initial thought of disease. However, a few minutes per day of positive thoughts are seldom sufficient to counteract the 60,000 thoughts per day that flow randomly through one’s consciousness.

A favorite Biblical quote in this movement is “As a man thinketh in his heart, so he is.” Now that makes more sense, since the heart is one’s intellectual center which, in a fully developed person, dominates the other functions of the mind. But, those thoughts are beyond words and conscious thought are merely their reflection in the mind. As such, they cannot be controlled at will, but through mental purification, perhaps truly higher thoughts will dwell in one’s heart. However, such thoughts will be unrelated to the desire for a new Maserati or an Alaskan cruise.

Mantras Now there are certainly stories about miraculous events effectuated through mystics. In genuine mysticism, this will be the result of sacred magic and will have a totally different character from personal magic or sorcery. New Thought is not interested in sacred magic, gnosis, or higher states. On the contrary, it prides itself on being “practical” (or “pragmatic”), so that it can use the occult forces for personal benefit in a more or less mechanical way. There is no emphasis at all on any sort of purification of the types explained in Julius Evola’s essay recently made available on this blog.

Now the repetition of positive thoughts in a “mind treatment” is ultimately ineffective without such purification. Such a mind treatment is really a form of mantra “although one can repeat it a million times, but as long as it is not *known*, it remains a mere flapping of the lips”. Hence, the missing link in New Thought is that gnosis. Certainly, thought has an influence in the world of manifestation, since knowing the true name of a thing is to know its essence. However, the true gnosis of a mantra requires intense development, which is not a part of any New Thought teaching. Moreover, such a thinking is not merely passive in the sense that the “universe will respond” to one’s thoughts. Rather, there has to be a force or will associated with it.

The Placebo Effect and the Unconscious A simpler explanation of certain results that make New Thought plausible is the “placebo effect”, by which a materially ineffective medication actually produces a real healing provided the person truly believes the medication is effective. Emile Coué, in his work as a pharmacist, noted that his customers would often report a cure even when he gave them a placebo, or inert sugar pill. Due to space considerations, I will treat this in a separate post.

It is interesting to see how esoteric ideas get distorted in the popular mind. That is why such teachings can be hidden in “plain view”. It is also why “initiation” is necessary, or else their true significance might never be realized.

After a post on the metaphysical basis of what is valid in New Thought, based on Fr. Wiesinger’s book *Occult Phenomena*, we will present an alternative worldview, the one that the mystics actually taught.

Posted on 2013-11-18 by Cologero

* * *

JA on 2013-11-19 at 12:12 said:

I am not at all familiar with new thought; is Thelema connected with it ? also this sounds like A Course in Miracles and other things I've found in New Age bookstores.

Cologero on 2013-11-19 at 13:41 said:

Yes, JA, it is the pervasive ideology behind New Age movements. A Course in Miracles is certainly related, although Charles Upton gives it a rather extended analysis in one of his books.

Jacob on 2013-11-21 at 20:02 said:

I agree Cologero. When I think New Thought I think of people like Napoleon Hill or even Deepak. It seems the New Thought movement seeks shallow and fading things (usually money it seems). It appears to try the exact opposite of Stoicism. Really interested in Evola's thoughts.

Pickman on 2013-11-27 at 22:40 said:

Would Eckhart Tolle fall into this category? He does seem to abide by the new age theory of human "spiritual evolution" yet his practice entails a no-mind state of being similar to the Upanishads.

Ash on 2013-11-30 at 18:52 said:

It appears to me that as a whole, New Thought has a lot less publicity now than it did from around the 70's to the early 2000's. A lot of that seems to have been the vehement attack on New Thought by the New Atheist/Skeptic crowd, which did do a lot of good in exposing charlatans who had been fleecing their flocks for quite a pretty penny. I'd say the types of "thought control" more present today (at least in cities and academia) are those coming from the ideologies seeking to dismantle "gender binaries" and other remaining traditional conceptualizations. Speaking personally, the main appearances New Thought has made around me has been with bored housewives and alienated businessmen.

Of course, that doesn't discount how similar ideas/delusions regarding our minds and how our personal wishes create reality have made inroads into our culture. I highly recommend the documentary "Century of the Self", which details this process from Freud til the end of the 20th century, including how these mindsets have been used to exercise control over consumers, political movements, etc. Applying the mental disciplines this blog talks about would disrupt powerful networks in our society if even a tiny percentage of the population began to practice them.

B on 2014-01-26 at 08:38 said:

New Thought has shed its skin but you can still see in a more materialist guise neurolinguistic programming (nlp) and many other quirky forms of self-help. If you add a fair dose of

pop-culture it reappears as chaos magick, which is often an important component of many magic-centered communities.

Whether 'New Thought' is to be blamed for the cultural relativism at the heart of political correctness I am not sure: you could just as well blame Nietzsche or any solipsist for that matter?

For those reading French, here is a link to an article by Guenon on Bergson, and, en passant, William James – I would imagine this will be relevant:

<http://esprit-universel.over-blog.com/ren%C3%A9-gu%C3%A9non-la-%C2%AB-religion-%C2%BB-d%E2%80%99un-philosophe>

8.5 The German New Thought Movement

This essay was originally published by **Julius Evola** in *Bilchnis* in June, 1928. It is a review of the *Neugeist* movement in Germany, which was derived from the **New Thought** movement in USA that had been developing previously. Now "Neugeist" is the German translation of "New Thought", but, following Evola, I have sometimes translated it as "New Spirit" ... Evola sometimes uses the German term, and others the Italian *Spirito Nuovo*, a convention which I have followed. The essay will be presented in two parts. This first part is a general introduction. The second part will describe the actual exercises recommended by the New Thought Alliance.

These early articles from Evola that I have been posting demonstrate his spiritual quest, and are quite removed from the later preoccupations with politics, race, etc. It is clear, if readers will look back over the many reviews translated here, that Evola was willing to accept a form of Christianity that was "practical", mystically inclined, and aligned more with Eastern teachings. Apparently, he was never able to find it, since he subsequently turned away from that quest. He even rejected what he, not incorrectly, called the "vedantized Christianity" of Guido De Giorgio.

The other failed quest was Evola's search for "special" powers, whether in the Tibetan Buddhists, yogis, or even the "New

Spirits". It is clear, given the number of references to them, that he was obsessed with the idea. Once again, all the magical exercises probably did not create those powers in the expected way. His correspondence with **Rene Guenon**, which was have made available, show this.

As for the German New Spirits, they seem to have disappeared without a trace; I am only familiar with Driesch, but only in a different context. I am sure that they were more intellectually sophisticated than their American counterparts. Since New Thought owed a certain intellectual debt to German philosophy, the Neugeist movement probably found a point of contact in it.

Of course, in a sense, they were on the right track. Thoughts do control our lives, that is why we deem it so important to understand one's own thought process. However, they seemed to have been inventing stuff on the fly without ties to a formal tradition. They retained the language of Christianity, but not its essence. As Guenon makes clear, the esoteric cannot be divorced from the exoteric, something that the New Spirits believed they could do. That is why the movement had to fail. On the other hand, a **Valentin Tomberg**, for example, managed to keep the esoteric and the exoteric together. That is the path to the future, the worthwhile way to "change your life"; this path is immune to the petty criticisms of the dominant — and only — Western tradition that are heard in some circles.

In contemporary central Europe one of the spiritual currents that is gaining more ground, is that of the New Thought Alliance (*Neugeistbund*). In essence, it is an offshoot of that reaction against religious dogmatism and scientific materialism, that that had already given rise to other more or less spiritual and mystical movements, like New Thought [in English in original], neo-Rosicrucianism, Christian Science, Anglo-Indian Theosophy and even spiritism. In regards to Neugeist there is however a sense of seriousness and enthusiasm not very common in most of these

sects.

Not that it represents actually something original and united: on the contrary, there are clearly found in it ideas from Hindu yoga, medieval mysticism, and even classic German thinkers like Herder, Lessing, Goethe, Schiller, while on the practical side, the influence of the studies on autosuggestion brought in vogue by Coué and Baudouin is very clear. In spite of all this syncretism, in Neugeist there is a certain impulse that in a good measure unifies such elements close to an experienced need to bring man to recapture the sense of interiority and spiritual force.

The movement has its center in Pfullingen (Württemberg), where the editor J. Baum publishes the review *Die Wiesse Fahne* and a collection of small volumes among which in fact there are enough good ones (e.g., F. Eberspacher, *Der Giest sie Führer*, K. O. Schmidt, *Selbst und Lebensbemesterung durch Gedankenkraft* and *Wie knonzentriere ich mich?*, etc.). From Pfullingen, the movement extends especially toward Switzerland, Hungary, and Austria, where it has another organ: *Das Neue Licht*, edited by F. V. Schöffel. There are among the adherents some rather noted names, such as Prof Verweyen and the vitalist H. Driesch.

Neugeist intends to be essentially a practical spiritualism, an active mysticism, with disdain for everything that is simple theory or belief. "Neugeist", says Eberspacher, "as vision of the world proceeds from this principle: that no knowledge has value if it is not applied practically; that the best ideas serve no purpose, if they are not transformed into action. Men must instill practically every day in life the teachings of a vision of the world."

The first opposition is naturally to materialism; in the second, to the ancient concept of faith and religion, which it wants precisely to replace with the New Spirit (*Neugeist*). According to this ancient concept, says the author cited above, "faith is nothing more than believing in undemonstrated propositions. Instead, for the New Spirit, faith is a force, by means of which the highest energies can be awakened." Dogma and

confession are enemies and lethal for the spirit. Neugeist wants to be an “*undogmatisches Tatchristentum*”, i.e., an active Christianity without dogmas.

At the center of its praxis, there is the concept of the sovereignty and power of thoughts. “First of all, the most powerful of all forces lies in the force of thought. The entire cosmos, all forms, and all phenomena, starting from the atom up to the solar system, are nothing if not materializations of the thought of God. Thoughts construct character, form bodies and faces, regulate health, determine our external relations, our destiny, happiness, or misfortune, the joy or sorrow of men. That which we form, shape, produce, is our creation from the inside—thoughts are the seeds, and the fruit is our fate, our good or our evil.” (*Schöffel in Das Neue Licht*).

That said, it is clear that attention is then brought to the techniques to make oneself master of thought in order to act, by means of it, in the direction of spirituality, elevation, and strength, on which it depends. Hence, the noted connection of Neugeist with the teaching of Yoga, with the modern practices of suggestion and autosuggestion, with the mystical disciplines of silence and meditation, purified however of their devotional or moral coloration and undertaken only from the point of view of their practical efficacy.

The inner journey given by Schmidt (*Wie konz, ich mich?*) is divided into four major phases.

1. **Concentration.** This includes liberation, internal calm, “Silence” and the concentration of thinking, feeling, and willing into a single point.
2. **Meditation,** understood as the highest level of concentration in which man begins to direct thought onto a determined goal (concentrated meditation) and to make himself capable of keeping, this direction (pure meditation) fixed above everything,

3. **Contemplation**, or inner mystical absorption, where the ear is turned to the “inner voice” to which then one must try to identify oneself, proceeding then to the next level
4. **Realization**, or self-completion, the level that precedes “making oneself Christ” (*Durchchristung*), that is the highest stage of all the practices of the “new Spirit”. It is the same as “cosmic consciousness” and “being one with God” of all mysticisms.

We don’t think it is without interest to reproduce some samples of the exercises used in the New Thought Alliance. The following are found in *Die Giest sei Fuhrer*.

Upon awakening in the morning, get dressed quickly. Turn to the East, extending the arms toward the Sun, draw seven complete breaths, breathing with the formula: “Primordial creative force, fill me up.” Feel the force as it floods you. Then cross your arms on your chest and say, or think, intensely: “I am one with infinite life, its force fills me, today I will have full dominion over myself, I have its force. I am, I will, I can.” Then say this formula in the same position: “I send thoughts of love, peace, and harmony to the entire world, may all beings be happy and blessed.”

Another formula that is concerned more with the breath is found in Schmidt. Here the ancient Hindu doctrine of prana is understood, i.e., the mystical energy of life carried by the air.

The air contains powerful forces that I introduce while breathing in. I draw these forces consciously. They flood my entire body and make me healthy, vital, free! They make me energetic and healthy! The forces restore me and animate me. I feel vital, energetic, healthy.

While exhaling, mentally and consciously chase away all the waste that has accumulated in your body, and at the same time, all the

evil dispositions and impressions, negative and destructive thoughts. Think and feel: "I breathe, I am free ... free! I feel free — I am conscious, I breathe. Cosmic forces flood me and unite me to the Divine!"

The repetitions, naturally, are made with the aim of autosuggestion. And now a formula for calm and inner silence. It follows exercises by which the complete relaxation of the body and every tension, almost to the point of no longer feeling it, are first stimulated. Again, from Schmidt:

The external world has disappeared. I am alone, deeply in myself ... I am silent, I am calm. I think and I feel that I am completely calm. Tranquility and calm are in me. Everything is calm rhythmic proportion, cosmic harmony, infinite peace.

I am calm

Calm as though in a distant abandoned tomb.

Calm as though in the base to a clear transparent mountain lake.

Calm as though in a city underneath the heat of the summer sun, calm, tranquil, desolate, without noise, in anticipation of the freshness of the evening.

Finally we translate a collective formula used by the Stuttgart group which was published in *Die weisse Fahne*.

Om!

Rise up in me, you Conqueror of Death! Light of Christ!
Infinite splendour of my soul!

You are! You dare! You burn up! In my soul. Light of Christ
in me, I adore you!

In me was your Golgotha! In me is your Resurrection! Your
eternal life lives in me! In me your paradise blooms! In me your

liberation rejoices. In me your victory exults! In me your ancient flame shines.

The Victor rises again!

You bring me back to the lost Father. You gave back the Father in me, who is also the Father of your original generation.

Your Father is also in me! Om! I am!

You, Lord, have risen again in me! New Spirit!

Ardent Spirit, resplendent with the original Light! Holy Spirit!

You who secures everything. You who hears everything. You breathe the world. You, the generator of the new Spirit. You the adsorbing Principal, to be bursting, the wise end, you, again the only Principle. You, the Everything and the Nothing, you, the One in Everything.

You, the eternally active spiritual presence! Rising again!

Heaven jumps in me. The most sacred veil tears asunder in me. Your Light erupts from it. Your dawn Light of Eternity.

In front of me, in me, every night!

Ancient Light, jubilant victory of the resurrection in me!

Om! Victory! Victory! Victory! Om! Christ, you are the new spirit of Resurrection in me! Om! Peace! Peace! Peace is with us all! Om!

As you see, it is all rather well constructed in suggestive and intensely charged emotions in order to lead to a state of mystical exhilaration, not without certain character of virility.

What is interesting is to notice the scientific and, we would say, secular elements in the background, with which all the various means are syncretistically gathered in order to produce experiences, which are of value essentially from their practical efficacy. In other words, technique, in place of faith, and inner facts to acquire from pure individual experience, without dogmatic and profane “interpretations”, with an eye simply on their pragmatic “truth” for those who demand a sense of exaltation of liberation of vital energy. Reaching to the foundation in this direction,

one can expect that one day religion, as well as theology itself, will become an experimental science, certainly an upheaval, not lacking interest, that leads us back to a proper view of mystical and traditional esoterism.

These and similar movements are therefore observed with curiosity, as signs of the times. To the critic, for now it is more opportune to replace the watchful gaze that deepens the new themes that could begin to speak out in them.

Posted on 2013-12-04 by Aeneas

* * *

scardanelli on 2013-12-04 at 21:45 said:

"The first opposition is naturally to materialism; in the second, to the ancient concept of faith and religion, which it wants precisely to replace with the New Spirit (Neugeist)"

It seems that all such spiritual movements that are predicated on an opposition are doomed to failure. If the nature of this opposition is dualism then this dualism would make true transcendence impossible. This might also be applied to those traditionalists whose only rule for membership is being "against" the modern world.

Likewise for any attempt to strip Christianity of its dogmas or confession. It seems to me that the truly esoteric should grow like a tree from the ground of the exoteric. The way of most new age movements is an attempt to usurp or get around the law rather than to develop and gain freedom from the law.

Anna Kaiser-Swadling on 2013-12-06 at 12:15 said:

I've used something similar to the first "auto suggestion" for many years. I find it empowering. Evola also has some techniques for falling asleep that I've applied for years after the "I am alone, deeply in myself", i.e. visualising and moving toward a golden mountain peak, lying on your side and visualising you're looking from the back of your head, and another, lying on your back letting your eyes fall back then sense you're flipping back with them into the air above.

anon on 2013-12-07 at 04:37 said:

This stuff showed up on my radar when I stumbled across Lisiewski, who hated New Age, but liked New Thought (NT). I woke up early today, and have been trying to find (online) the succinct Lisiewski quote about NT that first impacted me, but to no avail. I guess these long ones will do.

"You are the first of my readers to acknowledge that they have looked into that form of Mysticism referred to as 'New Thought.' I am very happy you have indeed. You will find that—as I have written in the Magical Thought of the Week column weeks ago—Mysticism completes Magic: it is not the other way around, no matter how much this upsets people who are so entirely devoted to Magic. The entire matter of Spiritual 'Unfoldment' as I term it—not Spiritual 'growth' as the New Age insists—eventually leads to this end.

"Further, the amazing thing is that what the individual so desires; what he or she so sincerely wants or needs in their life, is all obtainable through this form of Mysticism, and ever so easily. Yet the paradox is that one cannot force one's self into accepting, working, and mastering New Thought simply because the results they require are so readily obtainable from it. Quite the contrary. One must 'unfold' into it. And when that glorious day dawns, then all is made perfectly clear and works almost effortlessly for the individual so blessed with this 'discovery'.

"People who are attracted to Magic must persist in it until the day comes when they 'step over the line' that leads from Magic to Mysticism. It cannot be hurried. It cannot be rushed. But it will come. This is what Percy Bullock, one of the original members of the Golden Dawn Society meant, when he said at the turn of the 20th century, 'In the end, we all become Mystics.'

"Congratulations on your being attracted to it so early on. Perhaps—as sometimes does happen—it is the right—and only—Path for you to follow, even from the beginning."

– Joseph C. Lisiewski

"My Reply: again, these individuals neither understand the difference between the 'imaging' I teach, and the 'visualization' which their New Age calls for. Nor do they understand the difference between one of their so-called 'Invocations,' a 'Prayer,' and an 'Affirmation,' all of which I have thoroughly spelled out both in my books and on this website. And as the next reply will further show, New Thought has nothing whatsoever to do with 'visualization' (in fact, those methods of New Thought that truly do work to produce full results have very little to do with Imaging either. That is, they employ Imaging only in so far as one forming the most 'general thought template' of that which is desired.)"

– Joseph C. Lisiewski

"Always use a nine foot diameter Circle of Art for every ritual and ceremonial act. 'Nine' is the number of Yesod, of course, and corresponds to the subconscious (unconscious) mind, wherein all Magic truly occurs- we only 'see' the results of that 'occurrence' in the outer world (Malkuth.) That is, the subconscious mind should be thought of as the Causal Agent of the External Effect we wish to produce. There is a great deal of correlation between this concept and the central doctrine of New Thought. That is, with the extremely pragmatic philosophy and practice of the latter. But this is another matter for another time."

– Joseph C. Lisiewski

"It may help if I give you an example. As I stated in Ceremonial Magic, I was born into a Roman Catholic family and raised in that Faith. And while I cannot abide the Catholic church in its present form, I yet consider myself a Christian, and more exactly, a Catholic! How can this be? Quite simply, I found the philosophical teachings of Pierre Teilhard de Chardin, a Jesuit Priest, theologian, philosopher, and paleontologist-and whose complex writing unify certain aspects of Science and Religion-to have a profound impact upon me. Together with the New Thought Philosophy, the two enabled me to form my own eclectic system of thought; one which is in perfect agreement with my own subconscious state of subjective synthesis, and which allows my magical efforts to succeed splendidly."

– Joseph C. Lisiewski

"Apparently, they never heard of the work of Ralph Waldo Trine and his book, *In Tune With the Infinite*, which is regarded as the first independently published book on New Thought, and which is given credit for being one of the major works on the subject that sparked the New Thought Movement itself. And it was published in—1897! That is, his final manuscript, originally written in 1889, was published years before their famous *Golden Dawn* was being torn asunder by internal strife, and moving toward its ultimate 1900 collapse. Further, one has only to read Trine in the most cursory way to see if any 'Golden Dawn' material—even theoretical—is in it. The philosophy of the *Golden Dawn*—and the Mysticism of Trine—are as different in theory and practice as are night and day.

"In the same vein, the people demanding I acknowledge the GD as having created the Mysticism of New Thought have no knowledge whatsoever of the existence and work of others in the field of mystical enquiry which has come to be termed 'New Thought.' For instance: they apparently are completely oblivious to the late 19th century writings and teachings of Emilie Cady and Charles Fillmore, cofounder, who began the Unity Movement of circa 1890, the very time at which the first *Golden Dawn* Temple was getting underway in England. Formally called the Unity School of Christianity, the groundbreaking works of Cady and Fillmore—along with Trine's and a number of others less well known—constituted the initial creative impulse that launched the New Thought Movement.

"Further, unlike the bickering and backstabbing of the famous London GD Temple 'elite' of the 1890's, enthusiastic collaboration between the schools of thought arising within the original New Thought Movement was the order of the day. Example: Emilie Cady—a staunch independent—published several of her most notable works in *Unity Magazine*, the official organ of the Unity School of Christianity in 1894-95 (these were then published as three paperbacks for the general public in 1896-1897.)"

– Joseph C. Lisiewski

“But the Golden Dawn did has its effect, or so I speculate it did. That is, I cannot prove it empirically, but my research suggests more than a casual connection exists between the New Thought Movement and the original Golden Dawn as operated in England in the 1890’s. And that is, that after the Golden Breakup in 1900, a plethora of new books arose on the subject of New Thought, the great majority of which suddenly began teaching ‘visualization’ as part of their process. Not only that, but the visualization techniques they insisted upon are in every way exactly the same as can be found in any New Age book today—be it on Magick or on visualization techniques designed to bring about one’s desires. For instance, the numerous works of Wattles (1902) Wilcox (1902) Towne (1904) Fritz (1906) Larson (1908) Sears (1919) Schubel (1922) and Van Rensselaer Day (1928) are only a few of the many that initiated this unfortunate trend, while the latter works of Fersen (1929) Landone (1937) and Collier (1943) continued it. And of course, these later efforts were seized upon by the New Age and ‘expanded’ into the non-functional miasma of so-called ‘New Thought’ that generally exists today.

“In short, as the GD history states, most members of the original London Temple were ‘unknowns’ who drifted away after the demise of the Temple. It may be that such people as Wattles—amidst dozens of others—were indeed members of the Order, or were acquainted with those who were. In either case, disillusioned due to the breakup of the GD, it is my opinion that they seized upon the New Thought Movement and added their ‘visualization’ techniques to it, thus destroying the genuine techniques behind this form of Mysticism; techniques that indeed do allow New Thought—or ‘Higher Mysticism’ as I term it—to work—fully, and without any Slingshot Effect. So much then for the people who lay claim that the GD ‘created’ New Thought. As far as I am concerned, all that the (former) members of the original GD did to the New Thought Movement was contaminate it...”

– Joseph C. Lisiewski

anon on 2013-12-07 at 11:08 said:

Warning: long and perhaps self-indulgent post follows.

Lisiewski’s marriage of grimoires and New Thought reminds me, to some degree anyway, of those people who try to combine NLP with Crowley and/or with chaos magic. The whole Disinfo.com/RAW/Gen P-Orridge scene. Except that stuff is more modernist, I guess, whereas Lisiewski is relatively more traditional.

I read Jason Augustus Newcomb’s “21st Century Mage: Bring the Divine Down to Earth”, years ago, and absolutely loved it. So much so that I joined his online forum for a while. And gushed words of appreciation at him. I couldn’t get into his other book that was available at the time, “New Hermetics”. I had found a pdf copy of it, but couldn’t force my way through it. It was NLP meets Leary meets Crowley meets RAW. Oh yeah, and hermetix too.

I remember when I first read an Anthony Robbins book, on the recommendation of someone I respected at the time, and thought to myself: "This is magic." I never would have thought that. I saw Robbins as crass infomercial huckster. A bullshit artist. And I guess in many ways he is. But his neuro-associative conditioning (NAC) techniques are basically a form of crude and uncontrolled magic. Or something akin to it. As I played around with that stuff, those many years ago, I remembered the Sorcerer's Apprentice segment of the Disney cartoon *Fantasia*. Where Mickey Mouse casts a spell over some brooms, and then loses control over them. It was like that. NAC would allow you to effect change on the world around you. But this was done by first affecting changes inside you. And some of these changes were damaging, blinding you. Perhaps good for taking someone from *tamas* to *rajas*, but blinding them to many important aspects of *sattva*. Anyway...

Newcomb's Mage book is basically about the K&C of the HGA, but in a sort of modernized and New Age-ified form. I neither know nor care if the practical suggestions that he offers in that book work. I already have my own practice. But the theoretical aspect of the book I found extremely and profoundly validating.

When you're navigating these meagerly-charted waters you need a compass. And the HGA provides that. Actually, I don't think of it as the HGA. As best as I can tell what people call the HGA and the K&C of the HGA are really fragments of something much larger. Much more beautiful. The Abramelin operation, I believe, allows one to access only some of what is there. Like seeing an iceberg, and knowing that more is there under water.

Newcomb's book goes deeper than the HGA, but I'm not even sure if that is conscious on his part, or if his "HGA" slipped some things in there, between the lines, in the connections between what he says, never fully spelled out. It's worth reading.

Before I read Newcomb, I read one of the best books that I have ever read in my life. A book whose concepts still deeply nourish me, nine years later. When I found it, it was like the culmination and synthesis of a bunch of stuff that I was studying. I could not believe that such a thing existed. It was as though it had been created just for me. Of course, none of us are all that special, and any thought that has occurred to us, has also occurred to someone else, somewhere else.

The book was like a synthesis and distillation of many aspects that I found most helpful and relevant in Jung, Tony Robbins, Crowley, Kabbalah, yoga, bhakti, chaos magic, psychology, New Age, religion and God knows what else. Plus I was physically chronically quite sick. And seriously worried about how the hell I the hell I was going to be able to support myself. I was working only part time. I was tired all the time. Low-grade fever almost all of the time. Heart-rate unnaturally high. All the time. Recovering from a very serious life-saving surgery. I did not seem to be getting better. I was afraid.

The crass and cheesy title of the book is "How to Get Lots of Money for Anything Fast". I have shared the pdf with significant people in my life, but none have had the experience with

it that I have. Maybe it really is suited to a particular temperament? Or to people looking for a particular thing? Some are turned off by the title. Understandably. But the book really isn't about money. Or that is only the surface. It is about the K&C of the HGA, although the author doesn't use those words. In practice, that is what it is.

The first time I did the exercises, it was profound. The strange chest pains I was having for some years, both before and after the surgery, were gone the next day. I kept expecting them to return. A week went by. Then weeks. Then months. Now years. The pains return only in periods of extreme stress. And that in very mild forms. Was it C.S. Lewis who said that pain was God's megaphone? I listen more carefully now, so I guess maybe He feels less of a need to shout as loud.

The book is about navigating life, with the guidance of the HGA. Actually, something deeper, lushier and fuller than the HGA. Some will use that guidance to make money, but that is really like using a smartphone to hammer a nail.

But it can be used for that also. I remember an interview with Lichtman where he talks about something tho the effect that his idea was to provide a process whereby people could take care of their material needs simply and quickly, leaving time and energy for their spiritual pursuits.

My understanding is that there is a reality. Different people describe that reality, to varying degrees of accuracy. With varying degrees of clumsiness. Insofar as their gunas will allow them to perceive and describe it. Depending on what their goal is, reality can be sliced up in different ways, sub-divided into different categories. Some more misleading than others.

Lichtman calls his system Cybernetic Transposition (CT), being inspired in part, by Maxwell Maltz's Psycho-Cybernetics. But there is also a big dose of Lichtman's own spiritual beliefs intertwined in all of it. This troubled me somewhat, as his system goes deep into the unconscious, and I was worried about implanting some of Lichtman's own blind spots and perception-distortions into my own heart.

So for a while I was really interested in what his path was. Finally, I was able to piece together who his spiritual teacher was. The dude's name escapes me at the moment. I could do a CT exercise to get my memory to cough up his name, but the important thing is that I found him both underwhelming, and mostly non-threatening. Maybe Lichtman has eclipsed his teacher?

Is Lichtman's CT Traditional? No, I wouldn't say that. And some of his blind spots I find loathsome. But I think CT can (largely) be used whoever one chooses. There is always a spiritual price to be paid with this kind of stuff, but I think CT fairly neutral, like logic. But then again, don't take my word for it. For all you know, I might simply be a self-deluded cultist.

Some of Lichtman's CT reminds me of a highly-fine-tuned version of chaos magic's sigilization process. Except done with words, paragraphs, vivid imaginary experiences. Instead of the commonly-used pictogram method. His ideas about getting the different parts of the brain

working together, in concert, working towards the same end, cannot help but remind me of Kabballah's description of different parts of the soul. And also the Gita's vyavasay-atmika-buddhi. I will resist the temptation here to discuss the parallels between the source of buddhi and the functions of the HGA. This post is already long enough.

CT has a bunch of controls built-in, to avoid having it blow up in your face, and for getting back on track. Since life is, in many ways, a moving target. You know now, things that you did not know then. And so on.

This is not meant as an infomercial, or endorsement of Lichtman. I'm not getting paid for this. It's a genuine outpouring. Lisiewski has his New Thought, the Disinfoonauts have their NLP Bandlerism. I prefer CT.

Dig it.

IA on 2013-12-07 at 11:26 said:

I've used daoist stretching, breathing and visualizing techniques for over 18 years following recurring back pain from an injury. You face the sun every morning. It has worked very well for the back pain and may have some emotional effect as well.

pareidoliastic on 2014-08-11 at 11:48 said:

anon on 2013-12-07 at 04:37,

I have read all of Lisiewski's works and he helped open my eyes to Alchemy and Hermetics. After having a profound encounter with NLP in helping me literally evaporate an addiction I was trapped in. I am now very hungry for more and how NLP/NewThought could help me grow and evolve and get past all the other blocks from brainwashing and false beliefs I am clouded by.

I found this very page on the Internet because I to have a vague recollection of him talking about NLP and it's relationship to 'magic/mysticism'

I have a great deal of trust in Lisiewski so his opinions and advice I give much more weight to than most.

From the quotes you gave he seems to indicate New Thought has been corrupted? Naturally because of the power these techniques have to modify the subconscious and influence ones subjective synthesis I am leery of just blindly following my natural instinct to read everything I can find on it. Other than his (apparent?) endorsement of Ralph Waldo Trine and his book, *In Tune With the Infinite* do you know of any of his recommendations on works for studying and working to find true liberation? I am also considering Hyatt's work in this area as I know he and Lisiewski were good friends.

Thank you, and anyone else who could perhaps aid me.

Cologero on 2014-08-12 at 07:51 said:

pareidoliastic,

You are referring to some of the comments on Lisiewski, which were motivated by the translate essay from the German New Thought movement.

"True liberation" is not found just from studying, but from "working" as you point out. It is not likely that much can be accomplished on one's own.

The danger is that before attempting to "modify the subconscious", you should have a very clear idea of what you are doing. In other words, don't tinker with the mechanisms until you understand the inner workings of the soul quite well.

Originally, NT was based on certain philosophical systems, mostly forgotten because of the low quality of the NT movement. We have been discussing the intellectual foundations of magical idealism, which would serve as a better foundation. After all, what does it mean that representations create reality? We plan to revisit this theme in the next week or two.

pareidoliastic on 2014-08-12 at 15:19 said:

Thank you for the reply Cologero. I guess the danger you mention is my trepidation about just 'jumping in'. I understand the power of it now firsthand by using aspects of these techniques crafted by another to help root out destructive beliefs I had held subconsciously which made changing something the typical world thinks is nearly impossible. But it was actually quite easy. It has been said this person's book uses NLP so that rang a bell in my memory from when I studied Lisiewski's work and writings.

So naturally I am excited and very interested in how far that rabbit hole goes (in a positive sense) in how much greater I can truly be with the right constellation in my subconscious.

I have not really studied this site yet and what it contains in this regard. Can you kindly point me in the direction of the right place or post to dive into the stream on exploring this 'magical foundation' theme you speak of?

And I look forward to your further posts on this theme you mentioned.

Many many thanks!

8.6 Emile Coue

This is the promised translation of **Julius Evola's** essay on **Emile Coué**. It originally appeared in *Bilychnis*, in the Jan-Feb issue of 1925 under the title *Emile Coué and "Acting without Acting"*. Here Evola goes well beyond Coué himself and provides metaphysical, philosophical, and psychological explanations for the phenomena described by Coué.

Along with New Thought, which itself has been heavily influenced by Coué, couism, or something like it, has been a part of Hermetic teachings when properly understood. In reading this essay, perhaps some of you will be intrigued by this seeming paradox:

1. Coué demonstrated almost “miraculous” results
2. Similar results have been very difficult to reproduce

If point 2 were not true, then everyone would be demonstrating miraculous powers today. That I have not witnessed, not even in the New Thought circles that I was formerly part of. Yet point 1 has some truth, and Evola himself was convinced of it. Following the translation, we will offer an explanation of why points 1 and 2 are both true ... unless someone else can explain it better.

The name of the Frenchman Emile Coué⁴ has made quite a splash in recent times. There was a period in which, especially in France and in England, Couism had become the word of the day: a real interest and very lively discussion gathered little by little around the figure of this modern thaumaturge, his famous psychotherapeutic method of “conscious autosuggestion”, and the wake of almost miraculous healings left by his travels in the countries of central Europe and the New World. In these days, Coué has also come to Italy to hold a series of conferences that, if not of true enthusiasm—perhaps because of the rather skeptical nature of the greater Italian public—certainly has attracted much attention of the type which, among the observations of modern psychology of the supernatural, is always more inclined to believe that the power of man can in reality reach far beyond that which the small, humble, what everyday life shows us as possible in general. To tell the truth, the need that stands at the foundation of Coué’s doctrine is rather important; it will therefore

⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/%C3%89mile_Cou%C3%A9

not be useless to attempt a reconstruction of it and, at the same time, to investigate up to what point the methods of Coué can be sufficient to it.

Section I

The starting point, undoubtedly, is this. Hypnotic phenomena are real. Recent studies in this regard—it is enough to cite Liebeault, Bernheim, De Rochas, Richet—have truly been conducted according to the principles of the strictest positivism, and put the matter beyond dispute. Now it is factual that the hypnotized person realizes a number of things of which, in the normal or awake state, he is not absolutely capable: concerning perceptions, the emotional element, or various organic functions, he has a power that touches the miraculous. How is that possible? Here we have the first position of couism, expressed in the principle—moreover already announced by Liebeault and Myers—that *every heterosuggestion (i.e., a suggestion made by another) is realized only through an autosuggestion*. That is, the theory that the power of the hypnotizer works directly on the hypnotized person is excluded. The hypnotizer only transmits a command, he only suggests the idea of the thing to be accomplished: but in order for the suggestion to be effective, it is necessary that the subject assume it, transform it into an autosuggestion and thereby realize it with his own strength. Receptivity is in fact an essential condition for the success of the suggestion. It would follow from that that the operative power in the phenomenology of hypnosis must be pushed back not to another, but to the I itself: that, at least, in its material aspect of a force “that does”, aside from the principle of the impulse that causes it.

It must be placed back on the I, so far, so good. But which I? Clearly not the I of the conscious personality: the hypnotic sleep effectively entirely abolishes such an I. It therefore necessarily pertains to another, deep power of subjectivity beyond that which consciously thinks and wills, a much vaster and stronger power that Coué designated sometimes as the

imagination, and at other times—following Jung—as the *subconscious*. Now in the phenomenon of heterosuggestion these two I's fall into two distinct beings: in the hypnotized person, the unconscious principle and realizer; in the hypnotizer, the conscious and directing principle. The problem that couism poses is this: to substitute the I of wakefulness for the hypnotizer and to reunite the two principles in the same subject. Hence, the concept of a suggestion to be made by oneself to oneself, according to directives that the I of awakening should formulate and the subconscious carry out: hence, the theme of *conscious autosuggestion*.

Before going further, let us lay down a more precise understanding of what the subconscious is. Here Coué—keeping in mind what the subconscious shows us it is capable of in hypnotic phenomena—refers to an entity that presides over *all* organic functions, from the most humble of the vegetative life to those that govern the mental processes themselves, and, therefore, it corresponds to entelechy as described by Aristotle and Driesch, the “*logos*” of Sthal, the “physical personality” of Ribot. But this determination is still exterior: it does not tell us what such a principle is in and for the I. And that is must be something for the I, which it in one way or another must emerge, must be put at the head of the luminous zone of consciousness, which is clearly presupposed by the problem of conscious autosuggestion: since if the two I's were such that they mutually excluded each other, or that when the subconscious emerges the consciousness is submerged and vice versa, it is clear that the action *ab intra* that couism proposes would not be possible.

Duality must therefore be in a certain way present in the very sphere of the life of awakening. To that we refer to Coué's other term, the *imagination*. He notes that in the same conscious life, two entirely distinct powers are in play: one relates to the plane of intellection, the clear consciousness and reflective will; the other to the murky reign of the instinct, emotion, passion, and deep and irrational convictions whose dominant principle is that of faith and imagination. The one is, to use Platonic

terminology, the *logos*, the other, *eros*. Coué distinguishes rather cleanly between these two powers: they have individuality and absolutely heterogeneous modes of acting. Now while the *logos* falls outside that deep principle that rules the whole of organic functions, the *eros* communicates with it so that, in a certain way, it is identified with it. The corollary follows immediately from that—the key point for couism—that the problem of the control of one’s own personality—and that not only with regard to the element of character, but also with regard to the physical being and, therefore in particular, the problem of eliminating psychic disturbances and maladies (psychotherapy)—it is mutual with that of the determination of the *eros* from part of the *logos*, for the “imagination” from part of the conscious I. This is the task of conscious autosuggestion: to succeed in making directives originating from the I from the imagination accepted, so that they moreover become directives for the organic subconscious which, blind and inert, cannot fail to obey them as it happens in hypnotic phenomena.

This is part 2 of **Julius Evola**’s review of the movement initiated by **Emile Coué**. It would be curious that Coué discovered all these techniques himself, since they are part of Hermetic and magic training. Here are some of the salient points to notice:

- A monoideism is a state of focusing the mind on a single idea as in hypnosis. Negatively, it is related to the “*idée fixe*” described by **Valentin Tomberg**, or more colorfully, and not completely inaccurately, as “possession by a gnome”. Positively, it is an aspect of deliberate concentration exercises.
- Man, as he is, i.e., the man untrained in mental or spiritual development, is not as conscious as he believes himself to be. Rather, he is a “puppet” under the domination of myr-

iads of suggestions, most of which do not emanate from himself.

- The so-called conscious mind, i.e., the discursive intellect is a mass of contradictory ideas which very often impede our lives.
- There is a deeper “I” or self, beyond that seemingly awake I, that is the true and real source of our lives.
- That deeper self responds to suggestions arising in the conscious mind or those entering the conscious mind from outside sources.
- To “reach” that deeper self, it is necessary to somehow suppress the incessant chatter of the conscious I. That is the real goal of meditation, concentration, and other so-called magical techniques. Even “sex magick” has nothing to do with sex, beyond using it as a means to bypass the conscious mind.
- Notice, for example, how Coué’s ideas track the notion of “concentration without effort” as described by Valentin Tomberg.
- It is clear that these techniques sound simple, but are quite difficult in practice. That would account for the seeming lack of success in most cases. The state of “conviction”, faith, or the ability to “will one thing” is elusive to those who think too much.
- Based on the examples that Evola provides, perhaps the purpose of these tests for *Qualifications for initiation*⁵ may be clearer.

Since autosuggestion is possible in principle, Coué sees it confirmed by a thousand facts of daily life. Three fourths of our actions —as he

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1161>

claimed to one of his disciples— are, more or less directly, supported by autosuggestion: only that we habitually suggest to ourselves without either knowing or willing it and, in most cases, as though it were all our doing. Here Coué emphasized the opposition of *logos* to *eros*, he often loves to highlight how our conscious will and reason can do nothing against an autosuggestion, since what makes us act is always the imagination. He says,

When the will is in battle with the imagination, it is the will that, without exception, loses the game.

Not only that, but the efforts made by the will in similar cases succeed simply in reinforcing the power against which it faces. This is the *law of reversed effort*. Examples:

1. The novice bicyclist sees a stone in the middle of the road, he *imagines* that he is going to run over it, he *struggles* to avoid it; the harder he tries, the more likely he goes right over the rock.
2. A person notices he cannot fall sleep; he wants to sleep: the more he wants it, the more he does not succeed in falling sleep.
3. A sufficiently large plank is placed across an abyss; if the same plank were place on the ground, a person would walk across it with the greatest nonchalance. But being placed over the abyss, he *imagines* he could fall; he does not then dare to traverse it: if, in spite of everything, by forcing an effort, he attempts it, in the great number of cases he is going to fall off. And so on.

These and numerous other examples show that the will can do nothing against a present suggestion. The secret of success is instead to oppose a suggestion not with an effort, but rather with another suggestion of the

opposite meaning: it is necessary, i.e., to translate the will into a corresponding “imagination”. Without that, the effort succeeds only in precipitating the occurrence in the direction opposite to the one desired. Therefore Coué says:

We who are so proud of our will, we who believe we freely do what we do, we are in reality only poor puppets of which our imagination holds all the strings. We cease to be these puppets only when we have learned to guide the imagination.

Here we can make a rather important observation about the mode of action of the two principles. In apparent contrast with what at first view would let us think of the classifications of logos and eros, we see that the mode of the first is action properly called, or effort, tension; in contrast, the mode of the second is purely mental, it is an “imagining”, a sudden and inner, effortless, self-representation. This pure “imagining” realizes, and realizes it to the very depths of the one’s being: instead action or will, purely called, is condemned to the periphery, and can do nothing in respect to the deepest stratum of the physical and emotive personality, and when it intervenes, it succeeds only in leading to battles and disagreements with almost always detrimental consequences.

The problem therefore is centered in the question of provoking consciously and intentionally that autosuggestive process which, in the background, plays such an essential part in daily life: or, in other words, of discovering the method by which one can act on the “imagination” starting from the I of awakening. Coué’s principle in this:

every idea that engages the spirit exclusively becomes “true” for the imagination; the concentration of the mind on an idea transforms this into a belief.

In technical terms: it is about creating in oneself a “monoideism”. Faith and monideism, ultimately, would be equivalent to each other. That said, the technique of couism is the following:

The principles of the will and the imagination exclude each other; in the hypnotized person the power of the subconscious is so great because a free field is left to it, while everything that is related to the will and consciousness is put aside. The ideal would therefore be the ability to enter a hypnotic state: but since the hypnotic state suppresses the conscious I by hypothesis, it is necessary to find a compromise, viz., of the intermediate stages in which the surfacing of the subconscious has the maximum, compatibly with the minimum permanence of the conscious principle.

Such are the so-called “hypnoid states”, among which Coué emphasizes that of *détente* or relaxation. It is a matter of realizing a complete relaxation of the conscious faculties, of excluding every mental and muscular effort or tension, just as happens immediately before falling asleep and in so-called *reveries*. When the mood of *relaxation* ends up sufficiently incited, the conscious principle that up to that point was put aside—withdrawn almost to the extreme corner of oneself—it can intervene and make the idea slip into the mind, or better put, the *image* of what one desires to realize. The mind must fixate on this image to the exclusion of all the rest, moreover without entering into the field of efforts, which would destroy the state of *relaxation* and, along with it, the state of receptivity and of suggestibility of the “imagination”. How then can one realize such concentration? Coué’s answer is:

By means of the very rapid repetition of a formulation which includes the idea in question; with the repetition, the mind is automatically and spontaneously brought to the idea, and its speed makes it such that other images are not inserted in the intervals. In particular: any counter-suggestions are not formed which would neutralize it and thereby render it ineffective. Through repetition, *monoideism* is formed: absorbing the whole spirit, the image strengthens itself slowly in the imagination until it becomes a dim and deep conviction; it is then employed by the power of the subconscious from which it certainly is turned into action.

If, e.g., in a hemorrhage, one succeeds in concentrating on the formula “the hemorrhage has stopped” —like a mood freed from conscious faculties—, to the point of rendering itself fully active, the related image lives in the mind—in a word: to the point of believing it, then this idea becomes a truth and a command for the subconscious that, as director of every organic function, makes the arterioles and venules contract naturally, just as would happen artificially with a tourniquet: and the hemorrhage is stopped.

This, in a few words, is Coué’s theory. In experiments, it seems to have been demonstrated as capable almost of a miracle. Limiting ourselves to the physio-pathological order, to which it particularly is oriented, not only functions but also organic paralyses, advanced stage consumption, generalized eczema, tubercular lesions, tumors, etc. have been cured, sometimes in very few sessions, by means of the autosuggestion developed from the illness itself under the guidance of Coué or his disciples.

In Section II, **Julius Evola** offers a critique of **Emile Coué**’s explanation for the successes of his method, and then provides his own explanation.

Making the connection between the “deep conviction of the subconscious” and “faith”, Evola then relates it to the “vexed question” of “grace”. In other words, why do some have faith and others do not? Or, in more practical terms, why are some healed by couism while most are not? However, Evola here is interested only in a psychological explanation, not a metaphysical one. So “grace” means only that its origin seems to come from outside rather than from one’s own powers. This is a different question from the metaphysical meaning of grace.

First of all, while faith is the belief in something unseen, it is more than that since it reaches deeper than our everyday I that we consider to be conscious. This I, however, is engaged embroiled in dualisms: subject-object, true-false, right-wrong. The deeper I,

on the other hand, is non-dual: it simply is and it wills one thing. There is a certain seemingly “heroic” attitude that sees doubt as concomitant with faith. But that is to remain perpetually at the level of that “I of awakening” while never penetrating to depths.

Rather, the proper development of faith is gnosis, i.e., the direct realization that has been mentioned several times in Evola’s essay. In this regard, Valentin Tomberg is a more reliable guide as we have shown in *The Elements of Sacred Magic*⁶.

To his credit, Evola does not deny the numerous preternatural and miraculous accounts of the saints, and, growing up in Italy, he would have heard of many. Therefore, he rejects a glib positivism that rejects miracles out of hand. In contrast, he develops a “metaphysical positivism” that would account for the reality described in those stories. Nevertheless, in the final analysis even metaphysical positivism leaves out something essential.

He rightly rejects the claim that the method of couism is sufficient in itself, apart from the person of the patient. Otherwise, if the method worked indifferently, there would be couism centers in every city instead of hospitals. At some point, it is up to the patient to develop faith or the image of his healing. Every suggestion, to be effective, eventually becomes an auto-suggestion. Not only the belief in couism, but also the belief in any ceremonial, ritualistic, sacramental, or symbolic forms have no power in themselves other than to motivate faith in those who need it.

Some, however, do not require any such aids. This would mean, fundamentally, that a man can do without a Tradition. Such a man, however, would not know what to have faith in, and hence would not find gnosis. Typically, he would actually be a secularist. The symbols cannot be discarded so readily. Yet, any psychological explanation can never be complete as long as something supernatural or transcendent remains unaccounted

⁶<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-elements-of-sacred-magic>

for (which it must, in psychology).

Nevertheless, Evola's emphasis that a personal realization is somehow always involved and that repetition for its own sake is useless is sound. Yet, there is one miracle that Evola's purely psychological explanation does not capture. That is Peter's raising Tabitha from the dead and the dead, presumably, are immune to a hetero- or auto- suggestion.

Section II

The great problem that comes into play in couism is that of the construction of faith. In fact, it becomes clear to everyone that that deep conviction of the subconscious that Coué speaks of is nothing other than faith. Fundamentally, it comes back to the vexed theological question of grace. The principle that faith, once reached, is an irresistible power, which immediately realizes what it believes is true, has been known from the most remote times and, at least in a certain measure, has since been scientifically sanctioned by modern psychology. And the significance of faith is not only subjective, it is also objective. The accounts of the miraculous phenomena that envelopes the figures of saints and creators of religion — so lightly discarded by so-called positivism — in reality take inspiration from faith. Of the similar phenomena of yoga and magic, the principle, in the final analysis, is faith or, if one prefers, autosuggestion. Explanation:

- At the first level, I can have the simple, empty concept of a thing.
- Beyond that, I can bring it to life in the imagination.
- In the third place I can perceive it exteriorly as a subjective hallucination.
- In the fourth place, I can act on other consciousnesses in a way that they also perceive it (collective suggestion).

- The *same* power, continued in an ever more intense affirmation that invests the level of physical being, becomes objective and, as such, is a magical act.

As the mage can be defined as the one who knows how, so to speak, *to influence the same nature*, to communicate his faith to it, with which one is preliminarily put in relationship by means of an act of love or sympathy.

However beyond that, the great question is to know *if*, and in this case, *how*, faith can be constructed positively and consciously by the I, and, to tell the truth, beyond any suggestion whatsoever. In the great number of cases, it is to be noted that the I does not possess faith as much as it is instead possessed by it. I.e., in them, faith is realized to the extent it does not flow from an absolute sufficiency, from a pure self-assertion of the individual, but from the suggestion derived from some idea, close to which the I originally — in the moment in which it was triggered — is passive and unconscious. So that if it is true that no suggestion (heterosuggestion) succeeds if it does not make itself an autosuggestion, it is also true that, almost uniformly, no autosuggestion (with particular regard to those that can extend the power of the I beyond normal) is actuated if it does not have a preliminary suggestion as a basis for motivation. That is, the I does not succeed in being present, to assert itself at the moment of the initiative. So the person of faith at Lourdes, in as much as it heals, to that extent he believes that it is not he, but divinity, who works the healing; to the extent the hypnotized person carries out miracles, to that extent the initiative, the suggestion, comes to him not from himself, by from the hypnotizer. And that, to tell the truth, can extend to a great number of Coué's patients, who heal to the extent that they believe either in Coué, or in the efficacy of the "method", or, at least, in the existence of the "subconscious", that he, and not themselves in naked individual affirmation, will know how to heal them.

Actually, for example, one would like to see if the healing of so many persons — *after Coué's invitation* — as soon as they affirm that they are

cured, would have likewise occurred if it were any of the readers who made that invitation to them. On the other hand, we must note that the various miracles of the saints, at least in Western mysticism, were experienced in the spirit of the intervention of a higher and transcendent power. The same magic is related to the whole of ceremonial, ritual, symbolic, etc., manifestations which are only the necessary substitute for those who do not know how to create the powers of the imagination by means of a positive central initiative, but attain them only indirectly by virtue of the suggestion emanating from a complex of extrinsic elements. Nothing other than this absence of oneself from the principle of a positive initiative, this incapacity to create faith *kath'auto* [in himself], gives the meaning to what is indicated as "grace" in Western theology. However, even if there is grace, conscious autosuggestion is a useless name: for the starting point, it has an unconscious autosuggestion (a hetero-suggestion)—a mystery and a passivity; and then the I appears the instrument of faith, not its creator and the possessor.

Such therefore is the true light under which the requirement emerging from couism must be examined. Now the idea that for the construction of faith an automatic repetition of formula in a state of relaxation is sufficient, is rather ingenuous. First of all, we must note — as was done above — that a great number of persons who succeed with such a method are already hetero-suggested, directly or indirectly, by Coué or by those who tell them about him and his doctrines. In the second place is the fact that the *imagination* or faith is *invariably presumed in itself*; i.e., one does not achieve it starting from something different from it, but rather starting from an initiative that resides in it and not in the peripheral faculties of normal consciousness. So that it is said: "The blind man does not have any possibility of making himself a guide." If the repetition is simply mechanical, if it is not already accompanied by a certain level of interior evidence, it results in nothing, and regarding that, anyone can perform the experiment whenever he wants.

In the East, where these things were studied at their foundation, they likewise recognize the importance of *japa* (repetition) through the “realization” of the so-called mantra (magical formula); however, it is explicitly said that one can do *japa* even a million times, but unless the mantra is “understood”, “awakened” (*sphota*), the *japa* remains a mere flapping of the lips. This “self-awakening” of the mantra is an illuminative moment; of pure inner evidence (so it is said in the texts that “awakening” the mantra means to realize it in one’s essence “made of light”, *Jyotirmaya*), which can be propitiated and intensified from repetition, but not generated, for that demands a true spiritual spontaneity, an effective passing of consciousness from one “dimension” to another.

It is a question of the same qualitative heterogeneity that intercedes between the concentration of the fire of a lens over a substance and its sudden burning up—naturally considering the phenomenon not from the physical point of view, but from that of the psychological effect in a spectator. Therefore, it is not necessary to have any illusions of the efficacy of the “method”: one can be certain that wherever it succeeds without a true initiative or inner conversion coming into play to animate it — of which very few are capable — it succeeds not through its own power, but rather through some hetero-suggestion that unconsciously is insinuated into the process. And then, from the practical point of view, the result will be equally good: its spiritual value, in reference to the previously mentioned problem, is therefore nullified.

This is the final installment of **Julius Evola**’s essay on **Emile Coué**. Section I was an overview of couism, Section II dealt with it from the psychological point of view, and Section III analyzes it from a metaphysical or spiritual point of view.

The spiritual level overcomes all dualities, so force cannot be understood as working against an “outside” object. Rather, the unmoved mover “acts without acting” in the Taoist and Aristote-

lean sense. Therefore, in conceiving or imagining something, it brings this about “without effort”. Thus, Evola claims that couism needs to be raised up from the unconscious. The “imagination” is a higher faculty (it is one of the “wits” or internal senses. See, e.g., *The Phenomenology of the Medieval Mind*⁷).

In this state, Evola claims, one will have power not just over the body and its vegetal functions, but even over physical nature. Unfortunately, couism itself is just a tool and not a road to get to that state. For that, “faith” is necessary. But faith in what? Does the “I” simply believe whatever it wants, or is there really a transcendent revelation that is necessary? Here Evola seems to fall short. As long as the quicksand of the subconscious is full of “obscure and murky” ideas, the I cannot lift itself by its own bootstraps from that trap.

Section III

In order to specify the meaning of that change of interior level, we can add the following observations. A rather profound truth stands behind the opposition of the will and imagination. We are accustomed to consider force as a near synonym to coercion, to reduce the will to mean *muscular*, but that however presumes an antithesis, a resistance (whether physical or moral), which the I faces and struggles against. All of so-called Western “activism” is based essentially on the concept of tension and effort. Now such a concept of action is fundamentally inferior. Referring precisely to this idea, Lao Tzu was compelled to indicate the mode of spiritual power as *wei-wu-wei*, or acting without acting. It is important to understand this point well.

It finds its best illustration in the Aristotelian concept of *akineton kinoun*, i.e., of the unmoved mover. The one, who is really the cause, does not move: he remains firm at the point of pure creative initiative. Move-

⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3559>

ment takes place only in the effect, in what proceeds from him and of which he remains the master and calm director. In this sense he, properly speaking, does not act: he conceives—he only produces the movement, he causes action without being dragged into the movement and passion, without engaging himself, but *effecting* it and dominating it. Such is the meaning of *wei-wu-wei*.

The same idea is found in the Shakti Tantra. The moment of the permanent (Shiva) is in the positive or masculine power, and the negative, or feminine is that of the dynamic and active power (Shakti). This is in open contrast with the western views which, having lost at this point any trace of the higher mode of the spirit, consider action relating to the simple demiurgic force, passion, manias, mere actuality or spontaneity as positive and masculine, i.e., having its own principle outside itself (and such is the truth of the “evolutionistic” doctrines such as those of Bergson and Gentile). This is, actually, to be called passive and feminine. Hence, even the deep sense of the opposition, in Christian Gnosticism, of the “pneumatic God” to Yaldabaoth, the demiurge God and creator.

The spiritual, by hypothesis, is superior to every antithesis or polarity; the material is instead formed in it and for this reason, its principle is struggle. The same concept of force—just as Guyau correctly noted—arises outside of the relationship to a resistance, so that it, in an absolute way, does not indicate potency, but impotency. Instead, the spiritual never needs to “struggle”, it unfolds in a calm way without fighting. Hence, the profound meaning of the paradoxical aphorism of Lao Tzu, that “truly victorious army is the one that has never fought.”

It is a matter of an inner and subtle action that is irresistible since it is part of the level of a principle, that has nothing against itself, that is entirely and hierarchically superior to every antithesis and polarity of the material or moral plane. This “creative indifference”—as Friedlander-Mynona calls it—that is pure, subtle conceiving, is referred to again, in the Kabbalistic tradition, and the eleventh Arcanum of Force in the Tarot,

in which the symbol of a woman holds tight the jaws of a furious lion *without any effort*, exhibits, precisely the manner of spiritual causality, the mistress of every violent force and every physical determinism. On the other hand, the Lodge, it is in the curious words: "he walks with a stick; therefore rifles discharge with a wave of his hand."

Now, it is precisely such acting without acting that it is necessary to refer to when Coué speaks of the "imagination": the world of this imagination, just as we expressly mentioned, is indeed not an acting in the proper sense, but instead a self-representation, a pure, interior apperception — something that becomes, insensibly and subtly, almost from nothing. The will is, to tell the truth, a principle connected to the physical being and the environment, a product of biological contingencies: it therefore necessarily submits to the limits and the conditions of the life of relation and the material plane. In the "imagination", the reflection of "acting without acting" is instead expressed, or acting without effort for higher spiritual spontaneity. In it, the I can therefore have a true magical organ, an organ by which it can assert itself over whatever eludes the willpower in the strict sense: over its emotivity and over its physiological being, and not only, but even— this affirmation does not seem too audacious—over physical nature.

The day will come in which one will realize that everything that man realizes by means of positive science over nature is only an illusion of power: in fact, it does not truly dominate in the various mechanisms devised by technology, but makes itself the slave and always more dependent on the various natural laws that it presupposes, recognizes, and exploits. And that is because the scientific attitude is essentially extroverted and separative and because its level is that of the I opposed to the non-I and not that of the principle that understands this duality and is interiorly superior to it. The secret of our impotency is precisely this: that we are preoccupied by things, that our action is almost magnetized by them, that it never truly draws its determination from its own interiority. We

put ourselves on the same plane of phenomena or the outer world, although we are subject to its laws. Should one instead place himself for an inner conversion at the level of that which rules phenomena, what external thing could no longer be resisted? Now in "faith", "imagination", etc., there is precisely a suggestion of such a level. If we would know that we do not see or act relying only on a pure affirmation or inner certainty, then we would unlock the realm of the only real power. This is active faith: the popular saying that faith is blind is spot on. But such blindness is not a privation, it is instead a perfection; it symbolizes the pure freedom where the "seeing" here would signify it was tied, it was subject to the law and the principle of the "other".

Coue's merit is therefore to have brought to light the inferior, negative character of the will properly (or improperly) called, in general, that of violent and antithetical action against the subtle mode of a realization without effort that, to tell the truth, stops being "sensible". His defect is not having understood "imagination" as a higher level of the spirit, but of having substantialized it superstitiously in a type of distinct entity opposed to the conscious I, to be used via small expedients. His method acutally does not center on the I in the role of the "imagination", but seeks instead to excite it from the outside through the technique of relaxation and repetition. Thus, in order to empower the conscious individuality, to elevate its pure energy to the luminous peak of a pure act, couism estranges the I from itself, doubles it in a type of hysterical dissociation. Then the imagination adopts the obscure murky power of the subconscious, studied by psychoanalysis that, in such cases, has this advantage over couism: it seeks to penetrate and resolve it in clear consciousness, where couism does not care about that, but only to make it work. And such a scission, admitted in principle, brings a serious consequence. If the subconscious then comes about as a distinct entity, man will also be able to dominate with it this or that element that previously eluded him, he will also be able to make his warts and his asthma disappear, but never

will he be able to guarantee an autonomy to what he wants and that he can only be the effect of obscure subconscious processes, which he does not know, nor can he know anything about them.

The same reasons in the name of which he could use or subject the subconscious—given also that he succeeds in it — would be able in their turn to be just the symbols of subconscious impulses: every freedom could be only the peripheral appearance of the instrument of an irrational and impenetrable force.

This essay on couism and its problems that arise from it suffices for now. Everyone sees that it is a matter of passionate questions, which would merit being considered and amplified rather more than what has so far been done.

Posted on 2013-12-16 by Aeneas

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scardanelli on 2013-12-19 at 10:41 said:

Thank you for this translation Cologero. It has been extremely useful to me in clarifying Tomberg's third letter and the concept of sacred magic.

Here's wishing you and your family a Merry Christmas. I offer my prayers for health and wisdom for you and all of the readers of Gornahoor.

"Thou, chaste Moon, full of joy,
Favour, since thy Apollo now reigns,
The Child who was born this day.
He alone will cast iron out of the world
And populate both Poles with
A most precious lineage of gold"

8.7 The Healing Power of the Mind

Although **Emile Coué**, who originated the affirmation, "Every day, in every way, I am getting better and better", may not be so well known

today, his influence is nevertheless very great indeed. Anyone on facebook cannot help but notice the constant flow of “positive affirmations” in his feed, which is undoubtedly part of Coué’s legacy. While I agree it is fine to think positively when appropriate, it often rises to the level of superstition. I knew a woman who refused to dance the tango with me because she felt the music was too sad.

It may even become delusional when the hard facts of life confront us. Prince Siddhartha’s life was totally altered when he came to terms with illness, ageing, and death; positive thinking alone cannot prevent them. In the teaching of the dominant religion closer to home, the loss of the Primordial State brought death, toil, and pain to the human race. The solution to death has to come from the outside, not from nice thoughts.

Evola, however, was quite interested in Coué and devoted a longish essay about his teachings⁸. Evola related Couéism to the “acting without effort” of Taoism, using language not unlike **Valentin Tomberg’s** description of the Juggler or Bateleur⁹. But before offering up the translation of that effort, I would like to provide a little background for comparison and contrast to Evola’s views. On the one hand, we will use some concepts from German philosophy to make a plausible case and also Fr. **Alois Wiesinger’s** comments from his book *Occult Phenomena*¹⁰.

The Soul Principles of Healing Fr. Wiesinger devotes several pages to Couéism. First of all, he notes the well documented possibility of the healing disease through interior powers. This is not implausible when we recall that the body is the form of the soul, so that changes in the soul life can and will affect the body. As a trivial example, we can note how erotic thoughts effectuate bodily changes. Fr. Wiesinger notes that

⁸See Section 8.6 in this book.

⁹<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/personal-effort-and-spiritual-reality>

¹⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/occultPhenomena.pdf>

there are in the subconscious those purely spiritual powers of the soul which are remains of preternatural gifts. Sometimes these can achieve wonderful results.

There two principles that account for Coué's success:

- Every thought strives towards its own realization
- The law of effort produces an opposite effect.

In the first law, the more a thought is entertained, the more the nervous system will seek to realize it. That is, the sense-stimulus nerve system will create a pathway for the motor nerve system. There are some drawbacks, the most obvious of which is that the vegetative soul is not very responsive to conscious control. (E.g., you don't digest your food by thinking through the process of digestion.) The other more subtle one is that every thought engenders some doubt, which may negate the original positive thought. Hence, Coué turned to the subconscious for the second principle. Fr. Wiesinger explains:

When the will commands an act, then the reason judges whether such an act is possible, reasonable, useful, etc., and so by its doubts and reflections prevents the first law from being effective.

Hence, the positive suggestions need to take place in an altered state, i.e., a "half-sleep", or "alpha state", and so on. That is why so much operative magic relies on techniques to quiet the conscious mind in order to reach down into deeper states. These states are more receptive to auto-suggestion and don't give rise to doubts. The modern Westerner is too dependent on reflection and the conclusions of science, so he finds it difficult to reach such states. Hence there results a self-fulfilling prophecy. This is unlike Jesus' teaching recorded in Mark 11:23:

Amen I say to you, that whosoever shall say to this mountain, Be thou removed and be cast into the sea, and shall not stagger in his heart, but believe, that whatsoever he saith shall be done; it shall be done unto him.

Although Fr. Wiesinger devotes several pages of examples, including those from Christian Science (a close relative of New Thought), we can skip past them for our purposes. The main points of interest are these:

- To be effective the discursive mind must be repressed. Evola refers to this as the First Trial¹¹. Valentin Tomberg also makes clear that the mind must be silenced.
- The various techniques are of value only insofar as they manage to bypass the chattering mind to reach deeper into one's soul life. Hence, there are no absolute techniques, but only those that are most suitable to one's personal equation.
- Phenomena like healings, astral travel, etc., are not necessarily the result of miracles. Rather they are usually the result of the activities of the spirit-soul over the body, since some vestigial preternatural powers still remain if they can be reached and activated.

Creativity in German Philosophy As should be well known, Evola was heavily influenced by German philosophy, to which he incorporated some elements of Thomism in an interesting way. In particular, **Johann Fichte**, following Kant, came to the conclusion that what could be known with certainty was the I and the freedom of the moral will. That concerns the noumenal, or transcendent, will. As this I “posits” itself, it must also posit the non-I so that the moral will has a field of action. Hence, this non-I is a privation and a free creation of the I. As the I becomes more

¹¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

aware of what it has done, it develops, perhaps even up to the point of becoming the “Absolute I” or Absolute Self.

For **Friedrich Schelling**, this creation takes the form of Art. Art is the human equivalent of “*creatio ex nihilo*”, or we Hermetists would say, “As above, so below”. So the question then is to what extent is the creation of the non-I really due to the I. Here, we should rely on the distinction between natural and artificial kinds. Natural kinds are the ideas in the mind of God, the Infinite Possibilities in Guenon’s language. Artificial kinds are the product of human design. It should be obvious, then, that a great deal of our personal and social life is actually the creation from artificial kinds, whether individually or as part of a group.

The course of our lives is to a greater or lesser extent the result of our decisions and our thinking about persons, places, things, and events encountered within it. The boundary between freedom and fate is not always clear cut, but it may be wise to err on the side of freedom. Similarly, our social organizations are also products of the human will. A people arises when there is a common mind on these things. Again, there is a natural social organization, the Traditional one, but even within that framework, there is ample room for human creativity and, unfortunately, the anti-creativity resulting from weakness, ignorance, and malice.

Here we see the possibility for the clash of worldviews. In this scheme, to some extent the “best” worldview will prevail, the one that leads to survival and thriving and is best aligned to the natural kinds. Nevertheless, passion and strength of will also have a lot to do with it.

Posted on 2013-12-09 by Cologero

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scardanelli on 2013-12-10 at 09:33 said:

“Here, we should rely on the distinction between natural and artificial kinds.”

So, in other words, we must learn to discern the spirits- to recognize the demons and egregores engendered by humanity, and to differentiate between these and genuine spiritual impulses.

It's interesting...since the first mention of New Thought on Gornahoor I have run into it in several places. Paul Foster Case mentions it in one of his books on the Tarot. Another commenter mentioned Lisiewski, who beleives that at the time of its inception, life was simpler and the techiques of New Thought were sufficient to gain the results that it promised. Since then, life has become mush more complex. In the words used here, there are many more artificial kinds of ideas that make it much more difficult for us to gain control. Thus the need to sepearate from discursive thought, to acheive silence.

Michael on 2013-12-10 at 21:40 said:

What is the mechanism whereby thoughts affect the external environment? If I understand New Thought correctly, they believe that everything is made out of God (sorry for putting this so crudely) and that we are emanations of God. Because we are, in a sense, God, we can affect our external environment.

If the New Thought metaphysics are incorrect, how can we affect our external environment via pure thought? I accept that we exercise a degree of control over our bodies.

Scardanelli, what are your thoughts on Paul Foster Case? He has a lot of good insights into the Tarot but seems to come to a conclusion that is opposite of Tradition.

scardanelli on 2013-12-10 at 22:34 said:

My only knowledge of New Thought is derived from what Cologero has shared here, but in a general sense, if the subtle rules the dense, then changes in the soul effect changes in the body. New Thought seeks to use daily affirmations to effect change in the material world. However, since these daily affirmations are only a few of the legion of thoughts, feelings, etc that we experience each day, they are mostly ineffective. Thus, it's not necessarily that their metaphysics are incorrect, but that they misunderstand the nature of the problem and it's practical solution (concentration, silence, the quieting of the mind). This is why Tomberg states that it is first necessary to learn concentration without effort, lest you become a mere charlatan.

As far as Paul Foster Case is concerned, I don't know if i'd recommend him necessarily, but there were a few interesting bits of information that helped fill in some gaps for me in his Introduction to the Study of the Tarot. I really only read it because I found it available as a free PDF.

There seem to be two competing interpretations of the Tarot, a Golden Dawn interpretation which he seems to be involved with and the French Hermetic school of Papus, Levi, Tomberg, etc. He places The Fool before the Magician rather than between Judgement and The World. So his

interpretation won't exactly line up with Tomberg's. The PDF, as well as some other interesting offerings, can be found at the *Ordre Martiniste Operatif au Quebec* website.

francismercuri on 2013-12-15 at 22:37 said:

"New Thought", or at least certain premises therein, deserve consideration. New Thought, and all of its repackagings err not so much in their interpretations of mechanisms of human consciousness, but in their evaluation that human consciousness operates in a vacuum—that it is the single force between "us" and all else. It has value—minimally in encouraging individuals to examine and remain attentive to their thoughts—to master thoughts, perceptions, and reactions to them—aka self-mastery, thus even if some of New Thought's premises and conclusions fall short, this is sound enough spiritual advice. But it roughly ends there.

New Thought often describes itself as a "metaphysical" system. It would be better if it regarded itself as a system (or science) of understanding and operating mind and consciousness in relation to matter, as it does not meet the muster of a "metaphysics". Metaphysics deals with "Total Possibility"—New Thought imposes the limit of consciousness and/or human consciousness in the process of "creating reality" ("we create our own reality" as the famous saying goes), and as such, can not be a true metaphysics (although perhaps more an epistemology, phenomenology, and "psychology").

Many more "traditional models" exist to contrast. In broad strokes there is the "Great Triad" formula—three special "Qi" existing—Tian (Heaven), Ren (Human), and Ti (Earth). Each have numerous subdivisions, characteristics, and qualities. The "band" of human qi that New Thought works with isn't even all of the human state, much less all states beyond human.

In more, and most radically "practical" terms, vis a vis producing "magical" results, New Thought, while only considering human qi, often "fails" when ignoring other streaming qis. "Heaven" in this context becomes astrological factors assessed by the cosmic observer before and during times of working. "Earth" becomes not only the concrete environmental conditions one finds oneself within (including their hereditary lot); but also the type of Telluric energies investigated by things like Classical Feng Shui, or otherwise handled under the guise of "local spirits".

New Thought then, imo, is not a failure, it just requires reassessment, and its limitations need be noted.

8.8 The Logician

Disclaimer: **This post is for amusement only.** What type are you?



INTPs are philosophical innovators, fascinated by logical analysis, systems, and design. They are preoccupied with theory, and search for the universal law behind everything they see. They want to understand the unifying themes of life, in all their complexity. INTPs are detached, analytical observers who can seem oblivious to the world around them because they are so deeply absorbed in thought. They spend much of their time in their own heads: exploring concepts, making connections, and seeking understanding of how things work. To the Logician, life is an ongoing inquiry into the mysteries of the universe.

Art work courtesy of *Aeolian Wind*¹².

Posted on 2021-12-23 by Cologero

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James on 2021-12-24 at 01:33 said:

The unfortunate thing about the popularisation of personality typing is that it is no longer being used as a tool for self growth but either as justification/glorification of infantile survival

¹²https://www.instagram.com/aeolianwind_/

instincts or horoscoping . Nonetheless , there are actual interesting things to be learned from them . The myers briggs system is not as decisively important to Individuation as something as the Enneagram – MBTI is more analogous to figuring out whether you're a right handed or left handed baseball player and allows you , in a material way , to assess your strength at the sport we know as adult life . MBTI , in a sense , belongs to the physical body whereas Enneagram belongs to the Etheric body .

Cologero on 2021-12-24 at 08:46 said:

Yes, James, you are correct. I did the Briggs years ago on a lark because a friend asked me to. I don't need it to know who I am, but I am surprised at its accuracy. I don't know if everyone has that experience.

MBTI is static, but the Enneagram does outline a path of development. Moreover, it requires self-knowledge, not some "objective" evaluation from the outside. I like the analogy to the etheric body. The trend today is to base types on physical characteristics like race, ethnicity, sexuality, etc.

S.P. on 2021-12-24 at 12:27 said:

INTJ in my case, has some interest, although evidently it is only a sample of certain material constants of the personality. Perhaps certain parallels can be seen between such types and spiritual castes.

De Bosit on 2021-12-24 at 13:10 said:

I really got into the Russian version of this (socionics). It's an interesting expansion on the idea with clusters of types that will naturally get along and hate each other, as well as the idea of your „dual“, the perfect mate for you. Generally it goes like that rigid logic types need extroverted feely types who complete them.

I got sick of it when I started justifying my likes dislikes around my own self diagnosed type, and so on.

James on 2021-12-25 at 06:42 said:

Another interesting note that had passed through my mind when examining MBTI was that its functions are based off of the Jungian functions of Sensing , Thinking , Feeling , and Intuition . These can , in a way , map out with what our Friend From Beyond the Grave spoke of in his meditation on The Fool where he explains how we can move from formal logic to moral logic and then "...lastly, intuitive penetration into the very essence of the subject." In other words , Sensing [physical fact] , Thinking [formal logic] , Feeling [moral logic] , Intuition [intuition] .

Now , if we grant the innovation that myers and briggs proposed of 'introversion' and 'extroversion' and assuming that our Dear Friend preferred his intuition to be internal (introverted),

then the MBTI system would dictate , if mapped out to this move from sense perception to intuition , would follow this path: extroverted sensing , introverted thinking , extroverted feeling , introverted intuition .

This pathing , if stacked by "superiority-inferiority" would yield: Ni , Fe , Ti , Se (the shorthand for the above mentioned functions) . This combination of functions is the DNA imprint of the so called "INFJ" Personality type which just so happens to be the personality type of Dante , Plato , and Jung (and , as some would contest , was also the physical component of the Lord's human "personality" [not to be confused with His PERONSHOOD] i.e. just as He had a specific DNA makeup , so , too , did He have a specific personality type).

I have found that MBTI in combination with Enneagram is an almost eerily accurate description of how the stars influence but do not compel . The other rather eerie side effect is that predictions about people's rest state behaviour including myself have become more and more accurate the more I understand the intricacies of the two systems .

Balder on 2021-12-27 at 14:06 said:

INTJ – it seems I'm the Architect. Most of the description was quite right, but some characteristics of the architect I didn't recognize in myself, perhaps because some of the questions were quite ambivalent; I could have chosen both extremities, depending on the situation and on what mood I am. What came to my mind from the term architect was that I loved drawing floor plans out of nothing when I was a child. I would absolutely love to be an actual architect, like designing whole cities after the tree of wyrd / life.

Some Notes on Sex Magick

9.1 Fundamentals of Sex Magick

The road of excess leads to the palace of wisdom.

WILLIAM BLAKE

Several would-be esoterists have tried to convince me that sex magick, particularly the Crowleyian version, is the fast track to enlightenment. They do so apparently on the grounds that since their social life already revolves around sex and drugs, that therefore it would be a natural fit for them. If it were that simple, then any American inner city would be a centre of spiritual enlightenment. Even an experienced Mason has told me that the search for the Grail is really *chercher la femme*, on the grounds that the shape of the cup reminds him of a vagina. I could only conclude that we travel in different circles.

Although there are reasons for limiting the male orgasm — and not out of prudery or some Victorian moral code — there is no doubt sexual energy has been used as a tool for self-realisation. Since Crowley has left

records of his experiences, it seems useful to pay attention. First of all, Crowley's "method of science" means that the sexual experience — even one's own — must be treated with detachment and objectivity. Any one who has attempted this will notice that regarding a sex act as merely physiological significantly changes the experience itself; he will also notice how much of the sexual experience is controlled by the imagination and not the biology.

Crowley's essay *Liber DCCCXI: Energized Enthusiasm* describes his experiences. He points out that the ceremonial use of sex has restrictions that don't apply to the natural physical purpose of sex.

If the act in itself is to be the sacrament in a religious ceremony, this act must be accomplished solely for the love of God. All personal considerations must be banished utterly.

And again,

I need hardly emphasize the necessity for the strictest self-control and concentration on their the celebrant's part. As it would be blasphemy to enjoy the gross taste of the wine of the sacrament, so must the celebrant suppress even the minutest manifestation of animal pleasure.

Crowley further notes:

It is, indeed, of the first importance for the celebrant in any phallic rite to be able to complete the act without even once allowing a sexual or sensual thought to invade his mind. The mind must be as absolutely detached from one's own body as it is from another person's.

Nowadays, Tibetan Buddhism is a rival for the sex magick crowd. Its appeal to its Western adherents is that it is cooler than their parents'

religion and compatible with science. Then there are all the thangkhas depicting the yabyum, again depicting something they fancy themselves to be skilled at when those interminable meditation sessions become fatiguing. Never mind that Tibetan Buddhist sexual morality is identical to that of the despised Roman church; they presume that is a mere detail that arises from the culture of Tibet and not fundamental to Buddhism.

Nevertheless, the Dalai Lama asserts that initiation into Buddhist Tantra is reserved to those who have achieved total indifference to experience. He gives the example that if you don't care whether you are served an elegant meal or a serving of faeces with a glass full of pus, then you are ready for Tantra. It seems that Crowley may have taken this dictum quite literally.

In his book *Carnal Alchemy*, **Stephen Flowers** notes that on one particular sex magick session, Crowley was "forced into an act of coprophagy as a kind of Holy Eucharist." (p. 20) Now Dr. Flowers is a brilliant linguist, a promoter of Germanic languages, and somewhat kinky himself. Nevertheless, he prefers the clinically sounding Greek term, rather than the more colourful Anglo-Saxon equivalent. I myself prefer the elegant French — *manger la merde d'amour* — since it sounds as though it deserves a glossy monthly magazine with scratch-off sniffers.

Posted on 2008-05-21 by Cologero

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Daniel on 2010-09-27 at 22:56 said:

"he prefers the clinically sounding Latin word caprophagous "

... you mean, of course, the clinical-sounding GREEK word.

Leonardo Cavalcanti on 2020-09-07 at 11:57 said:

Crowley was in many ways a charlatan. If he wrote many things that are true, that's because he was merely repeating, but what he really interested in was the counter culture of the subverted West, he acted as an agent of subversion, proving that he was the worst kind of charlatan, because he acted as a wolf in sheepskin.

Cologero on 2020-09-07 at 12:25 said:

I wouldn't disagree. I told a thelemite that Thelema is the de facto religion of the West, or at least of the USA. He couldn't see it.